

TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 1 OF SIX

The Missing Treaty and the War over Entrance Music

Mystery, investigation and classic adventures

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.

Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan’s creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.

Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspectiously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden’s scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [The First War Had a Jacket and the Second Had a Default Setting](#) - page 40. Names, race and who gets treated as the default.

The historical field guide: [Lesbian lives, desire and politics across several histories](#) - page 106.

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The Coalition Has Arrived and Nobody Approved My Throne

"My niggas," I announced, "tonight we make history."

"Tonight you make the table level," Rae said. She put one hand on the wobbling treaty desk and looked at the champagne balanced on its corner. History slid toward her wrist. She caught the glass without looking impressed.

I had advertised the evening as BUTCHES VERSUS STUDS: A NIGHT OF HIGH-STAKES DIPLOMACY. Six rooms of games. A coalition signing. A drag programme. A private casino floor and enough gold trim to make a reasonably secure country reconsider its reserves. The printer had asked whether versus meant a debate. I had said it meant ticket sales. There were no tickets. I was paying for everybody.

The first Great Butch vs. Stud War had happened in 1967 at the Blue Comet Social Club. That was the story I had been told. The story was entirely invented, and within that invention I had already managed to receive three incompatible versions. A borrowed jacket, a disputed jukebox selection and an unsigned peace agreement appeared in all three. The alleged artillery was a handbag full of coins.

Auntie June, eighty-two and still a butch with excellent posture, said she had won. Odessa, eighty-four, a stud everybody called Dez, said June had invented the rules after losing. They arrived in the same car. June carried Dez's bag. Dez was wearing a jacket that June recognised from 1967. I asked whether that was a provocation. "It's chilly," Dez said.

I had promised them a Second Great Butch vs. Stud War with a definitive ending. They had asked whether dinner was included. The veterans were already better at diplomacy than I was.

Kit arrived with a suit bag, a library tote and the posture of a woman who had already decided the sound system was inadequate. "I'm here for the karaoke," she said. Rae pointed at the crooked table. "I'm here because somebody said there would be decent food." I showed them their rival lecterns. They immediately used both to support the table.

"My niggas," Tank whispered, watching my international architecture become furniture repair, "peace is expensive."

"We haven't begun the rivalry."

"Your rivalry is holding up a buffet."

Nia came through the door carrying a fountain pen and wearing a dress that made Rae forget the table for just long enough to look up. Nia was a trans lesbian, a lawyer, and the first person to ask whether the signature page was attached to anything. I told her the lesbian delegation was on the left and the trans delegation was on the right. She looked between the doors.

"I already belong in both rooms. Are you charging me twice?"

"No."

"Good. Your borders are stupid."

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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She took two badges, clipped them together and sat beside Rae. Kit asked for a spare badge because hers would look good on her jacket. Within five minutes my factions had become accessories. I had spent four hundred dollars on velvet ropes to describe people who could simply walk around them.

Mika, the trans nonbinary planner, unhooked one rope and rolled it into a circle. They had a radio, three miniature model hotels in their bag, and a schedule that treated my welcome speech as a removable obstruction. "We're signing a game-night charter," they said. "Not dividing Europe. Move your face."

The face was mine, printed nine feet high on a backdrop. I had been photographed looking toward the future. The future needed the fire door behind me. Tank and Remy carried me sideways while I watched my own expression approach a mop cupboard.

Remy had come to perform as King Receipts. He was a trans man, a drag king, and the owner of a fanfare that began with an actual cash-register noise. Velvet Payroll heard the rehearsal through the wall and came over in a robe that had its own relationship with gravity. "Darling, if that sound means somebody's paying me, play it again."

"It's my entrance."

"Then enter with an invoice."

She wanted a full set, good light and a cheque that cleared. He wanted a microphone that worked and a partner who would stop laughing before the end of his love song. They settled the order of their first rehearsal by playing rock-paper-scissors. I had commissioned a twelve-page dispute mechanism. Nigga, they had used their hands for three seconds and gone back to work.

Shawna found me beside the unused lectern. "You look troubled."

"They're forming alliances without me."

"That's the event."

She kissed me, adjusted my collar and told me that if the signing finished before midnight, we could form a very private bilateral arrangement upstairs. I began caring about administrative efficiency with an intensity my accountant had never seen. I asked Mika whether the programme could be shortened. They handed me my own speech with every page crossed out.

Darnell arrived with the wrong jacket and a contribution nobody had put on the hospitality rider. "Who authorised cocaine at a coalition signing?" Velvet asked. "My fee doesn't include arguing with somebody who thinks his yacht is a personality."

"It's a beautiful yacht."

"Then marry it. The water's already booked."

Rosa pointed him away from the game table. Dre put his casserole in the space he vacated and claimed the blue controller. I started a sentence about Crip diplomacy. "Nigga, I brought dinner," he said. "Don't give the casserole a foreign policy."

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Mercedes tried the microphone. Porsche checked the projector. Kit asked Rae whether she wanted to inspect the mystery games. Rae said yes, provided nobody made her sign an agreement to enjoy them. Nia held up the actual draft. "That clause is already gone."

"You read it?" I asked.

"I crossed out 'irrevocable fun.'"

"That was my best line."

"That's why I used the thick pen."

So here it is, Lillian: two hundred and forty games, six departments, and a summit full of grown people who can disagree about an entrance without surrendering a friendship. You can read the game cards, follow the ridiculous ceremony, enjoy the scenes or skip directly to a title that catches you. Nobody needs a coalition's permission to have a good evening.

I tried one final welcome. "My niggas, the treaty will bear witness to - "

"The table's level," Rae said.

Everyone applauded. Nia squeezed her hand. Kit turned on the karaoke screen. I had prepared a declaration of historic unity, and the first unanimous decision was that a woman fixing my furniture deserved the microphone more than I did.

Fair. Fucking humiliating. But fair.

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Campaign Record: The First War, 1967

A fictional document from the equally fictional Blue Comet Social Club. This is invented family-and-club lore for the comedy, not an account of LGBTQ history.

June drove a bus, saved her tips from a second job, and bought a jacket with a lining she described as expensive. Dez made clothes and described the lining as polyester with ambition. Both remembered the jacket as magnificent. Each remembered being the reason it looked good. On the night in question, June had put a coin in the jukebox. Dez had selected the record. June claimed ownership of the next dance by financial contribution. Dez claimed ownership by taste. The cashier claimed somebody still owed for two ginger ales. Every account omitted the ginger ales until the receipt turned up.

The first engagement occurred beside the coat rack. June asked where her jacket had gone. Dez said a jacket was only borrowed if the owner remembered lending it. June said that was the precise opposite of how borrowing worked. Dez said she looked good. June agreed, which has complicated every subsequent attempt to describe this as a clean military victory.

The second engagement involved the microphone. Neither woman had been scheduled to sing. Both later described the duet as an ambush. The club programme called it an unexpected highlight. A photograph shows them laughing so hard that the microphone has been pointed at a lampshade. June says this proves sabotage. Dez says the lampshade had a better sense of rhythm than the committee.

A peace agreement was drafted on the back of the hall-rental invoice. It provided for alternating jukebox selections, return of the jacket before winter and payment of the ginger ales. June signed the front. Dez signed the back. They put their names on opposite sides of the same obligation and each spent the next fifty-nine years saying the other had never signed.

No armies marched. The event was an extravagant name for a club feud, a dance, a little money and two people who liked having a reason to see each other again. Their friends called it a war because their friends were dramatic. I called the sequel a war because the banner company charged the same amount for any title under forty letters, and I had not counted.

Now the jacket was back in the room, the veterans were sharing a plate, and I had purchased a triumphal arch. June asked which side had won. I said the new coalition would settle the question. Dez looked at the arch. "Baby, the carpenter won."

The summit would hear both accounts. It would negotiate a present-day game-night charter, give the performers a stage, and hopefully finish before Shawna decided my private peace process had missed its final appointment. The old invoice was in a folder. The new invoice was considerably larger. My niggas, history had learned how to charge interest.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Who Is in Which Delegation? Whoever Says So.

Rae is a Black stud lesbian and a bike mechanic who likes detective stories, excellent snacks and a signing table that stands up. Kit is a butch lesbian and librarian with serious opinions about karaoke and no reliable idea where she left her glasses. Their rivalry concerns this particular evening, not a rule about what either label means.

Nia is a Black trans lesbian, a lawyer with terrible handwriting, and a woman who wants a dance with Rae. She belongs to more than one caucus. Mika is a trans nonbinary event planner with a miniature-hotel collection and a suspicious weakness for spectacular staging. They will sometimes improve the plan by making it considerably more expensive.

Velvet Payroll is a Black drag queen who wants a paid show and a properly lit stage. She uses she/her in these scenes. Remy is a trans man and drag king, performing as King Receipts, whose awful puns have survived every soundcheck. Drag describes what they perform; it does not turn the cast into a single gender or orientation.

The veterans are Auntie June, a Black butch lesbian and retired bus driver, and Odessa "Dez," a Black stud lesbian and retired seamstress. Both are fictional. Their 1967 feud is remembered with affection, unreliable detail and an unreasonable interest in who still owns one jacket.

Aiden narrates and pays. Shawna is his wife and has plans of her own. Tank, Rosa, Mercedes, Porsche, Dre and Darnell bring the established Tellings party energy. All the people in these invented scenes are adults. Lillian remains the reader. The new summit cast and relationships belong to this generated companion, not to a claim about the source novels or real people.

The fictional crew's printed chorus is deliberately excessive: fifteen uses of the reclaimed plural on every fixed PDF page, including covers and indexes. It occupies a separate band. EPUB pages change with the reader's font and screen, so the reflowable edition carries the chorus at chapter boundaries instead. The practical cards remain ordinary readable descriptions.

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The Game Card Comes Before the Summit

Pick a genre or a title. Read the short pitch, what you actually do, the main catch and a first try. The longer explanation follows if you want it. The fiction comes afterward. You can understand why a game sounds interesting without reading a treaty, knowing the cast or doing any arithmetic.

The three labels describe editorial fit: A place to start is a promising candidate; Read the catch first identifies an obstacle to check; A more demanding detour is a narrower or harder possibility. The collection includes different levels of complexity. None of these labels describes the reader's intelligence or determines what they can enjoy.

The exact edition matters. An old adventure and its modern remake can ask for different movement, camera and inventory actions. Two people discussing one single-player mystery is different from a game with native co-op. The source notes keep these distinctions visible and leave unsupported features unknown.

The elaborate route is optional. A refusal costs nothing. You can stop, change games, ask for a reminder or prefer conversation. A first try is one meaningful action, not a prescribed duration or a test with a passing grade. This is leisure, not treatment.

The new coalition has no authority over your evening. "Then what are we signing?" I asked. Nia handed me the venue bill. "Your part is very clear." Shawna pulled out the chair beside her. The useful part of the evening was already happening there.

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The Coalition Has Created a Committee to Abolish Committees

Article 1. Enter through any door you like

Choose a department by what you want to do. Book I investigates suspicious people. Book II lets a turn wait for you. Book III looks around. Book IV moves ideas and objects into place. Book V listens to characters. Book VI brings company. A game belongs to one shelf in this Panorama so the count stays honest; its pleasures can overlap several shelves.

For the practical route, choose two titles from a shelf, read the catch, and try the more appealing opening. For the ceremonial route, continue below. The ceremony does not know better than you do.

Kit said the mystery room needed a better name. Rae suggested "the room with the mysteries."

Velvet proposed "Evidence, Darling." I offered "The Aiden Memorial Institute of Suspicion." "You're alive," Nia said. "And still talking," Rae added. Mika printed MYSTERIES on a sheet of paper and taped it to the door. The room became easier to find. My niggas had negotiated a sign by declining to negotiate with me.

Article 2. Name what the evening needs

Write or say up to three actual preferences: no required rush; no separate camera steering; avoid held input; few menus; light reading; little clue tracking; or native co-op. Add any theme you do not want. You can choose fewer than three or add your own.

These are boundaries for the selection, not traits assigned to a person. They can change next time. The record should read "tonight, no camera wrestling," not an assessment of somebody's capabilities. One is useful information. The other is a stranger wearing a clipboard.

A source gap is not permission to promise a feature. If we have not established how a game handles a requirement, its card is a question to check or a reason to choose another game. The optional web finder treats strict feature filters conservatively. The printed cards put the concrete catch beside the temptation.

Rae wanted no sudden rush and a place to put her drink. Kit wanted a story with somebody worth arguing about. Nia wanted to sit beside Rae. I began assigning each wish a ministry. "Nigga, hers needs a chair," Tank said. Nia pulled one over herself. The coalition resolved its first territorial question by moving furniture six inches.

Article 3. Choose a row, because the binder demands coordinates

Each department has forty cases. Pick one of five rows: 1, Quietly Curious; 2, Ready for a Conversation; 3, Willing to Inspect a Thing; 4, Here for the Atmosphere; 5, Open to a Wildcard. These are ceremonial mood names. They do not certify that every game on a row meets that mood; the actual card and preferences decide that.

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Choose a row freely. If you want dice, roll one ordinary six-sided die. Results 1-5 select that row. On a 6, visit the Incident Desk once and then choose a row yourself. There is no recursive reroll trap. The Incident Desk has had its authority to extend the evening revoked.

I called the mood rows a psychological instrument. Mika asked who had calibrated it. I said I liked the typeface. Velvet selected Here for the Atmosphere while adjusting an earring large enough to alter it. "My niggas, an instrument," Tank said, "is what Mercedes is trying to play while you explain the fucking menu." I left the mood rows to their modest work.

Article 4. Select the object whose paperwork you distrust

Choose an emblem, or roll an eight-sided die: 1 Envelope, 2 Key, 3 Plant, 4 Map, 5 Teacup, 6 Spare Chair, 7 Gold Stamp, 8 Clock. Read the corresponding column of the department's five-by-eight route grid.

The grid gives a case number. For example, department 1, row 2, emblem 3 gives local case 11, P011. Department 6 at those same coordinates gives P211. The same coordinates in different departments lead to different games. This is either a filing system or a multiverse, depending on whether you are speaking to Shawna or me.

Remy chose the Gold Stamp because it matched his jacket. Kit chose the Key because hers were missing. Rae selected the Spare Chair and immediately sat in it. I tried to explain that it was symbolic. "Then symbolically get another one," she said. Nia moved her bag. We had a perfectly good emblem and an actual seat, and I was the only person dissatisfied.

Article 5. Optional: give the evening an outrageously specific title

Write one short session trait. Examples: "Two Detectives, One Sandwich"; "The Map Can Come to Me"; "I Want to Know What She Meant by That"; "A House with Excellent Stopping Places"; "The Plant Is Lying"; "My Friend Has the Other Controller." A trait describes a taste or a situation, not a diagnosis.

Whenever it helps explain why a title sounds interesting, point to it. That explanation is already useful. You do not need a numeric bonus to care about a haunted town or a witness with a suspicious alibi.

If you enjoy the machinery, begin with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. Spend one to add two to the paperwork total OR reroll all four paperwork dice once. At most one token per selection. Refusing costs nothing; tokens never buy exceptions to preferences.

Velvet named her trait Paid Before the Encore. Remy chose Entrance Music Longer Than the Entrance. I wrote Historically Indispensable Host. Shawna put a line through indispensable. "Keep the rest," she said. "You did book the room." My niggas had discovered the cheapest possible way to reduce a national monument.

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Article 6. Four dice that cannot be cashed at the bar

Roll four ordinary six-sided dice. Each 1 or 2 means minus one, each 3 or 4 means zero, and each 5 or 6 means plus one. Add the four values. Your paperwork total is between minus four and plus four. This optional layer draws on Fate's familiar signed-dice idea; the surrounding selection rules are original Panorama rules.

If you spend a Stamp Token, either add two or reroll all four dice once and use the new total. You cannot buy a second modification on this selection. Reset to three tokens whenever you begin a new browsing session; no ledger needs to survive dinner.

The dice can produce a total from minus four to plus four. A +2 stamp can raise that part to plus six; the separate refreshment adjustment can add another zero, one or two.

Kit rolled and began calculating. Rae watched her pencil. "You always look this serious?" "Only when somebody's pretending numbers are fate." Nia smiled into her glass. Velvet asked whether a plus two could extend her set. Mika said the arithmetic selected a game. "Fine. My contract selects the encore." Two systems, both suddenly clearer than mine.

Article 7. Optional: the snack amendment

Record a separate snack adjustment: one if somebody has already brought the drink they wanted, plus one if wanted snacks are within reach and no one is expected to fetch them. The maximum snack adjustment is two. Keep it separate from the dice-and-stamp paperwork total; Article 8 adds it exactly once. If these conditions are irrelevant, use zero. This arithmetic is a joke about hospitality; nobody needs to eat or drink anything to participate.

Do not delay choosing a game to qualify for this amendment. Do not make a snack score into a task for somebody else. The best possible snack state is people having what they actually want.

Rae negotiated for better crisps. Kit supported her motion immediately, which spoiled my photograph of historic rivalry. Dre set down the casserole and Tank became the first delegate to support the amendment with both hands. "My niggas," I said, "let the record show - " Rosa gave me a plate. For once the record benefited from silence.

Article 8. The entirely unnecessary formula

First find the local case from the grid: eight times (row minus one), plus emblem. Add the paperwork total and the snack adjustment, if you used them. If the result exceeds forty, subtract forty until it is 1-40. If it is below one, add forty until it is 1-40. Otherwise keep it. The final local case number is always between 1 and 40.

Then add forty times (department minus one) to get the complete P-number. Department 3, row 1, emblem 2 starts at local case 2. A paperwork total of minus three and a snack adjustment of one gives zero. Wrap zero to forty. In department 3, local case forty is P120.

This is a shelf address. It is not a probability of enjoyment, a cognitive score, a ranking, or an instruction to buy something. It chooses a page to consider. Read that page's ordinary fields before treating it as a candidate.

If arithmetic gets in the way, use the offline finder or choose directly.

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Mika checked the formula. Nia checked the example. Rae checked whether Kit was using the back of the menu as scrap paper. I asked who was checking the atmosphere. Velvet looked over her shoulder. "I invoiced you for that, darling." The shelf address survived the inspection. My claim to be essential did not.

Article 9. Read the game first; Aiden can wait

Read the short pitch, what you do, main catch and first try before the longer comic scene. The full appeal and catch give the detail behind those summaries. Aiden's scene and verdict are fiction; a funny reason is not evidence for a game feature.

Check the exact edition and platform. A remake can change movement, menus and saves. A touch port can differ from a desktop pointer. A Steam store date may be the port's date rather than the original release. Local co-op, online co-op and two people discussing a single-player game are not interchangeable.

If the card conflicts with a real preference, reject the candidate. If it is promising but has an unresolved operation, check that specific operation before investing in it. "Can we select this inventory object comfortably?" is more useful than "Is this an easy game?"

The screen showed a beautiful landscape. I declared it perfect for everybody. Kit asked about the camera. Rae asked about holding buttons. Nia asked which edition I was looking at. "My niggas," Tank said, "you can't answer a control question with a sunset." I turned the card over and read the part I should have read first.

Article 10. The appeals court

You may make one ceremonial appeal or skip the ceremony entirely. To appeal, choose a neighbor: the previous local case, the next local case, or the same local case in another department. Wrap case 1 backward to 40 and case 40 forward to 1. Check the new card as usual.

After that one appeal, stop calculating. Choose either candidate, browse the direct index or close the book. Every route ends with a human decision; there is no compulsory loop, escalating fee or penalty for declining both.

If you would rather talk, talk. If you would rather stop, stop.

I appealed the seating chart because I was no longer in the middle. Nia asked whether I wanted to be near Shawna or near the photographer. I said both. Shawna held out her hand. The photographer moved to the buffet. My niggas, a constitutional crisis ended with one entirely reasonable choice, and I did not require a second hearing.

Article 11. A genuinely useful first session

Load the chosen edition before introducing its controls. Show one meaningful action. Keep a reminder if wanted. Find pause, save or exit so leaving feels ordinary. Do not turn a trial into a lesson with a hidden passing grade.

For a mystery, that might mean one conversation or one clue. For an exploration game, a nearby path and a place to stop. For a turn-based game, one decision with the menus already explained. For co-op, agree who wants which role and whether the roles have equal kinds of action.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Stop, change games or take a break whenever wanted. A day off makes room for leisure; it does not require a whole day of screen time. The useful note afterward is a sentence about what was enjoyable and where to resume.

Rae tried one clue. Kit had a theory. Nia listened and then offered a different one. Nobody asked me to introduce the game. I stood there with the microphone until Mika took it gently out of my hand. "There," they said. "Your first useful action." I went to find Shawna, who had saved me a seat without establishing a department for it.

Article 12. What these departments are allowed to claim

This is a researched, source-linked candidate catalogue with original comic writing. Game descriptions were checked against publisher, developer, platform or identified supporting sources. Control classifications and first-trial suggestions are editorial judgments unless tied to an explicit declaration. No card claims a complete-path playtest.

The catalogue deliberately contains different levels of complexity. Turn-based strategy and elaborate deduction belong here only for readers who want those specific demands. The direct index and catches let you pass them by. "There are two hundred and forty games" does not mean "all two hundred and forty will suit the same evening."

The offline finder uses the same case IDs as the books. It makes no network requests and does not inspect your library. Marking a title interesting does not install or buy it. Its strict feature filters require stated evidence; an unknown is not silently accepted.

I announced that the catalogue proved universal happiness was possible. Velvet asked whether I had tried every game. "Not personally." "Then put that on the same fucking poster." Nia uncapped the thick pen. My niggas, an honest limitation arrived with better handwriting than my slogan, which was impressive because Nia's handwriting was terrible.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Twelve optional declarations of personality

1. Two Detectives, One Petty Rivalry. Choose mysteries you want to discuss. Conversation beside a single-player game is not native co-op.
2. The Coalition Can Bring the Map Here. Prefer a desk, static scene or fixed framing; check the actual movement and camera.
3. Velvet Has Questions for the Ghost. Supernatural stories may appeal; horror and bereavement still deserve a look.
4. Three Caucuses, One Comfortable Chair. An intimate setting can contain a rich story. A small world does not guarantee simple decisions.
5. My Turn Is Not a Diplomatic Emergency. Turn-based candidates can wait between choices while still having complicated menus.
6. You Have the Controller; I Have a Theory. Agree whether you want co-op, shared discussion or passing the controls.
7. The Plant Has Refused to Sign. Observation and occult mysteries; check the reference-book and clue-tracking work.
8. Rae Fixed the Treaty Table. Building can be absorbing. Confirm the desired mode and its control demands.
9. Nia Came for the Story and Stayed for Rae. Character interest can motivate a game; reading load and choice pressure remain separate questions.
10. Mika Reopened the Side Door. Explore because the place interests you; test movement and looking around before a longer journey.
11. The Puzzle Can Wait for the Encore. Use evidence about untimed play. A funny trait cannot establish a feature.
12. Aiden Has No Veto Over My Evening. Choose directly, stop or change your mind without spending a token.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The incident desk

1. The rival lecterns form a table. Rae and Kit cooperate before Aiden can photograph the rivalry. Choose a row; repairing the furniture does not change a game feature.
2. Three badges, one delegate. Nia sits with both caucuses. Aiden orders another badge and receives another bill. Choose a row; no identity adds or subtracts points.
3. The drag programme has a rider. Velvet finds an unpaid rehearsal in the schedule. Mika finds a pen. Choose a row while the performance gets its own agreement.
4. King Receipts enters twice. Remy wants the cash-register fanfare to land properly. The second entrance is worse and he enjoys it more. Choose a row; no encore roll.
5. The cocaine is not a centrepiece. Darnell misunderstands the hospitality plan. Rosa clears the game table and Dre puts down dinner. Choose a row; no fictional drug affects the route.
6. The karaoke caucus expands. Kit starts a song and discovers Rae knows the harmony. Aiden loses his scheduled welcome slot. Choose a row.
7. The trans delegation has the actual key. Mika opens the side room everyone has been debating. It contains chairs. Choose a row; you do not have to hold a meeting to sit down.
8. A dance enters the minutes. Nia asks Rae directly. Rae says yes. Aiden tries to record a historic development and is told to find his own wife. Choose a row.
9. The blue controller has no foreign policy. Dre calls dibs, then offers to swap when somebody wants that seat. Aiden abandons his theory about international colours. Choose a row.
10. The treaty pen is a eyeliner pencil. Velvet retrieves her property. Kit lends an ordinary pen. Choose a row while the summit discovers affordable stationery.
11. Private negotiations upstairs. Shawna and Aiden leave their own agenda out of the public record. Tank can say choose a row without a ceremonial sash. Choose one whenever wanted.
12. The portrait receives no reimbursement. All caucuses agree the giant picture of Aiden was his own decision. Choose a row; unanimity is occasionally very inexpensive.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 1. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P001	P002	P003	P004	P005	P006	P007	P008
2. Ready for conversation	P009	P010	P011	P012	P013	P014	P015	P016
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P017	P018	P019	P020	P021	P022	P023	P024
4. Here for the atmosphere	P025	P026	P027	P028	P029	P030	P031	P032
5. Open to a wildcard	P033	P034	P035	P036	P037	P038	P039	P040

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The Veterans Have Seen My Welcome Package

“Nigga, why have you declared war at a hotel?” Shawna asked.

The banner was still rolled up. That should have bought me time. Unfortunately, my wife could read the invoice. THE SECOND GREAT BUTCH VS. STUD WAR occupied its own line, directly above PREMIUM UNFURLING ASSISTANCE. I explained that war was a metaphor. She pointed at the next line. “Then why does your metaphor need a smoke machine?”

Auntie June arrived before I could develop a defense. Eighty-two, retired bus driver, Black butch lesbian, blue suit sharp enough to separate me from my excuses. Odessa, whom everyone called Dez, followed with a garment bag over one arm. Eighty-four, retired seamstress, Black stud lesbian, looking at June like she'd been returning the same overdue library book for fifty-nine years.

“The first war wasn't about the jukebox,” June said immediately. “It was about principle.” Dez took off her glasses. “It was about you putting your song on six times.” “People liked it.” “People left, nigga.” The legendary Blue Comet Social Club feud of 1967 had three surviving accounts, all contradicted by the two surviving people telling them. There was a borrowed jacket, a hall-rental agreement each swore the other had never signed, and a peace dinner that apparently ran out of potato salad before peace could develop.

I had heard this story at a cookout and made the reasonable leap to hiring a casino convention floor. My invitation promised rival entrances, a game night, and a coalition summit to settle unfinished business. June had accepted because she wanted to hear her song on a good system. Dez had accepted with June's jacket in her garment bag and a counterclaim about decades of excellent alterations. Everybody else had accepted because I'd said there would be food and interesting games. The relationship between those objectives and my budget was already deteriorating.

Rae arrived with a bike helmet under her arm and examined the signing table before saying hello. Black stud, mechanic, detective-story enthusiast, a woman capable of diagnosing a wobble from six feet away. Kit came behind her carrying a karaoke folder and asking where her blue entrance light was. White butch, librarian, soft voice, powerful opinions about a chorus. I gave them separate welcome packets. Kit opened hers. “Mine says we're bitter rivals.” Rae looked at the crackers. “I'm bitter about these.” They went together to find better ones.

Nia, a Black trans lesbian and femme, had received two packets, one for the lesbian caucus and one for the trans delegation. “Do I get two dinners?” she asked. “Only if you can carry both,” Rosa said. Nia smiled and stayed near Rae, who was making an excellent argument for actual olives. The contract lawyer had promised to inspect our evening's agreement. She had not promised to spend her whole night lawyering. Her other objective was a dance, though she hadn't yet decided how to ask for it.

Mika, our trans nonbinary event planner, put a tiny model hotel beside the registration tablet. “For scale,” they said. I thought they meant my ambition. They meant the floor plan. Velvet

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Payroll, a Black drag queen with exquisite timing, swept in with a garment rack and a payment schedule. Remy, a trans man whose drag-king name was King Receipts, followed with a crown and the world's most aggressively cheerful fanfare. Velvet needed stage time. Remy needed a microphone that worked. Mercedes needed both of them to let her finish soundcheck. Porsche needed me away from the recording equipment.

Shawna took my hand. "I need my husband for part of tonight." I assured her that the husband was in exceptional operating condition. "Then stop leasing him to your own decorations." She looked beautiful, amused, and very close to putting me in a cupboard until I could behave.

Mika handed Rosa the silver folder while she cleared registration. Somewhere in that transfer I decided the welcome sign needed a stiffer backing. Elsewhere, I put the ceremonial pen down while checking my portrait. These were small decisions. History enjoys waiting until small decisions have become expensive before telling you which ones mattered.

June and Dez took chairs beside the first mystery game. The banner came down crooked. Tank stared at it, then at me. "These niggas wanted a party. You bought them a sequel." I reached for the folder to explain the agenda. It was gone. The pen was gone too. Shawna smiled without mercy. "There. First mystery."

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P001 / A PLACE TO START

The Blackwell Legacy

Edition considered: PC original game; current publisher patch must be recorded

Meet a reluctant New York medium and her sharp-tongued ghost partner in a compact mystery built around their developing relationship.

What you do. Talk with people, follow notebook leads, and connect names or clues while revisiting places in a supernatural investigation.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Names and notebook combinations take tracking; verify manual speech advance, and consider the suicide and bereavement themes.

Why it might click. A compact New York supernatural mystery joins a reluctant medium to a sardonic spirit guide. Conversations and notebook connections make discovery feel personal; the developing partnership offers more reason to continue than simply clearing another puzzle.

The full catch. Notebook combinations, returning to locations, and remembering names remain real work. Suicide and bereavement are central. Reviews report no timed or dexterity challenges, but this is not a complete-path playtest. Current desktop patches offer manual speech advance through a Ctrl+P toggle; verify it waits.

Try this first. Set manual speech advance if you want it, with help if useful. Try one conversation and one notebook lead, then decide whether these two people are company worth keeping.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P001 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Blackwell Legacy

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ghost Delegation Has Arrived

I reserved a seat for Joey Mallone because Blackwell had a ghost partner and our summit had an attendance minimum. One more delegate could keep the hotel from charging for empty chairs. Rae lifted his name card. “Does he want chips?” “He transcends appetite.” Tank reached around her. “Then he transcends these.”

Kit was trying to hang her entrance banner without covering the screen. Her reading glasses slid down her nose. She pushed them up, looked at Joey’s chair, and asked whether an invisible guest also needed an entrance song.

“Something haunting,” I said. Mercedes played three notes from the invoice notification on my phone. The whole fucking room recognized it.

Our Rosa watched the medium get another unwanted responsibility. “That’s my supernatural power too.” She handed me the catering form. I tried passing it to the ghost delegation.

Rae sat in Joey’s empty chair and held the screen steady for Kit. Tank kept the chips. Nigga, even the dead were organizing more effectively than me.

Aiden’s verdict. The ghost partnership may earn your curiosity; follow the plain notes first. At our summit, the invisible delegate has already lost both his vote and his snacks.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher premise and developer Ctrl+P patch notice; timing description is a secondary review, not current complete-path testing. PC original only.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/80330/>

Source 2: <https://steamcommunity.com/app/80330/allnews/>

Source 3: <https://www.keengamer.com/articles/reviews/the-blackwell-legacy-review/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P002 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Darkside Detective

Edition considered: PC first game; current accessibility build must be recorded

Investigate small, absurd paranormal cases with a recurring comic detective partnership, using static scenes that keep the focus on dialogue and objects.

What you do. Inspect objects, read conversations, and try using inventory items on the scene or on one another to advance a case.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Inventory dragging, small hotspots, and pipe or tile puzzles need checking even though timed input is not declared.

Why it might click. Comic paranormal investigations offer a recurring detective partnership and short case boundaries. Static scenes let attention settle on objects, dialogue, and absurd situations rather than keeping an avatar and camera moving together.

The full catch. Current Steam metadata declares play without timed input. That does not mean hold-free: PC reviews describe dragging inventory items onto objects or other items. Pipe and tile puzzles also appear. Text reading and small hotspots deserve an actual check before treating this as comfortable.

Try this first. Begin the first case, inspect one object, and test one inventory drag. Check that text advance and the save/exit route feel understandable before continuing.

Aiden’s complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P002 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Darkside Detective

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Haunting Has a Lighting Rider

Kit wanted blue light for her entrance. Rae wanted enough ordinary light to find the signing table. I promised both and pressed the button marked ATMOSPHERE.

The ballroom went purple. A motor groaned behind the curtain. Tank said, “Nigga, your atmosphere sounds like it owes money.”

We had The Darkside Detective on a monitor, which encouraged me to identify the groan as a paranormal case. Mika opened the curtain. My rented revolving platform was trying to turn beneath a refrigerator.

“That isn't a ghost,” they said. “That's your champagne presentation.” I said presentations required mystery. Rae unplugged it before the mystery required a fire report.

Kit found a separate lamp and aimed it at the table. Then she restored her blue entrance light. Two useful decisions, neither of which required me to say haunting again.

Remy tried the microphone. “Spirits are high.” Velvet closed her eyes. “Baby, save something for the people who aren't trapped here.” I paid the refrigerator's appearance fee.

Aiden's verdict. These little paranormal cases invite curiosity, with dragging still worth testing. Our electrical mystery ended when somebody stopped listening to my description and looked behind the curtain.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary Steam accessibility declarations inspected. Inventory dragging is documented by a PC review; no hold-free alternative was verified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/api/appdetails?appids=368390&l=english>

Source 2: <https://www.bigbossbattle.com/review-the-darkside-detective/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P003 / A PLACE TO START

Phoenix Wright: Ace Attorney Trilogy

Edition considered: 2019 PC compilation; post-November 2025 update scope

Meet theatrical witnesses and recurring friends in courtroom mysteries where matching a statement to evidence can produce a satisfying breakthrough.

What you do. Read testimony, consult the Court Record, and compare statements with evidence; the updated compilation also offers Story Mode assistance.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Reading and evidence menus are central; automatic text progression may feel rushed, and wrong evidence can incur penalties.

Why it might click. The original trilogy supplies memorable witnesses, recurring friendships, and theatrical courtroom mysteries. Comparing testimony with a piece of evidence can deliver a satisfying click of understanding; the story has room for comedy and emotional stakes.

The full catch. Reading and Court Record menus are central, and wrong evidence can incur penalties. Dramatic music may feel urgent even when the interface waits. The November 2025 update adds Story Mode and Auto-play; automatic text progression may itself feel rushed. Later evidence interactions still need checking.

Try this first. Use the updated 2019 compilation. Start The First Turnabout with manual text advance, compare one statement, and use Story Mode whenever enjoying the next scene matters more than solving it.

Aiden’s complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P003 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Phoenix Wright: Ace Attorney Trilogy

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Objection, the Host Has Bought Another Entrance

Nia saw Phoenix Wright on the screen and asked why my hotel bill described a SECOND TRIUMPHAL ARRIVAL. I said the first triumph had gone well in rehearsal.

“You haven't arrived once,” Shawna said. “You've been here all afternoon.” “Emotionally, baby.” “Financially, too.”

Rae wanted the receipt entered into evidence. Kit objected because her entrance music had been charged to the same line. Suddenly the rival caucuses shared a fascinating concern about itemization. I pointed at Nia. “You're a lawyer. Defend me.” She looked at the receipt. “I'm off duty, and the witness has written his confession in gold foil.”

Remy struck a small gong for order. Its handle came off in his hand. Velvet took the gong away and gave him a spoon. Nobody let me call a recess.

The verdict was simple: one entrance per actual arrival. Kit got her music separated from my nonsense. Rae saved a chair beside Nia. Nigga, the defense had plans after court.

Aiden's verdict. The courtroom ensemble can be wonderful company, with menus and evidence tracking understood. My summit's first ruling limits triumphal arrivals to occasions when somebody actually arrives.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Current Steam declares play without timed input; Capcom November 2025 notice confirms Story Mode for this 2019 trilogy. No hands-on audit of all cases or holds.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/787480/>

Source 2: <https://steamcommunity.com/app/787480/announcements/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P004 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Strange Horticulture

Edition considered: PC current release

Run a rain-soaked plant shop where curious customers, occult questions, and identifying unusual specimens gradually reveal a world beyond the counter.

What you do. Compare plants with the reference book, handle objects on the desk, and follow letters or map clues for further discoveries.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Cross-referencing and dragging need testing; wrong answers raise Rising Dread and can trigger a recovery puzzle.

Why it might click. A rain-soaked plant shop provides a recurring home base, curious customers, and an occult story. Identifying specimens connects looking closely with useful decisions, while letters and map clues gradually widen the world beyond the counter.

The full catch. Books, plants, labels, letters, and a map can create substantial cross-referencing. Desk objects use dragging; a developer patch added a double-click sticky-drag alternative, whose own double-click demand needs testing. Wrong answers raise Rising Dread and can lead to a recovery puzzle. Calm presentation is not simplicity.

Try this first. Identify one customer's plant with the reference book. Compare ordinary dragging with the documented sticky option before adding map exploration or several simultaneous questions to the desk.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P004 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Strange Horticulture

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Plant Shop Has a Catering Complaint

Strange Horticulture inspired me to label the centerpieces with mysterious Latin names. Rosa read one card and asked why I was serving sandwiches beside Something Possibly Fatal.

“Atmosphere.” “Move your fucking atmosphere away from my bread.”

Rae wanted fresh mint for the water. Kit wanted the fern removed from her sightline to the stage. I said the plants were participants in the occult experience. Shawna asked whether the fern had paid a deposit.

Nia inspected my labels. Every scientific name was a cocktail. She turned over the nearest card. “This plant is apparently a Double Manhattan.”

Mercedes took the labels for song requests. Mika moved the tall centerpiece onto a low side table, where it promptly looked better. I pretended that had been my second design proposal.

Rae brought Nia a glass with actual mint. Nia thanked her without making a speech. I tried offering Shawna a botanical surprise. “If that means another fern in our suite, nigga, surprise somebody else.”

Aiden’s verdict. The plant shop’s close observation may appeal, while dragging and cross-referencing deserve a trial. Our centerpiece survived only after its mysterious identity stopped threatening the sandwiches.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher premise inspected; developer patch mirrored on SteamDB supports sticky dragging. No-customer-deadline observation is secondary, not full-path verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1574580/>

Source 2: <https://steamdb.info/patchnotes/8300183/>

Source 3: <https://www.gamesradar.com/have-you-tried-strange-horticulture/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we’re good.

P005 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Case of the Golden Idol

Edition considered: PC 2022 game with current Redux edition; not The Rise of the Golden Idol

Turn suspicious deaths into an unfolding conspiracy by linking the people, objects, and motives visible in carefully arranged crime scenes.

What you do. Inspect a scene, identify its people, and place words into deduction slots to build an explanation that fits the evidence.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Later cases accumulate names and possible words; check placement controls, hints, text size, and comfort with murder imagery.

Why it might click. Static scenes of suspicious deaths become a larger conspiracy as names, objects, and motives connect. The reward is constructing an explanation that fits the evidence, with visual detail and social relationships doing much of the storytelling.

The full catch. Later cases add many names, roles, and possible words. Murder imagery is deliberate, and the grotesque art may not be welcoming. This card concerns the original game with its current Redux edition, not Rise. Check exact word-placement, text size, and hint controls rather than assuming every release behaves identically.

Try this first. Study the first scene and identify the people before attempting its full explanation. Try moving one word into a deduction slot, then inspect the hint interface if curiosity has turned into bookkeeping.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P005 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Case of the Golden Idol

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Golden Idol Has My Chin

I unveiled the centerpiece statue while The Case of the Golden Idol filled the monitor. A bronze-looking man stood on a little plinth, one hand raised toward destiny.

Tank leaned close. “Nigga, that's you.” “An idealized statesman.” “They idealized your stomach.”

Kit found a red velvet rope around it and assumed something valuable had been stolen. Rae said something valuable had definitely disappeared from the budget. Nia asked whether the figure could hold the missing treaty pen.

I placed a pen in its raised hand. The hand bent forward. My idealized statesman now appeared to be demanding a gratuity from a fern.

Velvet examined the plinth. “It rotates?” “For the reveal.” “Put my spotlight on it.” She stepped onto the nearby floor mark and transformed my unveiling into a rehearsal for her number.

Mika let her finish before telling me the statue blocked a cable route. We moved it. Nigga, the first conspiracy in the room was everybody discovering a better use for my monument.

Aiden's verdict. Enjoy assembling a conspiracy if the names and deductions sound satisfying. Our golden idol's secret was a rental surcharge and a much better performer standing beside it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher describes freely investigated freeze-frame scenes; current-edition announcements establish Redux. Drag/hold behavior and full completion were not playtested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1677770/>

Source 2: <https://steamcommunity.com/app/1677770/allnews/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P006 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Syberia

Edition considered: 2002 PC original; not Syberia Remastered

Follow a lawyer through an unusual European world of mechanical wonders, where the journey gradually changes what she considers important.

What you do. Click to explore locations, speak with people, collect useful objects, and use inventory items while following Kate's journey.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The 2002 original has small hotspots, fixed camera cuts, inventory, and repeated travel; complete timing freedom is unverified.

Why it might click. The original Syberia follows a lawyer into an unusual European world of mechanical wonders and unfinished lives. Kate's changing sense of what matters gives the travel emotional momentum beyond collecting the next useful object.

The full catch. This is the 2002 PC original, not the remaster. Click movement removes a separate look control, but fixed camera cuts, small hotspots, dialogue topics, inventory, and repeated travel can still frustrate. The publisher walkthrough's late sections use ordinary interactions; that is not an exhaustive no-timer guarantee.

Try this first. Explore the opening hotel, speak with one person, and test the inventory and save route. Let one useful object establish whether the older interface is inviting before committing to a long journey.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P006 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Syberia

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Automaton Is in the Coat Room

Syberia's mechanical world made me regret nothing about hiring a clockwork-looking greeter. It stood beside registration with brass shoulders, a little hat, and one excellent prerecorded welcome.

Rae walked past it. "Welcome, distinguished chairman." She stopped. "No." I said the greeting was generic. "So is the refund request," she said.

Mika opened its panel while Kit examined the gear decorations. Most of them were glued on. The entire mechanical wonder was a speaker wearing an expensive coat.

Shawna pressed the next button. "Welcome, distinguished chairman," it said again, louder. Tank put a bread roll in its open hand. "Nigga needs something to do."

We found the actual welcome recording on my phone. Mercedes had made it that morning. Warm, brief, no chairman. I had forgotten to send it because I was choosing epaulettes.

Mika replaced the audio. Rae carried the greeter to the coat room, where it welcomed everyone perfectly. My mechanical empire advanced through a cable and an apology.

Aiden's verdict. The journey's mechanical wonders have their own charm; examine the original edition's practical catches. Our greeter improved dramatically when we replaced ceremonial nonsense with an actual welcome.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected original-game publisher description and seven-page official walkthrough, including late sequences. Original PC control scope only; no full playtest.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/46500/>

Source 2: <https://support.microids.com/fr/support/solutions/articles/23000009217-solutions-syberia-1-et-2>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P007 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Unavowed

Edition considered: PC release

Meet an urban-fantasy investigation team whose histories and different abilities make the companions themselves a reason to pursue another case.

What you do. Choose an origin, talk with companions, and use objects or companion abilities to investigate situations and work through puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Inventory and abilities add memory demands; later timing and holding requirements are not fully audited across every branch.

Why it might click. An urban-fantasy investigation puts companions, their histories, and their abilities at the center of puzzle solving. Origins and branching situations give the ensemble room to react differently, making the people a reason to explore the next case.

The full catch. Inventory plus companion abilities creates more to remember than a simple conversation game. Violence, possession, death, and strong language are substantial. Ordinary PC interaction is pointer-based, but urgent scenes and every branch's timing or holding demands have not been fully audited.

Try this first. Choose an origin because it sounds interesting, meet the opening companions, and try one interaction. Verify text waiting and pause on the actual edition before relying on the adventure's slower ordinary rhythm.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P007 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Unavowed

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Everybody Brought a Different Kind of Trouble

Unavowed's companions had different histories and abilities. I announced that our coalition also required a specially selected team. Nia asked whether I meant the people already doing the work. “Exactly. I recognized their potential.” “After they carried your statue.”

Rae could fix the signing table's wobble. Kit knew where the spare lamps were. Mika had the floor manager's actual number. I offered charisma. Tank offered to carry charisma outside if it kept talking. Velvet wanted a team for her costume change, which sounded much more glamorous. I volunteered immediately. She handed me a garment steamer and pointed at the crease I had just made by leaning against her cape.

Shawna watched me concentrate. “Look at that. An ability.” I said I had several she knew intimately. “Keep one of them on the fabric, baby.”

By the time the crease vanished, Rae had fixed the table and Kit had found the missing pen cap. The team advanced. Its founder was still untangling a cord.

Aiden’s verdict. The companions may make the investigation worth learning, with branching input questions still open. My special ability currently involves keeping Velvet's cape away from a chair wheel.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary publisher premise and companion features inspected. PC interaction and content detail supported by review; zero timed inputs across branches remains unverified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/336140/>

Source 2: <https://gamecritics.com/gc-staff/unavowed-review/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P008 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Her Story

Edition considered: PC release

Follow words through live-action police interviews, letting a performance, contradiction, or unanswered question determine which part of the mystery you explore next.

What you do. Watch returned interview clips, type a promising search word, and compare what people say across the results you uncover.

Dialogue / text choices | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Typing and nonlinear recollection can be demanding; convenient hands-free video pausing has not been verified on desktop.

Why it might click. A live-action police interview mystery lets a noticed word become the next direction of exploration. Performance, contradiction, and interpretation supply the interest; there is no avatar or separate look camera between the player and the testimony.

The full catch. Typing, names, nonlinear clips, and remembering what a phrase referred to can be demanding. Convenient video pausing is unverified: player reports describe holding the slider to freeze a clip. Do not assume search-at-your-own-pace means hands-free pause during playback. Crime and relationship material is mature.

Try this first. On desktop, watch one returned clip, test how it stops or replays, and follow one promising word. Keep a short question nearby only if it helps preserve the thread.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P008 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Her Story

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Her Testimony Has a Better Search Term

Her Story made everyone interested in searching a statement by one revealing word. I suggested we search my welcome video for vision. Porsche searched for refundable.

Nothing came up. Tank whispered, “Nigga, that's the mystery.”

The missing treaty had last appeared in a clip I recorded beside the registration desk. We watched me lift a folder, praise my own foresight, then hand it off without looking. The recipient was outside the frame.

Kit asked for the next clip. I had recorded my shoes instead. Rae admired the sheer consistency of a man documenting everything except useful information.

Nia noticed a silver cuff at the edge of the image. Velvet held up both wrists. “These are gold, counselor. Don't implicate affordable jewelry in my affairs.”

Shawna found a later photograph. Mika had the folder, but the photograph didn't show where it went next. I proposed another speech to establish context. Six people said no with strikingly different levels of affection.

Aiden’s verdict. The interview search can reward a noticed detail; typing and video control deserve a check. My footage contributed one cuff, two shoes, and several minutes nobody can recover.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary publisher describes search/watch loop. Pause limitation is dated secondary user evidence, not verified current behavior; Telling Lies controls must not be substituted.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/368370/>

Source 2: <https://steamcommunity.com/app/368370/discussions/0/530645446312998268/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P009 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Excavation of Hob's Barrow

Edition considered: PC release

Explore Victorian folk horror through a suspicious village, bleak moors, and an antiquarian's investigation of a burial mound with unsettling implications.

What you do. Visit the opening village, speak with people, examine clues, and use inventory objects while following the antiquarian's investigation.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Horror and sudden audiovisual moments may feel pressuring; PC inventory dragging and later clue chains need checking.

Why it might click. Victorian folk horror gives its investigation a strong sense of place: moors, suspicious villagers, an antiquarian, and a burial mound. For someone who enjoys unease, the slow accumulation of wrongness may be as engaging as solving the inventory puzzles.

The full catch. Bleak horror, violence, and abrupt audiovisual moments can create pressure without a reflex timer. PC descriptions include inventory dragging. A Switch accessibility assessment reports low pressure and optional holds, but that does not prove hold-free PC play. Later puzzle chains still require remembering information.

Try this first. Try the opening village and one conversation. Test an inventory action and text advance on the exact edition; leave if the atmosphere itself is unpleasant, even if the controls behave perfectly.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P009 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Excavation of Hob's Barrow

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Burial Mound Is a Coat Pile

Hob's Barrow gave our investigation a moody turn. I found a suspicious mound behind the stage and told Rae we might be dealing with a deliberately concealed chamber.

She lifted a sleeve. "We're dealing with coats." "People conceal things in coats." "Usually their arms, nigga."

Kit insisted one coat contained her missing glasses. They were on her head. She removed them, thanked Rae very quietly, and then accused me of burying her entrance banner beneath the mound.

The banner was there. So was a pair of shoes, three abandoned welcome bags, and Remy's little crown. He emerged from rehearsal demanding to know why the monarchy had been interred.

Velvet put the crown on him crooked. "Historical accuracy." Remy bowed, knocked the banner loose, and revealed the hotel map we'd been trying to find.

I claimed the excavation as a success. Rosa handed me the coats. "Then carry your findings to the fucking coat room." Archaeology had developed a surprisingly personal labor requirement.

Aiden's verdict. Folk horror has a distinct appeal when unease is welcome; heed its emotional and input catches. Our excavation recovered a map and made the narrator useful for once.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher horror premise inspected. Switch low-pressure panel and PC drag description are secondary and edition-specific; no blanket control guarantee.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1182310/>

Source 2: <https://www.nintendolife.com/reviews/switch-eshop/the-excavation-of-hobs-barrow>

Source 3: https://as.com/meristation/2022/09/28/analysis/1664375021_208084.html

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P010 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Pentiment

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate a richly drawn historical community where art, faith, class, and personal loyalties give conversations consequences that unfold over years.

What you do. Walk between people, read conversations, and choose which leads or activities to pursue as the investigation develops around the community.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Reading and relationships accumulate; activities advance investigation time, and walking may require holding even without timed inputs.

Why it might click. A richly drawn historical community makes art, class, faith, and personal loyalties part of the investigation. People and consequences unfold over years, offering conversation and interpretation rather than a constant demand for quick physical reactions.

The full catch. Developer accessibility notes state there are no timed inputs or QTEs. Investigation time still advances through chosen activities, which creates decision pressure. Reading is extensive, movement may require holding, and names and relationships accumulate. Narration support differs by platform; do not assume every line is spoken.

Try this first. Try walking and one early conversation with readable text settings. Notice whether choosing a lead feels intriguing or burdensome before promising yourself an entire investigation or an optimal outcome.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P010 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Pentiment

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Illuminated Agenda Costs Extra

Pentiment's historical art prompted me to order an illuminated agenda. Gold initials, curling vines, a drawing of the summit founder in a position of modest authority.

Kit unfolded it. "That's a throne." "Modest for a throne."

Rae wanted to know when the games started. The agenda began with a poem about my generosity. Nia traced a beautiful vine across the paper until it ended at a blank space where the start time should have been.

Mika wrote the time in pencil. I protested that the calligrapher had a vision. "So do the caterers," they said. "It involves leaving before breakfast."

Mercedes liked the border and asked whether she could use it around her set list. Velvet requested the tiny portrait for a joke during her number. Suddenly my commission had three practical uses, none involving the poem.

Shawna folded the agenda into her bag. "I'm keeping this." I smiled. "Sentimental?" "Evidence. Nigga, the next romantic weekend is a beach and two towels."

Aiden's verdict. The historical community rewards sustained attention, with reading and activity choices carrying weight. Our illuminated agenda became useful at the precise moment somebody wrote a time on it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected developer accessibility notes and first-hand interview on activity-based investigation time. Turn pacing differs from decision pressure; actual movement setup untested.

Source 1: <https://pentiment.obsidian.net/>

Source 2: <https://www.mmorpg.com/interviews/the-rpg-files-building-obsidians-pentiment-interview-with-game-director-josh-sawyer-2000126821>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The First War Had a Jacket and the Second Had a Default Setting

June put a photograph on the table during the break. Four women stood outside the Blue Comet in 1967, grinning beside a car whose hood occupied most of the street. Dez touched the corner carefully. June pointed at her own shoulders.

“My jacket.”

“Our jacket,” Dez said. Rae made a low appreciative sound. Nia pulled up a chair. I reached for a microphone. Shawna took it out of my hand before anybody needed to explain why two elderly women discussing a photograph didn't require amplification.

June had bought the jacket with money she'd saved. Dez had borrowed it, altered it, and developed a theory of ownership based on how often people complimented her in it. At one point she'd returned something she described as equivalent. “It was brown,” Dez said. “So was the jacket.” June stared at her. “Aiden, this nigga returned a cardigan.” Tank nearly inhaled an olive. Kit sat down so quickly her glasses slid into her lap.

Dez insisted the cardigan had pockets. June said pockets weren't restitution. Remy wanted to know whether this dispute had inspired the original peace agreement. June said the agreement came after somebody interrupted her jukebox song. Dez said June remembered paying for the record and forgot who'd had the taste to select it. Both claimed the other had left the agreement unsigned.

Kit studied the photograph. “I thought the first rivalry was supposed to explain ours.”

June looked at her. “Which one is ours?”

Kit glanced between herself and Rae, then at the invitation. The design had helped her reach the wrong answer. White butch on one side, Black stud on the other, although my words had not stated it quite that plainly. I had put the faces in separate colored panels and trusted implication to perform the labor I couldn't defend aloud. June, a Black butch sitting directly between them, had become a very expensive problem for my layout.

“I know those aren't mutually exclusive categories,” Kit said. “I didn't invent his fucking invitation.”

“No,” Rae said. “But when he called you the butch representative, you took the good chair.”

Kit's jaw shifted. I recognized the look: a person finding one true detail inside an accusation and desperately wanting to negotiate the rest before acknowledging it. I had worn that look through three vehicle inspections. “I took the chair because I was carrying the music folder. You could have asked for it.”

“Why did I have to ask you?”

The room got quiet in a different way. Not reverent. Uncomfortable. My instinct was to buy something that made a noise. Shawna put her hand on my wrist without looking at me.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Kit said she hadn't felt particularly powerful arriving at an event where the host expected her to be a mascot. At the library she still heard people soften their voices before asking whether she worked in maintenance. She knew what it was to be stared at, to have a woman pull her child closer, to see her clothes become somebody else's public question. "So when you say I just get to be the default, I don't know where that person lives. I'd like her rent."

Rae let her finish. "I'm not saying nobody does shit to you. I'm saying the hotel guy asked you where you wanted the lamp. He asked me which door the contractors were using. Same shoes, same table, same invitation in my hand."

Kit looked toward the corridor. She'd been present for that exchange. "I thought he meant because you were fixing it."

"He hadn't seen me fix anything." Rae wasn't loud. That made it harder for me to hope the moment would dissolve into ordinary party noise. "You don't have to invent my experience out of yours before it counts."

June tapped the photograph. "And don't make me disappear so the argument fits two columns. I've been a Black butch longer than either of y'all has been deciding what to call this seating arrangement."

Dez smiled. "She was a difficult Black butch before breakfast too." June nudged her knee. The laugh loosened the room without cancelling anything that had been said.

I tried explaining that I wanted the invitation to feel bold. Rae turned it over. "Bold for whom, nigga? You get a funny war. I get assigned a whole personality before I even complain about the crackers."

That landed because she had complained about the crackers. I had treated the complaint as perfect character confirmation: of course my stud delegate arrived ready to inspect the room. The fact was less convenient. Rae was a mechanic, liked things that worked, and had been served terrible crackers. I had converted three ordinary facts into a costume that supposedly explained her.

"Stud is a word I learned from Black women who made room for me," Rae said. "It means something to me. It isn't a menu where you order confidence, tools, and whatever voice you think goes with them." She paused. "And yes, I brought tools. I'm not giving them back just to defeat your symbolism."

Kit laughed once, then stopped trying to make Rae laugh on her behalf. "I liked being introduced without having to explain myself," she said. "That's the part I don't want to admit. You said butch like the room would know what to do with me, and I liked it. I didn't ask who you were making explain the rest."

Rae nodded. It wasn't absolution. Kit didn't demand any. She took off the little ribbon I'd pinned to her chair and laid it on the table. Then she asked whether Rae actually wanted that chair. "No. I want the one beside Nia." Rae realized she'd said it plainly and reached for her water too quickly. Nia looked delighted and had the decency to examine her glass instead of conducting a public hearing.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Remy leaned back. “Can I put in one request? Don't turn masculinity into a staircase with me at the top because I'm a man.” He adjusted his tiny crown. “I spent forty minutes trying to glue this straight. Nobody should be aspiring upward into this particular crisis.”

Velvet straightened it with two fingers. “There, your majesty. Social progress.”

He smiled. “Somebody sees Rae, then Kit, then me, and wants one explanation for all of us. It saves them asking a person anything. I'm a trans man. My drag king is a performance. Those aren't interchangeable with being a butch woman, and being a man doesn't make me better at the microphone.”

“Nothing could,” Velvet said tenderly. He kissed her hand in theatrical gratitude for the review.

Kit looked at Rae's jacket. “For the record, that shoulder line is beautiful.” Rae smiled. “Your suit too. You look like you know exactly which song you want.” Kit sat a little taller. She liked her shape in those clothes; Rae liked hers. No correction was required. June watched them with satisfaction. “Looking good is allowed to be part of the politics, babies. Otherwise Dez owes me fifty-nine years of evidence for why she kept borrowing the damn jacket.”

Kit admitted she sometimes felt pushed to prove her masculinity by being unbothered. Don't ask for help. Don't enjoy the wrong song. Don't look too excited when somebody pretty notices you. “I've had gay male friends understand the performance part beautifully, and one tell me I was basically a junior version of him. I told him he couldn't afford my subscription.”

Rae said her friendships with men weren't one category either. One friend asked before helping with her bike; another assumed every repair was an audition for a masculinity contest. “I like the first nigga. The second can hold the flashlight if he learns to shut up.” She looked at Nia, then back. “And I don't want a woman to pick me because she thinks she's bought the reliable man package without a man in it.”

Nia put her glass down. “Good. I'm terrible at assembling packages. I like that you got excited explaining the brakes. You stopped checking whether everybody else was impressed.” Rae's face changed. Mine would have too. It was an intimate observation, and Nia offered it without making either of them a public symbol.

Shawna said she loved a man who sometimes confused being wanted with being required to run everything. I looked at her. “Baby.” “I'm speaking from the archive.” She squeezed my wrist. “Your tender parts aren't a leak in your authority, Aiden. Sometimes they're the only parts listening.”

I had a joke ready and let it go. That cost nothing and felt expensive.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Kit wanted to know what happened next. Not to the world; to our invitation, to the chairs, to the evening. Rae said she wanted the title left ridiculous if everyone remembered it wasn't a map of human beings. Kit could keep her entrance light. Rae could sit beside Nia. June could exist without becoming a footnote that repaired my race chart. The disagreement would not vanish because I found better paper.

I crossed out REPRESENTATIVE on the place cards. People could introduce themselves, and the caucuses could overlap. Kit kept her ribbon for the lamp. June kept the photograph. Dez kept the jacket, under protest. Rosa announced food, and nobody converted dinner into a reward for reaching ideological completion.

Shawna handed me the microphone at last. "One sentence." I looked at the room. "The good crackers are over there." Rae laughed first. Nigga, I had finally made an announcement I could substantiate.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P011 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Old Skies

Edition considered: PC release

Travel through seven historical settings with a time agent and voiced companions, exploring regret and the consequences of changing past events.

What you do. Meet the first assignment, examine objects, follow characters' motives, and work through puzzles involving cause and effect across time.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Death and retry are explicit features; temporal connections increase memory demands, and later input requirements still need checking.

Why it might click. A time agent's work provides seven historical settings and travelers with different motives. Temporal puzzles and a voiced ensemble connect the speculative premise to questions about regret, curiosity, and the consequences of changing what already happened.

The full catch. The publisher explicitly says the player can die and try again. That is a meaningful failure-state warning, not proof of harmless pacing. Temporal cause and effect can increase memory demands, and later timing, dragging, and dialogue advance need an edition-specific check. Some historical settings carry serious emotional weight.

Try this first. Meet Fia and inspect the first assignment before promising a complete excursion. Test ordinary object interaction and the pause/save route; treat any stressful sequence as a reason to reconsider, not an examination to pass.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P011 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Old Skies

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Time Agent Wants Yesterday's Rate

Old Skies put time travel within professional reach. I asked Nia whether a contract could be renegotiated yesterday. She said yesterday I should have read it.

“Nigga, that's what I'm proposing.” “You're proposing a time machine because you rented six chandeliers.”

Mika loved the chandeliers. This surprised everyone until they arranged three over the dance floor and admitted the room looked spectacular. Kit wanted the other three behind her karaoke entrance.

Rae pointed at the empty signing table. “Could one future include a lamp here?” Nia brought her a lamp. She also brought a chair and stayed in it, which seemed like a promising use of the present.

Shawna asked what I would change if we could travel backward. I said I would meet her sooner. She softened. Then I added that we could have booked the room before the weekend surcharge.

Her look traveled several years into my future. “Start over,” she said. I did, using fewer dates and absolutely no pricing information.

Aiden's verdict. The time-travel ensemble offers motives worth following, while death and retry remain real features. My attempt to revise history has been returned for a more romantic second draft.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher description: time-agent premise, historical eras, temporal puzzles, and retryable death. No declared absence of timed sequences established.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1346360/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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P012 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Primordia

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a decaying post-human world with a robot partnership whose banter and discoveries connect a theft to larger questions of belief and independence.

What you do. Spend time with the two robots, examine objects, and connect environmental details or inventory items to solve their immediate problems.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Puzzle connections and revisiting details take attention; the inspected source does not establish timer-free or hold-free play.

Why it might click. A robot partnership explores a post-human landscape and a city whose history changes the meaning of the initial theft. Mechanical decay, belief, independence, and companion banter make its world distinctive rather than merely another collection of locked doors.

The full catch. Environmental and inventory puzzles still ask for connections and returning to details. Optional puzzles exist, but optional extras do not make the main path effortless. The inspected storefront does not certify zero timers, no holds, or a particular text-wait setting; those remain checks, not benefits to assume.

Try this first. Spend an opening scene with Horatio and Crispin. Try examining one object and following one concrete problem, then decide whether the world's mood and puzzle language invite another visit.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P012 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Primordia

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Robot Has Applied for Independence

Primordia's robot partnership had me considering a future without the hotel manager. Mika pointed out that most hotel problems in our room originated with a human called Aiden.

I directed attention to my electronic welcome podium. Its screen read UPDATE REQUIRED. Tank said, "Nigga, even your furniture wants a new host."

Rae opened the little cupboard beneath it and found six charging cables, all for something else. Remy tried speaking through its built-in microphone. The podium answered with a piercing squeal.

Velvet took his arm. "Come sing with the living, baby." He went immediately, carrying his victory fanfare on a tiny keyboard. A machine had lost a romantic man to a better sound system.

Kit fetched a handwritten sign from registration. Clear lettering, correct room, actual times. She propped it against the dead screen and reclaimed her lamp.

I asked whether the podium could remain as a symbol. Rosa set a water pitcher on it. "Now it symbolizes water." The post-human future had an unexpectedly sensible refreshment policy.

Aiden's verdict. The robot world's personality may be the draw, with puzzle and input uncertainties intact. Our technological monument has found a durable career supporting a pitcher of ordinary water.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected exact-game publisher description for robots, stolen core, Metropol and optional puzzles. Control and complete-path timing guarantees were not found in that record.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/227000/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P013 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Strangeland

Edition considered: PC release

Enter a surreal carnival where strange inhabitants and symbolic puzzles explore identity and grief, with optional in-character hints to help interpretation.

What you do. Talk with inhabitants, interpret the surroundings, and investigate puzzle solutions; locate the optional hint system when you want help.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Suicide imagery, repeated death, and grotesque horror are central; alternative solutions do not prove a fully reaction-free route.

Why it might click. A surreal carnival turns identity, grief, and interpretation into an adventure's setting and puzzles. The publisher describes different solutions and meanings, a voiced cast, and an optional in-character hint system, giving the strange inhabitants more purpose than decoration.

The full catch. Suicide imagery, repeated death, grotesque bodies, and horror are central. Alternative puzzle solutions do not establish a fully reaction-free path; the publisher itself contrasts a shooting approach with another solution. Inventory reasoning and symbolic interpretation can also be substantial. Verify actual interaction before relying on a particular route.

Try this first. Read the premise and look at the opening atmosphere before beginning an investigation. If that is appealing, try one conversation and locate the optional hint system; no need to demonstrate tolerance for distressing imagery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, mic check.

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P013 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Strangeland

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Carnival Charges by the Reflection

The carnival in Strangeland made me reveal a surprise: a funhouse mirror wall beside the registration table. I expected wonder. Shawna saw eight versions of my suit and sighed.

“Nigga, one of you already takes up the evening.”

Velvet loved the tall mirror. It made her headpiece look six feet high. Remy preferred the broad one and struck a kingly pose. Neither asked me to explain the symbolism, a failure I tried correcting anyway.

Rae walked behind the mirrors to check whether the treaty folder had fallen there. She found the missing tray of good crackers. Tank had created a private refreshment alcove.

“That wasn't hidden,” he said. “It was intimate.” Kit held up my original party invitation. The same word was printed on the front. Nigga, my influence had become a public health concern.

We moved the crackers into the room. Velvet kept one mirror for her costume check. I stood before the narrowest reflection and told Shawna I still had it. “Then carry it upstairs later,” she said.

Aiden’s verdict. The surreal carnival suits a taste for disturbing material; its serious themes deserve the warning above. Our mirror maze concealed crackers and an unforgivably flattering version of me.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher description explicitly covers nightmare imagery, multiple solutions and hints. No universal timing or hold exemption inferred from those alternatives.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1369520/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P014 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Shardlight

Edition considered: PC release

Follow Amy through a post-apocalyptic investigation where inequality, loyalty, and a search for a cure give her difficult questions personal stakes.

What you do. Speak with people, follow a stated task, and use inventory objects or clues or clues to advance Amy's wider investigation through the setting.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Disease, hunger, and coercion make the story emotionally heavy; complete timing, holding, and dialogue-wait behavior remain unverified.

Why it might click. Amy's investigation gives an oppressive post-apocalyptic world a personal point of entry. The premise puts inequality, loyalty, and the search for a cure into the story, offering a protagonist with a concrete reason to keep asking difficult questions.

The full catch. Disease, hunger, death, and coercive government are explicit parts of the setting. They can make the experience emotionally heavy even during quiet interaction. Adventure puzzles bring inventory and clue demands. The source inspected here does not establish all-path timing, holding, or dialogue-wait behavior; those require a specific check.

Try this first. Try the opening conversation and one stated task only if the setting appeals. Test an inventory interaction and find save/quit before taking on the wider investigation or its darker consequences.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P014 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Shardlight

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ration Coupon Is for the Good Olives

Shardlight's divided world prompted an unfortunate comparison with my VIP snack table. Rae held up two bowls: good olives behind the rope, damp pretzels outside it.

“Who's VIP?” she asked. I named several sponsors. “Can they repair the signing table?” “Probably not.” “Then they're eating pretzels.”

Rosa had not approved the separation. A sponsor had moved the olives beside his banner while she was checking the kitchen. She took the entire bowl back without breaking conversation with the server.

I tried offering the sponsor a symbolic privilege. Mercedes suggested he could symbolically pay the musician. Velvet said she supported that tradition wholeheartedly.

Rae distributed the olives, saving a small dish for Nia. Nia looked pleased until Rae admitted she needed a witness that Tank had already taken three portions. Tank disputed the count but accepted the olives as evidence.

I removed the velvet rope. It snagged my jacket button. The hierarchy collapsed slowly, with me bent over trying to free my own ass from it.

Aiden’s verdict. The story's inequality and loyalties offer substantial material, with disease and coercion central. Our snack dispute ended with shared olives and a host physically caught in his own hierarchy.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact publisher premise inspected, including deprivation and vaccine lottery. Pointer-adventure classification is editorial; no complete-path control verification claimed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/336130/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P015 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Technobabylon

Edition considered: PC release

Discover a cyberpunk society through interwoven perspectives, where a police conspiracy and virtual experiences become questions of personal loyalty and choice.

What you do. Follow an opening protagonist's objective, read conversations, and connect inventory solutions with the developing investigation across different character perspectives.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Three protagonists, unfamiliar terms, and layered motives demand tracking; later confrontations and held inputs have not been fully checked.

Why it might click. Interwoven perspectives bring a cyberpunk city's systems down to individual choices and loyalties. A police conspiracy, virtual experience, and complicated personal stakes can supply a rich story for someone who enjoys gradually discovering how a speculative society works.

The full catch. Three protagonists, unfamiliar terms, inventory solutions, and layered motives increase the amount to track. The publisher warns of mature themes and violence. Point-and-click presentation does not establish that every later confrontation waits indefinitely, nor that every interaction avoids holds; the inspected source leaves those questions open.

Try this first. Follow one opening character and one immediate objective. Check text advance, ordinary interaction, and saving before deciding whether learning this future feels interesting rather than like another system to administer.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P015 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Technobabylon

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Smart Ballroom Knows Too Much

Technobabylon put a connected city on the screen just as the ballroom assistant announced, “Aiden's private strawberries are ready.” The microphone was still live.

Shawna smiled very slowly. “Your smart room's a messy bitch.”

Nia asked Mika to mute the announcements. Mika was busy trying to keep the lighting from following my phone into the men's room. Every time I moved, the chandelier nearest me brightened.

“VIP tracking,” I explained. Kit walked away holding my phone. The light followed her. She stood on her entrance mark, delighted. “Finally, a useful patron.”

Rae found a printed control card beside the tablet. She passed it to Mika, who separated the music controls from my location. The room stopped worshipping my trousers.

Mercedes asked whether the system had also recorded her rehearsal. It hadn't; Porsche had the independent recorder exactly where she wanted it. One person had planned for the future. The rest of us were listening to the hotel repeat that my strawberries were getting warm.

Aiden’s verdict. The cyberpunk perspectives reward interest in complicated systems and motives. At our summit, the smartest person kept her recording separate from the room announcing my private dessert plans.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher account of three protagonists, Central, Trance, conspiracy and mature content. Exact late-game input demands remain unverified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/307580/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P016 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Blackwell Unbound

Edition considered: PC release

Meet an earlier human partner for Joey in period New York, where a ghostly musician and separate incidents suggest a contained supernatural mystery.

What you do. Follow Lauren and Joey through conversations and clue connections, pursuing an opening lead across the living and the dead.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Names and clues need tracking; do not assume this title shares another Blackwell game's speech controls or timing assurance.

Why it might click. An earlier Blackwell investigation changes the central human partner while retaining Joey's sardonic presence. Period New York, a ghostly musician, and apparently separate incidents provide a contained supernatural mystery with a different emotional texture from Legacy.

The full catch. Clues, names, dialogue topics, and switching attention between the living and the dead can still require tracking. This title's publisher record does not certify the same manual-speech patch behavior as another Blackwell game. Do not transfer Legacy's review-based timing assurance or Ctrl+P setup without checking this edition.

Try this first. Meet Lauren and Joey, listen to the first lead, and inspect the actual text and interaction settings. Continue because their relationship interests you, not because a series order has become another obligation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P016 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Blackwell Unbound

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ghost Musician Has a Better Rider

Blackwell Unbound had a ghostly musician. Mercedes wondered aloud whether death at least ended arguments about soundcheck. Velvet said promoters would probably try paying in exposure across the veil.

Remy approached the microphone. “I’ve got a haunting number.” “You’ve got three puns and a keyboard,” Velvet said. “Show me the number.”

He played a little romantic fanfare, surprisingly gentle. Nia stopped reviewing the registration slips. Rae stopped pretending she hadn’t been listening. I saw an opportunity to introduce myself as patron of the arts.

Shawna caught my sleeve. “Let the man finish, nigga.”

Kit wanted the same warm spotlight for her entrance. Remy offered to share it if she stopped calling his keyboard a toy. She apologized to the keyboard first, which he accepted as sufficient diplomatic progress.

Mercedes marked a spot for him beside her piano. The ghost musician onscreen had company in spirit. I had company in person, specifically my wife standing on my foot whenever I inhaled like a man preparing a speech.

Aiden’s verdict. Period New York and the earlier partnership give this mystery its own flavor. Our living musicians have negotiated one shared spotlight and a temporary ban on my introductions.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher description establishes Lauren, Joey, 1973 and connected incidents. Input settings and no-timer claims are not inherited from other series entries.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/80340/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P017 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Blackwell Convergence

Edition considered: PC release

Return to Rosa and Joey for a city mystery linking apparently separate lives through settings shaped by art, film, and finance.

What you do. Explore an opening location, speak with people, use inventory objects, and connect leads through the established pair's investigation in the city.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Earlier character history adds context; inventory reasoning remains work, and this edition's timing and dialogue controls need checking.

Why it might click. Rosa and Joey return to a city mystery whose apparently separate people and locations conceal a larger connection. Familiar characters can make another investigation attractive after an earlier entry, while the art, film, and finance setting gives it a specific flavor.

The full catch. This is a later series entry, so character history and supernatural rules add context to the clues. Inventory and conversational deductions remain work. The inspected publisher description establishes the premise, not a guarantee about timed scenes, held inputs, or current dialogue controls on every version.

Try this first. If the partnership already appeals, investigate one opening location and one lead. Check text waiting and item use on this installation rather than relying on remembered settings from a different Blackwell title.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, read first.

Niggas, we're good.

P017 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Blackwell Convergence

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Film Premiere Is a Ten-Second Clip

Blackwell Convergence brought art and film into the evening, which reminded Porsche she had footage of my first attempt to unveil the summit banner. I requested a private screening. She connected it to the biggest monitor. “Very private. Only this room.”

Onscreen I pulled the cord with magnificent confidence. The banner rolled halfway down, stopped at BUTCHES VERSUS, and dropped a plastic laurel wreath onto my head. Kit laughed so hard she misplaced her glasses again.

Rae replayed the moment my face changed. “That’s when the budget left his body.” Nia wanted a copy for strictly nonprofessional reasons.

I said the clip had been taken out of context. Shawna asked whether the missing context made me better at cords. Mercedes supplied live suspense music for the replay.

Mika finally unplugged the monitor because people were gathering in the doorway. They saved the clip first. Nigga, my coalition now possessed a shared cultural artifact, and I was wearing the fucker in high definition.

Aiden’s verdict. The linked city mystery may reward a returning fan, with its own controls still needing inspection. Our summit’s first film festival has one entry and an extremely unwilling star.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher premise inspected for connected film, office, artist and investor story. Later-series burden is editorial judgment; control guarantees remain unverified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/80350/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we’re good.

P018 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Blackwell Deception

Edition considered: PC release

Join Rosa and Joey in an investigation of fraudulent psychics, personal secrets, and exploitation that also reaches into Joey's buried history.

What you do. Follow conversations and city leads, connect clues, and use the established partnership to investigate people claiming contact with the supernatural.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Death and manipulation are central; accumulated relationships add memory demands, and current input behavior needs its own check.

Why it might click. A mystery about fraudulent psychics lets an established supernatural partnership investigate both exploitation and personal secrets. Contrasting city settings and Joey's buried history may reward someone already curious about these characters rather than only the next puzzle solution.

The full catch. Death and manipulation of vulnerable hopes are central themes. Existing series relationships, dialogue, and clue connections can accumulate. The publisher premise does not establish an all-path absence of timed inputs or holds. Current text advance and inventory behavior should be checked independently of earlier Blackwell editions.

Try this first. Try one conversation and one lead if Rosa and Joey are welcome company. Notice the tone as well as the controls; interest in supernatural mysteries does not require enjoying every kind of darker subject.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P018 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Blackwell Deception

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Psychic Predicts a Separate Invoice

A psychic in Blackwell Deception would have recognized our next guest: a sponsor's cousin offering aura readings beside Velvet's costume rack. She had already predicted that I was powerful and generous.

“Nigga, she read the deposit form,” Tank said.

Velvet asked whether the aura reader had permission to occupy her changing space. The woman said she sensed tension. “Excellent. Sense it from the corridor.”

Nia wanted her chair back. Rae wanted the good crackers removed from the consultation fee. The reader offered a coalition discount, which made her the third person that evening to treat my invitation as a business incubator.

I tried settling matters with a gracious payment. Shawna took my wrist before I reached my wallet. “Ask what you agreed to.” I hadn't agreed to anything. The sponsor had promised his cousin a table.

He found her another spot near his own display. Velvet got her rack back, Nia got her chair, and I experienced the supernatural sensation of a problem ending without my card being charged.

Aiden’s verdict. The fraud investigation gives the familiar partnership a pointed new case. Our visiting psychic correctly sensed tension but incorrectly assumed my wallet had signed a contract with destiny.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected exact-game publisher description of psychic fraud and Joey's secrets. No unsupported transfer of input or timing features from another Blackwell game.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/80360/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P019 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Blackwell Epiphany

Edition considered: PC release

Follow the Blackwell partnership toward a series conclusion, with a larger mystery about the spirits Rosa and Joey have been helping.

What you do. Continue an established investigation by following leads, examining the opening situation, and checking dialogue and saving on this particular installation.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. This bleak finale depends on earlier character history; full timing, held-input, and text-advance behavior is not verified.

Why it might click. The final Blackwell story raises the stakes around Rosa, Joey, and the nature of the spirits they help. For someone already attached to the partnership, the larger mystery offers emotional continuity and the possibility of a meaningful series conclusion.

The full catch. Destruction of souls, death, and a bleak winter atmosphere make this a darker choice. It is a later entry with accumulated character history, not necessarily the best introduction. The publisher's story description does not verify every timed, held-input, or text-advance behavior; inspect this edition directly.

Try this first. Consider whether earlier Blackwell stories sound more inviting before opening the finale. If continuing an enjoyed series, try the opening investigation and verify dialogue waiting and saving without committing to finishing its darker arc.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P019 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Blackwell Epiphany

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Final Revelation Is Still Not the Treaty

Blackwell Epiphany put a finale on the screen. I decided this was the right moment to announce the mystery solved. Everyone turned. It was a terrifying amount of confidence to be responsible for. “The treaty,” I declared, “is in the silver folder.” Rae asked where the silver folder was. I had not prepared a sequel to the sentence.

Nia held up a photograph of Mika carrying it. Mika remembered handing it to a person in a cape. Velvet looked offended. “A cape is not a name.”

Remy had worn one too. So had the brass greeter before Rae moved it. Tank reminded us I'd briefly worn a table runner as a presidential sash. The suspect list was expanding in textiles.

Kit found a silver folder beneath the piano bench. I nearly embraced her. It contained Mercedes's set list and a very clear note saying AIDEN DO NOT REORDER.

I put it back. Some revelations arrive with emotional closure. Mine arrived with Mercedes looking up from the piano and saying, “Nigga.”

Aiden’s verdict. The series finale belongs to its accumulated relationships and darker stakes. Our premature revelation solved nothing except whether Mercedes still needs to put my name on explicit warnings.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher description of the central threat. Series-position recommendation is editorial; no complete-path control or emotional-fit guarantee.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/236930/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P020 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Shivah: Kosher Edition

Edition considered: PC Kosher Edition

Investigate a personal ethical mystery with Rabbi Russell Stone, bringing conscience, faith, and doubt into conversations within a specific New York community.

What you do. Meet Rabbi Stone, hear the premise, and make conversation choices while following a short investigation with more than one ending.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The Kosher Edition includes a distinctive conversation/combat system; later confrontation demands need checking despite the quiet opening.

Why it might click. A short-form mystery places conscience, faith, and doubt inside a specific New York community. Russell Stone's reason to investigate is personal and ethical, giving the conversations an appeal beyond collecting evidence for an abstract case.

The full catch. This card specifies the Kosher Edition, whose publisher lists revised presentation, voiced dialogue, multiple endings, and a distinctive conversation/combat system. That last feature requires checking rather than assuming all point-and-click interaction is relaxed. Death, cynicism, and moral decisions also give it a serious tone.

Try this first. Meet Rabbi Stone and hear the premise. Preview how a conversation choice works and how to save or leave; do not use the early calm as proof that the later confrontation has no timing demands.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P020 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Shivah: Kosher Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Rabbi Has Declined My Opening Prayer

The Shivah made me consider an opening blessing for the summit. Nia asked which tradition I planned to represent. I said the broad tradition of hoping the evening cost less than expected.

“That's not a denomination,” Kit said. “It's a wish.”

Rae thought the room could use a quiet minute. Velvet thought it could use a paid performer. Rosa thought it could use people sitting down before the food cooled. None of these requests required me to invent a religion.

I asked Tank to say something meaningful. He put his plate down and thanked Rosa and the kitchen staff by name. The room actually listened.

Then he thanked whoever had hidden the bad crackers. Rae raised two fingers. Her generosity was acknowledged. Nia smiled at her across the table.

I tried adding one final thought. Shawna handed me a water glass and said, “Amen to you drinking this.” Nigga, my spiritual contribution was hydration, and the congregation seemed sincerely grateful.

Aiden's verdict. The short mystery's ethical questions have their own appeal, with its confrontation system still requiring inspection. Our invocation improved when Tank remembered actual names and I stopped improvising theology.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher's explicitly titled Kosher Edition page, including conversation/combat and endings. Timing and holds not verified; unrelated or unresolved store matches excluded.

Source 1: <https://wadgeteyegames.com/games/the-shivah/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P021 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Resonance

Edition considered: PC release

Approach a science-fiction conspiracy through four lives, using remembered subjects as conversation material rather than relying only on collected objects.

What you do. Switch between characters, inspect objects, store useful subjects in memory, and bring those subjects into conversations during the investigation.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Separate character knowledge and two memory systems create heavy bookkeeping; late action, timers, and held inputs remain unverified.

Why it might click. Four playable characters approach a science-fiction conspiracy from different lives and loyalties. The unusual memory system lets remembered subjects become conversation material, giving investigation more texture than simply collecting objects and exhausting a fixed list of questions.

The full catch. Character switching, separate knowledge, inventory and two kinds of stored memory create substantial bookkeeping. The developer's dramatic race-against-the-clock wording does not establish which passages use actual timers. Required late action and held-input demands remain unverified; this is a conditional mystery, not a no-rush certification.

Try this first. Explore one character's first available conversation and inspect how a remembered subject becomes a question. Keep a short note with that character's name and immediate objective before considering a second viewpoint.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P021 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Resonance

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Four Witnesses and None of Them Saw My Shoes

Resonance gave us four perspectives on a conspiracy. Our missing-folder inquiry had four witnesses, which I assumed meant four times the progress. Nia said it meant four people could disagree accurately.

Mika remembered a cape. Remy remembered a silver cuff. Kit remembered the entrance music being interrupted. Tank remembered chicken. His statement was detailed and almost entirely useless.

Rae put four glasses on the table and asked everyone to stand where they'd been. I stood in the middle because the event revolved around me. Shawna moved me beside the trash can.

"That's where you were checking your shoes." "My shoes were being photographed." "By you, nigga."

From there I could see the service door. I remembered Rosa carrying the folder toward it. Rosa remembered handing it to me because my name was on the cover.

Everybody turned again. I looked down at my empty hands. Somewhere between receiving official papers and admiring my footwear, I had become both the principal witness and the fucking problem.

Aiden's verdict. The multiple perspectives and memory systems offer a distinctive investigation, with substantial bookkeeping attached. Our four-witness reconstruction has identified the host as a particularly poorly organized storage location.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer page supports four playable characters and the long-/short-term memory system. It does not verify a wholly untimed path. This is Wadjet Eye's adventure, not another product with Resonance in its name.

Source 1: <https://wadjeteyegames.com/games/resonance/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P022 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Gemini Rue

Edition considered: PC release

Follow two apparently separate lives through bleak science-fiction noir, where damaged identities and oppressive institutions make their connection worth discovering.

What you do. Investigate environments and conversations through contextual actions, following the linked stories while also facing required combat later in the adventure.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Required combat conflicts with a strict no-rush preference; accommodations described for the mobile port cannot be assumed on PC.

Why it might click. Azriel's search on a bleak colony world intertwines with an amnesiac captive's story. The attraction is adult science-fiction noir: damaged identities, oppressive institutions, rain, and uncertainty about how two apparently separate lives connect.

The full catch. This adventure includes required combat, so ordinary point-and-click investigation does not describe the complete experience. The PC interface also uses contextual actions. A publisher announcement discusses redesigned combat for a mobile port; that port's accommodations must not be assumed present on PC. A no-rush route is not established.

Try this first. If the atmosphere appeals, inspect an early investigation scene while someone checks the PC combat requirements separately. Do not treat a comfortable conversation as evidence that the later action will suit.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P022 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Gemini Rue

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Rain Machine Has No Noir Setting

Gemini Rue's bleak science-fiction mood appealed to me. I asked Mika whether the balcony could have a little rain effect for photographs. They looked at the existing puddle beneath the ice bucket. "Already arranged." "I mean cinematic rain." "Then photograph it dramatically."

Rae wanted the balcony dry because she'd parked her bike near the door. Kit wanted it dry because her entrance shoes had suede soles. Their united position failed to recognize my artistic ambitions.

Darnell offered a fog machine from his car. Mercedes said if one more person introduced a machine beside her equipment, she would start charging mechanical accompaniment rates.

I settled for a blue lamp. Remy stood beneath it in his crown and delivered a rain-soaked detective monologue despite being completely dry. Velvet supplied the rain sound with a shaker from the band.

The photograph looked excellent. I tried taking credit. Shawna pointed at the puddle. "Your contribution's leaking." Nigga, noir had become a towel assignment with flattering lighting.

Aiden's verdict. This science-fiction noir has strong atmosphere, but required combat makes its detour status matter. Our imitation achieved the rain through percussion and assigned the actual puddle to me.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

PC store supports the dual-character premise; the developer's mobile announcement explicitly confirms a combat system. Mobile redesign claims are not transferred to the PC edition. Complete PC control/timing accommodations are unverified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/80310/>

Source 2: <https://wadjeteyegames.com/2013/04/11/gemini-rue-now-on-the-app-store/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P023 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Emerald City Confidential

Edition considered: PC release

Meet familiar Oz figures recast as noir suspects and witnesses, with a detective's investigation revealing complicated motives beneath storybook associations.

What you do. Talk with suspects, inspect clues, and connect information across locations while following Petra's investigation through this reimagined Oz setting.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Dialogue and puzzle connections require tracking; the source does not settle later timing, dragging, or other input requirements.

Why it might click. Petra investigates an Oz recast as a noir city, meeting altered versions of recognizable figures. The pleasure lies in the friction between childhood storybook associations and a mystery full of suspects, witnesses and complicated motives.

The full catch. Recognizable characters do not make the investigation childish or mechanically effortless. Expect dialogue, clues and puzzle connections across locations. The inspected publisher material establishes the mystery structure but does not settle every timed sequence, drag gesture or later input requirement. Treat those as checks, not absent features.

Try this first. Meet Petra and follow one early conversation far enough to decide whether the reimagined Oz feels intriguing. Inspect one clue deliberately before opening a larger chain of objectives or consulting a walkthrough.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P023 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Emerald City Confidential

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Oz Has Revoked My Emerald Credit

Emerald City Confidential recast Oz as a noir city. I had recast our sponsor lounge as the Emerald Salon, mostly by paying for green fabric and hoping nobody asked further questions.

Rae asked why the emerald chairs were plastic. “Illusion,” I said. “Invoice,” Nia corrected, holding the rental sheet.

Velvet tried the central chair and sank six inches. She stayed perfectly composed while Remy helped her up. “The wizard has furnished this palace through a clearance event.”

Kit moved one green lamp toward the stage. Mika took two fabric panels for a better backdrop. Their improvements threatened to leave my salon as three chairs around a printer.

Shawna sat in the safest chair and crossed her legs. “Looks intimate now.” I sat beside her and told her the wizard still had a few tricks. She touched my knee. “Try one that doesn't require an extension lead.”

Tank brought drinks. The salon finally had a purpose. Its sovereign was no longer making announcements, which considerably improved the local government.

Aiden’s verdict. The familiar fantasy world becomes a distinctive noir investigation, with later input questions unresolved. Our emerald palace found its proper scale at two drinks and one chair that held.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher descriptions support Petra, the Oz reinterpretation, voiced characters and investigation across five chapters. No blanket no-timer or hold-free claim is established.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/37260/>

Source 2: <https://wadgeteyegames.com/games/emerald-city-confidential/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P024 / A PLACE TO START

The Mermaid Mask

Edition considered: PC release; current release status verify

Investigate a captain's death aboard an eccentric submarine, where voiced suspects and an elaborate locked-room setup support a theatrical detective partnership.

What you do. Talk with suspects, examine three-dimensional clues, and compare the case file's relationships while building deductions about the captain's death.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Developer declarations support untimed mouse play, but clue manipulation gestures and the memory demands of deductions still need testing.

Why it might click. Grimoire and Sally investigate a captain's death aboard an eccentric submarine. Voiced suspects, an elaborate locked-room setup and objects to examine offer a richly theatrical detective outing, with the investigators' partnership anchoring the weirdness.

The full catch. The current PC listing declares play without timed input, mouse-only play and saving at any time. Those are developer declarations, not a personal control trial. Inspectable three-dimensional clues may still involve gestures worth testing; dialogue, case-file relationships and deductions retain a meaningful memory load.

Try this first. Enter an early conversation, inspect a clue, then test how its view changes and how the case file records it. Judge those operations before committing to solving the whole submarine's personnel problems.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P024 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Mermaid Mask

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Submarine Has a Capacity of One Host

The Mermaid Mask's submarine mystery convinced me that a round window prop would make our registration desk unforgettable. Mika asked which side people would register from.

"Through the porthole." Rae looked at the opening. "Nigga, that's a pizza hole."

Remy put his face through it and announced himself as captain of the coalition. Velvet draped a scarf over his shoulder. "You've been promoted from snack hatch." He accepted the promotion with a fanfare from his phone.

Kit wanted the circle as a moon behind her entrance. Rae wanted it gone from the signing table. A negotiation began while I was still explaining the concept of immersive arrival.

Nia proposed using it beside the stage for photographs. Mika found a stand. Suddenly everyone wanted a picture with the ridiculous captain, including me, its neglected maritime founder.

I leaned through. My lapel caught. Shawna unhooked it while Tank took the photograph. The submarine mystery now concerned whether the host could exit his own décor without professional salvage.

Aiden's verdict. The eccentric submarine case has an appealing theatrical setup; clue gestures and deductions still deserve a trial. Our vessel's first emergency involved a lapel and no actual water.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact current Steam game and SFB site confirm release, premise and developer-declared Mouse Only, Playable without Timed Input and Save Anytime. Released July 16, 2026. Object-manipulation comfort is not independently verified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1696770/>

Source 2: <https://www.sfbgames.com/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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P025 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Broken Sword - Shadow of the Templars: Reforged

Edition considered: PC Reforged edition

Travel with George and Nico through a Templar conspiracy, enjoying conversations, places, and objects in a modern visual edition of their first adventure.

What you do. Inspect nearby objects, talk with people, and connect inventory clues while revisiting places as the travel mystery expands beyond its opening.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Inventory logic can require hints; an entirely untimed, hold-free path has not been established for this exact Reforged edition.

Why it might click. George Stobbert and journalist Nico Collard follow a Templar conspiracy through a classic travel adventure. Reforged presents the first Broken Sword in a modern visual edition, retaining the appeal of conversation, places, objects and a mystery expanding beyond an ordinary trip.

The full catch. Classic inventory logic and returning to locations can require notes or outside hints. The inspected Reforged page does not establish an entirely untimed, hold-free completion path. Verify troublesome set pieces in this exact edition before recommending it for a strict no-rush requirement; older versions are not interchangeable evidence.

Try this first. Try an early safe conversation and inspect a nearby object, watching whether the interface makes available actions clear. Stop after that small investigation and decide whether the travel-mystery tone earns further checking.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P025 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Broken Sword - Shadow of the Templars: Reforged

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Secret Order of People Who Want Their Coats

Broken Sword's Templar conspiracy made the cloakroom tokens look suspicious. Every ticket bore a little cross-shaped hotel emblem. I asked whether we had uncovered a secret society.

Kit said yes: people waiting for me to stop blocking their coats.

Rae had come for her bike lock. Nia had come for a cardigan. Velvet had come because a sponsor mistook her cape for public wardrobe. These were three distinct mysteries, and all their suspects were irritating.

I offered to investigate the emblem. Shawna turned my ticket over. My room number was written on the back in my own handwriting. "Aiden, your ancient order provides dry cleaning."

Remy found Rae's lock beneath his crown box. Nia found her cardigan exactly where she'd left it. Velvet reclaimed the cape from a man who had been photographing himself as a duke.

I told him costumes required permission. He pointed at my borrowed sash. Nigga, conspiracy is awkward when the evidence is wrapped around your middle and belongs to the catering department.

Aiden's verdict. George and Nico's travel mystery may be appealing, while the exact Reforged edition's unresolved demands remain. Our ancient order mostly wanted its coats and one stolen table runner.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Revolution's page identifies the 2024 Reforged edition and supports premise and adventure structure. Full-path timing and held-input details remain unverified; no older-edition accommodation is assumed.

Source 1: https://revolution.co.uk/games_catalog/broken-sword-1/

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P026 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Broken Sword 2 - the Smoking Mirror: Remastered

Edition considered: PC Remastered edition

Rejoin George and Nico for a globe-spanning artifact mystery, where their partnership turns an isolated discovery into a larger historical threat.

What you do. Use inventory objects, revisit locations, and follow what different people know as the second adventure's mystery develops across its settings.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Remembered information and inventory puzzles add load; the Remastered edition's complete timing and holding requirements remain unresolved.

Why it might click. George and Nico return in a second globe-spanning mystery involving an artifact, criminal entanglements and a larger historical threat. The attraction is their continuing partnership and the traditional pleasure of turning an apparently isolated discovery into a much stranger story.

The full catch. The Remastered edition must be assessed on its own. Inventory puzzles, revisiting places and remembering what each person knows can become demanding. Its adventure label does not prove that every hazardous scene waits indefinitely; the inspected developer page leaves complete timing and hold requirements unresolved.

Try this first. Inspect the actual controls and one early interaction before investing in a long session. If the opening danger itself feels unwelcome, switch games rather than treating endurance as the price of seeing the later mystery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P026 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Broken Sword 2 - the Smoking Mirror: Remastered

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Smoking Mirror Is a Heated Vanity

The Smoking Mirror was on the screen when Kit reported smoke behind Velvet's vanity. I announced an emergency before anyone identified whether the thing was actually burning.

Velvet looked up from her chair. "It's steam, nigga. That's how fabric stops looking like your trousers."

Remy was helping with the cape while Rae tightened a loose vanity leg. Nia held a lamp at the correct angle. They had assembled an efficient little backstage crew without giving it an ancient name.

I wanted to contribute. Velvet asked me to hold the mirror. I immediately angled it toward myself. Four people watched this happen without surprise.

Shawna took a picture. "For the sequel." Kit adjusted the lamp until Velvet's reflection was perfect, then stood back to admire her work. She was competitive about lighting because she was actually good at it.

The steam cleared. Velvet looked magnificent. I looked like a man holding equipment, a role that improved the whole room whenever I remembered to face it toward somebody else.

Aiden's verdict. The returning partnership offers another globe-spanning mystery, with this edition's practical uncertainties intact. Our smoking mirror required a steady hand and an extraordinary amount of restraint from its holder.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Revolution identifies the second game's Remastered edition and artifact-led story. No edition-specific complete no-timer/no-hold route was verified.

Source 1: https://revolution.co.uk/games_catalog/broken-sword-2/

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P027 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Broken Sword 5 - the Serpent's Curse

Edition considered: PC complete release

Follow a Paris gallery robbery into conspiracy with George and Nico, with voiced characters and a troublesome artwork anchoring the investigation.

What you do. Question a witness, inspect gallery evidence, and connect inventory objects or testimony as the investigation expands to more people and places.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Check the installed PC edition's controls; extra features described for the separate Definitive Edition are not assumed here.

Why it might click. The fifth Broken Sword begins with a Paris gallery robbery and murder, then follows George and Nico into a conspiracy. Fully voiced characters and classic point-and-click investigation make it an invitation to follow people, motives and a troublesome work of art.

The full catch. Expect inventory reasoning and an expanding cast. Revolution lists extra interface features under a separate Definitive Edition heading; this card does not assume that those features exist in the selected PC release. Required timing, holds and speech-advance behavior need checking in the installed edition.

Try this first. Follow the first available witness exchange and inspect a piece of gallery evidence. Notice whether dialogue pace and object selection feel comfortable before adding a second location or a page of speculative connections.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, we're good.

P027 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Broken Sword 5 - the Serpent's Curse

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Gallery Thief Has Excellent Taste in Frames

Broken Sword 5 began with gallery trouble. Our own gallery trouble involved my giant portrait disappearing from the entrance. I found an empty easel and announced a robbery.

Rae said, “Maybe the wall filed a complaint.” Nia covered her smile with a glass.

We followed gold paint flakes toward the stage. There was my frame, surrounding Velvet's performance poster. My face had been carefully removed and placed against the wall, where it appeared to be waiting for a bus.

Mercedes had borrowed the frame with permission from the floor manager. I asked why nobody sought mine. She held up my morning message: MAKE THE STAGE LOOK EXPENSIVE. “We obeyed the nigga.”

Kit wanted the portrait moved away from the lighting cables. Remy offered to face it toward the room so I wouldn't feel excluded. Shawna suggested facing it toward the invoices so it could finally learn something.

I carried myself into the storage alcove. The gallery had improved, and its patron had become responsible for transporting the least popular exhibit.

Aiden's verdict. The gallery conspiracy invites a classic investigative outing; use the exact edition notes above. Our art theft improved the stage and left its subject carrying a surprisingly heavy ego.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer page supports gallery theft/murder and classic point-and-click structure. Its Definitive Edition feature list is explicitly not transferred to the unspecified complete PC edition; full timing remains unverified.

Source 1: https://revolution.co.uk/games_catalog/broken-sword-5/

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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P028 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Beneath a Steel Sky

Edition considered: 1994 PC original

Explore an authoritarian machine-controlled city with Robert Foster and his robot companion in the original satirical science-fiction adventure from 1994.

What you do. Examine the first environment, distinguish inspecting from using objects, and follow an immediate objective through the older adventure's city investigation.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The older interface and navigation need a trial; mobile release features and a completely untimed path are not established here.

Why it might click. This is the original 1994 adventure: Robert Foster is taken into a city under authoritarian machine control, accompanied by the circuit board of his robot friend. Its appeal is a bleak science-fiction setting with room for satirical personality and practical investigation.

The full catch. This older adventure's interface, object logic and navigation deserve a direct trial. Abduction, violence and oppressive institutions shape the story. The developer page does not establish a death-free or untimed complete path, and its mobile release details must not be transferred to the original PC game.

Try this first. Inspect the first accessible environment and identify the immediate objective without trying to cover the whole city. Check how examining and using an object differ, then decide whether that interaction makes sense in practice.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P028 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Beneath a Steel Sky

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Machine Has Put Me on Hold

Beneath a Steel Sky's controlling machinery had nothing on the hotel's automated service line. It asked for my account number, room number, event number, and something called my event personality.

"Distinguished," I said. The system returned to the beginning. Tank put down his glass. "Nigga, try expensive."

Rae wanted a replacement table leg. Mika wanted a technician for the microphone. I kept demanding a supervisor, which apparently summoned a longer recording about unforgettable hospitality.

Kit found the printed staff list inside a drawer. She called the actual banquet office and described the two problems in one breath. A person answered. An actual person, with a name and a screwdriver.

While we waited, Nia slid a folded coaster under the table. Rae tested it and smiled at her. Temporary stability had become a flirtation, which was more than my account personality ever achieved.

The technician arrived before I escaped the menu. He took my phone, pressed zero, and handed it back. The future was humiliatingly local.

Aiden's verdict. The original adventure's satirical machine city is distinctive; its older interface needs a trial. Our automated system surrendered to a printed staff list and a technician named Luis.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Revolution identifies original release 1994, Foster, Union City and the AI premise. The card targets original PC, not the later mobile edition or Beyond a Steel Sky. Complete timing/death/hold behavior remains unverified.

Source 1: https://revolution.co.uk/games_catalog/beneath-a-steel-sky/

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P029 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Kathy Rain: Director's Cut

Edition considered: PC Director's Cut

Follow Kathy's family investigation through a small town, where her grandfather's death opens secrets and the Director's Cut expands the original mystery.

What you do. Read the initial context, speak with people, and use Kathy's notebook while testing the Director's Cut's advertised single-click mouse interaction.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Family trauma and puzzle memory remain substantial; the source does not settle every late timer, chase, or held input.

Why it might click. Kathy's investigation connects her grandfather's death, family history and the secrets of a small town. The Director's Cut expands the original mystery and advertises a single-click mouse interface, making the combination of investigative conversation and a clear protagonist worth examining.

The full catch. A simpler click interface does not remove puzzle memory or emotional intensity. Family trauma and disturbing material matter here. The source does not settle every late chase, timer or held-input requirement. This is specifically Director's Cut, not an assumption that the 2016 original behaves identically.

Try this first. Read the initial context and try one conversation with Kathy's notebook close at hand. Assess both the single-click interaction and whether this family mystery feels compelling today; neither decision requires completing a case.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P029 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Kathy Rain: Director's Cut

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Biker Has Found My Family Evidence

Kathy Rain's family investigation caught Rae's attention immediately. She pulled a chair closer while I explained that my own family history also contained mystery. Shawna said most of mine concerned receipts.

Rae asked whether the missing treaty might be in my jacket. I said I had checked. Nia asked whether I had checked the jacket I was wearing earlier.

I had worn three. Nigga, diplomacy requires options.

Kit fetched the first from the coat room. Its pocket contained a parking ticket, a lipstick-marked napkin from Shawna, and my handwritten phrase HISTORIC MOMENT, PAUSE FOR APPLAUSE. Rae read it aloud very gently, which made it worse.

Shawna reclaimed the napkin. "Private correspondence." I said it proved I was a man of deep relationships. She kissed my cheek. "It proves you were supposed to come find me before ordering more décor."

The jacket contained no treaty. It did contain the pen's presentation box, empty. Our family investigation had expanded into my habit of carrying expensive containers without their intended contents.

Aiden's verdict. Kathy's family mystery has a clear investigative personality, with its darker themes and unresolved late demands retained. My jacket investigation uncovered romance, vanity, and an impressively empty presentation box.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Director's Cut listing supports single-click interface, expanded story and family investigation. It is not a full-path accessibility audit; late required timing and holds remain unverified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1395030/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P030 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Whispers of a Machine

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate Nordic science-fiction murders with Vera, whose responses influence abilities and connect her personality to how the investigation can be solved.

What you do. Choose conversation responses, inspect Vera's available augmentations, and use abilities or clues to pursue solutions during the unfolding murder investigation.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Abilities and alternative approaches add memory demands; every required timer or held gesture has not been verified.

Why it might click. Vera investigates murders in a Nordic science-fiction world where forbidden technology and personal history intersect. Her responses influence the augmentations available for solving problems, connecting the detective's character to the practical shape of the investigation.

The full catch. Different abilities, dialogue approaches and possible solutions create more to remember than a single straightforward clue chain. The premise includes violence and grief. The inspected listing does not establish every required timer or held gesture, so character depth should not be mistaken for a simple interface promise.

Try this first. Follow an early conversation and choose the response that feels natural, then inspect how the game explains Vera's available abilities. Write down one ability in plain language instead of trying to optimize an entire personality.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P030 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Whispers of a Machine

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Augmented Host Still Can't Find a Pen

Whispers of a Machine gave its investigator abilities shaped by her responses. I wondered what augmentation the summit would give me. Rae said a pocket that remembered what I put in it. Kit suggested directional hearing tuned to the word no. Shawna said that upgrade would change our entire marriage.

Nia wanted a pen that could make her handwriting legible. She wrote her name on a scrap to demonstrate. Remy looked at it. "Beautiful. Which kingdom?" Nia laughed and flicked the paper at him.

Rae retrieved it before it reached a puddle. She kept it beside the lamp while pretending to tidy the table. I noticed because I am a perceptive man whenever the evidence involves somebody else's love life.

Mika asked me to use that perception on the missing folder. I found a silver corner beneath a welcome bag. It was foil from a chocolate bar.

Tank thanked me for returning it. My augmentation had activated: highly selective discovery of things another nigga had already eaten.

Aiden's verdict. The detective's changing abilities may make this science-fiction case interesting, with branch and input uncertainties intact. Our host's first augmentation appears optimized for locating wrappers instead of documents.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher listing supports Vera, cybernetic abilities shaped by responses, voiced dialogue and multiple puzzle solutions. Memory rating is editorial; full-path timing and input requirements are unverified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/631570/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P031 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Kathy Rain 2: Soothsayer

Edition considered: PC release

Rejoin Kathy as a private investigator in 1998, following a serial-killer case where a larger city brings professional ambition and financial stakes.

What you do. Follow an available lead, talk with people, and use the notebook to organize names, places, and clues in the expanded investigation.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The larger case adds tracking and dark material; control findings from Director's Cut do not automatically apply to this sequel.

Why it might click. The sequel follows Kathy in 1998 as a private investigator drawn into the Soothsayer serial-killer case. Its appeal is an established adult lead facing a larger city, new people and a case that ties professional ambition to immediate financial stakes.

The full catch. A larger investigation means more names, locations and clues, even with a notebook to organize them. Serial murder brings dark material. The inspected store page establishes the story and notebook, not a guarantee about all late timing or input sequences. Director's Cut findings do not automatically apply to this sequel.

Try this first. Read Kathy's opening situation and investigate one available lead. Use the notebook to summarize what the lead means, then judge whether the sequel's mood and interface invite another conversation rather than another obligation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P031 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Kathy Rain 2: Soothsayer

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Private Investigator Has a Public Balance

Kathy Rain's sequel gave us a working investigator with financial problems. Rae looked at the screen, then at the hotel manager approaching me. "Everybody needs a case that pays."

The manager wanted approval for a second delivery. I asked which delivery. He said the commemorative signing chairs. Kit slowly set her glass down.

"We already have chairs." "These commemorate." Nia asked what they commemorated. The treaty wasn't found, much less signed. I explained that anticipation was part of an event's visual language. Shawna translated. "This nigga ordered monograms before we agreed on initials."

Rae offered to inspect the chairs for wobbling. The manager said they were decorative. She stared. "A chair you can't sit on is a shelf with confidence." Velvet immediately wanted one as a prop, provided I paid its appearance fee.

I cancelled the second delivery. There was a cancellation charge. Tank watched me sign it. "Look at that. Your first successful investigation located exactly where the money goes."

Aiden's verdict. The sequel's working detective and larger case offer a fresh draw, without inheriting earlier control assurances. Our investigation has established that commemorative furniture can celebrate an event still missing.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact 2025 sequel listing supports 1998 setting, financial premise, Soothsayer investigation and notebook. All-path timing and held inputs remain unverified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1466390/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P032 / A PLACE TO START

Tangle Tower

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate a mansion death entangled with a painting, meeting an animated, fully voiced cast whose expressions and relationships invite another question.

What you do. Question suspects, inspect objects closely, and compare testimony or family relationships while examining the mansion's rooms and puzzle objects.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed mouse play is declared, but dragging and puzzle manipulation still need testing; relationships and testimony require attention.

Why it might click. Grimoire and Sally investigate Freya Fellow's death in a mansion where a painting appears entangled in the crime. A fully voiced, animated cast and richly drawn rooms make conversation and character observation a large part of the appeal.

The full catch. The current PC listing declares mouse-only play, play without timed input and saving at any time. Those declarations are useful but do not establish comfortable dragging or manipulation of every puzzle object. Remembering family relationships and comparing testimony still require attention; an untimed mystery can be a substantial mystery.

Try this first. Speak with one suspect and inspect one object closely enough to test selection and any manipulation. Decide whether the voices, expressions and room details make you want to ask a second question.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P032 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Tangle Tower

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Painting Has Been Holding the Pen

Tangle Tower's suspicious painting made Kit examine the frame around Velvet's poster. Something gold was wedged behind the backing. She pulled out the treaty pen with a satisfied little noise.

I applauded. Rae asked how it got there. "Temporary storage," I said. "In a painting?" "A secure cultural location."

Nia took the pen and tried it on a scrap. Her signature emerged looking like a small animal had escaped across the paper. The pen worked beautifully; its operator remained interesting.

Rae turned the scrap sideways. "I can read it." Nia raised an eyebrow. "That's either romance or an eye examination." Rae put the scrap in her pocket and declined to clarify.

Kit demanded credit for the discovery. Velvet promised to mention her during the show, provided Kit stopped aiming the entrance lamp directly into her mirror.

I reached for the recovered pen. Three hands moved first. Shawna tucked it into a plain cup on the table. Nigga, the vault had been downgraded to something I could actually see.

Aiden's verdict. The voiced mansion mystery gives observation a theatrical setting, with manipulation still worth checking. Our painting surrendered the pen and accidentally produced a much more interesting exchange beside it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact PC listing supports premise, voices and developer-declared Mouse Only, Playable without Timed Input and Save Anytime. Gesture comfort and complete-path suitability have not been independently tested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/359510/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P033 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Detective Grimoire

Edition considered: 2014 PC commercial game; not Flash original

Explore an odd swamp attraction through a compact murder case, where interviews and visible conclusions challenge rumors about its unusual inhabitants.

What you do. Meet witnesses, select available ideas, and join them into small conclusions while following the commercial standalone game's murder investigation.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The puzzle interfaces need testing; the inspected listing does not confirm that every sequence avoids timers or held dragging.

Why it might click. The commercial 2014 Detective Grimoire builds a compact murder investigation around an odd swamp attraction and its inhabitants. Interviews and assembled conclusions give the detective's reasoning a visible role, while the creature rumors invite questions about what people assume and why.

The full catch. This is the paid standalone game, not the earlier browser title. Its mouse/touch-oriented design still involves connecting ideas and handling puzzle interfaces. The inspected listing does not explicitly verify that every sequence is untimed or that no drag-and-hold gesture is required; check the actual build before treating it as a sure fit.

Try this first. Meet an early witness and try forming one small conclusion from the available ideas. Observe whether selecting and joining those ideas feels natural, without imposing a deadline for reaching the correct answer.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P033 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Detective Grimoire

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Swamp Monster Has a Catering Badge

Detective Grimoire's swamp attraction gave me an idea for the empty decorative pond beside registration. I suggested a mysterious creature emerging during the welcome. Mika said the welcome was already late.

Tank rose from behind the pond holding a tray. "Creature's ready." He had been retrieving a dropped fork. Rosa wanted the fork washed, not mythologized.

Kit put a green lamp behind him. Velvet supplied a low dramatic note. In six seconds they produced a better monster reveal than anything I'd paid for all afternoon.

Rae photographed it for the group chat. Tank demanded approval before release. "I got sauce on my collar." Nia told him the sauce established a motive.

The catering supervisor arrived, recognized her missing tray, and ended the supernatural incident by asking Tank to carry it to the buffet. He went happily because it contained fresh food.

I proposed making this a scheduled feature. Shawna shook her head. "Let the nigga eat once without you turning it into a package." The swamp returned to decorative unemployment.

Aiden's verdict. The swamp investigation has a compact, oddball premise; its puzzle interfaces still need a trial. Our monster's motivations were refreshingly legible once somebody looked at the tray he carried.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

The 2014 commercial game's Steam listing supports the swamp case, voiced cast, conclusion system and mouse/touch design. Complete timing and held-gesture requirements are not verified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/272600/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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P034 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Roottrees are Dead

Edition considered: 2025 Steam remake; not free browser original

Reconstruct a wealthy family's genealogy through a simulated 1998 internet, enjoying the moment scattered photographs and articles form a coherent family tree.

What you do. Search information, compare photographs or articles, identify a person, and place the resulting relationship into the family tree one connection at a time.

Dialogue / text choices | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Names, generations, visual identification and typing create heavy reading and memory demands; this card covers the 2025 remake.

Why it might click. The 2025 remake turns a wealthy family's genealogy into an investigation through a simulated 1998 internet. Photographs, articles and other fragments gradually identify people and their relationships, making the central reward the moment scattered information clicks into a coherent family tree.

The full catch. Names, generations, visual identification and search terms create a heavy memory and reading load. Typing and navigating the information interface matter more than reflexes in the described core activity, but that does not certify every input as effortless. This remake differs from the free 2023 browser original.

Try this first. Identify one person using one clearly connected source, then place or record that single relationship. A separate scratch note can hold a name while you test the search and family-tree interface without filling the whole chart.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, we're good.

P034 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Roottrees are Dead

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Family Tree Has Three Catering Branches

The Roottrees' genealogy inspired me to explain the summit through a relationship chart. I drew separate circles for every caucus and immediately ran out of paper connecting the same people. Nia looked at her three arrows. "I've become a transport interchange." Remy wanted a little crown drawn beside his stage name. Kit wanted me to spell librarian correctly.

Rae took the marker and added BIKE FRIENDS beside herself and Mika. Mika collected tiny hotels but apparently also rode to work. I hadn't asked because I was busy assigning everyone ceremonial chairs.

Velvet added PEOPLE WHO REQUIRE PAYMENT across the bottom and connected half the room. Rosa drew the largest arrow. Nobody argued with the scale.

I noticed the chart was resting on a rigid silver backing. My heart jumped. It was a tray, which Tank promptly reclaimed for sandwiches.

The genealogy remained. Shawna drew a small heart between our names and then a line from mine to UNPAID INCIDENTALS. Nigga, our family tree had excellent documentation.

Aiden's verdict. The remake's family reconstruction can be absorbing, with heavy name and relationship tracking. Our summit chart grew clearer once people added their actual connections and corrected my spelling.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact 2025 Steam remake listing supports early-internet research, family-tree deduction and rebuilt interface. The memory assessment is editorial; no universal timing/hold guarantee is inferred from the genre.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2754380/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P035 / A PLACE TO START

The Rise of the Golden Idol

Edition considered: PC base game

Investigate strange events in a new era of the Golden Idol format, uncovering connections between crime, belief, and institutional ambition.

What you do. Inspect crime scenes, gather useful words, and assemble explanations that connect individual incidents with broader deductions across a chapter.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Observation is described as self-paced, but names and cross-case deductions become dense; input gestures still need a trial.

Why it might click. A new era gives the Golden Idol deduction format fresh social scenery: investigators piece together strange events involving crime, belief and institutional ambition. The game invites close reading of scenes and reconstructing what happened rather than steering an action hero through them.

The full catch. The publisher explicitly describes exploring scenes at your own pace. That supports unhurried observation, not low complexity: names, collected words, connections across cases and chapter-level deductions can become dense. Input comfort and any required dragging still need a local check; dark crime scenes are central.

Try this first. Open the first case, inspect a small cluster of connected clues, and try stating aloud what seems to have happened before filling every answer. Leave the broader conspiracy for another sitting if the first scene is enough.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P035 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Rise of the Golden Idol

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The New Conspiracy Is the Same Expensive Host

The Rise of the Golden Idol made me suspect a second wave of hidden influence. Someone had changed the welcome slide from HISTORIC RIVALRY to GAMES, FOOD, AND A POSSIBLE AGREEMENT.

“Who authorized this?” I asked. Mika raised a hand. Then Kit. Then Rae. Then Nia. I was confronting a conspiracy with unusually accessible minutes.

Velvet said the original slide made the evening sound like a televised argument. Remy preferred the new one because possible agreement left room for his deliberately ridiculous fanfare.

I complained that the revised title lacked grandeur. Mercedes changed the font size. “There. Larger.”

Rae brought the good crackers to Kit’s table. Kit moved her lamp so Nia could read. The alleged rival camps were trading useful things while I defended a slide none of them wanted.

Shawna stood beside me. “You can still introduce it.” I brightened. “Briefly.” Nigga, they had granted the founder a small ceremonial habitat with extremely firm boundaries around its noise.

Aiden’s verdict. The new deduction cases change the social scenery while keeping dense connections central. Our latest conspiracy succeeded through a clearer slide, a larger font, and fewer promises from me.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher description supports 1970s setting, twenty cases and exploration at the player’s pace. The waits label refers to scene investigation, not a tested blanket guarantee about every input or comfort need.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2716400/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P036 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Gabriel Knight: Sins of the Fathers 20th Anniversary Edition

Edition considered: PC 20th Anniversary Edition

Follow a New Orleans writer's ritual-murder investigation into family secrets, with supernatural noir and rebuilt presentation in the twentieth-anniversary edition.

What you do. Try bookshop interactions, talk with people, and use inventory clues or remembered conversations to pursue Gabriel's developing investigation in the city.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Murder and horror are central; modern presentation does not prove that every dangerous or timed passage has been removed.

Why it might click. Gabriel's investigation of ritual murders draws a writer and bookshop owner into a family mystery in New Orleans. The twentieth-anniversary edition retells the first game with rebuilt presentation and additional material, offering a strong dose of place, conversation and supernatural noir.

The full catch. The story includes murder, horror and fictionalized religious material. Adventure puzzles can demand inventory reasoning and remembered conversations. This remake's complete path has not been checked for every dangerous or timed passage; do not assume its modern presentation removes the original design's possible pressure points.

Try this first. Try one early conversation or bookshop interaction and see whether Gabriel's personality and the setting appeal. Check the interface at the same time, keeping the first objective small rather than committing to the entire supernatural history.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P036 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Gabriel Knight: Sins of the Fathers 20th Anniversary Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Bookshop Owner Has Found My Draft Speech

Gabriel Knight's writer protagonist made Kit ask whether my welcome speech had an editor. I said I preferred an unfiltered voice. She found page four and put on her glasses.

"Your opening contains two openings." "They're complementary." "They're both about your shoes."

Remy offered to perform the second as dramatic monologue. Velvet volunteered ominous accompaniment. Before I could withdraw publication rights, he was reading MY PRESENCE HERE TONIGHT with the solemnity of a cursed duke.

Nia laughed into her napkin. Rae looked at her instead of the performer for a moment, then turned back before it became a scene. I noticed and generously refrained from announcing anything, a sacrifice nobody has properly rewarded.

Kit cut the speech down to six sentences. She kept my thank-you to Shawna, which I had written honestly before the shoes took over.

Shawna read that line and squeezed my hand. "Keep this voice, nigga." I did. The cursed duke remained available for a separate booking, according to his agent Velvet.

Aiden's verdict. The New Orleans supernatural mystery offers atmosphere and a complicated history; its dangerous passages still matter. My own writer's mystery improved after an editor removed two ceremonial shoe descriptions.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact twentieth-anniversary Steam edition supports Gabriel, New Orleans, murders and added remake material. Complete timing and held-input requirements remain unverified; fictional portrayals are not presented as cultural research.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/262000/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P037 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Still Life

Edition considered: 2005 PC original

Compare two disturbing investigations across eras, as a contemporary FBI case and a grandfather's earlier work begin to echo one another.

What you do. Examine crime scenes and connect layered puzzle information while following the contemporary investigation and its links with the earlier case.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. A documented required robot-and-laser timing puzzle conflicts with strict no-rush needs, alongside graphic crime material and complex puzzles.

Why it might click. Two related investigations in different places and eras create the appeal: a contemporary FBI case and a grandfather's earlier work gradually echo one another. This is a dark serial-crime adventure for someone specifically interested in disturbing mysteries and historical connections.

The full catch. A contemporary review describes a required robot-and-laser puzzle that depends on timing even though it is not a simple countdown. That materially conflicts with a strict no-rush preference. Graphic crime material and layered puzzle logic add further demands; this is a clearly marked detour, not an easy recommendation.

Try this first. Start by considering the subject matter and the documented later timing obstacle. If both are acceptable with a chosen helper or shared-viewing arrangement, inspect an early investigation scene without interpreting it as the whole game's control profile.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P037 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Still Life

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Laser Corridor Leads to the Washroom

Still Life's two investigations had a difficult timing sequence in its notes. Our real-life difficulty was a decorative laser corridor I had hired for guests entering the washroom passage.

Rae stood before the red beams. "I need to pee, Aiden." I said they weren't actual security lasers. "Then stop making my bladder look like a heist."

Mika reached for the controller. Kit asked to keep the lights for the stage backdrop, where nobody had to negotiate their body through a theatrical threat to use a toilet.

Remy tried stepping through with dramatic precision. His cape caught on the stand. Velvet freed him while asking whether his kingdom possessed ordinary doors.

I helped Mika move the equipment. The beams made an excellent pattern behind the empty stage. Kit adjusted them with genuine pleasure and no further competition.

Rae returned from the newly ordinary corridor and gave us a thumbs-up. Nigga, the most successful accessibility feature I'd funded all evening was moving my own fucking idea out of the way.

Aiden's verdict. The disturbing dual investigation belongs in the detour group because a required timing puzzle is documented. Our laser corridor was considerably easier to fix: we stopped blocking the washroom.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher listing establishes the original game's dual-era crime premise. GameBoomers' contemporary review specifically reports timing-dependent robot/laser movement. No claim that this obstacle has an accessible skip is made.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/46480/>

Source 2: <https://www.gameboomers.com/reviews/Ss/Stilllifebynickie.htm>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P038 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Grim Fandango Remastered

Edition considered: PC Remastered edition

Travel through a distinctive land of the dead with Manny, where a compromised job expands into noir adventure, memorable characters, and music.

What you do. Explore Manny's workplace, talk with characters, and connect inventory objects while moving through the remaster's unusual world and developing story.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Indirect inventory logic can need hints; additional control schemes do not establish comfortable movement or remove every timing concern.

Why it might click. Manny's journey through a noir-inflected land of the dead combines memorable characters, an unusual visual world and a rich musical identity. The remaster refreshes presentation while preserving the adventure's central pleasure: a compromised little job opening into a much larger story.

The full catch. Traditional inventory puzzles and indirect solution logic can require considerable memory and hints. The developer confirms additional control schemes, but that alone does not establish comfortable movement or every timing requirement. Check the PC controls in practice; do not import PlayStation button instructions or assume remaster means simplified puzzles.

Try this first. Explore Manny's first available workplace interactions, compare the installed control choices, and test movement between two nearby points. Let the voice and atmosphere win your interest before agreeing to carry a long inventory of unsolved errands.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P038 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Grim Fandango Remastered

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Travel Agent Has Sold Me an Afterlife Upgrade

Grim Fandango's travel-business trouble made me inspect the hotel's event upgrade sheet. I had purchased a Legacy Welcome Experience. No one could explain what it did after the welcome ended. Tank said, "Maybe your descendants get a drink." Rosa wanted to know whether descendants also covered overtime.

Velvet liked the phrase and sang it as a lounge refrain. Remy harmonized badly on purpose. Mercedes found a chord underneath them, and suddenly my useless purchase had an actual musical identity. Kit dimmed the entrance lights to suit the moment. Rae pulled out a chair for Nia. Nia sat, still holding the recovered pen cup so I couldn't improve its storage arrangements.

I slid beside Shawna and whispered that I could sell her a private upgrade. She looked at the clock. "Does this one include the man showing up?" I promised an excellent arrival window.

The song ended before I finished explaining it. Velvet bowed. Nobody applauded the event package, but everybody applauded her. Legacy had selected a better travel agent.

Aiden's verdict. Manny's strange noir journey has strong character and musical appeal, with movement and timing concerns retained. Our legacy package finally earned applause after Velvet turned its name into a song.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

PC listing supports premise and remastered presentation; Double Fine confirms additional control schemes. Full control comfort and all-path timing are unverified. No native co-op is inferred from Remote Play Together metadata.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/316790/>

Source 2: <https://www.doublefine.com/news/grim-fandango-remastered-pre-orders-now-available>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P039 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Thimbleweed Park

Edition considered: PC release

Meet five playable oddballs in an eccentric 1987 town, where ensemble comedy and strange connections reward curiosity about people and places.

What you do. Choose Casual, follow one character's objective, and try conversations or object interactions before switching characters and managing more unfinished tasks.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Casual mode reduces some demands, but five characters and inventories still require tracking; exceptional inputs remain worth checking.

Why it might click. An eccentric 1987 town ties together five playable characters and an increasingly strange mystery. The attraction is ensemble comedy, peculiar locations and the satisfaction of uncovering connections while a traditional adventure keeps revealing another layer of oddness.

The full catch. The publisher offers Casual and Hard modes and describes exploration at your own pace. Casual is the more relevant first trial, but it does not make five characters, inventories and ongoing objectives trivial. Interface gestures and any exceptional sequence still need checking; selecting a difficulty is not a universal no-hold guarantee.

Try this first. Choose Casual and follow one character's immediate objective. Try one conversation and one object interaction, noting whether the action interface is clear before switching people or collecting a large list of unfinished tasks.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P039 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Thimbleweed Park

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Five Witnesses Locate the Back of a Sign

Thimbleweed Park's ensemble reminded Nia that we had never finished reconstructing the folder's route. She assembled five people around the registration desk and made me keep my hands visible. Mika had given it to Rosa. Rosa had given it to me. I remembered using it to stiffen a sign. Kit remembered the sign because I had spelled her name wrong on it.

Rae turned the welcome placard around. There it was: the silver folder, taped to the back beneath a command to CELEBRATE DIFFERENCE. Tank bent over laughing.

“Nigga, you used the treaty as cardboard.” “Archival support.” “You taped international relations to a fucking easel.”

Nia carefully removed the tape while Kit held the placard still. The papers were intact. Velvet requested the discarded sign for a later joke and received unanimous approval from everyone except its author.

Shawna opened the folder. The first page said DRAFT AGENDA. No treaty yet. I had successfully lost a document that hadn't even reached the level of commitment I was claiming.

Aiden’s verdict. The eccentric ensemble may reward patient tracking; its multiple inventories still create work. Our five-person investigation found the missing draft precisely where the host had converted it into furniture.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher listing supports five playable characters, Casual/Hard modes and exploring at one's pace. Casual is an editorial first-trial choice, not proof that every interaction or entire path meets all preferences.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/569860/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P040 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Full Throttle Remastered

Edition considered: PC Remastered edition

Follow Ben through a compact biker adventure with animated road-movie energy, distinctive characters, visual attitude, and a strong rock-music identity.

What you do. Talk with characters, investigate with inventory objects, and progress through Ben's adventure, including active road sequences beyond the quieter conversations.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Required action remains in the remaster; a complete no-reflex route or universal skip has not been verified here.

Why it might click. Ben's trouble with powerful interests unfolds through a compact biker adventure full of distinctive characters, visual attitude and rock music. The remaster restores the original game's presentation and adds archival material, preserving a very particular kind of animated road-movie energy.

The full catch. This is not solely unhurried conversation and inventory work. Its remastered road sequences retain active gameplay, and the adventure includes action demands. A complete no-reflex route or universal skip has not been verified here. Treat it as a deliberate detour if required timing is unwelcome.

Try this first. Watch or try an early quiet conversation to judge the tone, while keeping the later action warning visible. Decide separately whether someone wants to handle those sequences; shared help is an arrangement, not native cooperative play.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P040 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Full Throttle Remastered

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Biker Declines My Cavalcade

Full Throttle's road-movie attitude made me ask Rae to lead a ceremonial motorcade around the hotel entrance. She looked at me, then at the newly recovered agenda.

"Does the agenda say motorcade?" "It could." "Then keep the fucking pen away from him," she told Nia.

Remy wanted to arrive on something impressive. Velvet offered him the little wheeled costume trunk. He sat on it with his crown perfectly straight while Tank pushed him six feet and demanded a transport fee.

Kit played his victory fanfare. It was terrible, triumphant, and exactly as requested. Remy grinned so widely that nobody suggested replacing it with something tasteful.

Rae put her bike lock back in her bag. Nia asked whether she could show her the bike later. "If you like," Rae said, suddenly less fluent than she'd been about every snack in the room.

I offered to organize their viewing. Shawna took my arm. "You got an appointment with me, nigga." For once I followed the correct person through the correct door.

Aiden's verdict. The biker adventure has unmistakable attitude, with required action keeping the practical warning decisive. Our motorcade shrank to a costume trunk, and the narrator finally honored an existing appointment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Double Fine supports the remastered game's premise; the platform interview with Tim Schafer confirms the playable Mine Road sequence's preservation. No unverified skip/no-action route is claimed.

Source 1: <https://www.doublefine.com/games/full-throttle-remastered>

Source 2: <https://blog.playstation.com/archive/2017/01/13/how-double-fine-is-tuning-up-full-throttle-remastered-for-ps4/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A Provisional Agenda and One Very Firm Dinner Reservation

We recovered the draft from the back of the welcome sign. The pen had emerged from a picture frame. Neither discovery reflected especially well on the host, but the papers were readable, the pen worked, and Kit had successfully negotiated her name being spelled correctly in the announcement. A summit needs achievable milestones.

Shawna and I came back from the corridor a few minutes later. I had given her actual attention, which improved her opinion of the evening and temporarily destroyed my ability to remember why I had purchased a smoke machine. Tank looked at my collar. "Negotiations going well?" "Private session." "Nigga, your tie's private too. Put it back where it lives."

Nia spread the draft on the now steady table. Rae had repaired the wobble with help from the hotel technician. Kit aimed the lamp. Nobody called the arrangement historic. It simply worked. June and Dez took opposite chairs, discovered that put them too far apart to discuss the photograph, and moved closer without asking which side they represented.

The draft was ridiculous in several places. I had proposed separate victory entrances for people who belonged to overlapping groups. Remy had a paragraph describing his fanfare as obligatory. He claimed he hadn't written obligatory, only essential. Velvet crossed out both and wrote PAID SHOW FIRST. Rosa added a clear meal time. Mercedes protected her soundcheck. Mika added an actual start time and took possession of the room controls.

Kit wanted her karaoke turn. Rae wanted snacks worth eating and a table nobody had to hold upright while signing. Nia wanted her legal contribution limited to the agreement for this evening, after which she would be free to enjoy it. I said everybody wanted something. Shawna touched my arm. "Yes, baby. That's why they came." She wasn't delivering a lesson. She was asking me to stop sounding surprised.

June proposed putting the old Blue Comet claims on tomorrow's agenda. Dez objected that tomorrow had already been used as a settlement date since 1967. Nia suggested a separate little accounting session tonight. Both veterans accepted, provided it didn't interrupt the music. I sensed an opportunity to preside. Six people found useful reasons for me to remain standing away from the pen.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, we're good.

We agreed the order of the evening: games, food, financial terms, rooms, the stage, and a final agreement only when the words were actually ready. This was a provisional agenda. Nobody signed a grand coalition treaty. Remy played four seconds of his fanfare anyway. Velvet took his keyboard, played the final note properly, and handed it back with a kiss on his forehead.

Rae offered Nia a look at her bike before the next room. Nia said yes. I nearly volunteered a photographer. Shawna tightened her hand around mine until the thought passed safely through my body without becoming a purchase.

The hotel manager arrived carrying the financial statement. June leaned over to Dez. “Second war already got a casualty.” Dez looked at the total. “His deposit.” Nigga, the next campaign had begun before I'd finished enjoying the first truce.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The Department of Lesbian Lore Has Seized the Microphone

Aiden requested the entire history of lesbians, preferably in a font that made him look responsible. The archive declined the second condition. What follows is a substantial, selective field guide through several histories of desire, community, conflict and organizing. Its dates orient the reader; they do not rank cultures by how far they have progressed.

There is no single family tree that begins in Greece, passes through white Europe and ends by admitting everybody else. Nor can one white-butched/Black-stud rivalry explain the racial boundaries of lesbian life. Read the locally named people, organizations and records here as distinct histories that sometimes meet, rather than stages of one universal development.

Every dossier separates the historical account, a question for interpretation, the limits of the evidence, and a completely fictional summit scene. A source record may be a manifesto, an organizational self-history, an interview, an abstract or a curator's description. Those are different forms of evidence. An archive finding aid does not mean its whole collection was read.

Pleasure belongs in the history alongside organizing and exclusion. Sexual roles, gender presentation, erotic preference and identity can connect without being interchangeable. This guide discusses desire and sexual politics without converting anyone's body or boundaries into a spectacle. Aiden supplies enough spectacle already. The fictional 1967 Blue Comet war remains entirely outside the factual timeline.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, we're good.

Choose a historical dossier

H01. Sappho did not leave a membership spreadsheet
Page 108

H12. Audre Lorde: desire as knowledge, pleasure as a political question
Page 119

H02. Anne Lister: a lover, a diarist, and a landowner
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H13. Chicana lesbian thought: a coalition must remember who built it
Page 120

H03. Mabel Hampton: parties, clothes and remembered words
Page 110

H14. Pleasure and danger were not obliged to become enemy nations
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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.
Niggas, lights on.
Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, pens out.
Niggas, mic check.
Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, chairs in.
Niggas, take turns.
Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, snacks here.
Niggas, dance later.
Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, read first.
Niggas, we're good.

Ho1. Sappho did not leave a membership spreadsheet

Archaic Greek poetry and its later reception

Sappho's poetry and its reception offer a starting point for a history of women's desire, not the first box in a universal identity chart. The British Library's manuscript account distinguishes the surviving fragments from later stories about the poet. Some poems concern love for women; later writers interpreted, celebrated and moralized her life in conflicting ways. Modern sapphic language draws on that legacy, but a contemporary identity vocabulary cannot simply be pasted onto an ancient social world.

The archive itself is part of the story. The Library discusses the loss, copying and difficult language of the poems, and challenges the easy tale that a single coordinated campaign of suppression explains everything missing. A fragment's survival and a later biographer's claim are different kinds of evidence. Our editorial inference: wanting an ancestor is understandable; inventing certainty about that ancestor makes the history smaller, not more intimate.

The question underneath. What do we actually know, and what have later readers wanted an ancestor to prove?

Evidence limit: Sappho is not made the origin of every culture's same-sex desire.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I unveiled the Lesbian Family Tree. It was gold, six feet tall and, because the contractor had misunderstood branching, faintly on fire.

Kit asked where I had put uncertainty. I showed her the cloakroom. June asked where I had put everybody who had never written anything down. I showed her an empty branch.

'Nigga,' Tank said, 'you bought a tree and still managed to lose the forest.'

Mika unplugged it. The historical record immediately became easier to breathe near.

Peter Toth, British Library - The Mystery of Sappho. Read scope: Curatorial manuscript essay read; no independent Greek translation or complete corpus study.

<https://www.bl.uk/stories/blogs/posts/mystery-of-sappho>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Ho2. Anne Lister: a lover, a diarist, and a landowner

Yorkshire, 1791-1840

Anne Lister left an unusually extensive record of a woman's relationships with women alongside business, travel and everyday life. Calderdale Museums describes twenty-six diary volumes, substantial coded passages, estate management and her partnership with Ann Walker. Walker moved to Shibden in 1834. Their relationship was embedded in property, family and the possibilities available to two women with resources; those material conditions belong beside the romance.

That is a reason to resist turning Lister into a generic representative of every woman who desired women in nineteenth-century Britain. A surviving house, a large written record and the ability to travel give this life a particular visibility. The museum documents subsequent preservation and transcription work as well. Editorially, the important contrast is between a detailed individual archive and the lives a comparable archive cannot recover. Recognition need not require calling someone the first, the only, or an uncomplicated political model.

The question underneath. Whose independence also depended on property, and whose records survived?

Evidence limit: A partnership ceremony is not presented here as a modern legal marriage.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I announced that a private archive deserved a private wing. Shawna asked whether I had kept last month's electricity bill.

'That is contemporary history.'

'It is a final notice.'

Rae studied my model of the wing. 'Does the reading room need a champagne lift?'

I explained access. Nia explained access back to me, more accurately and with substantially fewer moving parts.

Calderdale Museums - Anne Lister. Read scope: Museum account and description of diary preservation read; full diaries not read.

<https://museums.calderdale.gov.uk/explore/famous-figures/anne-lister>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Ho3. Mabel Hampton: parties, clothes and remembered words

1920s-1930s, recalled decades later

In interviews with Joan Nestle, Mabel Hampton remembered women gathering near her Harlem home for food, dancing and companionship. She described mostly Black company, while also remembering white friends from Greenwich Village. These recollections preserve a social world with interracial connections without implying that the wider city offered equal welcome. Clothing also depended on movement through public space: Hampton distinguished arriving by car from walking outside in trousers.

Hampton recalled several words used around women who loved women, including butch and sometimes stud. Her testimony records remembered usage, not a single origin or timeless definition for either term. She also described paid sewing and stage work and a lasting relationship with Lillian Foster. The resulting history includes attraction and pleasure alongside the practical arrangements that let people meet, earn money and travel together.

The question underneath. How does the route to a gathering shape who can dress freely once inside?

Evidence limit: Later-life memory contains uncertain dates; one person's vocabulary cannot establish universal historical usage.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I announced that everyone could arrive in whatever made them feel magnificent. June asked why my magnificent complimentary shuttle stopped three blocks away.

'The car photographs better beside the fountain.'

She looked at me for long enough to age the upholstery. Mika redirected the driver. June held the door while Dez climbed in wearing the disputed jacket.

'There,' June said. 'Now the freedom has transport.'

I went to tell the photographer about the fountain's unexpected independence.

Making Gay History: Mabel Hampton (authorized oral-history excerpts, 2026). Read scope: Read episode notes and the complete edited interview transcript; audio was not auditioned.

<https://makinggayhistory.org/podcast/mabel-hampton/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Ho4. Gladys Bentley: performance, desire and the price of public visibility

1920s-1950s

In Harlem, Gladys Bentley earned her living as a blues singer and pianist through parties and nightclub appearances. Suits, a top hat and flirtation with women became elements of her public performance. The American Masters documentary places that career within entertainment opportunities for Black women, while also describing criticism from people concerned with respectable public images of Black life. Celebrity and sexual visibility could coexist with constraint.

Bentley later worked in Los Angeles and altered her public presentation. An early-1950s magazine account presented claims about heterosexual marriage and hormonal treatment; those claims do not settle her private experience. The documentary interprets this turn against repression and employment pressures. Her history therefore invites attention to who controlled a performer's livelihood and reputation, without making stage clothing a reliable certificate of either sexual orientation or a modern gender identity.

The question underneath. Who gets to read an entertainer's clothes as freedom while ignoring the conditions of her employment?

Evidence limit: Documentary interpretation and Bentley's public claims are distinguished from independently established private experience.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

The costume consultant looked at Rae's shirt and began explaining Rae to Rae. It took him forty seconds to misplace an entire person.

'The shirt has a label,' she said. 'Try reading that one.'

He identified the washing temperature correctly. Velvet applauded once. Remy gave him a laundry bag instead of a microphone.

I asked whether the consultation was refundable. Nia said that depended on what I had paid him to know. Nigga, the invoice was suddenly very difficult to defend.

American Masters: Gladys Bentley: Gender-Bending Performer and Musician (PBS, 2020). Read scope: Read the complete online documentary transcript; did not watch the video.

<https://www.pbs.org/video/gladys-bentley-gender-bending-performer-and-musician-i0xlo0/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H05. A novel reaches the prosecutor's desk

Britain, 1928

The National Archives preserves an August 1928 communication about Radclyffe Hall's *The Well of Loneliness*. Its public description identifies a letter concerning possible prosecution for obscene libel; a Home Secretary's note threatened prosecution if the publisher did not withdraw the book. The accompanying transcript excerpt notes favorable literary reviews. The document makes a specific conflict visible: literary recognition did not prevent the state from treating a representation of lesbian life as a problem to suppress.

This is a record of official scrutiny, not a complete account of Hall, her politics, the novel's readers or the eventual litigation. It also asks us to separate a work's historical importance from agreement with every idea inside it. A book can provide recognition and still use concepts its later readers dispute. That last distinction is our reading question, rather than a claim that one prosecution document can summarize lesbian literature.

The question underneath. Who gets to decide whether depicting desire is itself indecent?

Evidence limit: The legal claim is limited to the dated document, not current law or a full trial history.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I appointed myself Head of Dangerous Literature and confiscated the karaoke binder.

Kit waited until I reached the third power ballad. 'What is the alleged danger?'

'Your intention to perform all of these.'

Velvet took the binder back. 'That is a scheduling dispute, sweetheart.'

For a man with a new sash, I was learning a discouraging number of limits to jurisdiction.

The National Archives - *Well of Loneliness*, DPP 1/88. Read scope: Archive description and indexed transcript excerpt read; direct page returned 403; no complete trial-file inspection.

<https://www.nationalarchives.gov.uk/education/resources/twenties-britain-part-two/well-of-loneliness/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Ho6. Ruth Ellis and Babe Franklin: a home with room to dance

1940s-1960s

Ruth Ellis and Ceciline 'Babe' Franklin made their Detroit home a gathering place for Black gay and lesbian people who encountered discrimination in bars. Known as the Gay Spot, it offered conversation, laughter and dancing across several decades. The Bentley Historical Library's account connects that hospitality with the couple's daily life, rather than presenting community as something created only by a formal organization or a public demonstration.

Ellis operated a printing business and darkroom from the same home, producing materials for local churches and small businesses. Work, partnership and social space were physically intertwined. Reading the house as community infrastructure is an interpretation grounded in those arrangements: people needed somewhere to gather, and someone had to sustain it. This was a household offering an alternative to commercial nightlife, not evidence that all Detroit venues shared the same exclusions or practices.

The question underneath. Whose work makes a welcoming room possible when a commercial venue closes its doors?

Evidence limit: The archival feature synthesizes earlier accounts; underlying collection boxes and the documentary were not examined.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I declared the room a historic community space. Rosa asked me to carry the folding chairs upstairs. 'Surely there is a ceremonial role.'

She handed me two chairs. 'Both hands.'

By the third trip I understood why history required refreshments. Shawna met me with water and a kiss on the cheek. I tried to turn toward the photographer without spilling either.

'Just enjoy being useful,' she said.

Nigga, it was more exhausting than being admired and significantly better received.

Katie Vloet, *Living with Pride* (Bentley Historical Library, Fall 2018). Read scope: Read the library feature, especially The Gay Spot section and its source list.

<https://bentley.umich.edu/about/collections-magazine/fall-2018/living-with-pride/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Ho7. The founders the simplified story leaves out

San Francisco, 1955-1956

The Library of Congress’s Daughters of Bilitis guide identifies Filipina Rosalie ‘Rose’ Bamberger as the person who proposed a private lesbian social club. Four couples met in 1955. Rose and her partner Rosemary Sliepen worked in brush manufacturing; the guide also identifies a founding participant known as Mary as Chicana. Del Martin and Phyllis Lyon became prominent figures, but prominence should not erase the other founders.

The organization’s move toward public advocacy created disagreement over exposure and risk. The guide reports that working-class founders were uncomfortable with that direction. The Ladder began in 1956 and built a nationally distributed lesbian readership. This history complicates a simple story of a white middle-class movement later discovering diversity. It also complicates the idea that private social life and public activism were identical needs. Our interpretive question is material: who could afford visibility, and who stood to lose work, privacy or a place to gather?

The question underneath. When does being visible help, and who bears the cost of becoming visible?

Evidence limit: Unequal public recognition does not mean lesser participation.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

The commemorative plaque arrived with my name occupying most of it. I said that was a template problem.

June asked who had booked the room, washed the cups and found the money before the template existed. I checked the plaque. There was no space left.

'Use the back,' Dez said.

'That sounds historically dangerous.'

She smiled. For once, I had learned something from an invoice.

Library of Congress - The Daughters of Bilitis. Read scope: Detailed archive research-guide text available through indexed web retrieval; original organizational records not independently read.

<https://guides.loc.gov/lgbtq-studies/before-stonewall/daughters-of-bilitis>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Ho8. A manifesto argues that desire is political

Radicalesbians, 1970

The Woman-Identified Woman is an argument by Radicalesbians, not a neutral dictionary entry. The 1970 manifesto treats the threat of being called a lesbian as a means of policing women, including women in liberation movements. It asks women to put their relationships with one another at the center of political life. Its ambitions exceed securing tolerance for a private sexual minority.

Reading it historically also means noticing its sweeping claims about women, men, social roles and sexuality. An influential intervention need not supply the language every later lesbian must accept. We can ask what becomes possible when people refuse shame and what becomes obscured when a shared political category seems to speak for everyone. That question opens room for the racial, class and gender disagreements elsewhere in this field guide. Those are comparisons we invite readers to make; the manifesto itself does not resolve them for us.

The question underneath. What changes when a private stigma becomes a collective political name?

Evidence limit: Historical political argument; its generalizations are not adopted as biological or universal facts.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I declared that every disagreement now had political significance. Shawna asked whether that included my shoes blocking the doorway.

'Especially those.'

'Then organize them elsewhere.'

I wanted a movement. Apparently it required moving. Tank watched me carry both shoes across the room with the solemnity normally reserved for a national flag.

Radicalesbians - The Woman-Identified Woman (1970). Read scope: Selected passages of the reproduced primary manifesto, PDF pages 1-3.

https://lgbtqhistory.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/04/The_Woman_Identified_Woman.pdf

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H09. Salsa Soul Sisters: making a community when the bars excluded you

Founded 1974; subsequent organizing

Salsa Soul Sisters formed in New York in 1974 as a community for lesbians of color. The American LGBTQ+ Museum describes racist bar practices that restricted entry or treated women of color differently once inside. Shared sexuality did not guarantee shared access. Organizing a separate space could therefore answer a concrete exclusion, while allowing members to define cultural and practical priorities themselves.

The group's activities connected poetry, music and dance with information about health and support for women entering jobs outside conventional expectations. Children and family life also belonged within that community. Archival descriptions record publications, retreats, events and meeting materials. Together these sources suggest an organization sustained through repeated work, rather than a single heroic founding moment. Its example complicates a simple opposition between social pleasure and politics: building a place to meet could involve both.

The question underneath. When does creating a separate room expand participation rather than abandon coalition?

Evidence limit: Accounts describe particular exclusions and organizational experiences, not every lesbian bar or every member's perspective.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

My inclusive buffet had acquired a sponsor-only rope. Tank was on one side of it. The casserole was on the other. Diplomacy had approximately eight seconds left.

I explained that the rope was ornamental. Rosa unhooked it.

'Then it can ornament the cupboard.'

Rae took Nia a plate and asked what she wanted on it. The evening resumed its actual business. My sponsorship representative stood holding a velvet cable with no remaining social function.

American LGBTQ+ Museum, 50 Years | Salsa Soul Sisters. Read scope: Read the full anniversary article, including founders' recollections.

<https://americanlgbtqmuseum.org/salsa-soul-sisters/>

Lesbian Herstory Archives, Salsa Soul Sisters Exhibitions and Events. Read scope: Read the collection and exhibition description; individual archival items were not examined.

<https://lesbianherstoryarchives.org/salsa-soul-sisters/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H10. The archive is also an argument about who matters

Lesbian Herstory Archives, 1970s onward

The Lesbian Herstory Archives describes its origins in groups that formed through the Gay Academic Union during the 1970s. Its mission is to preserve records of lesbian lives and make them available to future generations. The archive's own digital-resource descriptions name photographs, periodicals, organizational and personal records, shirts, buttons and newsletters. Ordinary possessions and community-made media are evidence, not merely decoration around famous lives.

The 1978 newsletter's statement of purpose makes the collecting ambition explicit: experiences omitted by dominant historical accounts should be recorded and preserved. Reading this alongside elite diaries changes the question from 'Who was exceptional enough to remember?' to 'What work lets ordinary lives remain knowable?' This is our interpretive comparison. A collection's existence does not make every past life recoverable, and the website's description is not a substitute for opening each record.

The question underneath. What counts as evidence when nobody important thought your life worth filing?

Evidence limit: The 1978 newsletter's mission statement was inspected separately; most collection items were not read.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I donated a portrait. June donated a shoebox. The shoebox immediately became more interesting. There were old programmes, a button, a photograph with writing on the back and a receipt nobody could agree about. My portrait contained only me, at an angle I had approved.

'Can the frame hold documents?' Mika asked.

Nigga, my face was one hinge away from becoming useful storage.

Lesbian Herstory Archives - Digital Resources. Read scope: Collection descriptions read; individual recordings not auditioned.

<https://www.lesbianherstoryarchives.org/digital-resources/>

Lesbian Herstory Archives - institutional history. Read scope: Mission and institutional-origin description read.

<https://www.lesbianherstoryarchives.org/>

Lesbian Herstory Archives Newsletter 4, February 1978. Read scope: Indexed text of the statement of purpose inspected; no claim of full ten-page reading.

<https://lesbianherstoryarchives.org/content/uploads/2020/06/News04.pdf>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H11. Combahee: political theory required travel money, meals and relationships

Mid-to-late 1970s; recalled in 2003

Barbara Smith's oral history describes the Combahee River Collective and related Black feminist retreats as settings where political analysis, cultural exchange and ordinary logistics met. Participants pooled travel money and borrowed homes; serious discussion shared time with food and performances. Smith recalled Audre Lorde, Cheryl Clarke and Gloria Hull among those contributing cultural work. These recollections show ideas developing through relationships and material arrangements, not only through a finished manifesto.

Smith also acknowledged personal conflicts, including tensions around friendship, attraction and attachment, while declining to narrate private details. That boundary deserves respect: desire mattered within organizing, but it does not explain away the politics. Her account gives a useful alternative to either saintly unity or gossip. A group could produce enduring work while its members struggled with intimacy, disagreement and the pressure of depending deeply on one another.

The question underneath. How can political intimacy support collective work without turning friendship into an obligation to agree?

Evidence limit: This is Smith's retrospective account; she explicitly expresses uncertainty about the first retreat's year.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I reserved the quiet room for Advanced Theory. Three people wanted it for private conversations, and one wanted to sit without my voice coming through a speaker.

'Which one is theory?' I asked.

Mika checked the booking sheet. 'Yours is the only request that can survive in the corridor.'

Shawna found me outside rehearsing my introduction. She took my hand. 'You could spend ten minutes having a life instead of announcing one.'

Nigga, I cancelled the introduction and kept the reservation for us.

Barbara Smith interviewed by Loretta J. Ross, Voices of Feminism Oral History Project (May 7-8, 2003). Read scope: Read interview metadata and transcript pages 66-70 on conflicts, retreats and statement circulation.

<https://www.smith.edu/libraries/libs/ssc/vof/transcripts/Smith.pdf>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H12. Audre Lorde: desire as knowledge, pleasure as a political question

1978

In *Uses of the Erotic*, Audre Lorde argues that deep feeling and the capacity for joy can inform how people judge their work, relationships and political lives. Her erotic is wider than sexual activity: she connects embodied pleasure, creative effort and the experience of sharing with others. This argument challenges arrangements that measure work only through profit or treat emotional needs as irrelevant.

Lorde writes from her position as a Black lesbian feminist and links meaningful shared experience with the possibility of collective action. She also distinguishes sharing another person's feelings from using that person, making consent part of the argument. Read historically, this is a forceful intervention into how desire and power might connect, not proof of an innate feminine essence or a checklist that every lesbian must satisfy.

The question underneath. What changes when pleasure becomes a question about meaningful work and mutuality, as well as sex?

Evidence limit: Lorde's theoretical claims are attributed to her; this reproduction is not a critical scholarly edition.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

The Pleasure Committee reported that decorating my private lounge had become a joyless unpaid shift. I told them the result would be spectacular.

'For whom?' Velvet asked.

I turned toward the half-installed mirror and caught myself answering.

Rae suggested I finish the decorations while everyone else tried a game. Shawna left me one uninflated balloon. 'Start with a small ambition.'

Nigga, I had funded a committee that could recognize bad work immediately. It was proving expensive in ways I had not budgeted.

Audre Lorde, *The Uses of the Erotic: The Erotic as Power* (public reproduction excerpted from *Sister Outsider*). Read scope: Read all three pages of the reproduced essay; no authoritative-edition collation was performed.

https://mamagenas.com/wp3/wp-content/uploads/2016/M16/Uses_of_the_Erotic.pdf

University of Waterloo, (1978) - *Uses of the Erotic* - Audre Lorde. Read scope: Read the catalogue entry to confirm the 1978 date.

<https://uwaterloo.ca/equity-diversity-inclusion-anti-racism/catalogs/educational-catalogue-resources/1978-uses-erotic-audre-lorde>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H13. Chicana lesbian thought: a coalition must remember who built it

1981 anthology; Moraga's 2015 retrospective, reprinted in 2016

Cherríe Moraga's Chicana lesbian writing places sexuality beside language, family and political belonging. She coedited *This Bridge Called My Back* with Gloria Anzaldúa in 1981, assembling different literary and artistic forms around women of color's lives. This was a coalition project, not a claim that every contributor occupied the same position. Moraga's own work moves between Spanish and English, poetry and prose, making form part of the encounter rather than treating theory as something detached from a life.

In a later preface excerpt, Moraga argues that political memory matters: movements lose something when each generation imagines itself the first to invent resistance. Her argument connects intimate and institutional conflicts with work, migration and place. Read together, these selected sources suggest a demanding question for coalition: whose lived knowledge becomes the foundation, and whose becomes an optional addition? That is our synthesis of the excerpts, not a summary of every essay in the anthology.

The question underneath. Who gets treated as a source of political theory, and who is merely invited to supply an illustrative personal story?

Evidence limit: This is a US Chicana contribution to a wider coalition, not a substitute for every Latina or Latin American lesbian history.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I had invented coalition before lunch. By dinner, Kit had found three books and two people who could explain why my announcement was late.

I offered to call it a reimagining. June offered to call it reading.

The reading list was under the buffet's short leg. Rae retrieved it, repaired the table and asked whether my keynote had any other structural applications.

Nigga, I gave the first ten minutes to somebody who had arrived knowing something.

Cherríe Moraga, *Catching Fire - La Voz de Esperanza*, March 2016, excerpt from the fourth-edition preface. Read scope: One-page scan of printed pages 2-3; read Moraga's excerpt and its permission note, not the complete preface or anthology.

<https://thisbridgecalledcyberspace.net/FILES/3904.pdf>

Haymarket Books - *Loving in the War Years: And Other Writings*, 1978-1999. Read scope: Publisher's description and edition metadata; no full-book reading claimed.

<https://www.haymarketbooks.org/books/2006-loving-in-the-war-years>

Gloria E. Anzaldúa Literary Trust - *This Bridge Called My Back*. Read scope: Book description, publication history and coalition discussion; no anthology chapters read through this page.

<https://gloriaeanzaldua.com/this-bridge-called-my-back/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

H14. Pleasure and danger were not obliged to become enemy nations

Barnard sexuality conference, 1982

Barnard's retrospective account describes the 1982 Scholar and Feminist conference as a flashpoint in arguments over sexuality. The planners wanted to address both sexual violence and women's right to pleasure. A diary documenting preparation, writing and artwork became the focus of controversy; the college attempted to confiscate it and later paid for a reprint without its name. The institutional response belongs to the history of the argument, not just its publicity.

The retrospective criticizes a division that framed participants as either pro-sex or anti-violence. That opposition concealed the conference's attempt to think about both. This does not mean all positions were compatible or that harms were imaginary. It gives our fiction a better problem than 'the fun lesbians defeat the prudish ones': how can people discuss coercion, erotic possibility and unequal power without pretending one concern automatically answers the others? The question remains a question rather than an official verdict on the entire feminist sex wars.

The question underneath. Who gets lost when pleasure and protection are treated as mutually exclusive loyalties?

Evidence limit: This account is one retrospective perspective on a larger, contested history.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I commissioned two lecterns: FUN and SAFETY. They arrived bolted together.

'A manufacturing mistake,' I said.

Nia put her notes across both. 'Leave it.'

Darnell offered to improve the discussion with cocaine. Shawna moved his proposal away from the pastries. Velvet asked whether anybody had considered being outrageous while still listening when another person said no.

The contractor sent an invoice for innovative joinery. For once, I paid without a speech.

The Scholar and Feminist Online - retrospective introduction to thirty years of the conference. Read scope: Institutional retrospective's 1982-conference passages read; full conference proceedings not read.

<https://sfoonline.barnard.edu/sfxxx/printtjja.htm>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H15. Punk, clubs, sex and politics occupy the same room

Rebel Dykes, London, 1980s-early 1990s

Bishopsgate Institute's Rebel Dykes collection describes a network of lesbians and punk women in London whose lives connected art, music, club nights and political organizing. The archive names activity around Greenham Common, the South London Women's Hospital occupation, anti-censorship, sex workers' rights, opposition to Section 28 and HIV/AIDS activism. Its holdings include footage, images and later oral histories connected with Chain Reaction and the SM community.

The useful point is not that this network represents all British lesbians or that everyone agreed about sex. A locally specific scene can combine pleasure, practical mutual reliance and controversial politics. A club is not necessarily a holiday from history; it can be one of the places history is made. That interpretation also resists flattening the past into either respectable petitioners or a costume party. Here the details are drawn from the collection description, while the recordings themselves remain a further-reading route.

The question underneath. What kinds of organizing become visible if the dance floor counts as a serious place?

Evidence limit: A particular London network, not a universal account of lesbian sexual culture.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I asked Velvet to recreate a historic underground club. She asked how underground I meant. I pointed to the penthouse.

'You mean exclusive.'

'It has an elevator.'

'Those are different problems.'

Remy tested the speakers. The bass shook a small gold plaque off my portrait. The room voted, without holding a vote, that this was the best use of the sound system so far.

Bishopsgate Institute - Rebel Dykes Archive. Read scope: Administrative history and scope/content description read; oral histories and film not watched.

<https://www.bishopsgate.org.uk/collections/rebel-dykes-archive/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H16. Women were people with AIDS, organizers and caregivers

ACT UP and women's AIDS activism, late 1980s-1990s

The ACT UP Oral History Project's Women & AIDS page insists on several roles at once: women living with AIDS, movement leaders and caregivers. Its materials describe organizing over the CDC definition of AIDS, women's access to services, prison conditions and peer support. The page also identifies work by Maxine Wolfe, Sarah Schulman, Catherine Gund and other participants. A lesbian history that mentions only care for gay men would miss the political agency and varied lives represented here.

The site is an activist archive, and its framing should be identified as such. For this guide, the inspected evidence is its descriptions of films, printed materials and campaigns; we did not watch every recording. Our interpretive connection is to coalition work: sharing a movement does not guarantee that everyone's urgent needs appear in its public story. Counting people, funding services and changing institutional criteria are also political acts. This is historical context, not present-day medical advice.

The question underneath. Who becomes a patient, a leader or only somebody else's helper in the movement's memory?

Evidence limit: No claim that all women in this archive were lesbians; no simplistic origin story for acronym order.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

My first coalition report had a section called Supportive Ladies. Nia drew one line through the heading.

'Where are the decision-makers?' she asked.

I pointed at the same names.

'Then why did you write this?'

I blamed the software. Kit rotated the laptop toward me. The offending phrase was still selected, and my hands were still on the keyboard. Nigga, technology had become a witness for the prosecution.

ACT UP Oral History Project - Women & AIDS. Read scope: Curatorial descriptions and identified campaign/media records read; videos not auditioned.

<https://www.actuporalhistory.org/actions/women-aids>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H17. Wabanaki perspectives: a shared term does not erase a nation's own names

1990 terminology milestone; Wabanaki organizing from 2009

The Wabanaki Two-Spirit Alliance explains that Two-Spirit was introduced at the 1990 International Indigenous Lesbian and Gay Gathering in Winnipeg. A shared term could support reclamation without replacing the names, teachings or roles of individual nations. Its account connects identity with kinship, land, language and responsibilities; a translation concerned only with sexual attraction would miss part of what is being described.

The Alliance traces its own beginnings to a 2009 gathering responding to isolation and loss, while emphasizing cultural connection, celebration and life. It includes people who name themselves in several ways. Some Indigenous people identify as lesbian or queer without identifying as Two-Spirit; neither label authorizes an outsider to assign the other. For a lesbian history appendix, this is a necessary boundary as well as a connection: solidarity can support another community's self-definition without absorbing it into a familiar identity category.

The question underneath. Can a coalition share resources without demanding that every participant translate themselves into its organizer's preferred categories?

Evidence limit: Two-Spirit is not a universal Indigenous identity or a synonym for lesbian; this account reflects one regional alliance.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

My universal label maker ran out of space after the first person introduced themselves. I offered abbreviations.

Mika offered the off switch. Nia asked why a machine I had bought ten minutes ago should have more authority than the people standing in front of it.

I said the manufacturer called it professional. Kit printed AIDEN on a blank card and handed me a pen.

The remaining space was for whatever I learned next. It was a humiliatingly large card.

Wabanaki Two-Spirit Alliance - Understanding the Term Two-Spirit. Read scope: Definition, 1990 gathering account, historical context and self-naming guidance; nation-specific vocabulary lists not generalized.

<https://w2sa.ca/two-spirit-library/understanding-the-term-two-spirit>

Wabanaki Two-Spirit Alliance - The Story of W2SA. Read scope: Community description, purpose, 2009 origin account and cultural-gathering history.

<https://w2sa.ca/about>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H18. Visibility becomes an action, not a compliment

Lesbian Avengers, 1992-1993

The Lesbian Avenger Documentary Project dates the New York group's beginnings to 1992 and names six experienced founders: Ana Simo, Sarah Schulman, Maxine Wolfe, Anne-christine d'Adesky, Marie Honan and Anne Maguire. Its account connects the first action to the fight over Queens's multicultural Children of the Rainbow curriculum and to frustration with lesbian invisibility. Media and visually striking action were tools, not incidental decorations.

The project describes the 1993 Washington Dyke March as a major moment in the group's expansion. Reading its own history shows both specificity and circulation: a local strategy could inspire other chapters without giving a single office ownership of every lesbian demand. Our editorial question is about who is seen and on whose terms. Visibility can mean appearing in somebody else's photograph, or deciding what action puts a previously neglected issue in front of the public. Those are not interchangeable achievements.

The question underneath. Are people merely visible, or do they control what the public is being asked to notice?

Evidence limit: The account calls itself incomplete; chapter experiences should not be treated as identical.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I offered the coalition a publicity package. Velvet asked what it contained.

'My face, but supportive.'

She asked again.

'A larger version for outdoor use.'

Mika turned my easel toward the wall and handed the performers the programme. The publicity improved so quickly I briefly suspected sabotage. Tank assured me that, in this case, those were the same event.

Lesbian Avenger Documentary Project - A Brief History. Read scope: Participant documentary project's organizational account read; no complete archive or film viewing.

<https://www.lesbianavengers.com/about/history.shtml>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H19. Gauteng: Nkateko and the placards that remain

1996-1998

GALA's guide records Nkateko, founded in Gauteng by Beverley Palesa Ditsie in 1996. It describes the constituency using period language for Black lesbian, bisexual and transgender gay women. The group participated in Johannesburg Pride in 1997 and dissolved in 1998. Collection AM 2661 contains organizational information and 22 handmade placards from that Pride.

This modest inventory changes what a historical story can notice. A short-lived organization can leave evidence of collective expression without becoming a lasting institution. The placards invite investigation of how participants presented themselves, although we read the catalog rather than the signs. Our interpretation remains limited: traces of agency and gathering cannot supply the group's complete internal history. Its disagreements, pleasures and reasons for ending remain questions to explore in the collection.

The question underneath. Which movements disappear when longevity and famous leaders determine what counts as historically important?

Evidence limit: Historical group terminology does not establish every participant's identity or explain the dissolution.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I ordered a bronze monument to the summit. June collected the handwritten signs. Her collection could tell you what people had asked for. Mine could tell you my preferred jawline.

The foundry called about the deposit. I asked whether they could cast a cancellation instead.

'Keep the invoice,' Dez said. 'You never know what idiots will make historically significant.'

Nigga, I filed it flat and checked both sides.

GALA Queer Archive - Collection guide, Nkateko AM 2661. Read scope: Nkateko entry, printed pages 59-60 of currently served PDF; objects not inspected.

<https://gala.co.za/wp-content/uploads/2021/08/GALA-Archival-Guide-20210825.pdf>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H2o. Kolkata: support, public argument and a magazine in one's own voice

1999-2004 founding and early publishing milestones

Sappho began in Kolkata in June 1999 as a self-support group for lesbians, bisexual women and transmasculine people. The organization's retrospective describes a wish to share ordinary dreams and difficulties as well as desire. Sappho for Equality followed in October 2003 as a platform connecting community support to rights and wider social participation. These are related developments with different dates, not interchangeable names for a single founding moment.

In January 2004, the group published the first Swakanthey, its bilingual magazine, and distributed it at Kolkata's book fair. Art, poetry, prose and articles offered a public creative voice beyond organizational announcements. This history holds a useful tension: people may need an intimate place to belong and also want to address audiences beyond it. The group's account includes debating and revising its own approach; it is not a tidy march from private silence to a finished public freedom.

The question underneath. How can a group speak publicly without making public visibility a condition of receiving friendship and support?

Evidence limit: This Kolkata account cannot represent all of India or South Asia; transmasculine participants must not be relabeled as lesbians.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

The first issue of our summit magazine had twelve photographs of me and a generous half-column reserved for everybody's voices.

Mercedes asked whether voices came in smaller sizes now. Velvet laid her performance photograph over my centerfold. Remy placed a drawing on top of my chairman's message.

Shawna found the one picture where I was actually helping. They kept that one.

My publishing career survived, substantially reduced in square footage.

Sappho for Equality - About Us. Read scope: Organization's Sappho and Sappho for Equality histories, including June 1999 and October 2003 milestones.

<https://www.sapphokolkata.in/about-us>

Sappho for Equality - 2003 Landmarks. Read scope: Inception and support-to-entitlements discussion; counseling chronology read but not evaluated as clinical evidence.

<https://www.sapphokolkata.in/our-journey/details/69>

Sappho for Equality - 2004 Landmarks. Read scope: First Swakanthey publication and book-fair account; the magazine's individual issues were not read.

<https://www.sapphokolkata.in/our-journey/details/67>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H21. The Philippines: GALANG puts economic life inside sexual politics

2008 founding and the organization's subsequent program account

GALANG describes beginnings in conversations among lesbian friends and its registration in the Philippines in August 2008. Its founders wanted organizing to confront the relationship between sexuality and poverty. The organization identifies itself as lesbian-initiated and lesbian-run, working with lesbians, bisexual women and trans men in urban poor communities. Its account therefore places employment, services and material resources inside the discussion of sexual and gender freedom.

The program description joins community leadership training and participatory research with policy advocacy. It also lists Tatsulok Komiks, a lesbian comic-book series, among its educational materials. Creative storytelling belongs here alongside practical organizing, rather than appearing only after material needs have been solved. These sources describe an organization's purposes and methods, not an independent evaluation of its results. Their challenge to this appendix is concrete: an account of recognition remains incomplete if it never asks how people gain the resources to live and organize.

The question underneath. What changes when a sexual-freedom agenda treats access to work and services as central rather than supplementary?

Evidence limit: The organization does not stand for every Filipino community; an alliance among LBT people does not erase their different identities.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

The gold-plated Visibility Award cost more than the transport reimbursements. The volunteers noticed because the reimbursements had not happened.

I proposed a photograph with the award. Rosa proposed paying people.

Shawna turned the trophy upside down and read the return policy. The cashier asked why I was returning it. I said we had discovered a more practical form of recognition.

Nigga, a bank transfer had none of the trophy's sparkle and considerably more fans.

GALANG Philippines - About Us. Read scope: Full organization-authored About text returned by search index; founding account and constituency, excluding undated poverty statistics.

<https://www.galangphilippines.org/about/>

GALANG Philippines - What We Do. Read scope: Full indexed program description: capacity building, advocacy, research and institutional development; comics themselves not read.

<https://www.galangphilippines.org/about/what-we-do/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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H22. Stone is not the final boss of masculinity

Contemporary terminology, with historical inheritances

Ro White's Autostraddle discussion draws on interviews and earlier lesbian writing to describe variation in stone identities. Some people use the word for firm limits on receiving sexual touch; others describe more specific boundaries. The article cautions against assuming that every stone person has the same explanation, history or relationship to gender. Its contemporary testimony is useful precisely because it does not yield a single personality profile.

For this book, the distinction is between self-description and an outsider's prediction. Clothes, confidence, race or a partner's femininity do not tell another person what contact is wanted. Nor is changing someone's boundary a romantic achievement. Those are ethical conclusions we bring to the fiction, rather than instructions for an intimate act. A reader can learn vocabulary without treating it as a license to interrogate a stranger. The term may help someone communicate; the actual person still supplies the meaning that matters in that relationship.

The question underneath. Does a label help a person speak, or are you using it to stop listening?

Evidence limit: This is non-graphic discussion of identity, desire and boundaries; terminology varies.

AIDEN HAS ENTERED THE ARCHIVE / FICTION

I had designed a masculinity leaderboard. At the top was a photograph of a very large boot.

Rae asked what the boot had consented to. I said the image was licensed.

'Different question,' Nia said.

Kit liked the boot. June hated the heel. Shawna asked why a chart about other people had my signature across it.

Nigga, I deleted the ranking. The boot remained handsome and entirely unavailable for comment.

Ro White - The Gay B C's of Sex: S Is for Stone. Read scope: Article text including first-person interview accounts inspected through indexed retrieval; no participant treated as representative of all stone people.

<https://www.autostraddle.com/stone-butch-definition/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Cultural reading notes

These are cultural reading notes, not a taxonomy of people. The dialogues are original fiction: each character has a partial perspective and no character speaks for an entire community. The fictional 1967 feud is not actual LGBTQ history. The notes below distinguish what was inspected from what was not.

C1. Black lesbian gender and sexual culture: celebration and resistance

Wilson's qualitative study describes gender and sexual roles in one African American lesbian community as sources of both expectations and resistance. That situated finding cautions against treating a character's label as a universal rule about behavior, desire or power.

Read scope: Abstract only; full article not inspected for this revision.

<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/19296308/>

C2. Brown Boi Project - About Us

The organization describes work among masculine-of-center women and queer and trans people of color across racial and gender justice. Its account helps frame masculinity as something people can enjoy, examine and change without assuming identical experiences or power.

Read scope: Organizational self-description and participant testimony on the About Us page.

<https://www.brownboiproject.org/about-us.html>

C3. The Combahee River Collective Statement

The collective connects race, gender, sexuality and class, and pairs solidarity with criticism of sexism. Its position informs the distinction between cooperation and erasure of internal conflict. It is a specific 1977 political statement; it is not evidence for the invented 1967 feud.

Read scope: Selected sections of the primary statement, especially pages 1-4 of this reproduction.

https://lgbtqhistory.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/04/Combahee_River_Collective_Statement.pdf

C4. Stone Butch Blues - selected author notes

These notes emphasize context, changing terminology, self-definition and collective connection. They provide a reason to let different generations use language differently, rather than force every fictional person into a single present-day vocabulary. The novel's scenes and prose are not reproduced.

Read scope: Selected author notes, printed pages 333-335 / PDF pages 350-352. No fresh full reading of the novel is claimed.

<https://www.lesliefeinberg.net/wp-content/uploads/2015/08/Stone-Butch-Blues-by-Leslie-Feinberg.pdf>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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C5. What Is a Stud? The History of Black Lesbian Masculinity

The interviewees describe varied personal expressions of stud identity, including nonbinary experience, within Black queer culture. These accounts resist a checklist of clothes, sexual roles or personality traits. The fictional Rae speaks for herself.

Read scope: Brief use of first-person interviews with Cortney Matthewis and \$leazy EZ; no interview quotations reused.

<https://www.them.us/story/what-is-a-stud-the-history-of-black-lesbian-masculinity>

C6. The Gender of Desire: Joan Nestle's Last Interview - Our Dyke Histories

Nestle's first-person account brings pleasure, class, race and risk into the same social world. It helps foreground femme desire and agency, rather than making a femme character a passive partner or a reward. No interview scene or erotic passage is adapted.

Read scope: Selected written interview/transcript passages; audio not auditioned.

<https://www.queergeographies.com/the-gender-of-desire-joan-nestles-last-interview/>

C7. Mabel Hampton Oral History Project - Reflections on Lesbian Fashion

The exhibit's presentation of Hampton helps check against erasing Black butch lives or equating butchness with whiteness. Clothing and self-description belong to a particular life. June is an invented character, not a portrait of Hampton.

Read scope: Curatorial descriptions inspected; recordings not auditioned and no new transcript made.

<https://herstories.prattinfoschool.nyc/omeka/exhibits/show/reflections-on-lesbian-fashion/mabel-hampton-oral-history-pro>

C8. Sylvia Rivera's 1973 speech - transcript in Document Set 3

Rivera's speech challenges exclusion within a movement and asks who provides material support to vulnerable community members. It informs the coalition's concern with paid work, resources and accountability. Rivera does not appear in the fiction, and no speech is assigned to a fictional character.

Read scope: Speech transcript on PDF page 2. The packet's Stonewall biographical claim is not relied upon.

<https://teachrock.org/wp-content/uploads/Document-Set-3-Sylvia-Rivera.pdf>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 2 OF SIX

The Treasury Has Survived the Second Great War

Turn-based strategy, cards and role-playing

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.

Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan's creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.

Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.
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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden's scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [Both Sides of the Paper and Who Gets Paid to Hold It](#) - page 27. Money, labor and respectability.

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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 2. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P041	P042	P043	P044	P045	P046	P047	P048
2. Ready for conversation	P049	P050	P051	P052	P053	P054	P055	P056
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P057	P058	P059	P060	P061	P062	P063	P064
4. Here for the atmosphere	P065	P066	P067	P068	P069	P070	P071	P072
5. Open to a wildcard	P073	P074	P075	P076	P077	P078	P079	P080

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A Coalition Cannot Pay You in Exposure

“Nigga, why is your chair listed as a vehicle?” Tank asked.

The hotel manager had delivered the financial statement in a folder thick enough to qualify as supporting furniture. We had found the agenda, recovered the pen, and agreed to discuss money before the evening grew any more ceremonial. I had responded by taking my seat in a mechanical photo throne. Its footrest extended into the exact place the catering staff needed to walk. Even my sitting down had logistical consequences.

“It's powered,” I explained. “So is a vacuum,” Rae said. “One of those would help.” She had returned from showing Nia her bike and looked unusually pleased with a discussion of brake cables. Nia looked pleased too. Neither had submitted a report. I respected their privacy by waiting almost twelve seconds before suggesting a commemorative photograph. Shawna squeezed my shoulder until my interest in documentation subsided.

The second room offered strategy games, card battles, long role-playing stories, and enough imaginary governments to support my worst instincts. I had printed place cards for ministries. Rae's said Practical Affairs. Kit's said Cultural Affairs. Nia's said Legal Affairs. Shawna looked at the last word and asked whether her ministry could be Private Affairs, beginning with my immediate removal from public office. I assured her my domestic portfolio remained exceptionally strong. “Your portfolio was late to its appointment,” she said. Tank studied the invoice harder, out of respect for a man dying in office.

Velvet put her actual contract beside the ministries. She had a costume rack, a rehearsed number, and a fee that didn't become less real because I called the evening a coalition. Remy wanted his microphone checked and his fanfare left gloriously ridiculous. Mercedes wanted her own set and recording arrangements honored. Porsche wanted nobody borrowing her equipment in exchange for gratitude. Rosa wanted staff time paid. Those were concrete requests. My request concerned being photographed beneath a large symbolic eagle nobody remembered approving.

Mika loved the eagle. “It would look incredible over the stage.” I pointed at them triumphantly. “But we don't have the rigging or the money,” they continued. The betrayal arrived with professional measurements. They put their tiny model hotel on the table and began using coins to represent possible costs. It was the first casino activity that had frightened me before anybody placed a bet.

June and Dez arrived carrying the Blue Comet folder. The jacket came too, over Dez's arm. June identified it as her asset before she sat down. Dez identified her alterations as a long-term investment. Their 1967 peace arrangement had apparently failed because each believed the other had refused to sign. Both now wanted the current summit to recognize their excellent record of reasonable behavior. I understood the emotional appeal of a committee certifying whatever story made you look best.

Nia declined to certify either veteran's entire life. She would help read the old paper during the break. For now she wanted clear terms for this evening and then freedom to be a guest. Rae

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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moved the good crackers within her reach without interrupting her sentence. Kit slid a lamp toward them, then reclaimed it an inch because she needed light on her own notes too. Nobody disappeared into service. Everybody kept a chair.

Dre sat down with his casserole and claimed the blue controller he'd brought. His Crip affiliation didn't make him my Minister of Blue Lighting, a position he declined before I finished explaining it. Darnell offered to underwrite entertainment from future yacht income. Velvet asked whether future money could arrive before present soundcheck. Darnell looked toward the bar, where his economic theory faced fewer follow-up questions.

I wanted to tell everyone that turn-based games meant a peaceful room. Shawna tapped the thick financial statement. "This waits while you think. Does it feel simple?" Fair. Waiting gave us time to understand decisions; it didn't remove the decisions. The useful game notes would remain plain, so a person could choose an appealing challenge without having me convert patience into a promise of ease.

I raised the ceremonial pen. Nia handed me an ordinary pencil. "Until we agree on the numbers." The mechanical chair lowered itself with a squeak that sounded expensive. Tank caught my glass. Rosa moved the catering trolley past my newly humbled knees. Nigga, the treasury had opened for business, and its first order was getting my ass out of the aisle.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P041 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Sid Meier's Civilization VI

Edition considered: PC base game, no expansion requirement

Build a civilization whose cities, discoveries, and relationships reflect your decisions, gradually creating a history with a direction of your own.

What you do. Found a city, choose its production or research, and manage units, districts, policies, and relationships with neighboring powers over successive turns.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Solo turns allow deliberation, but menus and planning are heavy; test map gestures and readability rather than assuming cognitive simplicity.

Why it might click. Build a civilization across a large sweep of history, choosing how cities grow, what people research and how to deal with neighboring powers. The appeal is seeing many small decisions create a society with a recognizable direction rather than following one prescribed storyline.

The full catch. District placement, research, policies, diplomacy and multiple units produce heavy menu and planning demands. Single-player turns permit deliberation, but this is emphatically not cognitively simple because it is turn-based. Avoid assuming online turn settings match solo play; held map gestures and interface readability still need a trial.

Try this first. Use the guided opening or a modest single-player start to found one city and make one production choice. Judge whether the explanations make that decision interesting before opening an empire's worth of additional responsibilities.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P041 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Sid Meier's Civilization VI

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Capital Has Four Fountains and No Change

Civilization VI encouraged me to describe the summit budget as an emerging nation. I pointed at the four decorative fountains on the rental sheet. “Public infrastructure.”

Rosa pointed at the unpaid extra staff hours. “Public embarrassment.” Tank leaned over the page. “Nigga, your civilization discovered waterfalls before wages.”

Kit wanted one fountain moved away from her music stand because its cheerful gurgling competed with every quiet note. Rae wanted the same fountain emptied before somebody knocked it over beside the signing table.

I argued that capitals needed grandeur. Nia asked whether grandeur had a receipt we could cancel. Mika admitted the fountains looked beautiful, then identified two we could return without dismantling half the room.

June offered to name the remaining pair after herself and Dez. Dez said naming something after her didn't satisfy a debt, especially if it mostly leaked.

We returned two fountains. The staff line became payable. I announced the first reform of my administration. Shawna wrote CARRIED THE FOUNTAIN beside my name, which was historically precise and politically devastating.

Aiden's verdict. The empire-building scope can be rewarding when its planning appeals; waiting turns do not simplify it. Our capital has achieved payroll by reducing its unnecessary population of fountains.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact base-game PC listing supports districts, research, policies and diplomacy. Waits refers to single-player turn decisions; complete input comfort and multiplayer timer/co-op configurations are not verified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/289070/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P042 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Old World

Edition considered: PC base game

Guide a historical dynasty where aging rulers, competing families, and personal events give empire management a continuing story about people.

What you do. Read a ruler's decision, consider its personal consequences, and manage cities, resources, character roles, and court relationships as the dynasty develops.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Untimed input is declared, but cities and family relationships form a dense strategy game; co-op setup needs separate checking.

Why it might click. Old World combines historical strategy with a living dynasty: rulers age, families compete, children grow and personal events affect the state. People and relationships can give empire management a more intimate story than a map of anonymous production totals.

The full catch. The developer declares play without timed input, a mouse-only option and saving at any time. That is encouraging for pacing, while court relationships, cities, resources and character roles still make this a dense strategy game. Declared co-op exists, but its setup and shared responsibilities require a separate check.

Try this first. Follow the introductory guidance until one ruler faces one clear decision. Read the affected person's name and consequence, then decide whether that personal layer makes the surrounding management enjoyable or merely adds another spreadsheet to remember.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P042 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Old World

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dynasty Has Inherited a Cardigan

Old World's family politics made June argue that the Blue Comet jacket debt should be treated as a dynastic matter. Dez asked whether decades of alterations entitled her heirs to a sleeve.

“Your heirs can inherit the cardigan,” June said. “My aunt liked that cardigan,” Dez replied. “Then your aunt can adjudicate, nigga.”

I offered to establish a hereditary Ministry of Restitution. Nia asked whether I intended to pay its salaries. Suddenly I admired a smaller government.

Rae examined the photograph of the original jacket. She liked the stitching across the shoulder. Dez began explaining how she'd altered it, and Kit leaned closer because she'd never seen a lining like that.

June listened, pretending not to. When Dez described the final fitting, June remembered which song had been playing. They disagreed about the song but remembered the same ridiculous dance step.

Shawna touched my knee beneath the table. “That's a dynasty.” I nodded like I understood, then offered to order a crest. “Nigga,” she said, and the noble house survived without merchandise.

Aiden’s verdict. The dynasty's personal events may make empire management attractive, with its dense systems understood. Our inherited claim concerns one jacket, one cardigan, and a remarkably durable shared memory.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact listing supports dynasties/families and declares no timed input, Mouse Only Option, Save Anytime and co-op. Those declarations do not establish low menu load or a personally comfortable multiplayer arrangement.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/597180/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P043 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

HUMANKIND

Edition considered: PC base game

Combine cultures across historical eras, shaping a civilization whose cities, conflicts, and achievements reflect an accumulating series of different choices.

What you do. Choose developments, manage resources and diplomacy, and make battlefield decisions while adapting the civilization to changes across successive historical eras.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Empire and battlefield systems overlap, making memory demands high; solo turns do not establish relaxed settings in every configuration.

Why it might click. Shape a civilization by combining cultures across eras rather than staying with a single identity throughout history. City growth, fame and tactical conflicts turn the map into an account of accumulated decisions, including choices about what kind of achievements matter.

The full catch. Empire management and battlefield decisions sit on top of one another. Culture transitions add systems to learn, while resources, diplomacy and competing goals make the memory load high. Turn-based battles do not establish a universally simple control scheme or relaxed multiplayer timer settings; begin with solo play and inspect menus.

Try this first. Follow the early guidance through one development choice and read what it changes. Stop to decide whether comparing those possibilities feels engaging before treating the next historical era as an obligation to keep playing.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P043 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

HUMANKIND

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ministry Has Changed Its Outfit Again

HUMANKIND's changing cultures inspired my declaration that the summit could evolve beyond its first identity. Velvet looked at my new ceremonial jacket. "You mean your fourth outfit."

"Adaptation." "Dry-cleaning liability."

Mika wanted to move from welcome mode to actual evening mode. Kit wanted the stage colors changed for karaoke. Rae wanted the budget to recognize that good snacks remained good snacks regardless of historical era.

June said the Blue Comet had reinvented itself three times in one summer. Dez remembered the same jukebox in every version. "New sign. Same nigga hogging the buttons." June smiled proudly, taking this as evidence of continuity.

Nia revised the proposed ministries into temporary jobs with specific endings. Velvet became the person approving her own costume handling. Rosa retained catering authority because she'd already been doing it successfully.

I asked what I became. Shawna held up the jacket bag. "A husband who can put his old clothes away." My civilization entered a new era carrying its previous era over one arm.

Aiden's verdict. The changing-culture structure offers a distinctive historical strategy, with its management burden intact. Our summit's latest era has replaced ceremonial titles with jobs that end when their work does.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher listing supports combining cultures, fame and turn-based tactical battles. Pacing label applies to solo strategic decisions; complete holds, map controls and multiplayer configurations remain unchecked.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1124300/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P044 / A PLACE TO START

Into the Breach

Edition considered: PC Advanced Edition update

Solve small mech battles by reading enemy attacks in advance, finding a move that changes several threats through clever positioning.

What you do. Inspect the next announced attack, identify threatened squares, and move or act with a mech to change what will happen.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The small board still demands spatial reasoning and limited-action planning; selection controls need testing, and failure changes a run.

Why it might click. Small mech battles become visible tactical puzzles because enemy attacks are telegraphed before the next turn. The pleasure is finding an unexpected move that changes several threats at once, often by shifting positions rather than simply choosing the strongest attack.

The full catch. A compact board can still ask for demanding spatial reasoning. Protecting buildings, understanding attack direction and managing limited actions are central, and failure changes a run. The turn structure supports thought before acting; it does not prove every menu or selection gesture suits the player. Advanced Edition adds more systems.

Try this first. Try the opening guidance and inspect one announced enemy attack before choosing a move. Say which square is threatened and what one action changes; there is no need to solve the entire campaign to test that central pleasure.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P044 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Into the Breach

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Mech Has Moved the Dessert Table

Into the Breach showed attacks before they landed. I wished the hotel did that with invoices. Mika pointed out that the rental company had sent me six clear estimates.

“Nigga, those were telegraphed,” Tank said. “You ignored the telegram.”

Rosa needed a path from the kitchen. Remy's costume trunk occupied one square, Kit's lamp another, and my ceremonial chair occupied enough territory to govern itself.

Rae sketched the room on a napkin. One move: chair against the wall. Another: trunk beside the stage. Suddenly the dessert trolley could pass without threatening a crown or a kneecap.

Mika liked the rearrangement so much they added a tiny model chair to their miniature hotel. Kit objected that the real lamp's new angle improved Velvet's entrance more than hers. Velvet offered to trade the angle after her show.

I attempted to move my chair with dignity. Its wheels squeaked through the entire negotiation. Shawna followed carrying my abandoned sash. The giant machine in this battle was my fucking furniture.

Aiden's verdict. The visible tactical problems may appeal to careful planning, while the practical notes govern the trial. Our napkin battle succeeded by relocating one oversized chair instead of buying another solution.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher describes minimalistic turn-based combat with telegraphed attacks; current PC includes Advanced Edition content. Waits reflects tactical decision structure, not a complete no-hold/comfort certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/590380/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P045 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Wargroove

Edition considered: PC base game

Lead a displaced queen's bright fantasy campaign, using distinctive commanders and varied terrain to make positioning and resource choices matter.

What you do. Follow campaign instructions, select units on the map, and choose movement or attacks while managing funds and different army roles.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Army funds and unit matchups require learning; exact co-op coverage, timing settings, and selection gestures need their own check.

Why it might click. Wargroove gives turn-based army battles a bright fantasy cast and a campaign about a displaced queen seeking allies. Commanders have distinctive special abilities, while different units and terrain make each map a problem about positioning and resource choices.

The full catch. Managing an army, its funds and its unit matchups is more involved than moving one character. The editor and multiplayer add separate layers rather than simplifying the campaign. Co-op is listed, but exact campaign coverage and setup should be checked; no untimed or hold-free claim applies automatically to every configuration.

Try this first. Start with the campaign's opening instruction and command one unit through one explained action. Test the map selection interface and the clarity of the unit information before recruiting a large army or opening the editor.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P045 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wargroove

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Displaced Queen Has a Better Fanfare

Wargroove's displaced queen needed allies. Velvet needed the electrical socket beneath my ceremonial chair. I considered these parallel struggles and offered a formal alliance. She pointed. "Move your throne, nigga." Diplomacy was becoming terribly specific. Remy proposed a joint entrance with his fanfare leading into her number. Kit challenged the key. Mercedes tested the transition at the piano while the rest of us waited to discover whether monarchy could hear pitch. It actually worked. Remy looked delighted. Velvet adjusted one note, he adjusted his bow, and the alliance gained a musical border neither objected to. Rae moved the extension cable away from the signing table. Nia held it clear while she worked. I offered strategic commentary until Shawna asked me to be the infantry carrying the chair. We parked it against the wall. June sat in it instantly. "Better than the Blue Comet chairs." Dez asked whether she'd borrowed this one too. The queen had been restored, but the historic opposition retained its seat directly beside her.

Aiden's verdict. The fantasy campaign and commander personalities can make tactics appealing, with unit and interface demands retained. Our musical alliance found its socket by expelling the host's throne from useful territory.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact PC listing supports turn-based campaign, commander Grooves and native co-op categories. Co-op mode scope is not assumed to cover the whole main campaign; complete input demands are unchecked.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/607050/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P046 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Wargroove 2

Edition considered: PC base game

Return to colorful army tactics through linked campaigns, new commanders, and a conflict over forbidden technology in an expanding fantasy world.

What you do. Read a commander's ability, move units, and use battlefield actions while learning the revised Groove system through the initial campaign.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. New abilities add knowledge to army management; extra modes and listed co-op do not automatically simplify campaign play.

Why it might click. The sequel builds a new conflict around forbidden technology and several connected campaigns, with new commanders and a revised Groove system. Its attraction is returning to colorful map tactics with fresh factions, tactical possibilities and a continuing fantasy world.

The full catch. New commander abilities and linked campaigns add knowledge to the familiar army-management demands. The separate Conquest mode and editing tools are optional avenues, not recommended first steps here. Native co-op is listed, but campaign coverage, timing settings and comfortable selection controls need their own verification.

Try this first. Take the initial campaign instruction one action at a time and read one commander's ability carefully. Compare that single mechanic with ordinary movement before exploring extra modes or designing an ambitious custom scenario for everyone else.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P046 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wargroove 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Forbidden Technology Is a Jukebox with Bluetooth

Wargroove 2's forbidden technology led June to inspect the wireless music tablet with suspicion. She wanted her Blue Comet song queued. Dez wanted evidence that it would play only once.

I offered a password-protected accord. Mika said we could simply put the song in the set list. My treaty provisions were losing to buttons again.

Remy asked whether his revised fanfare counted as new technology. Velvet said it counted as a persistent condition. He played the opening anyway, softer, and she smiled before she could stop herself.

Kit wanted a clean transition into karaoke. Mercedes wrote the order on a card: song, number, break, karaoke. Four lines resolved a conflict I had planned to announce beneath a projection of crossed swords.

June approved until she saw her song appeared only once. Dez tapped the card. "Reparations begin with restraint, nigga."

I quietly deleted the crossed swords from the slideshow. Mika caught me, then admitted they looked excellent. We saved them for an optional photograph, where forbidden technology could harm only my dignity.

Aiden's verdict. The sequel adds factions and abilities to an already tactical structure; those additions still require learning. Our forbidden jukebox technology has been restrained by a four-line card and Dez's finger.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Current publisher listing supports three campaigns, revised Grooves, Conquest and native co-op. Waits refers to turn-based tactics, not an all-modes or hold-free guarantee.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1346020/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P047 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Advance Wars 1+2: Re-Boot Camp

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch compilation

Explore rebuilt Advance Wars campaigns where colorful commanding officers and land, sea, and air units turn terrain into a tactical puzzle.

What you do. Follow training, inspect a unit's information, and choose movement, capture, or attack decisions while managing different battlefield roles and funds.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Ranges, funds, and mission conditions still demand planning; versus multiplayer does not establish a shared campaign or comfortable controls.

Why it might click. This Switch collection rebuilds the first two Advance Wars campaigns around colorful land, sea and air battles. Commanding officers bring personalities and special powers, while terrain, capture decisions and different unit roles provide a board-game-like tactical focus.

The full catch. Bright presentation does not remove the need to compare ranges, terrain, funds and matchups. It is turn-based, but particular mission conditions can still create strategic urgency. Nintendo's listed multiplayer includes versus play; do not assume a shared campaign. Hold behavior and readability require a check on the actual display.

Try this first. Follow the early training and move one unit using its displayed information. Check whether the explanation makes its purpose clear before progressing to a larger force with several different roles to remember at once.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P047 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Advance Wars 1+2: Re-Boot Camp

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Land, Sea, and Air Budgets Are Mostly Snacks

Advance Wars gave me three branches for our imaginary ministries. Land would cover seating. Sea would cover drinks. Air would cover the chandelier rental. Nia waited until I finished admiring the symmetry.

“Where are the performers?” “Culture.” “You’ve invented a fourth ministry to avoid paying the first three correctly.”

Tank volunteered for Sea and immediately requested a water refill. Rae claimed Land long enough to reject the decorative chairs nobody could sit on. Kit asked whether Air included stage lighting or just my emotional atmosphere.

Mika drew three columns on a sheet and wrote actual costs beneath them. The chandeliers overwhelmed their branch before the first skirmish. I tried declaring emergency powers.

Shawna vetoed the phrase emergency powers. Velvet seconded her. Remy played a tiny defeat sound, then apologized to the sound for being too effective.

We abandoned the ministries and kept Mika’s cost columns. Nigga, my armed forces had dissolved into an ordinary budget, leaving the admiral holding two glasses of water and a very good sandwich.

Aiden’s verdict. The colorful tactical collection offers commanding personalities and varied battles, with planning and controls still to assess. Our three service branches have achieved hydration and surrendered their ceremonial titles.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo identifies the Switch remake collection and turn-based land/sea/air tactics, terrain and CO powers. Versus multiplayer is confirmed; native campaign co-op is not established. No complete no-hold guarantee.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/advance-wars-1-plus-2-re-boot-camp-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P048 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Fire Emblem: Three Houses

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game

Choose a house of characters to know over a long story, where relationships develop alongside tactical battles and a continent's political crisis.

What you do. Talk with the cast, manage lessons and equipment, explore the monastery, and command units through tactical battles in the chosen house's story.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Normal/Casual reduces losses, but schedules and menus remain heavy; monastery movement adds a separate camera-control question.

Why it might click. A teacher's relationship with students develops alongside tactical battles and a continent's political crisis. Choosing a house gives the long story a particular group to know, making friendships, loyalties and changing circumstances a substantial part of the experience.

The full catch. Normal difficulty with Casual mode revives fallen allies after battles, but it does not remove lessons, schedules, equipment or tactical menus. Monastery exploration adds three-dimensional movement and camera considerations. This is a rich character game with heavy management demands, not a simple visual novel because conversations are prominent.

Try this first. Choose Normal and Casual for the first trial, then assess one introductory battle explanation and one conversation. Test monastery movement separately when available; comfort with selecting a battle square does not answer the camera question.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P048 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Fire Emblem: Three Houses

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Three Houses and None of Them Owns the Extension Cord

Three Houses prompted me to divide the evening into noble houses. I gave Kit, Rae, and Velvet each a colored ribbon. Nia immediately asked which one she should wear.

“Whichever represents you.” “Several, Aiden.” “Then take several.” She did. My elegant taxonomy looked like a gift-wrapping accident within thirty seconds.

Remy wanted a crown on his ribbon. Mika wanted the colors to match the actual room map. Rosa asked whether the ribbons were washable because one had already landed in sauce.

Kit tied hers around a lamp so nobody borrowed it during rehearsal. Rae used hers to mark the repaired table leg. Velvet added hers to a costume where it looked intentional and expensive.

June said every house in 1967 had shared one extension cord. Dez corrected her: it belonged to Dez, and June had returned a lamp cord without a plug.

I removed the houses from the budget. Shawna kept one ribbon around my wrist. “So I can identify my wandering investment, nigga.”

Aiden’s verdict. The long character story has appeal alongside tactical battles, while schedules, menus, and hub controls remain substantial. Our noble houses immediately became ribbons serving more useful purposes than classification.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo confirms turn-based battles, academy exploration/calendar and Normal/Casual options. Casual removes permanent allied losses in battle, not other complexity. Whole-path hold/camera comfort remains untested.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/en-gb/Games/Nintendo-Switch-games/Fire-Emblem-Three-Houses-1175482.html>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P049 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Fire Emblem Engage

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game

Experiment with character and Emblem pairings in colorful tactical battles, discovering how different strengths change the options available on the grid.

What you do. Read unit matchups, select battle actions, and develop characters through weapons, rings, skills, and pairings with legendary Emblems as the campaign progresses.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Normal/Casual and other aids change punishment or support decisions; they do not establish low menu load or comfortable hub movement.

Why it might click. Engage emphasizes colorful tactical battles and the abilities gained by pairing characters with legendary Emblems. The appeal is experimenting with a cast's different strengths and seeing how a chosen pairing changes the possibilities on a grid-based battlefield.

The full catch. Weapon relationships, rings, skills and party development create many interlocking rules. Nintendo confirms Normal difficulty, Casual mode and Auto-Battle, plus a limited rewind system. Those aids change punishment or decision support; they do not prove low menu load or comfortable movement around the hub.

Try this first. Use Normal and Casual, read one unit's weapon matchup, and try its basic action before exploring every ring combination. Examine Auto-Battle as an optional tool only after seeing what it controls, keeping the choice to participate or delegate yours.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P049 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Fire Emblem Engage

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Emblem Is a Sticker on My Wallet

Fire Emblem Engage made Remy ask whether our imaginary ministries could pair with legendary patrons. I said everyone could benefit from my sponsorship. Velvet placed a glittering sticker on my wallet.

“There. Legendary funding.”

Kit paired with Mercedes for an entrance-music arrangement. Rae paired with the hotel technician to stop a second table wobbling. Nia paired with a glass of wine and explicitly declared herself off duty for ten minutes.

I asked who wanted the Aiden emblem. Tank raised his hand, took my wallet, and paid the delivery man for the extra good crackers. My power activated immediately and with alarming efficiency.

June wanted a commemorative sticker for surviving both Blue Comet wars. Dez wanted one for surviving June. Remy made both by hand and gave them matching crowns.

Shawna recovered my wallet before I could sponsor a commemorative sticker kiosk. She peeled the glitter from the leather and pressed it onto my jacket. “There, baby. You can feel powerful without opening anything.”

Aiden’s verdict. The character pairings give this tactical adventure a distinct attraction, with its systems and movement questions retained. My legendary emblem currently grants allies access to the cracker budget.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo supports grid tactics, Emblem pairings, Normal/Casual, Auto-Battle and limited rewind. No full-path hold/camera assurance or shared campaign is inferred; multiplayer scope remains unverified here.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/en-gb/Games/Nintendo-Switch-games/Fire-Emblem-Engage-2267157.html>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P050 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Mario + Rabbids Kingdom Battle

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game

Join Mario characters and Rabbids in comic tactical battles, where their different roles make cover, positioning, and coordinated attacks worth learning.

What you do. Follow a solo battle explanation, compare movement with an attack, and learn exploration, equipment, and abilities as the adventure continues.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Local co-op covers separate challenges, not the full campaign; navigation and controls need checking without assuming the sequel's accommodations.

Why it might click. Mario characters and Rabbids join forces in colorful tactical battles, with each hero contributing a different role. The mismatch between earnest adventure and Rabbid behavior offers a comic frame for learning positioning, cover and coordinated attacks.

The full catch. Combat takes turns, but exploration, equipment and abilities still require learning and navigation. Nintendo describes local co-op as additional challenges, not the entire story campaign. Do not infer the sequel's hold toggles or other accommodations for this first game; exact gesture and camera comfort need checking.

Try this first. Follow an early solo battle explanation and compare one movement option with one attack. If playing together is the main attraction, inspect the separate co-op challenges and their requirements rather than promising shared control of the whole campaign.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P050 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Mario + Rabbids Kingdom Battle

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Rabbids Have Applied for Cabinet Positions

Mario and the Rabbids formed an unlikely tactical team. Our summit's unlikely team was Kit and Tank, who wanted the same stage platform for completely different reasons.

Kit wanted height for karaoke. Tank wanted to see whether the buffet had been replenished without standing. "Strategic awareness," he said. Nigga had studied my vocabulary too well.

Rae inspected the platform and found it sturdy. Mika pointed out that moving it now would delay Velvet's rehearsal. A compromise formed: Kit could use it later, Tank could use his legs immediately.

Tank objected to the burden placed on the Ministry of Appetite. Rosa held up a fresh tray. The minister crossed the room at impressive speed.

Remy climbed onto the platform and tried a heroic pose. His crown tilted into one eye. Velvet straightened it, kissed his cheek, and asked him to stop dying before the opening number.

I proposed making them co-chairs. Shawna said we already had too many chairs and the next title would incur a storage fee.

Aiden's verdict. The mismatched cast gives the tactics a comic frame; the separate co-op challenges are not the campaign. Our unlikely coalition has resolved its platform dispute through the attraction of hot food.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo confirms turn-based combat and separate local co-op challenges. Co-op flag is restricted to those challenges; no whole-campaign co-op or Sparks of Hope control options are transferred.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/mario-plus-rabbids-kingdom-battle-switch/>

Source 2: <https://play.nintendo.com/news-tips/game-releases/mario-rabbids-kingdom-battle-release-date/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Both Sides of the Paper and Who Gets Paid to Hold It

Nia unfolded the old Blue Comet invoice during the break. June pointed at the front. “My signature. The other party refused.” Dez turned it over. “My signature. The other party refused.” Nobody spoke for three beautiful seconds. Then Tank put his face in his hands.

“Niggas. Turn the fucking paper over.”

They had each spent fifty-nine years looking at the surface that supported their argument. June had signed the hall charge. Dez had signed the peace terms on the reverse. Both signatures were there, along with alternating jukebox selections, return of June's jacket before winter, and two ginger ales that had survived every retelling by remaining unmentioned.

I reached for my phone to photograph the breakthrough. Shawna said I could ask first. Both veterans agreed, provided I kept the picture out of any slideshow containing my face. Apparently they'd read the conditions of my hospitality more carefully than their own peace agreement.

June studied the jacket clause. Dez studied the ginger ales. Each had located a different obstacle to victory. Remy offered a two-sided fanfare. Velvet put a hand over his keyboard. “Let these women experience the silence, baby. They paid fifty-nine years for it.”

The present-day hotel invoice waited beside the historical one. Kit had found a duplicate lamp charge. Rae had found a labor line that assumed she'd remain available to repair furniture all evening. Nia had found herself listed as legal support through midnight. None of those entries had been agreed with the people whose time they described.

I said the hotel must have misunderstood. Rae turned the page toward me. The note read PER HOST REQUEST. My handwriting, for once, was entirely legible.

“Nigga, you can't call my hands a resource before you ask whether they're free.”

I began explaining that I'd meant available in case something went wrong. “Something already went wrong,” she said. “You spent my evening.” Her voice was sharper than it had been over the crackers, and it should have been. This wasn't a preference about olives. I had given somebody else a claim on her time because she had been helpful in front of me.

Kit said she could take some of the work. Rae shook her head. “The work isn't yours to redistribute either. Start with the assumption that I came to play.”

I saw Nia close her folder. She'd been trying to do that for twenty minutes. I had interpreted each new useful answer as an invitation to produce another question. A free lawyer was becoming one of my favorite features of the room, which was an ugly way to think about a woman who had come partly because she liked the mechanic sitting beside her.

I crossed out both assignments. The correction didn't make the earlier presumption clever. Nia kept the folder closed and said she would join the rest of the conversation as a person, which I considered a remarkably modest demand under the circumstances.

The sponsor approached before we could enjoy our breakthrough. He wanted a photograph with the coalition's respectable leadership before the performers changed into their show clothes. He

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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nodded toward Kit and me, then looked at Velvet's headpiece as though it might damage his insurance.

Kit asked what he meant by respectable. He said polished, professional, welcoming to everyone. Velvet lifted her payment schedule. "I'm a professional. Welcoming everyone is already in the room. Which part of my head costs you customers?"

The man laughed because he wanted it to be a joke. It wasn't only a joke. Remy stood beside her in ordinary clothes, crown in hand, waiting to learn which version of him the sponsor considered sellable. Nobody at the table had volunteered to become the decorative proof that money could get along with difference if difference selected a quieter outfit.

I offered to take the photograph later. Shawna looked at me. "Later with whom?" I had tried delaying the choice without changing it. My skill at mediation often consisted of moving a bad sentence ten minutes into the future and hoping nobody followed.

The sponsor left to take a call. Kit exhaled. "I could do the picture and insist the show stays exactly as planned. It might keep the money uncomplicated."

Rae looked at her. "Uncomplicated for whom?"

Kit was tired of that question, which didn't make it the wrong one. "For the people getting paid. Sometimes I've kept a library event alive by letting a donor feel like the room looked familiar. I'm not proud of every conversation. I also don't want the performers losing a fee because I chose the cleanest speech."

Kit looked at me before continuing. "And don't decide the person who can write a check is the bravest one here. My library hours got cut. I can't replace a lost fee out of my account. That affects what risks feel available." I had been preparing a generous expression; it became uncomfortable on my face. Rae nodded. "I believe you. It still matters whose face the sponsor chose for professional." Kit said yes, both things mattered. Neither sentence paid the fee. We still had to find the money, and my advantages were about to become useful only if I stopped treating them as a superior moral personality.

Velvet nodded once. "That's a real problem. Here's my real answer: ask me before you purchase my survival with a smaller version of me." She wasn't rejecting every negotiation. She wanted the person whose work was being negotiated to exist inside it. "I can choose an outfit for a client. I can also say the client's request costs more than the booking's worth. Don't make that choice and hand me the money like you rescued me."

Remy said the sponsor had called his act surprisingly tasteful. "I know what he meant. I also know my act contains a pun about a royal accountant getting double-entry heartbreak. Tasteful wasn't a review. It was relief."

Velvet laughed despite herself. "That joke is so fucking bad." "And yet it belongs to me." He put his crown on, crooked again. She left it crooked for once.

Rae described the hotel entrance earlier: Kit received a question about lighting, Rae received directions for contractors. Kit had initially explained the difference away because she hadn't wanted the room to become unpleasant before the party started. "I made the pleasant version

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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more important than the thing you said happened,” Kit said now. Rae nodded. She didn't make Kit perform an apology twice just to prolong the advantage.

June leaned forward. “Money doesn't ask all of us to become respectable in the same way. But don't use that sentence to tell me I've never wanted a nice suit or a calm evening. I like both. This suit is beautiful.” Dez touched her sleeve. “It is. And this time it's actually on its owner.”

June let the laugh settle. “I've swallowed things at work to keep wages coming. I've also said no and worried afterward. I don't need my younger self put on trial by people who got to read the ending before deciding what she'd do.” She looked at me. “Your room needs choices. It doesn't need a purity competition sponsored by your wallet.”

I had been quietly imagining myself funding a perfect space where none of this occurred. That fantasy flattered the payer. It also made every complication somebody else's failure to appreciate the gift. I could rent chairs. I could pay staff. I couldn't make a Black woman's account of what happened at the door unnecessary just by paying for a nicer door.

Nia asked whether we could keep two questions visible: what immediate arrangement a person chose, and what conditions made the choice expensive. “I don't want my own compromises used to tell the next person they're obligated to make them. I also don't want a room full of spectators grading whether I resisted attractively enough.” Then she opened her hands. “That's my contribution. Somebody else can type it if they want it remembered.”

Mika typed. They also admitted they'd nearly accepted the sponsor's photograph request because they wanted the event to start and the room to look successful. “A beautiful room can photograph a problem out of existence,” they said. “I'm very good at that. I'd like to be good at knowing when I'm doing it.”

Kit asked about putting the cost somewhere visible. What would it take to keep the promised fees independent of the sponsor's flattering photograph? This time she asked Velvet first. Velvet named the amount already contracted, not a moral price. Rosa named the staffing balance. The hotel manager confirmed which duplicate and unopened rentals could be refunded. Numbers replaced the vague threat that honesty would bankrupt the evening.

Darnell arrived asking whether his party supplies qualified as entertainment expense. Tank glanced at the bag he'd been carrying. “Your cocaine is not a coalition department, nigga.” Darnell took it away and returned with a plate, where his contribution could remain the size of his appetite. We did not need his procurement story to understand the difference between an agreed fee and a personal decision.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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I covered the contracted shortfall, approved the refunds, and told the sponsor the photograph would include whoever independently wanted to be in it. Nobody owed a performance of gratitude. He could choose whether he wanted the photograph on those terms. The room did not instantly become just. It became a room where one particular leverage attempt had failed without its target losing her fee.

Kit kept the duplicate-charge note. Rae kept her evening. Nia stayed seated instead of reopening the folder. June and Dez requested copies of both sides of their invoice and agreed to split the ancient ginger-ale debt symbolically over dinner. No interest. No tribunal. No commemorative eagle.

I offered the eagle at a discount. Shawna kissed my cheek, took my pencil, and said, “The survivors have suffered enough.” Then she asked me to dance later as her husband, without representing any ministry. Nigga, I accepted before somebody could turn the offer into a job description.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P051 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Mario + Rabbids Sparks of Hope

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game

Travel between imaginative planets with Mario and the Rabbids, combining heroes with Sparks while their antics give each new place comic appeal.

What you do. Explore with direct movement, inspect control options, and choose hero abilities or battle actions while learning how movement-based techniques work.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Useful control options exist, but camera, direct movement, and traversal still need testing; the first game's co-op does not transfer.

Why it might click. Mario and the Rabbids travel between imaginative planets, meeting odd characters and combining heroes with helpful Sparks. Tactical battles sit inside a larger exploratory adventure, with the cast's antics providing a light comic reason to see what the next place contains.

The full catch. Ubisoft documents specific hold toggles, single-press alternatives, camera adjustments, automatic skill management and invulnerability. These are real options, not proof of a wholly no-rush path: direct movement, camera handling and airborne or traversal actions need checking. The first game's co-op challenges do not establish co-op here.

Try this first. Inspect those control options before play, then test ordinary movement and a first battle at the preferred difficulty. Check how a team jump or other moving action feels when introduced; stop there if the practical demands outweigh the appeal.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P051 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Mario + Rabbids Sparks of Hope

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Planet of Unpaid Balloons

Sparks of Hope sent its cast between imaginative planets. I had ordered three balloon planets to float over our budget table, each labeled with a proposed fund. The largest was HOST'S DISCRETION.

Rae turned it around. "This nigga gave himself Jupiter." Nia laughed so suddenly her wine nearly joined the solar system.

Mika loved the planets and refused to let me claim their defense as support for the labels. They peeled off HOST'S DISCRETION and replaced it with an actual estimate of the remaining room charge.

The label barely fit. Kit requested a smaller planet for stage lighting. Velvet asked whether her fee had become a moon because she preferred money that didn't orbit somebody else's priorities.

Remy found a marker and drew a crown on the nearest tiny satellite. June and Dez argued about who had discovered the planet of borrowed jackets first.

Shawna cut the string to my enormous balloon and handed it to me. "Hold your discretionary spending." Nigga, I spent the entire discussion physically attached to a bad decision.

Aiden's verdict. The colorful planetary journey has comic appeal, with movement, camera, and update details still important. Our budget's largest planet is currently tethered to the man who named it after himself.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer UX interview documents listed options and time to think during turns; publisher article confirms direct real-time movement. These do not verify every traversal sequence. Single-player sequel assessed separately from Kingdom Battle.

Source 1:

<https://news.ubisoft.com/en-gb/article/3geL8lbYETmgHk6W017HpS/mario-rabbids-sparks-of-hope-accessibility-spotlight>

Source 2: <https://news.ubisoft.com/en-us/article/65J7B5ga4HkMpXtYWQ7QX5>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P052 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

XCOM: Enemy Unknown

Edition considered: PC base game; not Enemy Within expansion

Build Earth's defense against an alien invasion, growing attached to soldiers whose battlefield decisions connect to research, equipment, and headquarters planning.

What you do. Move soldiers into cover, choose explained combat actions, and manage research, budgets, equipment, and base decisions between ground missions.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Multiple soldiers and base systems add weight; casualties create pressure, and complete interception or held-input behavior is not audited.

Why it might click. Lead a defense organization against an alien invasion, growing attached to soldiers while choosing research, equipment and battlefield tactics. The appeal is the connection between a strategic headquarters and the small, consequential decisions made by a squad on the ground.

The full catch. Turn-based ground combat still involves cover, ranges, hit chances and multiple soldiers. Research, budgets and base decisions add another layer, while casualties and global threats create pressure. This card is Enemy Unknown without assuming Enemy Within additions; complete interception, timing and held-input behavior has not been audited.

Try this first. Use the opening tutorial and focus on one soldier's move into cover and one explained action. Assess whether the battlefield information feels interesting before treating the larger base-management system as part of an evening's commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P052 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

XCOM: Enemy Unknown

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Alien Invasion Has a Delivery Window

XCOM's headquarters needed research, equipment, and people ready for a crisis. Our headquarters received a delivery marked EXTRATERRESTRIAL WELCOME EFFECT. I asked the driver whether he had the correct room.

He showed me my signature. Tank said, “Nigga, the aliens know who summoned them.”

Inside were silver inflatable creatures intended for the entrance. Kit wanted one behind the karaoke stage. Mika wanted all three above the registration desk. Rae wanted to know whether either improvement was worth the charge.

Nia asked which items could still be returned. The driver pointed to the unopened boxes. Everyone looked at the creature I had already inflated halfway while pretending to investigate it.

Shawna let the air out. The alien collapsed slowly against my chest, an intimate portrait of fiscal surrender. Velvet photographed only after asking, and I agreed because it was admittedly excellent.

We kept one for the show and returned two. The invasion was contained. Its surviving diplomat received a feather boa and a supporting role, neither authorized by its home planet.

Aiden's verdict. The connection between headquarters and soldiers can create compelling stakes, with broad management demands retained. Our alien emergency was resolved through unopened packaging and one surprisingly employable silver visitor.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Base-game listing supports turn-based squad combat, base/research management and interceptions. Pacing is mixed because the full strategic/interception loop is not certified wholly untimed. No expansion feature is assumed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/200510/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P053 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

XCOM 2

Edition considered: PC base game; not War of the Chosen expansion

Lead a resistance under alien occupation, developing soldiers whose ambushes, successes, and losses become the history of a mobile organization.

What you do. Inspect cover and movement boundaries, choose soldiers' actions, and manage the base, skills, and mission objectives across the resistance campaign.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Turn limits create urgency; camera operations, held-Control waypoint paths, and permanent casualties add demands in the base game.

Why it might click. The sequel turns Earth's defenders into an insurgent force, building a mobile organization and conducting tactical missions under alien occupation. Ambushes, soldier development and the changing campaign give each squad's successes and losses a continuing personal history.

The full catch. Turn limits create strategic urgency without requiring a fast mouse click. The manual also describes many action controls, camera operations and a held Control-key gesture for waypoint paths. Base management, skill trees and permanent casualties add weight. This is the base game; expansion options for changing timers are not assumed.

Try this first. Leave the tutorial enabled and inspect one soldier's movement boundary and cover information. Read a turn-limited objective literally when it appears, then decide whether pressure measured in decisions is acceptable even when the decision itself can be considered.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P053 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

XCOM 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Resistance Has Occupied the Photo Booth

XCOM 2's resistance put ideas into Porsche's head. She and Mercedes took over the sponsor photo booth after its operator insisted every photograph needed his bottle in the foreground.

"He bought the backdrop," I said. "He didn't buy my face," Mercedes said.

Velvet joined them with the surviving inflatable alien. Remy supplied a crown. The booth rapidly produced a series of excellent pictures in which the sponsor's product appeared nowhere except accidentally beneath a chair.

I approached as mediator. Porsche handed me a plain backdrop cloth and asked me to hold one corner. The resistance had conscripted its supposedly neutral observer.

Kit adjusted the light. Rae took Nia's picture, then let Nia take hers. Neither called it anything more significant than a photograph, which was why I was absolutely forbidden to provide commentary.

The sponsor accepted the alternate setup after Velvet offered a separately priced product shot. Nigga, the occupation ended through commercial negotiation, while I remained holding the cloth because everyone liked the angle.

Aiden's verdict. The insurgent campaign has strong squad appeal, but turn limits and other demands preserve its detour warning. Our photo-booth resistance won a plain backdrop and a voluntary advertising rate.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher supports base-game premise; official port manual documents turn-based actions, turn timers, casualties and held Control for waypoint movement. Waits concerns tactical decisions, not absence of turn pressure. No War of the Chosen options transferred.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/268500/>

Source 2: <https://www.feralinteractive.com/en/manuals/xcom2/latest/steam/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P054 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Invisible, Inc.

Edition considered: PC base game

Plan corporate infiltrations where different agents and equipment make one well-chosen action open an unexpected path through security toward a valuable escape.

What you do. Inspect guards and sight lines, use agent abilities or hacking resources, and plan an extraction while choosing actions across successive turns.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The alarm rises each turn, so thinking time does not remove pressure; abilities and extraction plans require substantial tracking.

Why it might click. Corporate espionage becomes a tactical puzzle about agents, security systems and getting out with something valuable. Different operatives and equipment combinations let a plan feel clever when a small, well-chosen action opens an unexpected route through trouble.

The full catch. The designer describes an alarm that rises at the end of each turn. Thinking time is available, but escalating consequences can still feel urgent. Agent abilities, hacking resources, sight lines and extraction plans create heavy demands. Custom modes exist, yet a specific no-pressure configuration has not been established here.

Try this first. Try the introductory mission and inspect a guard's attention and one available agent action. Watch what changes when the turn ends, then judge the alarm's emotional effect rather than deciding solely from the absence of a seconds countdown.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P054 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Invisible, Inc.

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Corporate Spy Wants the Dessert Password

Invisible, Inc.'s corporate espionage made me suspicious of a locked catering cart. Rosa told me it contained dessert and would open when dessert was supposed to open.

Tank studied the latch. "Any agents available?" Rae pointed at the schedule. "Your extraction window's in twenty minutes."

I offered to negotiate early access for senior leadership. Shawna asked whether leadership intended to eat dinner first. I said this was reconnaissance. She removed the dessert fork from my hand with considerable expertise.

Nia and Kit were discussing the actual security deposit. Kit wanted the hotel to acknowledge the condition of its lamps before anyone moved them. Nia approved the idea and asked Porsche to photograph the equipment.

While we handled useful corporate intelligence, Tank asked Rosa directly whether there were extra strawberries in the kitchen. There were. She brought him a bowl because it didn't disturb service.

Nigga completed the mission by knowing a person's name and asking a normal question. I was still explaining my stealth plan to a woman married to it.

Aiden's verdict. The espionage planning can feel clever, while rising alarms still create pressure. Our dessert operation succeeded through a polite request, leaving my elaborate infiltration plan without an employment opportunity.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher supports stealth systems/custom modes; first-person designer article explains alarm advancement per turn. No particular alarm-removal setting or full input accommodation is inferred.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/243970/>

Source 2: <https://www.gamedeveloper.com/design/game-design-deep-dive-alarm-systems-in-klei-s-i-invisible-inc-i->

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P055 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Shadowrun Returns

Edition considered: PC original release

Follow a murder investigation through Seattle's mix of magic, cybernetics, and corporate power, with a team whose different abilities support the job.

What you do. Read conversations, choose a starting archetype, and direct team actions in tactical battles while managing attributes, equipment, spells, and other abilities.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Reading and character systems are substantial; turn-based fights do not certify every mission demand or held gesture on the full path.

Why it might click. A murder investigation moves through a Seattle where cybernetics, magic and corporate power collide. The story offers an adult genre mixture, while turn-based team combat lets different kinds of characters contribute practical abilities to the same job.

The full catch. Character creation, attributes, equipment, spells and tactical positioning are substantial systems. The game also relies on considerable reading, so a mystery-led premise does not make it a simple detective interface. Turn-based fights allow consideration, but the complete mission path and every held gesture have not been independently tested.

Try this first. Pick one clear starting archetype and follow the first conversation before studying every possible build. In the first instructed battle, learn one basic action and one support option rather than trying to master magic, drones and hacking together.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

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P055 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Shadowrun Returns

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Mage Has Read the Catering Contract

Shadowrun Returns mixed magic and corporate trouble. I suggested our financial committee needed a mage. Nia asked whether a mage could make my personal purchases stop appearing under SHARED EXPENSES.

“That's advanced magic,” Tank said. “Nigga's been practicing for years.”

Rae found the charge for monogrammed tool rolls. I had bought them to honor her table repair. She stared at the initials. They were mine.

“It's a summit gift.” “Then why does it say AIDEN?” “Brand continuity.”

Velvet took one look and offered to use a roll for makeup brushes if I stopped calling it a diplomatic gesture. Remy wanted another for cables. Actual people found useful purposes while the corporation's founder struggled with its reputation.

Shawna drew a line through SHARED and wrote PERSONAL beneath the charge. Nia approved the classification without billing us for sorcery. Rae kept the plain tool roll she'd brought from home, tightened one final screw, and left my branding on the table where it belonged.

Aiden's verdict. The murder mystery's magic-and-technology mixture may reward learning its tactical systems. Our corporate enchantment broke when Shawna changed one expense label and nobody mistook my initials for generosity.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher describes Seattle murder investigation, classless development and single-player turn-based tactical RPG. Waits refers to combat decisions; no complete no-hold or low-complexity certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/234650/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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P056 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Shadowrun: Dragonfall - Director's Cut

Edition considered: PC Director's Cut

Meet a Berlin crew with distinct histories and difficult loyalties, where relationships offer a substantial reward for learning Shadowrun's tactical systems.

What you do. Talk with the team, follow the first job, and choose tactical actions using character roles, equipment, and abilities across the campaign.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. This remains a reading-heavy tactical RPG; redesigned menus do not establish simplicity or settle every late mission's input demands.

Why it might click. Dragonfall brings Shadowrun's magic-and-technology world to Berlin and centers a crew with distinct personalities and histories. The Director's Cut expands the campaign and team material, making relationships and difficult loyalties a substantial reward for learning its tactical systems.

The full catch. This remains a reading-heavy tactical RPG with character builds, equipment and team abilities. Its redesigned interface is not evidence that menus are few or self-explanatory. The standalone Director's Cut differs from the earlier expansion; complete timing, held gestures and late mission demands have not been verified here.

Try this first. Meet the initial team and try a small portion of its first job, focusing on one character's role. Decide whether the conversations make you want to know these people before planning an optimized build or committing to every side mission.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P056 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Shadowrun: Dragonfall - Director's Cut

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Crew Has Conditions for Taking My Job

Dragonfall's crew had histories and loyalties. I recruited our own crew for a dangerous mission: persuade the hotel to refund the duplicate chair delivery. Everybody wanted to know the terms. Rae wanted me present so I couldn't summarize the conversation afterward. Nia wanted a time limit on how long she'd spend helping. Kit wanted the promised lamp left untouched during the expedition. Tank wanted food. Velvet wanted us back before her rehearsal. Remy wanted to perform his fanfare when we succeeded. We had not yet approached the manager and already possessed six competing victory conditions.

Shawna assembled the relevant receipts. She handed them to me, then made me read the first sentence of my own cancellation request aloud. It contained an apology and no mention of destiny. The manager refunded the unopened chairs minus the stated fee. Rae accepted the result. Nia reclaimed her evening. Remy played two tasteful seconds before remembering his promise to be ridiculous and adding three gloriously unnecessary more.

Nigga, the crew had earned its ending. I had earned a smaller bill.

Aiden's verdict. The developed crew gives this campaign a strong personal draw, while its tactical and reading load remains. Our refund mission succeeded because every participant knew exactly what they wanted from it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected exact Director's Cut page confirms standalone identity, Berlin, expanded missions/team material and revised combat/interface. No all-path timing/hold guarantee; mature themes include explicit violence and difficult backstories.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/300550/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P057 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Shadowrun: Hong Kong - Extended Edition

Edition considered: PC Extended Edition

Explore a dense Hong Kong urban-fantasy setting with a developed crew and corporate intrigue, plus an additional campaign in the Extended Edition.

What you do. Read crew conversations, manage characters and inventory, and alternate tactical team encounters with the game's separate Matrix interactions during the campaign.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Matrix stealth and timed code or symbol elements prevent assuming the whole game waits; a comfortable complete route is unverified.

Why it might click. The third standalone Shadowrun adventure offers a dense urban fantasy setting, a developed crew and corporate intrigue in Hong Kong. Its Extended Edition includes the later bonus campaign, giving players who enjoy the characters more story beyond the original ending.

The full catch. Do not treat the whole game as unhurried because combat takes turns. Its Matrix has stealth and timed code/symbol-matching elements reported in gameplay documentation. A comfortable way through all required instances has not been verified. Text, character builds and inventory management are also heavy; this is a deliberate story-focused detour.

Try this first. Assess an early crew conversation and the character interface, then investigate the Matrix requirements before committing to the campaign. If someone offers help, agree which operations they would handle instead of quietly assuming every later obstacle will disappear.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P057 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Shadowrun: Hong Kong - Extended Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Matrix Password Is Under the Ice Bucket

Shadowrun's Hong Kong crew faced a dense world of intrigue. Our immediate intrigue concerned the sponsor's tablet, which contained the itemized charges and refused to open without a code.

I announced we would need a hacker. Mika lifted the ice bucket. The code was on a card beneath it. “We need a dry card.”

Nia read the charges while Rae held a napkin against the wet corner. Velvet found a proposed fee for using her stage name in a sponsor slideshow. She asked who had decided that was a benefit to her.

The sponsor called it promotional synergy. Remy made a sad little keyboard noise. Mercedes asked him to repeat it under the phrase, which improved the presentation enormously.

We removed the unapproved slide. Velvet offered a separate rate if the sponsor wanted her involvement. He declined, and everybody survived the absence of synergy.

I tried locking the tablet dramatically at the end. It played a cheerful confirmation sound. Nigga, our cyberpunk operation concluded like somebody successfully setting a kitchen timer.

Aiden’s verdict. The crew and urban-fantasy setting are appealing, but Matrix timing elements keep the no-rush limitation real. Our smaller intrusion required a napkin and locating the code somebody had already supplied.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Extended Edition publisher page confirms revised Matrix and bonus campaign. Community gameplay documentation describes timed Matrix minigames; full-path alternatives are unverified, so no untimed completion is promised.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/346940/>

Source 2: <https://shadowrun-series.fandom.com/wiki/Matrix>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P058 / A PLACE TO START

Wildermyth

Edition considered: PC base game

Watch ordinary heroes acquire relationships, transformations, and lasting histories, creating a tactical adventure partly discovered through the consequences of your choices.

What you do. Meet the heroes, choose event responses, and direct battle actions while developing abilities and relationships; shared play can divide hero control.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Evolving characters and tactics require attention; injury and aging matter, and co-op still needs agreement about controls and decisions.

Why it might click. A band of initially ordinary heroes develops through tactical adventures, personal events and relationships. Characters can transform and carry their histories forward, giving the player a story that feels partly discovered through consequences rather than entirely delivered by a fixed cast.

The full catch. Tactical positioning, abilities, event choices and evolving characters all require attention. Injury, sacrifice and aging are part of the story. Native cooperative play can divide hero control, but setup and shared decisions still need agreement; it is not automatic simplification. Every input and late sequence has not been audited.

Try this first. Begin an introductory campaign and meet the first heroes before judging their long-term builds. Try one event choice and one battle action. If sharing play, agree who controls which hero and whether advice is invited.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P058 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wildermyth

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hero Has Acquired an Unflattering Nickname

Wildermyth's ordinary people could develop extraordinary histories. Remy asked whether the summit would remember him as King Receipts the Glorious. Velvet said it depended on how many fanfares he attempted before dinner.

Tank nominated me as Aiden the Charged. June preferred Aiden of the Many Deposits. Dez said my legend needed fewer syllables and more shame.

I tried naming my own heroic transformation: the Unifier. Rae looked at the budget balloons. “The Inflator.” Nia laughed, then apologized without sounding sorry.

Kit wanted a better title too. She proposed Keeper of the Entrance Light. Mercedes granted it immediately, along with responsibility for remembering where she'd put her glasses. The hero checked her head before searching anywhere else.

Shawna leaned into me. “I like the man before his titles.” I whispered something suitably promising about his other talents. She smiled and reminded him of the evening's private appointment.

My legend improved. No proclamation followed. The Unifier had discovered that a quiet sentence could outperform a rented banner when addressed to the correct woman.

Aiden’s verdict. The evolving heroes and relationships can make this tactical story feel personal, with consequences and coordination still important. Our party has generated several legends, most of them less expensive than mine.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher supports evolving heroes, tactical battles, difficulty choices and cooperative campaign play with separately controlled heroes. Memory rating is editorial; co-op does not guarantee reduced burden or complete input comfort.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/763890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P059 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Wartales

Edition considered: PC base game

Build a medieval company's survival story through contracts, camp life, skills, and equipment, with native co-op offering a way to share it.

What you do. Inspect party and camp menus, choose contracts, manage supplies and equipment, and use professions alongside tactical battles and world exploration.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Some professions use timed minigames; avoiding them throughout a chosen route is unverified, and party management is extensive.

Why it might click. Lead a band through a harsh medieval world, choosing contracts and gradually shaping its camp, skills and equipment. The appeal is the practical, emergent story of a company surviving together rather than fulfilling a single hero's destiny; native co-op can share that company.

The full catch. Food, money, gear, professions and tactical battles create extensive management. Some profession activities use timing-based minigames, so turn-based combat does not mean a completely untimed game. A whole-route way around those activities is unverified. Exploration and party maintenance add further demands; this is a marked detour.

Try this first. Inspect an opening party and camp menu before pursuing contracts. Check the specific profession interactions a chosen plan would need, and only then consider a short shared outing with clear agreement about who handles each operation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P059 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wartales

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Mercenary Company Has a Snack Clause

Wartales' working company made Rosa examine our catering agreement like a mercenary captain. She wanted clear hours, sufficient staff, and nobody treating the kitchen as a magical room that generated plates.

I said I respected the craft. She pointed at the overtime request. "Then respect it numerically."

Rae backed her, partly on principle and partly because the replacement crackers had transformed her opinion of the summit. Kit wanted the staff to have a break before her karaoke turn so they could enjoy themselves if they wished.

Nia drafted one clean payment line. Her handwriting looked like a decorative threat. Mika typed it while she read aloud, preserving the actual words and mercifully abandoning the penmanship.

Darnell approached with a vague proposal involving a yacht chef. Rosa asked for a name and a rate. He had neither. Tank escorted his nigga toward a plate before the proposal developed further.

We funded the staff hours. The company secured its contract, and I gained no heroic title beyond the name already printed on my card.

Aiden's verdict. The company's emergent journey has appeal, while timed professions and extensive management remain genuine catches. Our catering captain obtained clear terms, paid time, and freedom from Darnell's imaginary yacht kitchen.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher confirms open-world company management, turn-based combat and up-to-four-player co-op. Gamepressure's profession guide describes timing minigames. Their complete avoidability has not been established.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1527950/>

Source 2: <https://www.gamepressure.com/newsroom/professions-in-wartales-explained-list-and-description/zd543a>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
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P060 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Battle Brothers

Edition considered: PC base game

Lead a mercenary company through a harsh, unscripted world where recruitment, contracts, equipment, and battlefield outcomes create a history you can recognize.

What you do. Inspect recruits and gear, read contracts, travel across the world, and direct turn-based battles while paying wages and managing injuries.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. World travel is real-time while battles use turns; pause behavior needs checking, and harsh consequences accompany extensive management.

Why it might click. A mercenary company develops its own history through recruits, contracts, equipment and battles in a changing world. The appeal is a tough, unscripted campaign where decisions leave marks and a modest success can feel earned because failure remains possible.

The full catch. The publisher explicitly separates real-time world travel from turn-based battles. Roster management, wages, equipment, injuries and risk assessment are substantial. Harsh consequences can produce pressure even when battle decisions wait. Pause behavior during travel and every held-input requirement need checking; this is not a low-management fantasy adventure.

Try this first. Inspect a starting company's people and equipment, then read one contract's terms before accepting anything. Test travel controls and pausing deliberately. If the administrative burden already dominates the fun, another entry deserves the evening instead.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P060 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Battle Brothers

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Brothers Demand a Contract Before the Toast

Battle Brothers' mercenary company attracted June. "Everybody signs before anybody carries anything," she said. Dez raised an eyebrow. "Look at the Blue Comet discovering contracts."

June and Dez inspected their two-sided copies of the 1967 agreement. Both signatures were undeniable now. June insisted signatures only mattered if promises were kept. Dez inspected the alternating-song clause and suggested June had spent fifty-nine years negotiating with the fucking jukebox.

I offered a toast to old alliances. Velvet asked whether the current deposit had cleared. Nia checked the confirmation. It hadn't. The toast waited while I found the correct message on my phone.

Rae and Kit compared the actual staffing numbers. Remy brought Velvet water because she had stopped talking and that worried him more than her talking ever did.

The confirmation arrived. Velvet relaxed, thanked him, and accepted the glass. June raised hers. Dez raised hers too, without conceding the jacket claim.

Nigga, we had an alliance with conditions, which looked a lot like an ordinary agreement between people intending to remain friends after the evening cost money.

Aiden's verdict. The unscripted company history can be compelling, with harsh consequences and real-time travel carefully noted. Our alliance has postponed its toast until the payment confirmation becomes more than a hopeful promise.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher describes real-time travel, turn-based combat and mercenary contract/equipment management. Travel pause/hold details are not established here; strategic pressure is an editorial warning, not a seconds-timer claim.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/365360/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P061 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

BATTLETECH

Edition considered: PC base game

Command giant combat machines in a mercenary company where personalities, damage, and tactical outcomes continue to matter after the battle ends.

What you do. Inspect a machine's movement and weapons, make battlefield choices, and manage loadouts, repairs, contracts, and the company's equipment between engagements.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Technical menus and economic consequences are substantial; listed competitive multiplayer does not establish a cooperative story campaign.

Why it might click. Command enormous combat machines while managing the mercenary company behind them. The attraction is the connection between personalities, damaged equipment and tactical decisions: a battle's outcome follows the crew back to a traveling base rather than vanishing at a results screen.

The full catch. Weapon loadouts, heat, armor, positioning, repairs and contracts create substantial technical and menu demands. Battles take turns, yet long engagements and economic consequences can still feel taxing. The publisher lists competitive multiplayer and solo skirmishes; do not infer cooperative campaign play from sharing a screen or discussing tactics.

Try this first. Try the opening instruction or a solo skirmish and inspect one machine's movement and weapon choices. Before accepting a company-wide campaign, decide whether reading its equipment information is an enjoyable part of the experience or simply too much administration.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P061 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

BATTLETECH

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Battle Machine Has a Dry-Cleaning Bill

BATTLETECH's enormous machines made my mechanical photo throne look almost restrained. I said so. Rae crouched beside its bent footrest and asked whether restraint included the repair charge. "It came like that." Shawna found the photograph of me standing on it. "It came considerably flatter." Mika loved the chair's ridiculous silhouette. They suggested using it motionless in a corner for photographs. The hotel technician disconnected the troublesome mechanism, leaving a perfectly decent seat inside an absurd shell.

Remy climbed in and looked magnificent until his crown caught the top edge. Velvet removed the crown, sat on the broad arm, and told the photographer to proceed. Two professionals salvaged the machine through superior positioning.

I asked for a solo picture. Tank sat in my lap before the camera flashed. "Crew portrait, nigga." The photograph contained two grown men, one enormous chair, and my expression discovering new dimensions of regret.

Rae taped a note over the control: OFF. Nia added the repair estimate to my personal column. Our mercenary machine had returned from battle with an itemized history.

Aiden's verdict. The connection between machines, crew, and company finances can be absorbing, with technical systems still substantial. Our damaged throne has retired into portrait work and left its commander holding the repair bill.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher supports turn-based mech combat, contracts, repairs, company management and solo skirmish/PvP modes. Complete held/camera interactions are not tested; no native co-op inferred.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/637090/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P062 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

TRIANGLE STRATEGY

Edition considered: PC release

Explore political conflict where allies vote on major choices, making persuasion, scarce resources, and competing principles matter alongside tactical battles.

What you do. Read conversations, consider political choices, and direct units through positional battles while learning their abilities at a comfortable difficulty.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed input and adjustable difficulty support pacing, but dialogue, political names, tactics, and menus still demand substantial attention.

Why it might click. Political conflict, scarce resources and competing principles shape a story in which allies can vote on major choices. Tactical battles and conversations both matter, making the central attraction the tension between personal conviction, persuasion and the needs of a group.

The full catch. The PC listing declares play without timed input, adjustable difficulty and saving at any time. Those features help pacing but do not shrink the dialogue, political names, unit abilities or positional tactics. Expect a heavy reading and menu load; the story's moral weight may itself feel demanding.

Try this first. Choose a comfortable difficulty and follow an early conversation before testing one explained battle action. Pay attention to whether the political questions interest you enough to learn the surrounding systems; no vote of the Bureau can supply that interest.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P062 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

TRIANGLE STRATEGY

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Scales of Conviction Prefer Actual Dinner

TRIANGLE STRATEGY's voting allies made me propose a formal ballot on the summit menu. Rosa reminded me that the food was already prepared. I said the vote would affirm collective conviction. "Nigga, affirm it with a plate."

Kit wanted a vegetarian option kept clearly marked. Rae wanted the olives replenished. Remy wanted time to eat before his costume change. These requests required three practical adjustments, not an election between hungry people.

Nia suggested saving votes for genuinely unresolved choices. June immediately nominated the Blue Comet song. Dez vetoed a second play. June accused her of obstructing reconciliation through rhythm.

Mercedes offered to play a short instrumental echo during the break, which June accepted because she liked the arrangement and Dez accepted because nobody had to stand through the whole song again.

I announced consensus. Velvet corrected me: we had dinner requests and a musical compromise. Shawna put a plate in my hand before I could convert either into a constitutional doctrine. The scales of conviction tipped toward something hot and edible.

Aiden's verdict. The political choices and voting allies give the tactical story a distinctive appeal, with heavy names and systems retained. Our dinner negotiation required three adjustments and considerably fewer speeches than I proposed.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher supports conviction/voting and tactical systems; current PC metadata declares no timed input, adjustable difficulty and Save Anytime. These are declarations, not independent full-path control validation.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1850510/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P063 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Tactics Ogre: Reborn

Edition considered: PC Reborn edition

Follow Denam through factional conflict, where branching decisions connect personal loyalties with public consequences in a sustained tactical political fantasy.

What you do. Read the political situation, direct units through battle turns, and manage a roster's equipment, classes, and abilities as choices branch.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Reborn declares untimed input, but rosters and political names require learning; selection and camera comfort still need testing.

Why it might click. Denam's decisions unfold amid factional conflict in a kingdom shaped by past rule and renewed war. Branching story choices and tactical battles make the appeal a sustained political fantasy in which personal loyalties and public consequences rarely stay neatly separate.

The full catch. The current Reborn PC listing declares no timed input, mouse-only and keyboard-only options, and saving at any time. Even so, a large roster, equipment, classes, battle rules and political names demand substantial learning. Reborn's revised systems differ from earlier releases; comfortable selection and camera use still need testing.

Try this first. Read the opening situation and try one unit's basic turn without planning an entire army. Keep a small character note if useful, then decide whether the political intrigue makes the menus feel worthwhile rather than automatically accepting them as a toll.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P063 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Tactics Ogre: Reborn

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Reborn Agreement Has the Same Old Jacket

Tactics Ogre's branching loyalties made June consider possible futures for the jacket claim. One future involved Dez apologizing. Another involved Dez returning it. A third involved June retaining excellent material for conversation.

Dez favored the third. "You've had fifty-nine years of entertainment." "And you had the fucking jacket."

Nia offered to separate sentimental value from replacement value. June surprised her by declining a price. She wanted Dez to admit the cardigan had never been equivalent. Dez looked at the old photograph for a long moment.

"It wasn't equivalent," she said. "It was warmer." June swatted her arm with the paper, laughing despite herself. The branch narrowed but did not close.

Rae wanted to see the original jacket restored to its first shape. Dez said she'd saved an alteration pattern somewhere. Kit asked whether June would model it. June immediately discussed lighting.

I offered a commemorative runway. Shawna said one jacket did not require a new venue. Nigga, the future kept branching directly toward my credit card and being pruned by my wife.

Aiden's verdict. The branching political fantasy can reward sustained interest, with rosters and selection demands still present. Our jacket dispute has advanced to one partial admission and the possibility of excellent tailoring.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Reborn listing supports branching story, revised tactical systems and developer-declared no timed input/Mouse Only/Keyboard Only/Save Anytime. Complexity assessment is editorial, not a clinical rating.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1451090/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P064 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

FINAL FANTASY TACTICS - The Ivalice Chronicles

Edition considered: PC Enhanced version proposed for later assessment

Follow Ramza and Delita through Ivalice's struggle over class, power, and loyalty, with fully voiced dialogue in this edition's Enhanced version.

What you do. Choose Enhanced and Squire, then move characters and select battle actions while gradually learning jobs, equipment, and positioning during the story.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Squire lowers a barrier without removing tactical systems; Classic differs, and held-input or camera comfort has not been verified.

Why it might click. Ramza and Delita are drawn through a struggle over power, class and competing loyalties in Ivalice. This edition's Enhanced version adds fully voiced dialogue and refinements, offering a specific modern route into a substantial tactical story rather than an unspecified nostalgic recommendation.

The full catch. Use Enhanced with Squire difficulty for the proposed trial. That lowers a barrier but does not remove job systems, equipment, positioning or a large cast of names. The Classic version has different features. Complete held-input and camera comfort remain unverified, and a gentler setting does not make every battle simple.

Try this first. Select Enhanced and Squire, then follow the opening explanation through one character's movement and action. Read only the abilities immediately available before considering future job combinations; the first question is whether this turn feels understandable and interesting.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P064 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

FINAL FANTASY TACTICS - The Ivalice Chronicles

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Noble Class Has Lost Its Drink Tokens

The Ivalice story's class conflict made Rae examine the gold and silver drink tokens I'd ordered. I explained that gold represented summit leadership. She asked who had appointed it.

I looked at my own handful of gold. Nigga, evidence can be very loud without making a sound.

Nia wanted the distinction removed. Kit wanted her silver token accepted at the same bar as everyone else's. Velvet pointed out that performers had been assigned none because somebody assumed they wouldn't want refreshments while working.

Rosa called the bar manager over. We replaced both colors with one clear arrangement and made sure the staff knew it. The man looked relieved to lose a rule nobody had explained consistently.

Remy took the unused gold tokens for his costume. They made an excellent little ceremonial chain.

Velvet said it suited him. He blushed so openly that the entire room briefly became kinder.

I asked whether I could keep one token as founder. Shawna put it in my pocket. "Souvenir, baby. Not a political system." The noble class retired beside my room key.

Aiden's verdict. The Enhanced edition offers a particular route into this substantial political story, with tactical and control demands retained. Our class distinction has become a drag-king necklace and one useless souvenir.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Square Enix's current official page confirms exact title, Enhanced/Classic distinction, voiced Enhanced dialogue and Squire difficulty. Job/ability complexity is documented; complete no-hold/camera comfort is not.

Source 1: <https://final-fantasy-tactics-the-ivalice-chronicles.square-enix-games.com/en-us>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P065 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Disgaea 5 Complete

Edition considered: PC Complete edition

Enjoy an extravagant demonic rebellion where huge numbers and unusual combinations make increasingly elaborate systems part of the comedy and attraction.

What you do. Try the opening move-and-act battle loop, then gradually explore jobs, items, special mechanics, and customization if those systems become enjoyable.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The Complete edition adds extensive material and deep systems; turn-based decisions do not make its menu or memory burden light.

Why it might click. Disgaea 5 turns tactical role-playing into an extravagant comic machine of demons, rebellion, huge numbers and unusual combinations. Its appeal is enjoying systems that become increasingly ridiculous, with a cast and world equally happy to push beyond ordinary fantasy restraint.

The full catch. The Complete edition contains extensive added material and many deep systems: jobs, items, special battle mechanics and customization. That is a major menu and memory burden, not a promise of more effortless entertainment. Turn-based decisions help pacing, but the publisher's abundance is exactly the catch for someone wanting few systems.

Try this first. Try only the opening explanation and a basic battle action. Leave bonus scenarios and long-term optimization alone until the fundamental move-and-act loop feels enjoyable; there is no requirement to consume everything included in the word Complete.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P065 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Disgaea 5 Complete

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Damage Number Is My Bar Estimate

Disgaea 5's glorious numerical excess made Remy read my event estimate like a battle result. He started with the chandelier line and increased his dramatic voice for every extra zero.

Velvet accompanied him with an increasingly horrified piano chord. Mercedes let her because the timing was excellent.

I said big numbers could represent big ambition. Rae found three separate charges for gold ribbon. "This nigga has dealt critical damage to stationery." Kit corrected her that ribbon wasn't stationery, then admitted the distinction did not improve my defense.

Mika wanted one roll retained for the ceremony. They knew exactly where it would go. The other two could still be returned, which made their specific extravagance considerably more persuasive than my general one.

Nia marked the refund. Tank asked whether we could convert the savings into better dessert. Rosa said dessert was already good and he could stop campaigning before tasting it.

The damage report ended. Remy bowed. I survived with fewer ribbons and a numerical reputation that nobody intended to let me forget before breakfast.

Aiden's verdict. The exaggerated tactical systems can be a pleasure for someone who enjoys their depth, with dense menus understood. Our largest damage number belongs to a host repeatedly defeated by decorative ribbon.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Complete listing documents included scenarios, jobs, customization and multiple strategic systems. Waits is tactical decision pacing; no full-path no-hold or low-menu claim is made.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/803600/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P066 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Disgaea 7: Vows of the Virtueless

Edition considered: PC base game

Follow a reluctant fighter and enthusiastic client through demonic comic excess, where oversized transformations turn tactical possibilities into increasingly unreasonable spectacle.

What you do. Learn movement and attacks, select targets through PC menus, and explore character classes, items, and special battle mechanics as interest grows.

Mixed controls | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Systems remain dense, and auto-battle unlocks only after completing each stage; it is not a verified first-pass story bypass.

Why it might click. A reluctant fighter and an enthusiastic client anchor a demonic tactical adventure with exaggerated powers and comic excess. New systems such as oversized combat transformations fit a series whose appeal includes seeing a seemingly sensible strategy become gloriously unreasonable.

The full catch. The PC publisher specifically supports keyboard/mouse menu and target selection, but the many classes, items and mechanics remain dense. Auto-battle unlocks after successfully completing each stage; it is not a verified first-pass story bypass. Turn-based structure does not settle every held-input requirement or make the management light.

Try this first. Learn the first battle's ordinary movement and attack before opening every customization possibility. Test whether the PC menu and target controls feel clear, and judge the cast's humor separately from the attraction of increasingly elaborate numerical combinations.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P066 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Disgaea 7: Vows of the Virtueless

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Giant Transformation Doesn't Fit Through the Door

Disgaea 7's oversized transformations encouraged Mika to show us a concept for Velvet's entrance: a towering silhouette projected behind her, filling the wall from floor to ceiling.

Velvet loved it. So did Kit, which she admitted only after checking how it affected the next light cue. I tried claiming the idea as an extension of my own monument strategy.

"Nigga, this one's her size on purpose," Tank said.

The first test made Velvet's headpiece appear to grow through the ceiling. Remy stood beneath it and announced himself a humble subject. She reached down theatrically while he offered the revised payment envelope.

Rae and Nia laughed together. I admired the effect, then asked what it cost. Mika pointed at the projector already in the room. For once a giant idea didn't require a giant additional invoice.

Shawna kissed my cheek when I stopped searching for a way to make it cost more. Velvet rehearsed the entrance twice, each enormous shadow perfectly timed by people who actually knew their jobs.

Aiden's verdict. The comic tactical excess has its own appeal, while dense systems and first-pass limits remain important. Our giant transformation succeeded because the projector was already paid for and Velvet deserved the wall.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Base PC listing supports Fuji/Pirilika, Jumbification, keyboard/mouse menu controls and auto-battle unlocked by completed stages. No complete-edition extras, unconditional autoplay or hold-free guarantee is inferred.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2250600/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P067 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Chained Echoes

Edition considered: PC release

Travel with an ensemble across a war-torn world of dragons and machines, with political trouble and personal stories sustaining the journey.

What you do. Move through the world, read the cast's story, and select turn-based battle actions while learning skills and managing equipment along the way.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The publisher describes complex skills and equipment; directional movement may require holds, and every potential timing question is not settled.

Why it might click. An ensemble crosses a war-torn continent in a fantasy world that mixes dragons and machines with a deliberate older-RPG visual style. The appeal is a long journey through varied places, with character stories and political trouble giving the travels a continuing purpose.

The full catch. The publisher explicitly describes a complex skill and equipment system. Turn-based battles permit choosing actions, while exploration still requires directional movement and may involve sustained inputs. Visible enemies replace random encounters, but that does not eliminate combat, navigation demands or every potential timing question across the whole story.

Try this first. Follow the opening until you can test one movement segment and one explained battle choice. Read the currently useful skill information, then decide whether the cast and world make further systems learning attractive rather than assuming retro-looking graphics mean retro-sized complexity.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P067 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Chained Echoes

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dragon Has a Mechanical Expense Account

Chained Echoes' mixture of dragons and machines reminded me that I'd ordered a mechanical dragon centerpiece for the financial table. I had prudently forgotten to mention this during the fountain discussion.

The delivery man did the mentioning. Rae folded her arms. Nia stopped writing. Tank whispered, "Nigga's got downloadable debt."

The dragon was small, handsome, and completely unnecessary. Mika loved it instantly. Their miniature hotel collection apparently had room for a serious zoning problem. They offered to borrow it for the floor-plan display if it could remain unplugged.

I wanted to demonstrate the moving wings. Shawna asked whether that would make it nonreturnable. The delivery man nodded. My hand withdrew from the switch with the dignity of a man encountering a poisonous snake.

We photographed it for Mika, kept the packaging intact, and sent it back. They sighed sincerely, then placed their smallest model hotel beside the empty space.

Velvet watched the departure. "Good dragon. Came, threatened the treasury, left." Remy supplied one heroic chord. I accepted survival without merchandise.

Aiden's verdict. The ensemble journey's mixture of fantasy and machinery may be attractive, with movement and system questions retained. Our mechanical dragon threatened the treasury before departing safely inside its original packaging.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher supports story-driven ensemble journey, visible enemies, turn-based battles and complex equipment/skills. Held movement and complete path comfort are unverified; no all-game no-timer claim.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1229240/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P068 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Sea of Stars

Edition considered: PC base game

Join companions in a colorful sun-and-moon fantasy adventure, with local cooperative story play available through the Dawn of Equinox update.

What you do. Move through the world, inspect difficulty and relic options, and choose battle actions that include timed hits during the companions' journey.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Timed hits are real, including in co-op; a complete route avoiding every timed or held action has not been established.

Why it might click. A colorful, classically inspired role-playing journey follows Solstice Warriors through a world of sun-and-moon magic. The combination of scenery, companions and adventure is the attraction; the Dawn of Equinox update also makes the story available in local cooperative play.

The full catch. Timed hits are a real combat mechanic, including in co-op. The developer documents difficulty presets and relic adjustments, but this research does not establish a complete path avoiding every timed or held action. Movement and traversal require separate checks. Treat it as a deliberate detour rather than assuming turn-based means entirely unrushed.

Try this first. Inspect the installed version's difficulty and relic explanations, then test movement and one early battle with no expectation of perfect timing. If the required operations already conflict with preferences, enjoy the premise and choose another route without a mastery assignment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P068 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Sea of Stars

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Sun and Moon Have Separate Lighting Invoices

Sea of Stars' sun-and-moon magic made Kit and Mika discuss alternating warm and cool light over the stage. I heard the word alternating and prepared to authorize another rental.

Kit stopped me. "We have both lights." "But do we have the vision?" "Aiden, we have switches."

Remy wanted his fanfare beneath the warm light. Velvet wanted the cool one for her first pose. Mercedes tried the transition while Nia and Rae watched from the side of the room, sharing the last respectable crackers.

June asked for a blue light during the Blue Comet song. Dez said the original club had one working bulb and June was improving history. June admitted the improvement looked excellent.

I volunteered to operate the cues. Three people declined with such synchronized politeness that I suspected rehearsal. Mika took the controls and made the room look like an actual evening instead of a showroom.

Shawna led me to a chair. "You can watch something beautiful without directing it." I looked at her. For once the nigga answered correctly.

Aiden's verdict. The colorful journey and cooperative option can invite interest, while real timed hits preserve the warning. Our sun-and-moon experiment works through existing lights and a host finally enjoying the view.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer describes original story with Dawn of Equinox's up-to-three-player local co-op, timed hits and difficulty presets. This assesses that updated base adventure, not the OST or unverified Sunset Edition changes. Complete no-timed/hold path unknown.

Source 1: <https://sabotagestudio.com/press-release/sabotage-studio-announces-free-sea-of-stars-update-dawn-of-equinox-bringing-top-fan-requested-additions-to-pc-and-consoles-gains-november-release-date/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P069 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

OCTOPATH TRAVELER II

Edition considered: PC release

Choose among eight protagonists with distinct motives, then discover how their different beginnings and an expanding cast relate within one shared world.

What you do. Follow a chosen traveler's opening, select battle actions, and manage jobs, equipment, movement, and character abilities as the wider journey develops.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed input is declared, but eight stories and battle systems add memory load; comfortable directional holds remain a separate question.

Why it might click. Eight protagonists bring separate motivations and talents to a shared world, with stories that can be approached through different beginnings. The attraction is choosing a person who catches your interest, then discovering how an expanding cast and their journeys relate.

The full catch. The PC listing declares play without timed input, but battles still use several interacting systems and the wider journey includes movement, jobs, equipment and distinct character abilities. Remembering eight stories can become substantial. Directional hold comfort remains a separate question even when battle selections wait.

Try this first. Choose one traveler because the premise appeals, read that opening, and learn one ordinary battle action. Keep the next step attached to that character before treating the whole ensemble as a single large list of unfinished obligations.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, take turns.

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P069 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

OCTOPATH TRAVELER II

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Eight Protagonists Refuse to Share One Expense Code

OCTOPATH's eight different beginnings made me appreciate the summit's competing stories. I asked eight people to describe their immediate objective. The exercise became dangerous before the fourth answer.

Velvet wanted payment. Remy wanted his fanfare. Kit wanted karaoke. Rae wanted proper snacks. Nia wanted the financial meeting to end while there was still an evening left to enjoy.

Rosa wanted the kitchen schedule respected. Mercedes wanted a clean recording. Shawna wanted her husband to stop conducting surprise exercises when she had already told him her objective twice.

I counted myself as a ninth protagonist. Tank leaned over from his chair. "I'm ten, nigga. My story involves eating without an interview."

Mika wrote each cost beside the actual request. Some required money; others required me to stop occupying the microphone. The second category had an astonishingly favorable price.

Nia finished her glass and asked Rae about the bike outside. Their story moved forward without submitting another expense. I let it, partly from maturity and partly because my wife had confiscated the marker.

Aiden's verdict. The eight personal journeys offer different reasons to begin, with substantial memory and movement demands retained. Our ensemble's cheapest wish is for the host to stop interviewing people between bites.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact PC listing supports eight travelers, Path Actions, jobs and Break/Boost; developer declares no timed input. Mixed label reflects active exploration alongside waiting battle decisions, not a contradicted timer claim. Hold comfort unverified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1971650/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P070 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

DRAGON QUEST XI S: Echoes of an Elusive Age - Definitive Edition

Edition considered: PC Definitive Edition

Join an accused hero and growing band of companions in a colorful identity-searching adventure, with both personal backstories and traditional turn-based battles.

What you do. Inspect presentation choices, move through the world, and choose party actions while managing equipment and abilities across a long companion-filled story.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The 3D camera, directional holds, and optional minigames need checking; the 2D option is not an instant universal solution.

Why it might click. A young hero accused of being a threat gathers companions and searches for the truth of his identity. The appeal is a substantial, colorful adventure with personal backstories and a traditional turn-based battle structure; this edition also includes a two-dimensional presentation option.

The full catch. Party equipment, abilities, navigation and a long story create a meaningful memory load. The 3D presentation brings camera demands; trying 2D may change that burden but is not a universal solution or instant switch at every moment. Directional holds and optional minigame timing remain separate checks.

Try this first. Inspect the Definitive Edition's presentation choices and begin without extra Draconian challenge settings. Try ordinary movement and one early turn-based battle, judging both the immediate controls and whether the companions' tone makes a long adventure sound inviting.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, we're good.

P070 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

DRAGON QUEST XI S: Echoes of an Elusive Age - Definitive Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Two-Dimensional Kingdom Has Better Parking

Dragon Quest's hero had a complicated identity. I had a complicated floor plan, which Mika translated into a small arrangement of model hotels, paper tables, and a single toy chandelier.

I loved it. I immediately asked whether a miniature statue of me could fit near the entrance. Rae moved the tiny table into that space instead.

“Now people can sign.” “But where do I go?” Shawna tapped the chair beside her. “Try here, your majesty.”

Kit found it easier to discuss the lighting when she could point at a small stage. Velvet moved her changing area away from the little paper bar. Remy placed his crown token beside the microphone and declared the kingdom stable.

Nia reminded us that the real room still needed checking later. The model wasn't a magic substitute for walking through the actual arrangement. Mika agreed and photographed the proposed version for the venue discussion.

I slipped a tiny gold token into the entrance afterward. Tank caught me. “Nigga, even your miniature needs supervision.” He returned the table and ate a cracker with victorious calm.

Aiden’s verdict. The traditional adventure and presentation options may appeal, with camera, holds, and minigames still requiring checks. Our miniature kingdom helps discussion while leaving the actual room for a later inspection.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected exact XI S Definitive page confirms 2D/3D modes, companions, turn-based combat and optional Draconian challenges. Mode-switch limits and full input/timing comfort are not fully verified; no original-XI assumptions.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1295510/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P071 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Persona 5 Royal

Edition considered: PC Royal edition

Spend time with a stylish ensemble whose daily relationships connect to a supernatural struggle against abusive power, supported by striking music and presentation.

What you do. Read conversations, plan calendar choices and relationships, explore dungeons, and select combat actions while following the ensemble's long character story.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Required later countdowns and timed traversal conflict with strict no-rush needs; menus, calendar planning, and camera handling add complexity.

Why it might click. A stylish ensemble of students balances daily relationships with a supernatural campaign against abusive power. Royal offers an extensive character story with striking music and presentation, making the desire to spend time with its cast entirely understandable even when its systems are demanding.

The full catch. This is a detour for a strict no-rush preference. Royal walkthroughs document a required later boss with a thirty-minute countdown, alongside timed traversal elsewhere. Ordinary turn-based combat does not erase those exceptions. Calendar choices, relationship planning, combat menus, dungeon movement and camera handling create additional complexity.

Try this first. Judge the opening conversations and presentation, but keep the late countdown warning in the decision from the start. Establish a deliberate shared-viewing or help arrangement before investing in a long campaign if those required operations are unacceptable alone.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P071 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Persona 5 Royal

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Calendar Has Rejected My Surprise Event

Persona's crowded calendar made Mika inspect the summit schedule with renewed hostility. I had inserted a surprise founder's address between dinner and Velvet's show, using a font small enough to resemble a footnote.

Velvet found it anyway. "Why is your footnote twenty minutes?" "Context." "Nigga, I have a costume change, not a sabbatical."

Kit wanted her promised karaoke time protected. Remy wanted his microphone checked before he performed. Mercedes wanted the room quiet for one final recording test. Every real activity had a person waiting behind it.

I tried moving my address into the break. Rosa pointed out that a break containing an address became another event. Shawna suggested I deliver the speech upstairs to the mirror, which had already demonstrated remarkable patience with my work.

Mika removed the item. The schedule became legible again. I kept the little speech in my pocket because a man can retain private delusions without printing them on everybody else's evening.

Tank asked whether that principle also covered the dessert announcement. I reluctantly confirmed that it did.

Aiden's verdict. The stylish ensemble can be appealing, but its required countdowns and traversal keep the no-rush warning decisive. Our calendar has survived one attempted invasion by a twenty-minute footnote.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Royal PC listing supports premise. Royal-specific walkthroughs corroborate required Okumura time limits; no PC option removing them was verified. Story interest is separated from full-route suitability.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1687950/>

Source 2: <https://gamefaqs.gamespot.com/ps4/260936-persona-5-royal/faqs/78256/week-24-october-1st-october-9th-okumuras-palace>

Source 3: https://www.neoseeker.com/persona-5-royal/Okumura%27s_Space_Station

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P072 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

BRAVELY DEFAULT II

Edition considered: PC release

Travel with four heroes through a crystal-centered fantasy, using a battle rhythm that asks when to save actions and when to commit them.

What you do. Learn an ordinary attack and Default, observe the next turn, and combine jobs, abilities, and equipment as the adventure develops.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed input is declared, but Brave Points and jobs create heavy tactics; directional control may still require uncomfortable holds.

Why it might click. Four heroes undertake a crystal-centered fantasy journey with jobs and abilities that can be combined in different ways. The signature battle idea is deciding when to store action capacity and when to spend it, creating a recognizable rhythm of preparation and commitment.

The full catch. The PC publisher declares play without timed input and adjustable difficulty. That helps pace, while Brave Points, primary and secondary jobs, equipment and enemy behavior still create a heavy tactical load. Exploration requires directional control; a no-timed-input declaration does not establish that movement is comfortable without holds.

Try this first. Choose a comfortable difficulty and learn one ordinary attack and one Default action in the early guidance. Observe what changes on the next turn before planning elaborate job combinations or trying to bank an entire party's future at once.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, we're good.

P072 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

BRAVELY DEFAULT II

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Brave Points Are Actually My Wife's Patience

BRAVELY DEFAULT's stored and spent actions gave me a theory of marriage. I could accumulate goodwill through useful work and spend it on one magnificent surprise. Shawna listened with folded arms.

"What magnificent surprise?" "The theory is preliminary." "Then keep it theoretical, nigga."

I carried water, returned unused ribbons, and found Kit's glasses on top of the karaoke folder. Three useful actions. I began to feel extraordinarily rich in imaginary domestic currency.

Then I suggested a joint portrait above the dance floor. Shawna said she wanted a dance floor, not a shrine. My entire account disappeared in one sentence.

Rae and Nia were comparing the budget's remaining choices. Nia proposed saving a small reserve for genuine surprises. Rae said a broken cable counted; an unexpected portrait did not. Their agreement sounded suspiciously informed by recent evidence.

I returned to carrying water. Shawna touched my hand when I brought hers. No score appeared, no credit was issued, and the moment was better for being impossible to invoice.

Aiden's verdict. The crystal journey's stored-action idea gives its battles a recognizable rhythm, with jobs and holds still requiring consideration. Our host's imaginary goodwill account cannot purchase a surprise shrine above the dance floor.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact PC listing explains Brave/Default, jobs and four heroes; developer declares no timed input and adjustable difficulty. Mixed pace distinguishes exploration from waiting decisions, not a claim of required timers. Holds untested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1446650/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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P073 / A PLACE TO START

Slay the Spire

Edition considered: PC original game

Build a deck from limited choices, enjoying the moment a useful card-and-relic combination gives the next encounter a different shape.

What you do. Read attack and defensive cards, spend available energy, and choose cards or relics that develop a plan across the climb's encounters.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Card effects and energy require reading and planning; test targeting gestures, and expect losing runs as part of the structure.

Why it might click. Build a deck while climbing a changing sequence of encounters, choosing cards and relics that make the next fight play differently. The appeal is recognizing a useful combination and gradually shaping a plan from imperfect, limited choices rather than executing a fixed routine.

The full catch. The developer declares play without timed input, mouse-only play and saving at any time. Card text, energy, status effects and deck interactions still demand reading and planning. Test card selection and targeting for drag or hold comfort; losing a run is part of the structure, not evidence that the trial was wasted.

Try this first. Begin with the first available character and examine one attack card and one defensive card before playing either. Try one encounter and judge whether the tradeoff is satisfying without aiming to finish the entire climb on the first visit.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P073 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Slay the Spire

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Deck Contains Too Many Founder Cards

Slay the Spire's changing deck made Remy turn our remaining budget requests into little cards. He wrote each expense clearly and asked me which ones supported the evening we actually wanted.

I selected HOST'S PORTRAIT LIGHTING. Rae slid it back. "Try a card with another person's name." Velvet selected the stage payment. Rosa selected staff time. Kit selected the microphone check. Each card had an obvious effect, which made my proposal for a second ceremonial reveal look increasingly ornamental.

Nia added a reserve card and put it beside an equipment repair estimate. Mika liked having the tradeoffs visible. They also admitted they still wanted the giant shadow effect, which fortunately used equipment already paid for.

I tried sneaking my portrait card underneath the reserve. Shawna caught the edge without looking. Nigga, this woman had years of practice detecting suspicious spending from changes in my breathing. We kept the useful cards. Remy drew a tiny crown on his fanfare request and set it aside with excellent grace when Mercedes reminded him the keyboard was already there.

Aiden's verdict. The evolving deck can reward discovering combinations, with reading and losing runs part of the structure. Our budget deck improved after several cards stopped being different names for my portrait.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Original PC game listing supports deckbuilding/roguelike structure and declares Mouse Only, no timed input and Save Anytime. Card manipulation comfort and full-path suitability are not independently verified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/646570/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, we're good.

P074 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Monster Train

Edition considered: PC original game

Defend a train through stacked battle spaces, where choosing a creature's floor can matter as much as choosing the next card.

What you do. Place units on floors, play spells, and develop the deck through upgrades while defending the train across an ordinary solo run.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Exclude clock-driven Hell Rush from this trial; floor placement and card effects remain complex, with drag comfort unverified.

Why it might click. Defend a train across stacked battle spaces by combining units, spells and upgrades into a developing deck. The vertical layout changes the familiar card-battle question: where a creature stands can matter as much as which card is played next.

The full catch. Use an ordinary solo run for this proposal. The publisher explicitly describes Hell Rush multiplayer as a real-time, clock-driven competition, so exclude it from a no-rush trial. Multiple floors, unit placement, card upgrades and interacting effects still create a substantial mental load; dragging and held-input behavior require checking.

Try this first. Open a solo run and inspect one unit's placement and one spell before advancing the fight. Keep attention on the immediate floor arrangement; there is no need to plan a perfect deck or enter any competitive challenge to understand the attraction.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P074 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Monster Train

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Train Has a Dining Car with Conditions

Monster Train's stacked spaces made Tank arrange three serving trays vertically on a display stand. He called it the coalition's refreshment express. Rosa asked who had approved the unstable top layer. "The conductor," he said. She removed it. "The engineer disagrees."

Rae wanted the good crackers on the middle tray where people could reach them. Kit wanted the stand away from the music equipment. Nia wanted the bottom shelf to stop collecting everyone's abandoned papers.

I proposed a ceremonial dining carriage built around the whole buffet. Mika looked interested for one dangerous second, then checked the actual space and shook their head. Our event planner could resist extravagance when geometry finally got involved.

June took a plate and told Dez the Blue Comet had served sandwiches from an ironing board. Dez corrected the history: it was her ironing board, and June still had one of its covers.

Tank moved the stand. Nigga, our train acquired a safe route while another branch of the restitution campaign opened beside the cheese.

Aiden's verdict. The stacked card battles give positioning a distinct role; exclude the clock-driven mode and test gestures. Our refreshment train has moved onto a safer track under Rosa's uncompromising engineering supervision.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Original-game publisher page supports three vertical fields/deckbuilding and explicitly identifies Hell Rush as timed real-time multiplayer. Waits applies to the proposed ordinary solo mode, not all modes; holds remain unchecked.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1102190/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P075 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Griftlands

Edition considered: PC release

Navigate a rough science-fiction world where separate conversation and combat decks make negotiations, alliances, and grudges matter mechanically as well as narratively.

What you do. Read negotiation or combat cards, choose them in encounters, and manage relationships whose effects can follow the protagonist into later situations.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Two decks and relationship consequences require substantial text and tracking; every gesture or possible timing exception has not been audited.

Why it might click. Three separate protagonists navigate a rough science-fiction world through fights, negotiations and relationships. Maintaining different decks for talking and combat makes social encounters mechanically substantial, while choices about allies and enemies can follow the character into later situations.

The full catch. Two decks, relationship effects, faction loyalties and run-based consequences make this more demanding than a small casual card game. Considerable text explains abilities and social stakes. Turn-based card decisions support deliberation, but no full-path guarantee about every gesture or timing exception has been independently established.

Try this first. Start the opening character's story and read one negotiation card in context before building a grand strategy. Try one exchange, observing both what the card does and why the other person cares, then decide whether managing conversation this way is enjoyable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P075 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Griftlands

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Negotiation Deck Has a Compliment in It

Griftlands separated talking from fighting. I suggested the summit needed two decks too: one for negotiation and one for winning. Nia asked why I thought those were different objectives.

Rae said they were different whenever I negotiated with the hotel. Nigga, the table had stopped offering me easy openings.

Velvet wanted a clearer introduction before her number. Remy wanted his stage name pronounced with a dramatic pause. Kit wanted nobody shouting over the first note of her song. They negotiated three sentences and a cue without anyone declaring victory.

Nia complimented Rae's repair of the table. Rae, who could discuss a bent bracket for an hour, answered with six words and knocked a cracker onto the floor. The negotiation deck had acquired an unexpectedly powerful card.

I bent to retrieve it and struck my head beneath the table. Shawna asked whether this was my fighting deck. Tank said I appeared to be losing against furniture.

Rae laughed, Nia relaxed, and somebody gave me a napkin for my dignity. No alliance changed hands, but the atmosphere improved considerably.

Aiden's verdict. The separate negotiation and combat decks make relationships mechanically distinctive, with substantial tracking retained. Our most effective conversational card was a sincere compliment that briefly defeated a highly competent mechanic.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher supports three campaigns, separate negotiation/combat decks and persistent social consequences. Waits describes core card decisions; held gestures and complete-path exceptions have not been tested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/601840/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P076 / A PLACE TO START

Dicey Dungeons

Edition considered: PC release

Enter an absurd dungeon game show as walking dice, turning rolled numbers into equipment effects and small tactical puzzles with lively presentation.

What you do. Read an equipment requirement, assign a rolled die, and observe its effect before choosing another placement or continuing through the dungeon.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Arithmetic and equipment conditions require thought; test placement gestures, and begin with the initial character before learning different rule sets.

Why it might click. Walking dice face a peculiar dungeon game show, turning rolled numbers into attacks and other equipment effects. Different characters change the rules enough to make a familiar-looking die produce very different little tactical problems, with lively art and music supporting the absurdity.

The full catch. Equipment conditions, arithmetic and random outcomes require thought; later characters change the rules substantially. Turn-based play is the core, but placing dice may involve dragging or other gestures worth testing. Begin with the initial character rather than treating every class or bonus episode as equally simple.

Try this first. Use the first available character and try assigning one die to one piece of equipment. Read the requirement, observe the result, and judge the placement gesture before considering a whole dungeon or a different character with an entirely new rule system.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P076 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Dicey Dungeons

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dungeon Prize Is a Voucher for More Dungeon

Dicey Dungeons' absurd game show inspired Remy to host a draw for the evening's remaining decorative prizes. I supplied sealed envelopes and a voice suited to announcing a small monarchy. Kit won a voucher for one priority karaoke request. She pointed out she'd already negotiated a turn. "Then you've doubled your fortune," I said. "You've printed my existing fortune twice, Aiden."

Rae won a gold bottle opener shaped like my initials. Nia offered to trade her plain one. Rae refused because the ridiculous opener was beginning to amuse her, which I chose to count as brand success. June drew FREE JUKEBOX CHOICE. Dez intercepted it before she could celebrate. "That voucher expires in 1967." Remy laughed so hard he dropped the remaining envelopes.

Velvet collected them and found three prizes labeled MYSTERY. They were empty. I said mystery required imagination. Shawna supplied three drink tokens, all equal, and turned my defective prize system into something people could actually use.

The host retained one empty envelope as evidence of his apparently unlimited potential.

Aiden's verdict. The walking-dice spectacle has a distinctive comic appeal, with arithmetic and placement still needing attention. Our prize show improved once somebody put actual value inside the envelopes marked mystery.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer store supports characters/equipment; official project wiki describes turn-based dice allocation. Drag/hold alternatives and every episode are not verified; recommendation targets the initial character's basic loop.

- Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/861540/>
- Source 2: https://wiki.diceydungeons.com/doku.php?id=dicey_dungeons

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P077 / A PLACE TO START

Balatro

Edition considered: PC base game

Turn familiar-looking poker hands into a changing score puzzle, where Jokers and modifiers can make a modest combination unexpectedly powerful.

What you do. Build a recognizable hand, read Joker effects, and select or arrange cards to improve the combination for the next scoring target.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed mouse play is declared, but scoring modifiers and boss rules add memory demands; selection and rearrangement gestures need testing.

Why it might click. Poker-like hands become ingredients in a single-player score-building puzzle, transformed by Jokers and other modifiers. The attraction is watching a modest combination become unexpectedly powerful and deciding how each new card changes the plan for the next target.

The full catch. The developer declares play without timed input and mouse-only play. Hand recognition, scoring modifiers, changing boss rules and reading several effects at once still take attention. Card rearrangement and selection need a gesture check; a familiar deck does not mean all the surrounding rules are familiar or memory-light.

Try this first. Try the opening explanation and build one clearly recognized hand. Read one Joker's effect in plain language before buying or arranging a complicated combination, then decide whether discovering the score interaction feels satisfying rather than like unwanted arithmetic homework.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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P077 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Balatro

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Joker Has Entered the Reparations Budget

Balatro's surprising modifiers made June propose calculating interest on the Blue Comet jacket claim. Dez argued it should run backward because the story had entertained June for decades. June requested a less ridiculous calculation.

Nia put down her pen. "I'm not creating a financial product out of your flirting." Both veterans objected to the final word with suspicious speed.

Remy made a Joker card bearing my face. Its alleged effect was to double any decorating expense while reducing the host's ability to explain it. Velvet considered the rule remarkably well balanced.

I attempted a counter-card granting free speeches. Kit rejected it before I finished drawing the border. Rae proposed that all imaginary gains remain imaginary, an excellent safeguard for a table surrounded by actual casino carpet.

June named a modest, concrete settlement: Dez would look for the saved alteration pattern so they could discuss restoring the jacket, then buy dinner. Dez accepted dinner immediately and searched for a loophole in restoring.

Nigga, fifty-nine years of compound argument had resolved into two people spending another afternoon together.

Aiden's verdict. The score-building combinations can be satisfying, with modifiers and selection demands still real. Our imaginary interest calculation settled into a practical afternoon and a Joker that describes the host too accurately.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact base listing supports poker-inspired deckbuilding, Jokers and developer-declared no timed input/Mouse Only. No real-money gambling claim or guaranteed hold-free card manipulation is made.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2379780/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P078 / A PLACE TO START

Cobalt Core

Edition considered: PC release

Meet a small spaceship crew caught in a time-loop mystery, using card choices to reposition the ship as well as attack.

What you do. Inspect incoming fire, play movement or attack cards, and shift along one line to avoid shots or align weapons during encounters.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Crew decks, ship layout, and incoming fire interact; gesture comfort and the full sequence of encounters remain untested.

Why it might click. A small crew's personalities and a time-loop mystery sit inside spaceship card battles. Moving along a single line makes positioning part of the card choice: avoiding a shot or lining up a weapon can matter as much as adding more damage.

The full catch. Crew decks, ship layout, incoming fire and upgrades create interacting information to track. The publisher invites play at one's own pace, but gesture comfort and the complete sequence of encounters are not independently tested. This is a card-driven tactical game, not a reflex flying game, yet it still requires attentive planning.

Try this first. Inspect one incoming attack and one movement card during the opening guidance. See what shifting the ship changes before building a multi-card sequence, then decide whether the crew's banter gives you a reason to explore another encounter.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P078 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Cobalt Core

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Time Loop Has Replayed My Card Decline

Cobalt Core's crew faced a time-loop mystery. Our crew faced the payment terminal returning to the same cheerful screen every time I tapped my card. Tank began narrating the recurrence. "Again the captain confronts his destiny." "Nigga, stop." "Again destiny requests another method." The card wasn't declined; the reader had lost connection. Mika found the floor manager while Nia checked that we weren't approving duplicate charges. Rae moved the cable away from a chair wheel and discovered the practical villain. Shawna stood beside me without making a joke, which was suspiciously loving under the circumstances. I thanked her. "Don't thank me yet. I'm saving it for when the room's quieter." The next attempt worked. Velvet's remaining deposit was confirmed, and she relaxed her shoulders in a way I hadn't noticed she'd been holding them. Remy brought her the confirmation without a fanfare. I asked Tank to retire the narration. He nodded solemnly. "The captain has escaped the loop." Nigga added applause, and several traitors joined him. **Aiden's verdict.** The crew and time-loop mystery give these spaceship card battles personality, with interacting systems still substantial. Our payment loop ended through a cable repair and a carefully checked confirmation.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher supports card-driven single-axis combat, crew stories and playing at one's pace. No continuous-action flight claim; complete hold/gesture comfort remains unverified.
Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2179850/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P079 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Wildfrost

Edition considered: PC release

Build a companion-card group in a frozen world, enjoying how a carefully chosen move can change attacks several turns into the future.

What you do. Read friendly and enemy counters, place companion cards, and choose moves that alter positioning, effects, and the order of upcoming actions.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Counters measure turns rather than seconds, but attack order and survival demand planning; card-placement comfort still needs checking.

Why it might click. Build a traveling group of companion cards in a frozen world, arranging their effects and attacks to work together. The distinctive pleasure is planning around visible action counters, so that a carefully chosen move changes what happens several turns later.

The full catch. The counters measure turns until actions, not a requirement to click within seconds. Even so, attack order, positioning, status effects and companion survival can be demanding, and a cute appearance does not predict an easy run. Card placement gestures and all-path input comfort remain checks rather than verified assurances.

Try this first. Read one friendly counter and one enemy counter, then use the opening guidance to observe what advances them. Try predicting only the next action before attempting a long chain of effects or comparing every possible leader and deck.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P079 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wildfrost

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Frost Counter Is on the Dessert Table

Wildfrost's visible counters made me obsess over the dessert station. A little card told staff when to bring out the chilled trays. I asked whether it represented our remaining turns before catastrophe. Rosa read it. "It represents dessert."

Tank wanted to speed up the sequence. Rae wanted him to stop hovering over the good crackers while pretending to care about temperature. Nia passed Rae the bowl and received a smile that had nothing to do with fiscal policy.

Kit marked her rehearsal break on the schedule so it wouldn't collide with service. Mercedes agreed to test the final quiet passage earlier. Two small changes made the evening feel less like a set of people waiting to interrupt one another.

I offered an emergency countdown display. Mika said the existing card was perfectly adequate. June told me the Blue Comet had managed with Dez shouting from the kitchen. Dez said June had usually ignored that system too.

The trays arrived. Nobody froze, nothing exploded, and the coalition survived without acquiring another screen showing numbers I intended to misunderstand.

Aiden's verdict. The companion cards and turn counters create an interesting planning problem, with survival and placement demands retained. Our dessert counter has successfully measured service time without becoming a dramatic emergency broadcast.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher explicitly explains turn-based battles and counters measured in turns. This distinguishes counters from real-time deadlines; no low-difficulty or hold-free promise is inferred from visual style.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1811990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P080 / A PLACE TO START

Clubhouse Games: 51 Worldwide Classics

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch; individual games must be assessed separately

Find one enjoyable little ritual within a collection of distinct board, card, and other games, each offering its own in-game explanation.

What you do. Start with Four in a Row, read that game's instructions, and test selecting and placing a piece in the chosen player setup.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Assess each game separately: the collection includes reflex games, and multiplayer, touch, motion, and undo options vary by title.

Why it might click. The collection offers many small, distinct games with in-game explanations, from familiar boards to cards and more active diversions. Its useful promise is variety within one package: it may be possible to find one pleasing little ritual without adopting a long campaign.

The full catch. Assess individual games, not the collection as one control profile. Nintendo explicitly distinguishes strategic choices such as Four-in-a-row from reflex games such as Slot Cars and Toy Boxing. Multiplayer, motion, touch and undo availability vary by game. Shared competitive play is not automatically cooperative play.

Try this first. Open Four-in-a-row and read its own instructions, then test selecting and placing a piece in a local or solo arrangement without an added household timer. Check that game's controls and player setup before trying a second title.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P080 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Clubhouse Games: 51 Worldwide Classics

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Fifty-One Games and One Agreed Expense Sheet

Clubhouse Games offered a collection of small possibilities. I tried proposing fifty-one corresponding summit committees. Shawna took the pen out of my hand before committee number two could acquire stationery.

Rae selected a familiar board game for a short break. Nia sat beside her to watch, then asked to take the next turn when it came around. Nobody made a declaration about what this meant.

Kit and Remy compared the in-game explanations while Velvet checked the now confirmed show payment. Rosa put the final catering total beside it. Mika added the room charge and circled the modest reserve.

June and Dez agreed that their separate jacket arrangement belonged in their own handwriting, however much Nia's legal-looking paper tempted them. Their settlement didn't require everyone else to inherit the 1967 jukebox dispute.

I approved the financial sheet. It wasn't the final coalition treaty, merely numbers we understood and commitments we could honor. Tank applauded once, with his hands safely away from food.

"Historic, nigga." I bowed. Shawna pulled me into the empty chair before history ordered another banner.

Aiden's verdict. The collection offers many separate trials rather than one universal fit; choose individual games carefully. Our summit has agreed its financial sheet and wisely declined to establish fifty-one committees.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo confirms collection/tutorials and explicitly separates strategic/reflex games; proposed trial is Four-in-a-row only. Collection-level mixed pace/input must not certify every included game. Native co-op scope and game-specific holds are unverified.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/clubhouse-games-51-worldwide-classics-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The Money Is Agreed and the Furniture Is Still an Argument

The financial sheet fit on one page when we stopped describing every expense as a historic investment. Performer payments. Staff time. Room charge. Equipment already in place. A small reserve for things that genuinely broke, distinct from things I became excited about while walking past a rental catalogue. Nia read the categories aloud. Rae checked the numbers against the receipts. Kit caught a duplicated lamp charge and looked so satisfied that I almost ordered a small trophy before remembering the entire fucking meeting.

Velvet received the confirmation she'd been waiting for. She put her phone away and became interested in the room again. Remy offered his arm. They went to check the microphone together, discussing a deliberately terrible pun he intended to put into the introduction. She said it was awful. He said that was its function. She agreed it performed its function flawlessly.

Rosa confirmed the additional staff time and went to speak with the kitchen. Mercedes and Porsche checked the recording schedule against the show order. Mika marked the approved equipment on the miniature floor plan, then looked at the actual doorway and frowned. The budget was intelligible. The rooms still required work. I had mistaken paying for square footage for knowing what to do with it, a confusion apparently common among niggas wearing ceremonial jackets indoors.

June and Dez kept their copied invoice in a plain envelope. Both sides. June wrote TURN OVER on the front in enormous letters. Dez wrote SAME TO YOU on the back. Their private jacket arrangement included looking for the old alteration pattern and having dinner afterward. The original jacket remained with Dez for the moment, which June permitted while describing herself as extraordinarily patient. Dez called this a promising new direction in historical fiction.

Nobody signed the final coalition charter. We had agreed financial terms, confirmed immediate payments, and recorded unresolved decorative claims for later review. I remained optimistic about those claims because optimism is cheap until you arrange a spotlight for it. Shawna read the little unresolved line, looked at me, and said nothing. Marriage contains silences with the tensile strength of steel.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, we're good.

Nia put the pen down. Rae asked whether she'd like a little air before the next room. Nia said yes before making it sound more considered. Kit handed them the room map, then noticed she'd given them her karaoke list instead. Everybody laughed, including Kit. She retrieved the list and told them the good balcony was marked on the actual map, which Mika still needed to verify. Even flirtation had encountered our venue problem.

I watched them leave and kept every helpful suggestion inside my own head. Shawna noticed. She linked her arm through mine. "You can learn." I whispered that I possessed several advanced qualifications she hadn't examined tonight. "Then stop enrolling yourself in committees." Her smile gave my future a much more interesting shape than the financial statement.

Tank carried the budget into the next room. Mika followed with the model hotel. June and Dez continued arguing fondly about whether alternating songs meant one each or whichever one sounded better. The Second Great War had survived its treasury meeting. Its armies now needed somewhere sensible to sit, and I was about to discover that a room could be expensive in ways a receipt didn't explain.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

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Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 3 OF SIX

Nigga, Your Empire Is Blocking the Door

Forty places, small worlds and scenic arguments about what counts as progress.

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.

Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan’s creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.

Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden’s scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [The Same Door Did Not Look the Same from Every Chair](#) - page 27. Public space and being read by strangers.

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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 3. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P081	P082	P083	P084	P085	P086	P087	P088
2. Ready for conversation	P089	P090	P091	P092	P093	P094	P095	P096
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P097	P098	P099	P100	P101	P102	P103	P104
4. Here for the atmosphere	P105	P106	P107	P108	P109	P110	P111	P112
5. Open to a wildcard	P113	P114	P115	P116	P117	P118	P119	P120

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The Second Front Had Better Upholstery

The second front of the Great Butch versus Stud War opened when my welcome portrait jammed sideways in a doorway. Four grown people held the frame while I supervised from the angle where my face looked best.

"Nigga, move your face," Tank said.

"That's the back."

"It's still in the way."

Behind the portrait, Rae waited with a toolkit and a bag of crackers she considered beneath the summit's dignity. Kit, a white butch librarian, stood beside her holding three lighting diagrams and searching the top of her head for glasses already hanging from her collar. They had arrived to argue about rooms. I had given them an immediate common enemy with excellent dental work.

We had survived the financial negotiations. A provisional agenda existed. Nobody had signed the final charter, and Velvet Payroll could state the difference between an agreed performance fee and a host's vague promise without checking her notes. My casino convention floor now needed to become a place where people could spend an evening instead of a very expensive picture of one.

I had named the largest room the Chamber of Harmonious Victory. Shawna called it the ballroom because that was what the hotel sign said. She wanted us to finish the room survey, eat something sitting down, and eventually find a private stretch of evening where I was not addressing anyone in the plural.

Auntie June watched the portrait operation from a chair near the lift. At eighty-two, the retired bus driver had no interest in standing merely to observe my mistake from a greater height. Odessa, called Dez, sat beside her at eighty-four, wearing a jacket whose lining she had repaired herself. She had retired from sewing for customers, not from noticing bad workmanship.

"Blue Comet had narrower doors," June said.

"Blue Comet had fewer pictures of men blocking them," Dez answered.

They meant the entirely fictional social club where their entirely fictional 1967 feud had begun. Depending on who told it, the first war concerned a jukebox, a borrowed jacket, a missing quarter, or a look across a dance floor that neither woman described the same way twice. A peace agreement each called unsigned still existed on an old rental invoice. Dez carried it flat in her bag. June claimed to remember every clause, including several Dez insisted had never been written.

I had offered them honored positions as living witnesses. June asked whether witnesses got tea. Dez asked whether the honor included a chair with a cushion. Both demands had proved easier to satisfy than my plan for a heraldic balcony.

Mika unfolded the venue map on a table, then set one of their tiny model hotels beside it. They wanted the gala to begin before it became tomorrow's event. Unfortunately, they also wanted a

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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floating courtyard display, a mirrored arch, and perhaps a little tower for the model hotel if nobody watched the budget too closely.

Nia joined Rae at the table. She was a Black trans lesbian and femme, belonged to overlapping caucuses, worked as a contract lawyer, and wrote so badly that her room preference looked like a threat against a staircase. She wanted a reasonable agreement and, less publicly, a dance with the woman now rejecting our crackers.

Remy wanted a clear microphone route for King Receipts. Velvet wanted dressing space and an entrance that did not require her to fold herself around a drinks cart. Mercedes wanted her keyboard near a socket. Porsche wanted a corner where she could hear Mercedes without listening to me describe the socket's strategic value.

"The labels aren't seating assignments," Nia said when I began dividing the map into heroic opposing territories. She moved her own place card beside Rae's, then visited Mika's model and asked about the courtyard. Her evening had already crossed three of my proposed borders.

Kit selected the lounge with the good light. Rae selected the table that did not wobble. June selected the tea. Dez selected the chair beside June, while making clear that this was geography and not surrender.

We tilted my portrait and finally got it through the doorway. Tank asked where to put it.

I pointed to the center of the map. Every head turned toward me.

Shawna took my hand and pointed instead to an empty patch of wall. For once, the winning maneuver required me to stand aside.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P081 / A PLACE TO START

Unpacking

Edition considered: PC current release

Discover a person's changing life through the belongings they keep, arrange and carry into new homes over the years.

What you do. Open boxes, examine everyday objects and place them in rooms, noticing what each move reveals about their owner.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Small objects and visual searching still need checking, despite documented alternatives to holds, dragging and time limits.

Why it might click. Unpacking tells a life through belongings and the rooms they enter. The pleasure is partly arranging a space and partly noticing what survives each move. A familiar object can carry more character information than a long conversation. This is a worthwhile route for curiosity about people expressed through ordinary things.

The full catch. The developer documents no time limits, mouse-only PC play and alternatives to dragging or holding. Those specific provisions make it a stronger starting candidate. Visual searching, small objects and deciding where things belong can still take effort. Check the Allow Items Anywhere option if placement rules interfere with the pleasure.

Try this first. Open one box in the first room and place an object. Test the click-based interaction and whether the objects are comfortably visible before organizing everything.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P081 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Unpacking

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Nobody Packed the Table Legs

Rae opened the summit's first relocation box and found three photographs of me, a champagne saber, and a velvet cushion labeled ESSENTIALS. The signing table was still leaning against the wall.

"Where are the legs?" she asked.

"Different department," I said. "This box contains leadership."

Shawna took the photographs out. Under them sat the little chipped bowl she always used for her earrings. I had packed it myself. She looked at me, then quietly put it on the windowsill.

Unpacking was on the screen, a life appearing through the belongings that kept coming along. Kit held up my saber and asked what recurring emotional truth required a sword at a seating meeting.

"Celebration, nigga."

Rae found the table legs inside my portrait crate. I had protected the picture with enough hardware to furnish a church. Shawna kept the bowl where she'd put it. My portraits went underneath the table, where they finally contributed to its stability.

Aiden's verdict. Rae accepts the room's arrangement provisionally. My portrait gets a supporting role beneath the table, while Shawna's chipped bowl secures the only windowsill nobody wants to fight over.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam supports belongings-as-story and no timers. Official developer accessibility page previously inspected supports mouse-only PC, no required holds/drag/simultaneous buttons and Allow Items Anywhere. Actual comfort remains individual.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1135690/>

Source 2: <https://www.unpackinggame.com/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P082 / A PLACE TO START

Townscaper

Edition considered: PC release

Make a small waterfront town simply because you like its shapes and colors, without managing residents or a budget.

What you do. Place or remove building pieces and watch the town's architecture change, experimenting with the arrangement of your own little place.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Check camera movement, pointer control and any sustained input; a simple building idea does not guarantee comfortable controls.

Why it might click. Townscaper is a construction toy in which clicks generate buildings and pleasing architectural connections. You can follow a small visual idea, such as a street over water or a cluster of towers, without first learning a production economy. Its interest is shape, color and the surprise of what the building system produces.

The full catch. The small tool set does not remove every physical task. Moving the view, zooming and placing a precise block may involve a different input pattern from selecting a menu. Preview those actions on the chosen device. This is a place-making activity with little authored character story, so the appeal must come from making rather than following a plot.

Try this first. Make a three-house waterfront, change one color and turn the view once. Keep building only if those ordinary actions feel satisfying.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P082 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Townscaper

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Mika Built a Hotel Nobody Could Enter

Mika watched Townscaper's buildings gather over water and began placing their tiny hotel models across our actual summit map. Within minutes the lesbian caucus occupied a charming waterfront district with no bridge.

"It looks spectacular," they said.

"It looks stranded," Rae said, balancing a cheese plate above the model harbor. "Where do the snacks cross?"

I offered a gondola. Velvet asked whether the gondolier's wages were inside the newly agreed budget. I offered a smaller gondola.

Kit moved one miniature tower and opened a direct path from the entrance to the lounge. Mika stared at the gap as if she had knocked out a beautiful tooth.

Then Nia put two tiny chairs beside the water and asked Rae whether this imaginary neighborhood had a late bar.

Rae moved her cheese plate closer. Mika gave the bar a roof terrace. The map acquired a passage, a date venue, and precisely one less monument to my judgment.

Aiden's verdict. Mika keeps the waterfront, Kit keeps the open path, and Rae keeps the cheese. I withdraw the gondola proposal after discovering a boat cannot be paid in atmosphere.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1291340/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P083 / A PLACE TO START

Dorfromantik

Edition considered: PC release; Creative mode is a separate assessment target

Arrange a pleasing countryside of villages, forests and waterways, using Creative mode when unrestricted landscape-making is the main attraction.

What you do. Choose Creative mode, place landscape tiles and experiment with how fields, woods, water and settlements fit together.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Creative mode is the intended scope; camera controls and exact placement actions still need checking on your device.

Why it might click. Dorfromantik assembles a landscape from hexagonal tiles. Fields, settlements, forests and waterways make the next placement visually meaningful. The attraction is a small repeated action that grows into a countryside you can inspect and enjoy. It can suit someone who likes arranging a world more than managing its inhabitants.

The full catch. Choose the mode deliberately. Standard play involves tile supply, objectives and scoring; Creative mode is a separate assessment target, not a label for every session. Rotation, camera movement, small connection details and interpreting the interface still need checking. The sources support the game's building premise, not a universal promise that every control is hold-free.

Try this first. Open Creative mode with setup help if needed. Place one village tile, one field and one stretch of water, then examine the connections without chasing a score.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P083 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Dorfromantik

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Forest Was Blocking the Buffet

I arranged the hexagonal summit badges into a magnificent landscape while Dorfromantik assembled its own countryside on the television. Forest beside forest. Water beside water. My face beside every major settlement.

Tank reached for a bread roll and discovered the scenic arrangement covered the entire serving table.

"Nigga, your country got a hunger problem."

I said the badges would make a beautiful overhead photograph. Rosa said the photograph could feed itself, then moved my capital onto a napkin.

Kit began a separate row for the rooms people actually wanted to visit. Rae connected the lounge to the food. Mika fitted a little model hotel into an empty place and looked delighted when nobody objected.

I tried to restore a ceremonial avenue between my portrait and the entrance. Shawna set two plates across it and sat down with me.

"There," she said. "A settlement."

For once the land dispute ended with somebody bringing me potatoes instead of an invoice.

Aiden's verdict. The countryside may expand around dinner, but dinner receives priority. Shawna establishes a two-person settlement across my ceremonial avenue and declines every proposed road through our plates.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1455840/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P084 / A PLACE TO START

Hidden Folks

Edition considered: PC release

Explore crowded illustrated scenes full of small jokes and hidden people, with the search itself supplying the main pleasure.

What you do. Inspect a detailed scene, follow the target hints, interact with objects and look for the people or things described.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Dense drawings, tiny targets, zooming and scene navigation may be demanding; test any required dragging.

Why it might click. Hidden Folks turns searching into a lively illustrated scene. The hand-drawn crowds and interactive details reward looking closely, while target clues give a concrete reason to investigate. A companion can help spot possibilities without taking over a character or handling an inventory. The pleasure is noticing, testing and finally recognizing the right little detail.

The full catch. A static-looking scene can still demand visual scanning. Small targets, dense drawings, zooming and panning may be the main obstacles. Check whether navigation requires an uncomfortable drag on the selected device. The absence of an avatar does not itself establish every accessibility property, and this card does not certify the complete game as hold-free.

Try this first. Choose one target from an early scene. Read its clue, enlarge the view if useful and search together for that one person before opening a longer list.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P084 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Hidden Folks

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Find the Librarian, Win Her Glasses

Kit announced that someone had stolen her glasses to sabotage her map presentation. Hidden Folks filled the screen behind her with tiny busy lives. Our room offered a competitive field.

"They were beside a woman in silver," she said.

Velvet turned slowly. "Baby, that narrows nothing in this building."

We searched the drinks cart, the model hotel, and June's enormous handbag. Dez said it had concealed the Blue Comet jukebox quarters in 1967. June said an investigation required evidence.

Rae found a photograph of the earlier lighting argument. Kit was pointing upward. Her glasses were sitting on her head.

"They aren't there now," Kit said.

They were on Remy's head. He had borrowed them for King Receipts' scholarly entrance and forgotten he was still wearing them. He returned them with a bow. Kit inspected him, adjusted the frames on his nose again, and told him he looked expensive.

That stopped the investigation dead. Nigga had accidentally auditioned for a date.

Aiden's verdict. Kit recovers her glasses but loans them back for one entrance. Remy wins no legal title to the frames, although his scholarly expression earns an unexpectedly favorable review.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/435400/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P085 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

A Short Hike

Edition considered: PC release

Take a small island outing where conversations, discoveries and the route itself can be more appealing than reaching the summit.

What you do. Walk around the island, meet characters and explore paths, trying climbing and gliding only after checking basic movement.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Climbing, gliding, jumping and held movement make this conditional, even though the overall outing can feel gentle.

Why it might click. A Short Hike offers a compact island, a climb toward a destination and small encounters along the way. Its warmth comes from the people you meet and the freedom to let one nearby curiosity become the next activity. It is a smaller, more legible exploration proposition than a vast map filled with competing objectives.

The full catch. The developer describes an unhurried journey, but the controls still ask for movement. Climbing and gliding use held input; gliding also requires steering. Those demands matter even when the mood is gentle. Side activities need their own check, and there is no native simultaneous local co-op in the assessed version.

Try this first. Walk along an early shoreline or marked trail and speak to one character. Introduce climbing and gliding only after ordinary movement has become comfortable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P085 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Short Hike

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Roof Delegation Came Back Hungry

The summit map marked the rooftop lounge as a short excursion. I promised everyone a glorious view and began walking as if the view owed me money.

Halfway there, Rosa stopped beside a little balcony. Somebody had put two chairs in the shade. Music drifted up from the courtyard. She sat.

"The summit's above us," I said.

"So is the sun. I'm not chasing that either."

A Short Hike waited on the nearby portable screen, its small journey offering reasons to get distracted. Tank brought Rosa a lemonade. Kit discovered a poster for tonight's karaoke and forgot the roof entirely.

Mika wanted the party to begin, but even they leaned over the rail when Mercedes started playing downstairs. Nia asked Rae to listen to one song with her.

I reached the rooftop alone. Gorgeous. Empty. Wind knocked my napkin into a drain.

I returned carrying the view's official contribution: a chair for Shawna.

Aiden's verdict. The rooftop remains an option, not the evening's destination. Rosa's balcony receives chairs, lemonade, and the first crowd I have ever failed to summon with a larger room.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer Steam description supports unhurried summit exploration; named hands-on review supports held climb/glide and steering. No blanket statement about every optional activity.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1055540/>

Source 2: <https://saveorquit.com/2021/01/16/review-a-short-hike/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P086 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Yonder: The Cloud Catcher Chronicles

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a colorful open world where helping communities, gathering materials and tending projects provide reasons to keep visiting new places.

What you do. Travel between settlements and natural areas, talk to residents, collect resources and take on the activities that interest you.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Crafting, gathering and navigation can add complexity; third-person movement and camera coordination still need a direct check.

Why it might click. Yonder provides an open island with several environments and a broad set of activities, including gathering, farming, crafting and helping residents. Its appeal is the possibility of choosing a direction and making a small life within a landscape. The central restoration premise gives exploration a purpose without making every interest identical.

The full catch. This is a conditional open-world candidate. Third-person navigation brings movement and camera control, while professions, inventory, trading and quests can accumulate into a substantial interface. The developer's own-pace language does not erase the changing day, seasons or the work of remembering goals. It is single-player, even when a friend helps.

Try this first. Have a helper find an uncomplicated nearby route. Walk to one visible destination and try one gathering action before enrolling in every available profession.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P086 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Yonder: The Cloud Catcher Chronicles

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Open World Had Sixteen Errands

Yonder's island looked generous enough to hold every idea I had for the summit. I pointed at our map and allocated a garden corner, a crafting table, a tasting bar, and a restorative fountain.

Mika asked who would staff them.

"The community."

Rae held up a bag of broken crackers. "The community already has a complaint."

I recruited Tank for the fountain. He filled a punch bowl. Kit volunteered for the garden and returned with one borrowed fern, which she placed beside her karaoke list.

The tiny activities kept multiplying until Shawna asked which one I wanted to do with her. I named six. She waited.

"Walk to the courtyard?"

"Good answer."

When we came back, the ambitious island had become three tables people actually used. Rae had upgraded the crackers. Mika was decorating the fern. Tank charged nobody for punch, although he called each refill a public service.

Aiden's verdict. The annex keeps three useful stations and one excessively praised fern. The community rejects my sixteen errands but permits me to carry punch while Shawna chooses our next stop.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/580200/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P087 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Eastshade

Edition considered: PC release

Explore an island through painting and conversations, letting attractive places and the people who live there guide your curiosity.

What you do. Walk through the island, meet residents, gather what you need and make paintings of views that interest you.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person movement, camera control, travel and resource tasks remain part of the experience; no-combat does not mean low-demand.

Why it might click. Eastshade makes a traveling painter the center of an island adventure. Meeting residents, discovering places and making paintings give curiosity a tangible role in the world. The atmosphere and local stories may appeal to someone seeking a grown-up journey that does not revolve around fighting.

The full catch. The no-combat design is not the same as simple physical input. First-person walking and looking typically use separate controls, and crafting, canvases and quests add interface work. The developer's design essay is older than release; the final storefront supports the painting and exploration premise, not a guarantee about every environmental rule or input.

Try this first. Try a short village walk and one conversation. Test turning the view while standing still before deciding whether to learn the painting and crafting systems.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P087 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Eastshade

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / A Portrait of the Emergency Exit

I commissioned an artistic record of the venue negotiations after watching Eastshade make a painter's journey out of people and places. Mercedes said she would paint whatever caught her attention.

Naturally I stood beside the window.

She turned her chair toward the corridor.

"Nigga, the light's over here."

"So is your elbow. Move it."

Her sketch showed Rae holding a door for Nia while Kit dragged the snack cart through sideways. Behind them, Velvet was rescuing her sleeve from a decorative branch. It looked like an entire republic learning how wide a doorway was.

I suggested a more commanding central figure. Mercedes added Tank, carrying the branch away.

Shawna liked it so much she asked for a print. That wounded me until she pointed at a small shape near the window. Mercedes had included my hand, still offering my wife a glass of water while I campaigned for immortal greatness.

Apparently I had done something useful by accident.

Aiden's verdict. Mercedes chooses the subject and keeps the commission. The picture records a door held open, a branch removed, and my unexpected qualification to serve water without a commemorative plaque.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam supports painter, relationships and exploration. Developer no-combat essay is pre-release (2015); it does not establish all final environmental or input rules.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/715560/>

Source 2: <https://eastshade.com/without-combat/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P088 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Alba: A Wildlife Adventure

Edition considered: PC release

Get to know a small island by noticing wildlife, taking photographs and helping with a community effort to protect it.

What you do. Walk around the island, look for animals, photograph discoveries and speak with residents involved in its conservation story.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Camera use, small targets, navigation and any scene-specific timing need checking before calling the whole journey comfortable.

Why it might click. Alba places wildlife discovery and care for an island at the center of a bright adventure. Looking for animals and recording what you find supplies a recognizable activity within a place that also has residents and a conservation story. It offers a possible bridge from noticing details to moving around a small world.

The full catch. The gentle premise should not be mistaken for a verified control profile. Check movement, camera adjustment, aiming the camera, target recognition and the way objectives accumulate. Any required timing or unusual interaction remains an open question until the exact version is inspected. The child protagonist does not by itself determine whether the subject will interest an adult.

Try this first. In an early accessible area, find one animal and try one photograph. Assess the ordinary move-look-photograph sequence before making a collecting plan.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P088 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Alba: A Wildlife Adventure

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Bird Had Reserved the Courtyard First

Our proposed outdoor lounge contained one very determined bird and the branch its nest occupied. Mika's lighting sketch put a brilliant decorative arch exactly there.

I said the bird could have the east garden.

Rosa looked at me. "You going to explain the new address?"

Alba was on the screen, turning observation and care for an island into an adventure. Tank lowered his voice as if the bird had already appointed counsel.

Rae inspected the available shade. Kit found a different place for the chairs. Mika grumbled, then noticed the alternate corner gave their hanging lights a better reflection in the glass.

Now the bird was a visionary collaborator.

I leaned toward Shawna and said I had always favored this arrangement. She handed me the old sketch with my signature beneath REMOVE BRANCH.

Velvet used the back of it to fan herself. The bird remained entirely unimpressed by our coalition, which made it the most credible observer present.

Aiden's verdict. The courtyard plan moves around its existing resident. Mika claims the improved reflection, Rosa claims the shade, and the bird declines my offer of honorary summit membership.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1337010/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P089 / A PLACE TO START

TOEM

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a quirky illustrated world through photography, meeting people whose requests give you reasons to look at the surroundings closely.

What you do. Move between places, talk with characters and use the camera to photograph details connected to their small requests.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Camera aiming, zooming and any required holds remain input checks; the photographic premise alone does not settle them.

Why it might click. TOEM uses photography to turn exploration into observation. Its illustrated world and small requests give a reason to look at a place carefully, then try a picture that connects what you saw with what someone needs. The changing camera view can make an ordinary corner feel like a little discovery.

The full catch. Movement and photography are distinct tasks, so check both rather than assuming a small-looking world has one-button play. Camera aiming, view changes, object size and remembering several requests may matter. The store's photographic-adventure premise does not establish that every task is untimed or that every input avoids holding.

Try this first. Take one request, locate its subject and make one photograph. Keep the current request visible or write a short reminder if that makes the next action clearer.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P089 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

TOEM

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Photograph Proved the Wrong Thing

TOEM put the room in a photographic mood. I asked everybody to take evidence of what our annex needed. Rae photographed the crooked table. Kit photographed the dark entrance. Velvet photographed the unpaid invoice.

"Nigga, we're researching space," I said.

"My space is expensive."

Nia took a picture of Rae balancing the table with her boot. Rae demanded a copy, then pretended she only wanted documentation of the defect.

My contribution was a panoramic image of the ballroom with me in the center. I called it proof that the place had room for everybody.

Mika enlarged the corner. My portrait stand blocked the route to the lounge. Behind it, Tank was turning sideways with a casserole while Dre supervised the clearance.

We moved the stand. I kept the photograph anyway. Shawna had appeared in the reflection, laughing at something off camera, and nobody's evidence was going to persuade me to crop her out.

Aiden's verdict. The photographs secure better lighting, a clear passage, and Velvet's invoice review. My panorama survives as a picture of Shawna, a purpose it handles better than measuring doors.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam app 1307580, TOEM: A Photo Adventure (2021). The automated TOEM 2 match was rejected. Source supports photography, conversations and puzzles, not universal no-timing or no-hold claims.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1307580/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P090 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Lil Gator Game

Edition considered: PC release

Turn a friendly island into a make-believe adventure, meeting characters and enjoying the playful possibilities of its ordinary spaces.

What you do. Explore the island, talk with characters and take part in activities involving movement, climbing and improvised adventure.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Jumping, climbing, gliding and camera coordination are meaningful demands; the friendly tone does not remove them.

Why it might click. Lil Gator Game builds an island adventure around play, make-believe and meeting people who can become part of it. Exploration and small activities offer a lighthearted sense of progress. The emotional question of sharing an enthusiasm may resonate even when the visual style is deliberately playful.

The full catch. This remains a movement-based adventure. Check camera control, climbing, gliding, jumping and the frequency of held or combined inputs in the chosen version. A playful tone does not make those demands disappear. Someone who wants a darker mystery or dense adult dialogue may simply prefer another shelf, which is a matter of taste.

Try this first. Explore one nearby patch of the opening area and talk to a character. Try the basic movement and camera separately before committing to traversal challenges.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P090 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Lil Gator Game

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Cardboard Kingdom Asked for a Quiet Room

Remy made a cardboard crown for the room-allocation contest. Then he made one for Velvet, who objected to the fit, improved it with a silver napkin, and immediately claimed the lounge.

Lil Gator Game's make-believe adventure gave my competitive instincts terrible encouragement. I declared the corridor an unexplored kingdom and challenged Kit to seize it.

She walked past me carrying her tea.

"You surrender?"

"I'm going somewhere I can hear myself."

That left me king of a corridor with no subjects. Rae joined Kit. Nia followed with two cushions. Their quiet-room proposal suddenly had more members than my conquest.

Remy folded his cardboard sword into a sign pointing toward them. Velvet donated the silver napkin as a flag, then returned to demand actual stage time.

I brought the remaining crowns to the quiet room. Shawna chose one, put it on me crooked, and asked whether a king could sit still for five minutes.

I began a historically peaceful reign.

Aiden's verdict. The cardboard kingdom retains its costumes but acquires a quiet room. My reign is limited to one chair, five minutes, and whatever Shawna considers acceptable royal fidgeting.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1586800/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

The Same Door Did Not Look the Same from Every Chair

June offered to guide the room survey because she had driven a bus through worse arrangements than my hotel corridor. Dez said one of those arrangements had included a flowerpot that never recovered.

"The flowerpot was in the road."

"It was beside the road."

"It came to a very final understanding of beside."

I asked whether the Blue Comet peace agreement covered this incident. Both women told me it happened later. Even an imaginary war possessed boundaries I was capable of misunderstanding. We started at the entrance. Kit carried the map. Rae carried the good crackers. Nia volunteered to carry the napkins, then forgot them on the table because Rae had taken off her jacket and apparently created an administrative distraction.

The first disagreement concerned a chair.

Kit wanted the quiet-room chair near the window. Rae wanted it turned slightly so the door remained visible. Mika tried the angle. Kit moved it back.

"The light's better here."

"I can see the light from the other angle," Rae said.

"You could stop watching the door for one evening."

The room went still in a way none of my rented acoustic panels had achieved.

Kit's hand stayed on the chair. She was white, butch, soft-spoken until a matter of lighting or music made softness inconvenient. Rae was a Black stud who repaired bicycles, liked a good mystery, and had spent the afternoon making our furniture behave. At that moment, neither needed me to turn her into a delegation summary.

Rae set down the crackers.

"Was that a suggestion or something you decided I ought to learn?"

Kit looked at the chair, then at her. "A suggestion. Badly put."

"Nigga, you said it like I was doing the evening wrong."

I stepped forward with the authority of a man who had bought the room. Nia held out the forgotten napkins.

"Could you get these?"

I got them. My contribution improved immediately.

Kit said she watched doors too. She had stories about being mistaken for someone else, challenged in bathrooms, and studied by men who thought a haircut gave them permission to ask questions. She started telling one, then stopped herself before Rae had to stop her.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

"That doesn't mean I know what you were doing."

"I was choosing a chair."

"Right."

"And yes, I wanted the door where I could see it. You don't get my whole life for the price of moving a lamp."

Kit moved the lamp.

Rae watched the new light reach the page. "You do make a room look good. I noticed. I just want a say in where I am inside it."

Kit nodded. "Your table repair made my whole drawing possible. I could have remembered that before treating you like part of the furniture."

June remained in the doorway with one hand on Dez's bag. "I like seeing the door too. Sometimes it's because I'm old and waiting for the tea. Sometimes it isn't. Folks can ask before they finish the story."

She was a Black butch, a fact that made my earlier idea of assigning white butches one territory and Black studs another look even stupider in retrospect. June had been herself before Kit was born, and no neat diagram was going to reorganize her for my convenience.

"I wasn't trying to make it racial," Kit said, then winced at her own sentence.

Rae leaned against the table. "You don't have to be trying for it to be in the room."

The distinction sat there. Nobody applauded. Velvet looked at her watch, then put it away. She had a rehearsal to reach, but she also knew when a room had to finish the conversation it had started.

Nia took the crackers from Rae's hand and ate one.

"I have a selfish question. If we put the chair at your angle, where do I sit?"

Rae pointed beside it.

"Oh. Excellent."

Kit laughed once, relieved, then did not mistake the laugh for permission to skip the awkward part.

"Would you tell me if I'm doing that again?"

"I might. I might also go get a drink. I'm not promising to supervise you."

"Fair."

They tested the chair at the new angle. The lamp still worked.

That ought to have been enough for me to carry away. Instead, I offered to make the entire hotel corridor private so nobody would have to deal with strangers.

Mika looked at the cost sheet as if it had just threatened their family.

Rae looked at me. "I didn't ask you to buy the street."

"Not the street. Just a very affordable section of indoors."

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Shawna folded her arms. "You think every problem ends where your reservation begins."

I wanted to disagree. My card was already halfway out of my pocket, which weakened the defense. June said driving a bus had taught her to notice who felt entitled to explain the route to her while she was driving it. She also said some of her best passengers had been the ones who brought gossip and left her to do her job. She refused to turn decades of people into one moral photograph for my summit.

"Some folks were trouble. Some were funny. One man brought me a peach every Tuesday and never once tried to own the conversation."

Dez snorted. "You flirted with that man."

"He brought excellent peaches."

"Did you want him?"

"I wanted the peaches. You kept eating them."

Rae laughed, and the room could breathe again without pretending the earlier exchange had disappeared.

Kit said she disliked being read as an imitation of a man. Rae said that happened to her too, but they did not always get the same imitation assigned to them. She remembered one stranger calling her threatening while treating her white companion's matching boots as stylish.

"This one stranger," she said when I reached for my notes. "Don't turn me into your survey."

I closed the notebook.

Nia asked whether Rae wanted her nearby when a moment like that happened, or whether stepping in made the scene bigger. Rae considered it instead of supplying the perfect romantic answer.

"Ask me. Sometimes stand beside me. Sometimes let me finish. And don't start a courtroom because somebody looked at us."

Nia nodded. "I can resist one courtroom."

"Try two."

Their joking had a little edge. Nia's professional competence was not a key to every locked part of Rae's evening. Rae's alertness was not a command that Nia spend the night monitoring her. They were finding a way to want each other's company without converting care into a permanent assignment.

Kit sat on the other chair and admitted she had liked being the practical one in our room argument. She had mistaken being useful for being right about everybody else's comfort.

"Nigga, welcome to my entire personality," I said.

Shawna patted my shoulder. "You're visiting practicality. Don't buy property yet."

Mika asked what should change on the actual map. It was a good question because it gave the conversation somewhere to land besides my growing collection of important phrases.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

We kept two chair positions available. Nobody had to explain choosing either. The quiet room stayed optional. The information sign named a person to ask for help without promising that a rented convention floor could guarantee every encounter beyond it.

Velvet wanted the route to her dressing room clear so she could enter without inviting an audience to inspect her while she was half ready. Remy wanted the same courtesy with his stage clothes. June wanted tea in a cup she could hold comfortably. Dez wanted a cushion that did not slide every time she turned to argue.

These were requests from particular people. They did not cancel the difficult conversation. They made it possible to do something with it.

Tank asked Rae whether she wanted company when she returned to the reception desk to check the room key. He managed to ask it without already standing in front of her.

"Maybe later," she said. "I want to finish this tea."

He sat down. The bread stayed within her reach. For a man who could block a doorway by existing in it, he had a surprisingly good understanding of when not to become a wall.

Kit picked up the map again, then paused at the door.

"Rae, do you want to finish this route now?"

"In a minute."

Kit waited. Nia stayed beside the angled chair. I took Shawna's hand and resisted my final temptation to announce that the room had reached a historic understanding.

Tank arrived with tea before I could relapse.

June accepted her cup. Dez took the other chair, still claiming the flowerpot had been perfectly innocent. Outside the window, strangers crossed the courtyard without knowing our stories, our titles, or what the chairs had cost. We could not write their thoughts into the venue annex.

We could stop pretending everybody inside the room had entered it by the same route.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P091 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Smushi Come Home

Edition considered: PC release

Help a tiny mushroom find a way home through a forest whose scale makes ordinary places feel like an adventure.

What you do. Explore the forest, meet characters and try traversal activities while following the mushroom's journey toward a familiar home.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Movement holds, jumps and camera control need checking, especially before relying on its small scale as evidence of simplicity.

Why it might click. Smushi Come Home follows a tiny mushroom trying to return home through a forest. New tools, helpful creatures and light puzzles give the trip a clear purpose. The small scale can make familiar natural objects feel surprising, and the mycology journal supplies another kind of curiosity beyond simply reaching the next place.

The full catch. The primary description explicitly includes running, gliding, climbing, swimming and light platforming. Those are real control demands despite the cozy presentation. Assess held movement, steering and transitions between abilities. An own-pace exploration claim does not demonstrate that every jump or required action will be comfortable.

Try this first. Try a small stretch of walking and one conversation. Then inspect the earliest necessary traversal action before deciding whether the homeward journey feels inviting.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P091 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Smushi Come Home

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Smallest Delegate Had the Largest Sign

Mika placed a tiny model guest beside the venue map to demonstrate scale. Smushi Come Home was on the screen, a mushroom making a forest feel enormous. The model guest vanished beneath my ceremonial nameplate.

"That's a realistic representation," Rae said. "Nobody can see around your ass."

I shortened the nameplate by removing FOUNDER OF EXCELLENCE. It still covered the lounge.

Kit took the little figure on a tour between our model furniture. Three corners trapped it. One proposed doorway led directly into a decorative hedge. The hedge had cost me more than my first car.

Velvet picked it up and wore it briefly as a collar.

"Now it has a career."

Mika drew a clearer route. Remy carried the tiny guest to the model stage and made it bow. Nia asked whether this miniature person could reach the signing table.

Rae lowered the model pedestal. For the first time, the smallest delegate could see the room without climbing my reputation.

Aiden's verdict. The miniature guest survives the inspection and reaches the table. Velvet acquires a hedge collar, while FOUNDER OF EXCELLENCE becomes spare lettering for a considerably smaller sign.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1740300/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P092 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Haven Park

Edition considered: PC release

Make a small park more welcoming by exploring it, meeting visitors and improving the places where they can stay.

What you do. Walk around the park, talk with visitors, gather materials and make small improvements to its camping areas.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Building and gathering add tasks to remember, while movement and camera control still require a practical trial.

Why it might click. Haven Park combines a small explorable park with campsite improvements and conversations. Taking care of a place gives wandering a practical rhythm: find something, learn what a visitor needs and make the park more welcoming. Its family connection and local stories provide a modest narrative thread around that activity.

The full catch. The developer presents a peaceful open world, but building and gathering still introduce resources, quests and navigation. Check camera behavior, interaction distance, held movement and how many unfinished tasks the interface expects you to track. The advertised mood should not stand in for an edition-specific input assessment.

Try this first. Explore one nearby campsite and identify a single useful improvement. Complete that little loop before accepting a broad program of park redevelopment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P092 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Haven Park

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Campground Had Better Hospitality Than My Summit

Haven Park turned improving a campsite into a persuasive argument against my lounge. Mine had six velvet ropes, four ornamental lamps, and nowhere to put a cup.

Tank solved the cup problem by holding everybody's drinks until Rosa caught him trying to scratch his nose.

"Nigga, you're becoming furniture."

Rae wanted a solid table. Kit wanted a lamp that illuminated something besides its own price. Nia wanted the chair beside Rae, but called it a review of seating continuity.

Mika arranged a small corner with everything requested. People moved into it before I finished explaining the superior atmosphere near the ropes.

Velvet sat in my grandest chair, put her feet on its matching ottoman, and announced she would use the abandoned luxury suite as a dressing area.

I said the suite was technically a corner.

"Then you finally priced a corner correctly."

Shawna brought me to the useful little campsite. Tank could scratch his nose again.

Aiden's verdict. The improved corner receives a table, sensible light, and voluntary company. Velvet claims the deserted luxury furniture for costume changes, a use that finally justifies its dramatic upholstery.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1549550/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P093 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Mail Time

Edition considered: PC release

Make little deliveries through a storybook forest, with meeting people along the route providing much of the charm and interest.

What you do. Travel through the forest, speak with characters and carry letters or requests between the people you encounter there.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Platforming, jumping, gliding and remembering destinations can complicate the otherwise gentle delivery premise.

Why it might click. Mail Time turns deliveries into a forest adventure with distinct characters and places. Letters provide a clear reason to visit someone, while the world makes the route part of the attraction. It is a potential option for enjoying small social encounters without needing a dense mystery or a complicated economic simulation.

The full catch. The developer explicitly states no time limits or fall damage, which supports the pace side of this candidate. It also explicitly includes running, jumping and gliding. These physical demands must be assessed separately. Check camera movement, held glide input and remembering delivery destinations; do not assume the listed accessibility options solve every concern.

Try this first. Follow one early delivery from address to recipient. Test the first necessary jump or glide at a comfortable moment before planning a full mail route.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P093 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Mail Time

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Letter Took the Scenic Route

Nia wrote Rae a note and asked me to deliver it while Mail Time sent its small courier through a forest full of encounters.

I was an excellent choice. Charming, recognizable, impossible to ignore.

I carried the envelope to Kit, who directed me past the model hotel. Mika stopped me to relocate a doorway. Velvet wanted to know why her dressing room had become a public shortcut. Tank needed help lifting a tray.

By the time I found Rae, she and Nia were sharing a lemonade.

"Nigga, the author got here first." "The courier investigated the route."

Nia read the envelope and frowned. I had brought the wrong one. This contained her beautifully reasoned objection to the hotel surcharge, written so badly Rae thought it was a romantic threat against a coat rack.

Rae tucked it into her jacket anyway.

"First thing you ever gave me in writing."

Nia laughed, reached for another envelope, and handled her own distribution.

Aiden's verdict. The courier is relieved of romantic correspondence but retained for lifting trays. Rae keeps the surcharge objection, whose terrible handwriting has accidentally made it more personal than intended.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1607240/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P094 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Lake

Edition considered: PC base game

Follow a familiar delivery route through a lakeside community, getting to know people through workday conversations and personal choices.

What you do. Drive the mail truck, make deliveries and talk with residents, deciding how you want to spend time with them.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Driving and walking controls are central; camera coordination, menus and particular sequences still need checking.

Why it might click. Lake follows Meredith during a return to her hometown and a temporary job delivering mail. Adult relationships, ordinary decisions and the question of what kind of life to choose are the main attractions. The setting offers a slower social story rather than a grand fantasy quest.

The full catch. Driving and walking are real activities, not just scenery between dialogue screens. The developer mentions an autopilot option for the mail truck, which is worth checking, but it does not establish that all navigation becomes automatic. Verify camera control, interaction and the extent of that feature in the exact release before relying on it.

Try this first. Try one nearby delivery and conversation. Examine the driving assistance option, then decide whether the route itself adds pleasure or merely gets between the conversations.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P094 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Lake

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Meredith Got Mail, I Got Room Service

Lake's temporary return to hometown routines made Shawna ask what I would do if I had one ordinary day without arranging a spectacle.

"Spend it with you." "Doing what?"

I opened my mouth and almost rented a yacht.

She caught it. "Try smaller."

We took a cart of summit room notices along the corridor. She knocked; I handed over envelopes. Kit invited us in to hear two competing entrance songs. Velvet sent us away with a costume hook to return. Remy asked whether we could leave his flowers outside Nia's room for safekeeping. They were for his own date later.

The small deliveries kept becoming conversations. Nobody needed me to proclaim anything. I disliked how good it felt.

At the last door, Shawna ordered sandwiches and changed our room notice from HOST AVAILABLE to BACK LATER.

"Nigga," I said, "that's a major constitutional amendment."

She kissed me and shut the door on my speech.

Aiden's verdict. The host takes an ordinary break with his wife. Delivery notices remain legible, flowers reach safekeeping, and the coalition survives two sandwiches without appointing an acting supreme commander.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1118240/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P095 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

SEASON: A letter to the future

Edition considered: PC release

Record a world through photographs, sounds and conversations, building a personal account of places and people before they change.

What you do. Travel through the world, stop to meet people and collect impressions in a journal using photographs and recordings.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Cycling, walking, camera use, menus and journal organization can all add effort despite the reflective subject.

Why it might click. SEASON centers a bicycle journey, a customizable journal and the effort to preserve memories of a changing world. Photography, recordings and conversations make observation the substance of the story. It offers a more reflective reason to explore: choosing what deserves attention and how to remember it.

The full catch. A reflective premise does not establish an easy physical route. Cycling, walking, camera use and arranging journal material are different interactions to check. The story's impending change may also feel emotionally urgent even without a verified real-time deadline. Record the exact controls and pause behavior rather than inferring them from the mood.

Try this first. In the first available quiet area, collect one image or sound and place it in the journal. Decide whether the recording and arranging process itself is enjoyable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P095 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

SEASON: A letter to the future

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Future Requested Fewer Selfies

I announced a summit time capsule after seeing SEASON turn travel, recordings, and a journal into a way of remembering a changing world. My first proposed contents were photographs of me opening things.

Rosa suggested something somebody might miss.

Kit recorded the entrance music she and Remy were still arguing over. June recorded her account of the Blue Comet jukebox. Dez immediately requested an opposing track. Nia wrote down a joke Rae had made, then crossed out a sentence nobody else got to read.

Mika photographed their tiny hotel before the rooms changed again.

Darnell offered a recording of his yacht pitch. Mercedes pressed stop before he reached the second deck.

"Nigga, the future's suffered enough."

Shawna took my camera and filmed everybody passing dishes around the table. I appeared for three seconds, looking for her.

"That's all I get?" "That's what you were doing."

I kept that clip twice, once in the capsule and once where I could find it without a committee.

Aiden's verdict. The future receives a repaired cart, imperfect music, and a table full of people. Darnell's yacht presentation is excluded for length; my three seconds receive a private backup.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/695330/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P096 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Sable

Edition considered: PC release

Explore striking desert ruins and meet nomads while considering which path to take and what kind of life might fit the traveler.

What you do. Walk or ride through the landscape, meet people and investigate places, trying climbing separately from ordinary travel.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Navigation, held movement, climbing and gliding need testing; route-finding, puzzles and the distinctive visual style can still demand attention.

Why it might click. Sable offers a rite of passage across a striking desert landscape. Exploring ruins, meeting nomads and collecting possibilities for an identity give its open world a personal theme. Its appeal lies in choosing a path and considering where the traveler belongs, rather than following a crowded list of victories.

The full catch. The developer's description includes a hoverbike, climbing, jumping and gliding. Navigation and held movement therefore deserve a practical trial. The distinctive art may be beautiful without automatically making landmarks or depth easy to read. Menus, route-finding and puzzle difficulty should be checked before presenting it as a simple wandering game.

Try this first. Explore one nearby stretch on foot, then test the first vehicle or climbing interaction separately. Follow one visible curiosity instead of committing to a complete map.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P096 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Sable

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Mask Did Not Come with a Ministry

Sable's journey through possibilities for an identity inspired me to offer summit masks for different ceremonial duties. I had a gold one labeled SUPREME HOST and a smaller one labeled HOST EMERITUS.

Both were mine.

Velvet tried the gold mask, looked in the mirror, and said it needed better cheekbones. Kit selected no mask at all. Remy wanted one for King Receipts but refused to wear it while fixing his microphone.

"I got jobs outside the costume."

Rae examined the room list. She belonged in the lesbian caucus, wanted to visit the mechanics display, and planned to hear Mercedes play. My neat single-column assignments could not hold her evening.

Mika erased the columns and wrote room names instead.

Nia chose a little blue mask for no administrative reason whatsoever. Rae told her it looked good. The gold mask ended up on my model portrait, whose facial expression finally matched its lack of responsibility.

Aiden's verdict. The summit stops assigning whole evenings by label. Room names replace rigid columns, Remy separates performance from repair work, and my miniature portrait inherits the least useful mask.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/757310/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P097 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

ABZU

Edition considered: PC release

Move through an underwater world for the pleasure of its creatures, spaces, music and the feeling of being among them.

What you do. Swim through three-dimensional environments, steer around sea life and explore the spaces and discoveries along the route.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Swimming and camera coordination need checking, along with any scene-specific demands; beautiful motion can still require complex input.

Why it might click. ABZU makes underwater movement and marine life the center of a largely visual journey. Swimming among schools of creatures and discovering changing seascapes can be absorbing without a dialogue-heavy plot. Its attraction is the feeling of entering a place that moves around you.

The full catch. Swimming in three dimensions can require substantial steering and camera coordination. The official description also warns of dangers in the depths, so a peaceful visual style is not proof of uniformly pressure-free play. Check whether turning, ascending, descending and stopping are comfortable before committing to the wider journey.

Try this first. Use the first suitable open-water area to practice a short forward swim and a gentle turn. Let a companion observe the controls rather than immediately taking over.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P097 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

ABZU

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Aquarium Claimed Neutral Waters

The hotel aquarium divided the proposed lounge from the performance corridor. ABZU filled the screen with marine life, and Mika suggested we make the tank the summit's scenic center.

I immediately named it the Aiden Sea.

Tank pointed to the maintenance label. "Nigga, it's Howard's."

Howard, the aquarist, explained that chairs could stand back from the glass but the equipment door had to remain clear. Velvet wanted a blue reflection across her entrance. Kit wanted enough light to read the song list. Their competing requests briefly turned Howard into the most courted man in the building.

He adjusted one lamp and went to feed the fish.

The blue stayed. The list became readable. Nobody had needed to annex the tank.

Nia and Rae sat beside the glass. A fish followed Rae's ring as she moved her hand. I tried the same thing with my watch.

The fish left.

Howard said they had already eaten. Shawna said even the fish knew a sales pitch.

Aiden's verdict. Howard retains control of the aquarium and its equipment door. The coalition receives two chairs and sensible lighting; the Aiden Sea remains an unsupported claim on hotel property.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/384190/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P098 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Journey

Edition considered: PC release

Travel through a landscape whose mood comes from movement, music, ruins and the possibility of meeting an unfamiliar companion.

What you do. Move through the world, explore its spaces and experience the journey's changing terrain and possible encounters with another traveler.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Gliding, movement and camera control remain necessary checks; companionship is not a promise of conventional controllable co-op.

Why it might click. Journey builds meaning through landscape, movement, music and the possibility of encountering another traveler. Its sparse presentation leaves room for the player to interpret the trip. This may appeal when the desired story is a feeling of passage or companionship rather than detailed dialogue and inventory puzzles.

The full catch. The experience still involves steering, gliding and moving through a three-dimensional environment. The possibility of another traveler is online companionship, not a promise of local couch co-op or a reliably present helper. Check camera comfort and later pressure before treating its quiet opening as representative of every scene.

Try this first. Cross one early area and notice whether movement and the visual direction feel natural. Decide whether the atmosphere is engaging before worrying about reaching the destination.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P098 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Journey

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Two People Can Walk Without a Parade

Journey's distant traveler made me propose a ceremonial escort for anyone crossing the summit floor. I imagined music, banners, and a little bell announcing each departure.

Shawna took my hand.

"Come with me."

I signaled for the bell. She took it away from Tank and left it on the table.

We crossed the corridor without it. At the far end, Remy waited beside a chair with his flowers. He asked which room held the water jug. I pointed. He smiled and continued alone.

"Nigga, where's his escort?"

"Maybe he knows where he's going."

On our way back, Rae fell into step beside Nia. Neither called a meeting. June waved from the balcony. Dez sat beside her, holding the old jacket over both their knees.

I reached for Shawna's hand again. She let me keep it. For twelve magnificent yards I had company without a procession, a witness, or any reasonable opportunity to invoice the experience.

Aiden's verdict. The route remains open to company without compulsory escorts. Tank may ring the bell for dinner, provided he does not announce every person who gets up for water.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/638230/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P099 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

The Pathless

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a striking landscape with an archer and an eagle, if fluid movement and action are part of the desired attraction.

What you do. Travel across the world using the game's movement and archery systems, following a journey built around speed and motion.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Aiming, timing and traversal make this an action detour, rather than a dependable choice for avoiding reflex demands.

Why it might click. The Pathless combines a hunter, an eagle companion and a large mythic landscape. Movement and archery are part of its identity, alongside exploration of ruins and the story of a curse. It belongs here as a visually appealing action detour for someone specifically curious about that kind of movement.

The full catch. The primary description explicitly includes high-speed archery, acrobatics and boss battles. This is not an ordinary no-rush recommendation. The developer's forgiving treatment of permanent damage or death does not remove required reactions. Camera, aiming and combined inputs are central checks, and a strict no-reaction preference should send the reader elsewhere.

Try this first. Watch a short official gameplay sequence together, then test basic traversal only if that motion looks appealing. There is no obligation to turn admiration into play.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P099 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Pathless

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Eagle Refused My Seating Chart

The Pathless put a hunter and eagle into a mythic landscape. I decided our annex needed a ceremonial bird to lead visitors from the entrance to the stage.

Rosa asked whether I had considered a sign.

"Signs lack majesty." "They also don't shit on the carpet."

The hotel offered a feathered mechanical centerpiece instead. Mika loved it until the quotation arrived. Velvet read the number and said that bird had better sing harmony.

Remy spread its decorative wings to see whether it would fit near the doors. One wing covered the exit arrow; the other knocked my portrait crooked.

Rae folded it shut. "There. Resting."

We watched the actual game for a while, enjoying its grand scale from a safe distance. Then Kit lettered a handsome sign with a bird in the corner.

I carried it to the entrance myself. Shawna said I had finally become the eagle's useful companion.

Nigga, the bird had delegated its entire job.

Aiden's verdict. The mechanical eagle stays folded and the sign does the work. Majesty receives a small illustrated corner; the doorway keeps the clearance that my feathered appointment nearly consumed.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1492680/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P100 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Feather

Edition considered: PC release

Fly through an island environment for the feeling of movement itself, without needing a conventional chain of quests to motivate you.

What you do. Steer a bird through the landscape, explore the airspace and enjoy the changing views and ambient surroundings.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Continuous steering and camera-related motion may be uncomfortable; open-ended flight does not establish hold-free or effortless play.

Why it might click. Feather offers bird flight around an island, with music and changing scenery as the reward. The developer explicitly describes a world without enemies, combat or threats and supports flying alone or with online players. Its appeal is movement for its own sake, rather than collecting equipment or following a character drama.

The full catch. The absence of threats does not make flight effortless. Continuous steering, orientation, camera motion and any held controls need a practical check. Online multiplayer is different from native local co-op. Someone who wants a substantial mystery or a clear sequence of tasks may find the open-ended flight less satisfying than the premise suggests.

Try this first. Try one broad circle above an open area. Check turning and camera comfort before exploring narrow passages or inviting another online flyer.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, we're good.

P100 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Feather

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Dre Flew Past My Welcome Speech

Feather's island flight made the room unusually quiet. Dre watched the bird move through the changing scenery with his blue controller resting beside him. He said the view looked better without my welcome banner.

I said banners gave a place identity.

"Nigga, sometimes the place already got one."

Mika opened the courtyard curtains. Afternoon light spread over the model hotels, and suddenly everybody stopped asking whether we needed another illuminated backdrop.

Velvet tilted her chair into the light. Kit took off her glasses. Rae discovered that Nia had fallen asleep for a minute against the cushion beside her, then lowered her own voice without being asked.

I started to tell Shawna about the very expensive sky projection I had ordered.

She touched my knee.

We sat. Outside, an actual bird landed on the rail and surveyed the gathering. Nobody assigned it a role. It stayed longer than most of my paid consultants.

Aiden's verdict. The courtyard curtains remain open, and the sky projection goes on hold. Dre keeps the blue controller beside him while the actual afternoon performs without a summit appearance fee.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam app 545040, Feather; rejected Feather Land match. Developer explicitly describes no enemies/combat/threats and online multiplayer. Flight comfort remains untested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/545040/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Velvet Declared the Dressing Room Sovereign

The middle of the room survey became a border dispute when I suggested visitors could pass through Velvet's dressing area on their way to the balcony.

She looked at me through the mirror. One earring was on. One lay beside the brush. Her expression did not need the second earring to become complete.

"Nigga, do you want your audience walking through your pants?"

I said the route would save eight steps.

"It'll cost you a show."

Mika examined the alternative path. It was perfectly usable. It passed a window, a water jug, and a chair Kit had already claimed for the interval before karaoke. The only genuine obstacle was my desire for the map to look symmetrical.

Rae erased the shortcut. Nia wrote PRIVATE beside the dressing room, badly enough that Remy asked whether it said PIRATE. Velvet considered the latter for a second, then requested both accurate spelling and a working door latch.

June remembered a dressing corner at the Blue Comet made private by a coat hung across two chairs. Dez said she had been wearing the coat. June said that was precisely why everybody remembered it.

Nobody attempted to solve the old ownership claim. Kit checked the current latch. It worked. Mika placed the water jug outside the alternate route so people could stop without crowding the doorway.

I apologized to Velvet. She accepted the apology and asked me to carry the spare chair. I performed this task with the gravity of a man repairing an international incident through furniture.

When I returned, Remy was testing the stage approach. He knocked before entering the dressing space to ask about the shared mirror. Velvet invited him in. They made their own arrangement in thirty seconds.

Shawna watched me calculate how many diagrams I had produced to avoid that simple conversation.

"Don't say it," I told her.

"I wasn't going to."

That was worse. She smiled, took the map from my hand, and wrote OUR BREAK beside the courtyard. No border, no flag, just two words that gave me a destination worth defending.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P101 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

AER Memories of Old

Edition considered: PC release

Explore floating islands and old ruins through a journey that changes between walking and bird flight, with mystery in its setting.

What you do. Travel on foot and in bird form, visit islands and investigate ruins or temples along the wider journey.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Switching movement modes, flying and camera coordination need checking; atmospheric exploration is not automatically a simple control task.

Why it might click. AER combines bird transformation, floating islands and the investigation of an old, broken world. Flying between places and entering temples gives its mystery a distinctive rhythm. The visual simplicity may make the landscape inviting, while the pilgrimage provides more direction than an entirely open-ended flight toy.

The full catch. Changing between flight and on-foot exploration means learning more than one movement pattern. Check steering, landing, camera behavior and the controls used inside temples. Puzzles and route-finding add another layer. The official atmospheric description does not establish an absence of all timing demands or a hold-free route through the complete game.

Try this first. Try one short flight and a controlled landing, then explore a small nearby space. Decide whether the transformation feels pleasurable before following the wider pilgrimage.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P101 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

AER Memories of Old

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Floating Annex Was a Tablecloth

AER's floating islands gave Mika an idea. They suspended the model rooms above the summit map on clear stands, leaving the routes between them wonderfully visible.

I called it an aerial master plan.

Tank called it something he could spill punch through.

Kit carried her miniature lounge from one island to another, testing where the music would reach. Remy placed a tiny stage beside it. Velvet moved that stage somewhere with room for her train.

The islands looked separate until Rae stretched a blue ribbon between the entrance and the signing room. Then she added a second route to the quiet space.

I lifted the tablecloth to improve the background for a photograph. Every island wobbled. Nia caught the stage; Shawna caught my wrist.

"Nigga, leave the world attached to something."

Mika lowered the models back onto the table. The blue routes stayed. My aerial master plan became a normal map with excellent explanations, an indignity it survived beautifully.

Aiden's verdict. The annex returns to ground level with its connecting routes intact. Mika keeps the clear stands for decorations, and I lose permission to improve a tablecloth during active geography.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/331870/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P102 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Proteus

Edition considered: PC release

Wander through a changing island whose sounds, colors and atmosphere provide the experience, without a conventional story directing every step.

What you do. Walk around the island, look at its surroundings and listen to how the place responds and changes.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The lack of a conventional objective may not appeal, and walking plus camera movement still need checking.

Why it might click. Proteus is an exploratory island experience in which the surroundings respond musically to where you go. It has little conventional instruction, text or plot. The pleasure comes from observation and the changing relationship between sound, color and place, rather than solving a case or completing a set of chores.

The full catch. Its minimal goals can be either freeing or frustrating. First-person movement and camera control remain necessary even when there are few menus. The lack of hints is a documented design choice, so someone who wants a clear next action should treat that as a meaningful catch. There is no basis here for promising that an unstructured world will feel easy.

Try this first. Walk toward one visible landmark and listen to what changes. If the absence of a stated objective feels empty rather than inviting, choose a more directed game.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P102 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Proteus

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Corridor Had a Soundtrack and a Leak

Proteus made a landscape into something you could hear changing around you. Mercedes liked the idea of giving the summit rooms distinct musical entrances.

Kit wanted brass. Velvet wanted bass. Remy requested a fanfare containing one terrible pun and a cymbal.

I demanded a theme for the host.

Mercedes played three notes on her keyboard. Somewhere above us, a pipe answered with a drip. Tank looked up and moved the snack tray.

"Your theme got plumbing, nigga."

We followed the sound to the side corridor. The hotel staff closed that patch while they checked it, and Mika redrew the walking route around a different doorway.

Mercedes tried the music again from each room. The quieter entrance needed less, not more. Kit surprised everybody by choosing the soft version.

My theme remained three notes. Shawna hummed them while we moved the chairs. By then I liked it too much to complain about its modest orchestration.

Aiden's verdict. The rooms get distinct music at sensible levels, and the damp corridor stays closed for inspection. My three-note theme acquires an audience without acquiring the orchestra I requested.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/219680/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P103 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Dear Esther: Landmark Edition

Edition considered: PC Landmark Edition

Follow a voice through an atmospheric island, if fragments, uncertainty and the feeling of a place are more appealing than clear tasks.

What you do. Walk through the island while listening to narration and taking in the surroundings as the account gradually develops.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person walking and camera use remain, and the fragmentary narrative may not satisfy a wish for clear resolution.

Why it might click. Dear Esther: Landmark Edition presents a remote island through walking, spoken fragments and music. Its story turns around loss, memory and interpretation. This is a route for someone interested in literary atmosphere and adult emotional material, with relatively little conventional inventory or puzzle activity described by the developer.

The full catch. The physical task is still first-person navigation. Check turning, walking holds, audio clarity, subtitles and how narration behaves when you stop or revisit a place. The fragmented telling may demand attention even without complex controls. Its bleak tone is central, and the Landmark Edition should not inherit unverified technical details from another release.

Try this first. Walk to the first narration trigger and listen to one passage. Consider both the movement and the form of storytelling before treating the island as a longer commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P103 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Dear Esther: Landmark Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Nobody Needed Me to Interpret the Island

Dear Esther's island and spoken fragments made the lounge fall quiet. I waited a respectful interval of approximately half a thought before offering an interpretation.

Kit raised one finger.

I waited again.

Velvet took off one heavy earring and set it beside her glass. Remy folded his entrance list. For once, nobody needed the scene in front of us to become a competition about who had understood it first.

When the conversation resumed, Rosa talked about a place she used to visit. Mercedes answered with a memory of a road. I knew neither story.

"Nigga," Tank whispered, "you could just listen."

So I did, badly at first. Then better.

Mika quietly marked this room as somewhere people could sit without a programmed activity. I wanted to name it the Interpretation Lounge. Shawna wrote QUIET on a card and slid it over my proposal.

It was the shortest successful speech delivered at the summit that day.

Aiden's verdict. The room keeps its quiet option and loses my interpretive branding. Conversation may happen there, but nobody owes the host a theory before being allowed to sit down.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/520720/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P104 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Everybody's Gone to the Rapture

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate an empty village by following traces of its people, piecing together a community's relationships and the mystery of their disappearance.

What you do. Explore village spaces and follow the story encounters, listening to conversations that reveal what happened to the community.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person navigation and looking around are central, while unfolding encounters and their comfort need a practical check.

Why it might click. Everybody's Gone to the Rapture explores the vanished community of an English village through traces of conversations and events. Its mystery is inseparable from relationships, resentments and ordinary lives. The attraction is piecing together what happened to people rather than mastering combat or a large equipment system.

The full catch. The open environment requires first-person movement, orientation and finding the next useful trace. Spoken scenes and nonlinear order may create memory demands. Check interaction with the light phenomena, text support and walking controls in the PC version. A contemplative story still can be emotionally unsettling, and the source does not certify every interaction as untimed.

Try this first. Explore one small village area and follow one conversation fragment. Note a single person or question worth returning to, rather than attempting to map the entire community.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P104 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Everybody's Gone to the Rapture

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Everybody Had Gone to the Good Snacks

I entered the east lounge and found abandoned cups, an open songbook, and no delegation. Everybody's Gone to the Rapture was waiting on the screen, which gave the situation a deeply unnecessary atmosphere.

"Nigga, where'd the summit go?"

Dre pointed to a trail of napkins. I rejected that as insufficient evidence until Tank smelled warm bread.

We followed the small signs through the corridor. June's cardigan hung over a chair. Dez had left the Blue Comet scrapbook beside a mirror. Remy's microphone lay carefully wrapped on a table.

At the courtyard, Rae was distributing fresh snacks she had persuaded the kitchen to make. Nia sat beside her, delighted by a victory that required neither a motion nor my credit card.

I announced that the missing delegation had been recovered.

Rae handed me bread. "We told you."

She had. I had been recording a welcome message at the time. Shawna replayed the audio: everybody leaving, everybody explaining, me talking straight through the evidence.

Aiden's verdict. The missing delegation is found beside warm bread. Future room changes require a simple sign at the old door, because my welcome recordings cannot be trusted to hear themselves interrupted.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/417880/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P105 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

What Remains of Edith Finch

Edition considered: PC release

Discover a family's strange and moving history through the rooms and stories left behind in an unusually detailed house.

What you do. Explore the house and enter its different narrative episodes, following the changing interactions used to tell each story.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Episode controls vary and the material is emotionally intense; a compelling premise does not establish physically simple play.

Why it might click. What Remains of Edith Finch uses a remarkable family home to connect a series of short, varied stories. The attraction is the inventive relationship between each person's life and the way their story is presented. It offers rich emotional material without requiring the player to manage a conventional role-playing character sheet.

The full catch. Variation is also the principal control catch. The developer explicitly says the gameplay changes between family stories, so learning the opening does not establish a stable interaction pattern for the whole game. First-person navigation and later combinations need checking. Death is central throughout; this is a content preference to consider, not a surprise to conceal behind the attractive house.

Try this first. Explore an early room and assess the first change of interaction. Continue because that style of storytelling interests you, not because the opening seemed mechanically simple.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P105 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

What Remains of Edith Finch

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Family Room Needed More Than My Family

What Remains of Edith Finch made a house feel crowded with different lives. I looked at our summit map and noticed that my proposed family lounge contained fourteen pictures of me.

Shawna counted fifteen. One was printed on the cushion.

I offered to replace half with wedding photographs. Rae asked whether everybody else had families too.

"Of course."

"Then why your cousin got an entire wall?"

The room began changing. Kit put out a library book she had borrowed for the trip. Remy set his flowers in water. Rosa moved two chairs together without explaining who would use them.

Velvet insisted the room could also hold people who did not want to give a family presentation. Nia nodded and placed blank cards beside the photographs rather than labels beneath anybody's seat.

I removed the cushion picture myself. Shawna kept one wedding photo near the door, where I could see both of us in it instead of just my spectacular jacket.

Aiden's verdict. The family lounge becomes a room for people with different histories, including private ones. One wedding picture stays, while fourteen host portraits face a difficult but overdue housing shortage.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/501300/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P106 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Gone Home

Edition considered: PC release

Learn about a family by exploring their house and noticing personal traces, letting ordinary objects reveal relationships and hidden stories.

What you do. Walk through the house, inspect belongings and follow the information they reveal about the people who lived there.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person navigation, searching and remembering locations remain demands, and the atmosphere can feel tense despite its domestic setting.

Why it might click. Gone Home invites the player to understand a family by exploring its house and examining the things left behind. The personal story grows through rooms, possessions and written material. The developer explicitly describes no combat and no conventional puzzles, making investigation itself the central activity.

The full catch. First-person camera control, walking and inspecting objects still require comfort with navigation. Reading and keeping track of rooms may be more demanding than the mechanical premise suggests. The stormy, empty-house atmosphere can feel suspenseful even though the developer rules out attacks. Check text size and object manipulation instead of assuming the story's pace settles every concern.

Try this first. Investigate one room and choose one object or note that changes your understanding of the family. Test returning it and moving to the next doorway.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P106 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Gone Home

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Rae Found the Note I Wasn't Looking For

Gone Home's story through rooms and belongings sent us back to inspect the smaller lounge. I wanted to know whether it could hold a second television. Rae noticed a folded note under a cushion. It was Nia's draft invitation for a dance.

Rae stopped reading after her own name. She folded it again.

"Nigga, we found a private room. Let's act like it."

I said the note might be summit business. Shawna gave me the look that has closed several of my more ambitious jurisdictions.

We checked the sockets, chairs, and doorway instead. Kit found a lamp with a working switch. Velvet discovered the mirror was good enough for a quick costume adjustment.

Nia arrived looking for something and tried to sound casual about it. Rae handed her the note without comment, then asked whether she preferred the courtyard or the ballroom later.

"The courtyard," Nia said.

I had discovered the room's best feature without getting permission to narrate it.

Aiden's verdict. The smaller lounge keeps a useful lamp and an expectation of privacy. Rae returns the note unread beyond its greeting, then asks the question without needing the rest.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/232430/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P107 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Firewatch

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a relationship built through radio conversations while exploring a wilderness setting whose isolation gives the story its particular mood.

What you do. Walk through outdoor areas, investigate the surroundings and speak by radio as the narrative and relationship develop.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Camera control, navigation and dialogue-response behavior need checking, particularly if any sense of urgency is unwelcome.

Why it might click. Firewatch combines an adult relationship over a handheld radio with exploration of the Wyoming wilderness. Its appeal is the interplay between place, conversation and a developing mystery. The characters have histories and imperfect motives, so the emotional complexity comes from people rather than elaborate combat systems.

The full catch. First-person movement, map use and terrain navigation are substantial checks. Dialogue response behavior also needs direct inspection: a conversation-driven game should not receive an unlimited-waiting claim without testing it. The developer describes suspense and adult themes. This is a conditional story candidate, especially if any feeling of urgency is unwelcome.

Try this first. Try the earliest ordinary radio exchange and a short walk. Check whether response choices allow the desired pace before investing in the relationship or mystery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P107 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Firewatch

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Radio Made Me Sound Taller

Firewatch put an adult relationship across a radio, and I decided our summit needed a communications test. From the balcony I called Shawna in the east lounge.

"Command to beautiful woman. How's the view?" "Full of boxes, command."

Kit borrowed the second radio to test the far corridor. Her voice came back clear. Remy tried his stage fanfare through it and produced a noise like a trumpet trapped inside a lunch tin.

Velvet took the radio away. "Nigga, this is communication, not punishment."

The test found one corner where reception failed. Mika marked it and moved the information desk rather than making everyone shout from the doorway.

I stayed on the balcony after the others went inside. Shawna asked whether I was coming.

"Thought I'd enjoy the mystery."

"The mystery is whether your wife eats the last dessert alone."

I abandoned my remote post with a speed no communications policy had yet managed to inspire.

Aiden's verdict. The information desk moves to the clear reception area. Remy's fanfare is removed from the radio channel, and command returns indoors after receiving a credible dessert-related development.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/383870/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P108 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Stanley Parable: Ultra Deluxe

Edition considered: PC Ultra Deluxe

Explore a comic argument between a narrator, a player and a game, where choosing a route changes the experience's direction.

What you do. Walk through the environment, make route choices and listen to how the narrator responds to what happens next.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person movement, repeated passages and some darker content remain; inspect individual branches rather than assuming one uniform mood.

Why it might click. The Stanley Parable: Ultra Deluxe is a comic exploration of choices, narration and the rules games pretend to enforce. An office becomes the starting point for branches, contradictions and jokes that respond to what the player does. Its appeal is especially strong if arguing with an overconfident narrator sounds like entertainment.

The full catch. It uses first-person movement and contains many different branches. A simple corridor is not evidence that every ending has the same input or emotional demands. The developer lists added accessibility features, including content warnings, but their presence does not certify a no-hold or no-timing route. Check camera comfort and preview the relevant settings.

Try this first. Reach the first meaningful choice and follow the route you actually find amusing. Test pausing and leaving without treating every possible ending as an assignment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P108 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Stanley Parable: Ultra Deluxe

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Narrator Chose the Door Nobody Wanted

The Stanley Parable made me feel understood for eight seconds. Then its argument with narration encouraged Shawna to test my guided tour of the annex.

"The delegates entered the magnificent ballroom," I announced.

Kit opened the small lounge door. "They reconsidered and entered the magnificent ballroom."

Rae followed Kit. Nia carried the good crackers after her.

Mika asked whether I could stop narrating long enough to explain where the toilets were. I incorporated that into a stirring paragraph about infrastructure. Velvet pointed at the sign and kept walking.

Now I had a tour group consisting of Tank, who was waiting for me to move away from the bread.

"Nigga, you can't declare where folks want to sit."

I offered three alternative endings to the tour. Shawna chose a fourth: she kissed me, took my hand, and led me through Kit's door.

Inside, Remy had found the comfortable chair I had never bothered to describe. Everybody applauded him instead.

Aiden's verdict. The annex tour becomes optional and the signs become useful. My narration loses authority over doors, chairs, and where Shawna takes me when she has heard enough.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1703340/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, we're good.

P109 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Beginner's Guide

Edition considered: PC release

Take a guided journey through game spaces that raises questions about creators, interpretation and what an observer can really know.

What you do. Move through the presented environments and listen to the narrator's account of the places and their possible meaning.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person movement and camera control remain relevant, while detailed comfort and timing information are limited in the primary source.

Why it might click. The Beginner's Guide uses a sequence of game spaces and a narrator to tell a story about interpretation, creativity and a relationship to another person's work. It is a compact narrative experiment rather than a conventional quest or collection of systems. Its adult interest lies in the questions it raises about understanding and ownership.

The full catch. The primary description offers very little detailed control information. Do not turn its lack of traditional goals into a guarantee that every scene uses one simple input. First-person movement and changes between spaces should be checked directly. The story may also be emotionally uncomfortable rather than merely clever or relaxing.

Try this first. Experience the first short space and narration, then assess whether the combination feels compelling. Check movement and stopping behavior before following the entire sequence.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P109 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Beginner's Guide

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Mika's Model Was Not a Confession

The Beginner's Guide had me thinking about what a made space might say about its maker. Mika's hotel models seemed an irresistible research opportunity.

"This tiny balcony represents your desire to escape responsibility."

"It represents a balcony."

I moved on to the staircase. They put a protective hand over it.

Rae asked why I could not simply ask Mika what they liked. It struck me as an unusually direct research method.

Mika talked about the little railings, the satisfying scale, the possibility of holding an entire hotel in one hand. Then they showed us the model whose windows actually opened. Kit leaned closer. Velvet wanted to know whether the miniature suite cost as much as ours.

"Nigga, now you're asking useful questions," Tank said.

I apologized for the escape theory. Mika handed me a tiny plastic tree to hold while they moved the model.

For a beautiful minute, my role in somebody else's creative life required no interpretation beyond not dropping it.

Aiden's verdict. Mika retains authority over what their models mean. I receive temporary custody of one plastic tree and am advised that a balcony may, under ordinary circumstances, be a balcony.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/303210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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P110 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Vanishing of Ethan Carter Redux

Edition considered: PC Redux edition

Explore an atmospheric valley through an occult investigation and a dark family mystery, if unsettling discovery is part of the appeal.

What you do. Move through the valley, examine traces and reconstruct events connected to the investigator's search and the family's story.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Horror, violence, first-person controls and scene-specific interactions remain catches; keep Redux edition and installation details straight.

Why it might click. The Vanishing of Ethan Carter follows an occult-minded investigator through a detailed valley and a dark family mystery. Observation and reconstructing events give the landscape narrative purpose. It may appeal to someone who wants grown-up detective atmosphere with supernatural unease rather than a large combat system.

The full catch. The developer describes no combat, but that does not erase horror, violence or first-person navigation. Check scene-specific interaction, camera use and any unsettling sequences before promising a relaxed route. This card targets Redux; the inspected store treats it as content associated with the original product, so edition and installation details must be kept straight.

Try this first. Explore an early outdoor area and inspect one trace. Decide whether the visual atmosphere feels intriguing rather than oppressive before advancing into the darker investigation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P110 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Vanishing of Ethan Carter Redux

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Missing Nephew Was Charging His Phone

The Vanishing of Ethan Carter gave our room survey a dark investigative mood just before the hotel manager asked whether we had seen his nephew. The young man had been helping move chairs.

I volunteered to reconstruct his last movements.

Shawna asked whether anyone had called him.

I began at the abandoned trolley. A folded jacket. One empty cup. A shoeprint near the courtyard. The evidence suggested a journey of considerable emotional complexity.

Rae followed the charging cable behind the curtains and found him sitting on the floor with his phone. He was an adult with a break, which ruined several promising theories.

"Nigga, I had a whole valley of clues," I said.

"You had a cup," Tank said.

The young man showed Mika the nearest sockets and warned us which door stuck. His practical knowledge improved the annex more than my reconstruction.

I thanked him for his assistance. He asked whether I wanted my empty cup back.

Aiden's verdict. The chair mover's break remains his own business. His socket advice enters the venue plan; my dramatic reconstruction is reduced to collecting one cup and apologizing for the curtain.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Redux store entry and linked base-game store. Redux is described as associated content; base page supports the remaster relationship, mystery and no combat. Exact Redux input behavior remains untested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/400430/>

Source 2: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/258520/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

The Blue Comet Had Never Owned the Whole Sky

Darnell appeared on the balcony with a proposal to sponsor its naming rights. He offered a yacht photograph, an anecdote nobody had requested, and a bag of party baggage he wisely kept away from the tea.

Mercedes asked what he meant by sponsor.

"Exposure."

"Nigga, we're already outside."

He tried again with the word partnership. Velvet asked for a number. The discussion ended when no number appeared.

Below us, the courtyard lights had come on. Kit wanted one brighter patch near the path. Mika wanted the reflections to remain soft. They tried two settings and found a third both liked. I was preparing to call this a triumph of coalition procedure when June asked whether anybody could simply enjoy it for a minute.

We did.

Dez took out the Blue Comet scrapbook. A photograph showed the two women much younger, standing beneath a sign whose paint had already begun to peel. June wore the disputed jacket. Dez's hand was caught at its sleeve.

I asked who owned it at the moment of the photograph.

"The person wearing it," June said.

"The person foolish enough to lend it," Dez said.

Rae leaned in to look, then passed the book to Nia. Nobody asked the photograph to settle the dispute. It was doing another job: keeping an evening visible after the room itself was gone.

Shawna rested her head against my shoulder. I considered all the money I had spent trying to produce a moment that looked like this, then tried very hard not to announce that thought and ruin the free version.

Mika marked the balcony as an optional stop with chairs, water, and enough light to find the way back. Darnell wanted his name on the mark. Mercedes drew a little star instead.

"Nigga, that's exposure," she told him.

He laughed despite himself. June closed the scrapbook. Dez kept one hand on it. The sky remained completely indifferent to our naming rights, which made it the only venue feature I had no chance of accidentally renting.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P111 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

INFRA

Edition considered: PC complete game

Investigate the workings and failures of a detailed built environment, if infrastructure and noticing how places function sound intriguing.

What you do. Explore industrial spaces, examine structures and machinery, and follow the problems revealed by the environment as you investigate.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Hazards, navigation and camera demands keep this a conditional action-oriented detour, despite its unusual non-soldier premise.

Why it might click. INFRA makes structural inspection into a detailed environmental puzzle adventure. Photographing damage, tracing routes and uncovering how a city's systems failed can appeal to someone fascinated by real places and hidden institutional stories. The mystery grows from infrastructure rather than fantasy combat equipment.

The full catch. The developer explicitly describes hazards and a fight for survival despite the absence of guns. This is therefore an investigative detour, not an automatic calm-walking recommendation. First-person navigation, environmental puzzles, resource handling and dangerous situations need direct checks. A camera as the main tool does not mean the game behaves like a leisurely photo album.

Try this first. Inspect a short, ordinary early area and try documenting one defect. Assess movement and the first hazard warning before deciding whether this kind of investigation is enjoyable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P111 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

INFRA

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Crack Was Not a Decorative Feature

INFRA made structural inspection look more compelling than my guided tour, so Rae photographed the wobbly signing platform. I said the slight movement was a feature of the floating design.

"Nigga, that's the floor asking for help."

She called the hotel technician. I tried to accompany him under the platform until he handed me a flashlight and asked me to stand somewhere useful.

Kit kept people away while Mika moved the model map. Velvet objected to postponing her entrance, then saw the loose support and postponed it herself.

The technician repaired the problem without once complimenting my vision. Rae checked the table after he finished. It stood still.

I asked whether we should unveil the improvement.

Tank stepped onto the platform, turned around, and stepped off. Nothing shook. He nodded.

"Beautiful."

That was the whole ceremony. Shawna squeezed my hand, and I decided the strongest review of a stage might be watching somebody leave it safely with both shoes still level.

Aiden's verdict. The repaired platform passes the technician's check and Tank's uneventful crossing. My proposed unveiling is canceled because a stable floor has already made its entire public statement.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/251110/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, we're good.

P112 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Obduction

Edition considered: PC release

Enter an unfamiliar world assembled from strangely recognizable pieces, with exploration and mechanisms giving its mystery something concrete to investigate.

What you do. Move through the environment, inspect structures and work out relationships between mechanisms and the spaces they affect.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Free camera control, navigation and linked puzzles can be demanding; the mysterious premise does not establish comfortable operation.

Why it might click. Obduction places fragments of familiar life inside an alien setting and asks the player to investigate how its worlds work. Environmental puzzles and the desire to understand the place provide the story's momentum. Its appeal is the patient discovery of connections that initially seem unrelated.

The full catch. The game is visually and spatially elaborate. Walking, looking, operating devices and remembering how places connect can be substantial demands. This card proposes the ordinary screen version, not VR. The primary description establishes an exploration puzzle adventure with consequential choices, not a blanket absence of timing, holds or difficult navigation.

Try this first. Inspect one nearby structure and test a single interaction. Keep a brief note or image of the immediate question before exploring several routes at once.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P112 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Obduction

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Someone Put the Familiar Sofa in Another World

Obduction's familiar fragments in strange surroundings gave Mika permission to try a bold furniture arrangement. The old lounge sofa appeared in the middle of the ballroom beneath a silver canopy.

It looked like my aunt's living room had been abducted by an awards show.

Kit loved the sofa. Velvet loved the canopy. Neither loved the fact that my portrait occupied the only place to put a drink.

I suggested people hold their glasses ceremonially.

Rae moved the portrait and installed a small table. The alien civilization immediately improved.

Nia sat down and asked Rae to join her. They began debating which room should hold the quiet conversations. Halfway through, both stopped looking at the map.

"Nigga," Tank whispered, "the sofa solved the problem."

Mika kept the canopy but lowered its brightest light. I sat on the arm beside Shawna until she pulled me onto the cushion. My aunt would have approved of the furniture, then asked why everybody dressed so expensive.

Aiden's verdict. The displaced sofa earns a place beneath the canopy, provided its table remains useful. Mika adjusts the light, and two delegates discover the room they were trying to assign.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/306760/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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P113 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Myst

Edition considered: 2021 PC remake; not the 1993 original

Explore an enigmatic island of structures and mechanisms, if a place that gradually reveals its logic sounds like a compelling destination.

What you do. Visit parts of the island, inspect objects and solve mechanisms to uncover routes and more of its mystery.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. This is the 2021 remake: free movement, camera use, device manipulation and clue memory still need checking.

Why it might click. Myst combines a mysterious island, linked worlds and a story of family betrayal with environmental puzzles. The attraction is learning how a place works through observation and inference. This entry targets the 2021 remake, whose presentation and controls differ from the original screen-by-screen game.

The full catch. Do not assume the old game's navigation applies to the remake. Free movement, camera control, device manipulation and remembering clues all require checking. The developer documents an in-game photo feature that may help preserve clues, but VR comfort features should not be misrepresented as ordinary-screen settings. Puzzle difficulty can remain considerable regardless of input comfort.

Try this first. Explore one small area, photograph one useful-looking clue and test one mechanism. Use that concrete question to decide whether the island's style of reasoning is appealing.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P113 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Myst

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Brothers Were Arguing Over My Two Room Keys

Myst's linked worlds and family betrayal inspired me to give the annex a mysterious key ceremony. I held up two envelopes, one red and one blue, each promising access to an important room.

Tank asked which contained the kitchen key.

"That is not the mystery."

"Then improve the mystery."

Kit opened the red envelope and found a card describing the ballroom in elaborate prose. Rae opened the blue one and found the same prose with different adjectives. Neither envelope held a key.

I explained that discovery should be earned. Velvet asked whether the hotel would accept earned discovery instead of rent.

Shawna took the actual keys from my pocket. One opened the supply closet. The other was our room card, which she retained for excellent private reasons.

Mika printed ordinary room labels. I kept the envelopes for the eventual ceremony, now clearly marked EMPTY. It was the first honest clue in my entire immersive experience.

Aiden's verdict. The annex receives ordinary labels and working access. The mysterious envelopes remain available as props, while Shawna retains the only key whose destination requires no public explanation.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1255560/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P114 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Riven

Edition considered: 2024 PC remake; not the 1997 original

Explore a densely designed island world in its modern remake, where careful attention to the place supports solving its mysteries.

What you do. Move through the rebuilt world, investigate its structures and work out how its mechanisms and locations relate.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The remake's free three-dimensional movement differs from the older edition, and its interlinked puzzles can create substantial remembering work.

Why it might click. Riven asks the player to understand a richly connected world and the power shaping it. Observation of the environment supplies information that later becomes meaningful, making discovery feel like learning a place rather than completing disconnected puzzles. The 2024 remake expands and reimagines the original game's world.

The full catch. The remake explicitly uses free movement in a three-dimensional environment. That matters for camera comfort and must not be confused with the 1997 original's screen navigation. Its interlocking clues also make memory and note-taking significant. This is a deliberate reasoning stretch, not an easy label earned by the absence of a weapon.

Try this first. Observe one small area and record a single pattern or symbol without demanding an immediate solution. Test movement and view control before building a large notebook.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P114 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Riven

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Map Wanted Us to Learn It Before It Helped

Riven's connected world gave Kit an idea for a beautifully subtle summit map. She used symbols for food, music, conversation, and the courtyard, then explained their relationships with impressive confidence.

Remy walked directly into a storage room.

"That symbol means quiet," Kit said.

"It was very quiet."

Rae admitted she had mistaken the music symbol for a kettle. I said the whole system needed a commanding central landmark, perhaps a portrait. Nobody dignified that with fresh objection.

Mika kept Kit's elegant symbols and added plain words beside them. Velvet tested the new map by sending me to fetch a mirror. I returned with a mirror instead of an explanation.

Kit watched June and Dez reach the correct rooms without reviving their old Blue Comet seating feud, then grinned.

"My symbols still look good."

They did. Remy taped a smaller copy to his microphone case. When he found his own room without opening a cupboard, he performed his victory fanfare softly, which counted as progress twice.

Aiden's verdict. Kit's symbols survive alongside plain labels, and the storage room returns to storage. Remy finds his destination with enough confidence to celebrate at a volume the corridor can tolerate.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1712350/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P115 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Firmament

Edition considered: PC non-VR mode proposed for assessment

Explore strange machinery and environments with an unusual assistant, if figuring out how a constructed world works sounds rewarding to you.

What you do. Travel through mechanical environments, operate the Adjunct device and interpret machinery while following the mystery and a speaking companion.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Assess desktop separately from VR; moving, looking, targeting devices and sequencing puzzles still need practical checks.

Why it might click. Firmament offers a puzzle adventure through large mechanical environments, using a device called the Adjunct to interact with their systems. The mystery concerns the purpose of the realms and the companion who speaks to you. It may appeal to someone who enjoys machinery as part of a world's history.

The full catch. The imposing spaces require navigation and camera control, while device puzzles add interpretation and sequencing. Assess the ordinary-screen version separately from VR; the developer's VR comfort list does not automatically describe a desktop control solution. A recurring tool can simplify the vocabulary without making all its uses physically or mentally simple.

Try this first. Try the first device interaction and identify exactly what changed. Check moving, looking and targeting the mechanism before deciding whether the broader machine world is inviting.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P115 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Firmament

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Adjunct Was Tank Holding a Handle

Firmament's huge mechanisms and useful device made me resent how ordinary our furniture looked. I ordered a ceremonial lever to reveal the annex map.

The lever arrived unattached to anything.

Tank held it beside the curtain while Mika checked the delivery slip. "Nigga, I think I'm the mechanism."

Velvet suggested we pay him accordingly. He immediately requested dinner and a chair with arms.

Rae found a simple curtain pull already fitted to the rail. I said it lacked mystery. Kit pulled it. The map appeared. Everyone understood the result, a devastating setback for my artistic intentions.

Remy wanted to use the spare lever in King Receipts' entrance. He raised it majestically, caught his own sleeve, and had to ask Nia for help.

She freed him while Rae laughed hard enough to lean against the wall.

We put the lever on the prop table. Tank collected his dinner anyway, having completed the difficult preliminary work of standing near my purchase.

Aiden's verdict. The existing curtain pull wins the mechanism trial. The grand lever moves to the prop table, and Tank's compensation remains payable despite the position becoming obsolete almost immediately.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/754890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P116 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Witness

Edition considered: PC release

Explore an island of line puzzles that gradually teach their own rules, with discovering connections providing the main sense of progress.

What you do. Walk between puzzle panels, study their patterns and draw solutions as new relationships emerge across the island.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Camera movement, precise line drawing and demanding reasoning remain important; its understated presentation does not mean effortless play.

Why it might click. The Witness develops a large collection of line puzzles across an explorable island. Its particular pleasure is discovering what a visual rule means through examples, then recognizing a new twist. The environment becomes part of the thinking, so looking carefully can matter as much as manipulating the panel.

The full catch. First-person walking and camera control separate one puzzle from another. Drawing lines may involve precision or held input, and the reasoning becomes demanding. The presence of many apparently static panels does not prove the entire game has no timed or pressure-based content. Check the chosen route and ordinary panel interaction rather than offering a universal calm-game guarantee.

Try this first. Try a few introductory panels and stop when a new rule becomes interesting. Assess the drawing action itself and avoid treating the full island as a completion obligation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P116 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Witness

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Line Ended at the Snack Table

The Witness had everyone studying visual rules, so I proposed a floor design that would guide visitors through the summit by following a golden line.

Mika unrolled the sample. It made three handsome turns and ended directly under the snack table.

"Destination achieved," Tank said.

Kit wanted one line to the stage and another to the quiet room. Velvet asked how people would tell them apart under colored lights. I suggested we announce the distinction repeatedly over the microphone.

Remy tested that solution. Nobody heard his second sentence because the first had already irritated Rae.

She took two cards, wrote STAGE and QUIET ROOM, and held them where the routes divided. Mika nodded and added clear signs to the plan.

We kept a short gold strip near the entrance because it looked good. I tried to call that my original concept. Shawna stepped over it, took a cracker, and asked which rule required giving me credit for the entire floor.

Aiden’s verdict. The decorative line stays decorative, while clear signs handle destinations. Tank endorses the route to snacks, provided no one turns a perfectly visible table into an examination.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/210970/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P117 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Talos Principle

Edition considered: PC original release; not Reawakened

Work through spatial puzzles while encountering philosophical questions about purpose and existence, if thinking about both systems and ideas sounds appealing.

What you do. Explore puzzle spaces, move through their mechanisms and read or encounter the material that develops the philosophical story.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The original PC game includes drones and time-related puzzle mechanics; camera movement, object handling and spatial planning need checking.

Why it might click. The Talos Principle combines environmental puzzles with questions about personhood, authority and the remains of human civilization. Devices, beams and other mechanisms create practical problems, while texts and choices add an adult philosophical story. It offers both a place to think and something specific to manipulate.

The full catch. This entry targets the original PC game, not Reawakened. Movement, camera control, object handling and spatial planning all require assessment. The developer explicitly includes drones and time-related puzzle mechanics, so a turn-like appearance in some rooms should not become a claim of universal waiting. Reading and remembering relationships can also be substantial.

Try this first. Attempt one introductory device puzzle and read one optional piece of story material. Decide whether both halves are enjoyable before pursuing a larger sequence of rooms.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P117 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Talos Principle

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Automatic Door Had No Opinion About My Soul

The Talos Principle raised questions about authority and personhood while the hotel's automatic door refused to recognize my dramatic approach. I waved. It remained shut.

"Nigga, even the building's got questions."

Rae pointed to the manual opening beside it, then called the desk about the sensor. I preferred to discuss whether a host had a duty to earn entrance.

Velvet preferred to get her costume through.

Kit held the door while Remy and Tank carried the garment rack. Nia followed with the map. Nobody needed the sensor to settle a philosophical issue before doing the useful thing.

The technician arrived and found that my enormous welcome sign had blocked its view. He moved the sign six inches. The door opened.

I stepped back, tried again, and received immediate mechanical recognition.

Shawna applauded once. "There. A machine believes in you."

I took her hand and entered before it could reconsider the available evidence.

Aiden's verdict. The door's sensor receives a clear view, and the welcome sign retreats six inches. Philosophical discussion may continue inside, where Velvet's garment rack finally has room to pass.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/257510/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P118 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Talos Principle 2

Edition considered: PC base game

Enter a larger philosophical puzzle journey where a society's choices and ambitions give new meaning to the machinery and places explored.

What you do. Travel through puzzle environments, investigate mechanisms and follow conversations or discoveries about the society and its possible future.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The larger world and more machinery increase navigation and reasoning demands; its ideas do not simplify the controls.

Why it might click. The Talos Principle 2 develops its puzzle world into a more populated, character-driven discussion of civilization and its future. New devices and abilities accompany conversations and choices. It may appeal when philosophical ideas become more engaging through people who disagree about them.

The full catch. The large environments retain movement and camera demands, and new mechanics increase the amount to learn. The developer says the game can be finished without solving every puzzle, which may help set expectations, but that does not establish a low-input route. Check device manipulation, navigation and the difficulty of ordinary required puzzles.

Try this first. Try an introductory puzzle and one conversation. Use those two activities to judge the balance of physical interaction, reasoning and story, rather than aiming to master every optional challenge.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P118 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Talos Principle 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Civilization Was Two Chairs Facing Each Other

The Talos Principle 2 had us talking about what a community builds when it can imagine more than survival. I proposed a grand summit rotunda with my portrait at its center.

Kit proposed chairs that did not all face me.

The debate became unexpectedly serious. Velvet wanted a place where performers could rest after being visible. Remy wanted to hear other people without a microphone between them. Rae wanted the signing table close enough to the room that no one felt displayed on arrival.

Mika moved the model stage back and turned several chairs toward each other.

I looked at the new plan. It had less grandeur and more people apparently enjoying themselves.

"Nigga, where does the host sit?"

Shawna pulled out the chair beside hers.

We tested the arrangement with drinks. Within a minute, Kit and Velvet were arguing cheerfully about the entrance music instead of shouting across an aisle.

Civilization had finally developed a use for the space between my speeches.

Aiden's verdict. The revised seating favors conversation as well as performance. The host receives one chair beside his wife, a civilization-building investment that proves more popular than the proposed rotunda.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/835960/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P119 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Looker

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a comic response to familiar puzzle-game conventions, if playful surprises and jokes about apparent profundity sound like a good evening.

What you do. Move through the island, inspect puzzle situations and try the interactions that reveal the jokes within their setup.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person camera use and drawing or other puzzle actions still need checking despite the comic tone.

Why it might click. The Looker uses an island of puzzles to make jokes about a familiar style of serious puzzle adventure. The attraction is the combination of solving something and recognizing the absurdity around it. A little familiarity with the genre may make the satire richer, but curiosity about the joke can be enough to begin.

The full catch. Its compact comic premise does not certify easy controls or uniformly untimed play. First-person movement, drawing interactions and changing puzzle expectations should be checked directly. Humor also depends on taste; someone who wants an absorbing character story may prefer a different route. This is an editorial puzzle-comedy candidate, not a guarantee based on its brevity.

Try this first. Try the first small cluster of puzzles and see whether the jokes make the thinking more enjoyable. Stop freely if the parody feels like commentary on a party you did not attend.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P119 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Looker

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Joke Map Was Easier to Follow

The Looker's puzzle satire inspired Remy to draw a rival summit map. It featured a giant arrow marked AIDEN TALKING and a smaller arrow marked ANYWHERE ELSE.

Kit laughed into her tea. Betrayal had never sounded so soft.

I demanded a practical review. Rae followed the second arrow and found the courtyard. Nia followed it and found Rae. Velvet followed it and found enough room to turn in her costume.

The map was performing offensively well.

Mika added actual room names under the jokes. Remy drew a little crown over the snack table. Tank accepted the implied appointment without asking about salary.

"Nigga, you're all rewarding disrespect."

Shawna took my hand and followed the first arrow. It led to my chair. She sat beside me and asked whether the map could predict what happened next.

I became too interested in that experiment to continue the disciplinary hearing. Remy quietly copied his version for the entrance, where people could finally find both jokes and rooms.

Aiden's verdict. Remy's joke map earns a place at the entrance after Mika adds room names. My disciplinary hearing dissolves when Shawna demonstrates a more appealing use for its destination.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1985690/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P120 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Outer Wilds

Edition considered: PC base game; expansion assessed separately

Investigate a small solar system whose discoveries build on one another, if exploration and understanding are worth accepting a demanding structure.

What you do. Travel between locations, investigate discoveries and connect information gathered during repeated journeys through the solar system.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. A repeating time loop, flight and other action demands make this a clearly marked detour for a no-rush preference.

Why it might click. Outer Wilds builds a remarkable mystery around a small, changing solar system. Exploration and accumulated understanding reveal how its worlds connect. It belongs in the panorama because curiosity, discovery and a sense of place are central to its appeal, even though its demands differ sharply from the opening route.

The full catch. The official description explicitly identifies a time loop, environments that change with time, hazards and oxygen management. Flight and first-person navigation add major control demands. A strict no-rush preference makes this a detour, not a match. Do not imply that a companion, pause setting or familiarity removes those systems without evidence.

Try this first. Look at the premise or share a brief, spoiler-light official gameplay preview. Consider direct play only if timed exploration and flight are appealing rather than merely tolerable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, we're good.

P120 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Outer Wilds

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Solar System Was Closing at Ten

Outer Wilds put a changing solar system before us just as the hotel manager reminded Mika that one courtyard section closed at ten. I reacted as if she had announced the death of a star.

"We planned a whole evening."

"You planned six evenings," Shawna said. "It's one night."

Kit wanted the earlier balcony music. Velvet needed time to change. Nia asked whether the courtyard would still be available for one dance before the cutoff. Rae looked at her instead of the map.

Mika made a short sequence that allowed all three. No one had to sprint from attraction to attraction, and the room next door stayed available afterward.

I proposed stretching the evening through sheer prestige.

"Nigga," Tank said, "prestige can't move closing time."

We put the annex agreement beside the unfinished charter and the disputed Blue Comet invoice. June and Dez approved the rooms, carefully leaving the old war unresolved. Shawna opened the courtyard door, and for once I went with her before inventing another planet to visit.

Aiden's verdict. The venue annex records real hours and alternative rooms. The charter remains unsigned, while the courtyard gets its chance to be enjoyed before I attempt to renegotiate astronomy.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Primary storefront inspected for this game's premise and described mechanics. Input, pace and memory labels are editorial route aids; the card names unresolved control or whole-game checks. No hands-on completion audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/753640/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

The Annex Was Agreed, the Evening Was Still Ours

We spread the revised venue plan across the table Rae had made stable. It no longer looked like a campaign map drawn by a man expecting his portrait to repel invaders.

The ballroom had a clear entrance. The quiet room had a working lamp and no compulsory activity. Velvet's dressing area had a proper boundary. The courtyard had real hours, seats, and a route back inside when the evening moved on. The snacks could be reached without solving a decorative problem.

Kit traced the paths once with her finger. Mika checked the room names against the hotel signs. Remy set his microphone case beside the agreed stage position and found that his own feet still had somewhere to go.

"Nigga," Tank said, "we built walking."

"We negotiated an annex."

"We negotiated walking with snacks."

Nia read the agreement aloud in ordinary language. She had crossed out one of my phrases, sovereign corridor of collective splendor, and replaced it with clear passage. I privately mourned the phrase, which had cost nothing and still managed to be wasteful.

Rae asked whether people could change rooms when they wanted. Yes. Whether the quiet room required an explanation. No. Whether somebody could keep watching a game instead of joining the next ceremony rehearsal. Yes.

These answers sounded so ordinary that I nearly missed how much work my original plan had made necessary.

June took the pencil and marked the annex approved. Dez marked it too, then pointed at the old Blue Comet paper beside it.

"Separate question."

June nodded. "Still separate."

The final charter remained unsigned. The agreement from 1967 remained, in each veteran's account, unsigned by the other. We had settled where to sit without pretending to settle every story people brought into the room. Even I could see the difference, though it annoyed my desire for a dramatic concluding photograph.

Velvet folded the map and asked when the actual stage would be ready. Mika looked toward the costume racks, the unopened equipment cases, and the enormous box I had not yet explained.

"What is that?" Shawna asked.

"A mechanism."

"For what?"

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

I gave an answer containing the words seamless, immersive, and reveal. Rae picked up her toolkit again. Kit found her glasses. Remy began humming a fanfare designed to make any forthcoming embarrassment sound official.

Before we moved on, Nia touched Rae's elbow and asked whether the courtyard still had time for a dance later. Rae said yes. Nothing was signed, nobody applauded, and the answer looked stronger for not being announced.

Shawna led me through the clear passage we had finally managed to create. She stopped at the window, took my face in her hands, and kissed me until I forgot to assess the square footage.

Then she pointed at the box.

"Come on, nigga. Let's find out what you bought."

The next front of the war was waiting inside, probably with assembly instructions I had mistaken for optional reading.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 4 OF SIX

Nigga, the Peace Table Has to Stand Up

Puzzles, mechanisms, creative toys and retro desktop diversions

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.

Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan's creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.

Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden’s scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [The Camera Did Not Get to Name Everybody](#) - page 48. Drag, identity and the audience.

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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 4. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P121	P122	P123	P124	P125	P126	P127	P128
2. Ready for conversation	P129	P130	P131	P132	P133	P134	P135	P136
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P137	P138	P139	P140	P141	P142	P143	P144
4. Here for the atmosphere	P145	P146	P147	P148	P149	P150	P151	P152
5. Open to a wildcard	P153	P154	P155	P156	P157	P158	P159	P160

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The Battle of the Unassembled Stage

The mechanism inside my enormous box was a curtain opener with no curtain, a revolving stand with no assigned purpose, and a gold lever so impressive it distracted me from both omissions.

Rae put the delivery sheet on the table. "Which thing does the useful thing?"

I pointed at the lever.

She lifted it. Nothing happened anywhere else.

Tank nodded. "Portable authority, nigga."

Our venue annex was settled. People knew where the rooms were, the quiet space had a working lamp, and Velvet's dressing area no longer doubled as a shortcut for my sense of symmetry. All that remained was to build a ceremony capable of holding the people, the paper, the costumes, and my deteriorating confidence without collapsing under any of them.

I had prepared for this task by ordering objects.

Mika had prepared by measuring. This gave them an unfair advantage the moment we began. They placed their tiny hotel model on a clear patch of table, laid out the agreed route, and asked us to stop adding towers until the actual furniture worked.

Kit, the white butch librarian, carried the lighting plan under one arm and searched for her glasses with the other hand. They were in her jacket pocket. Remy discovered them while looking for the microphone clip, received a grateful smile, and ruined it with a pun about seeing eye to eye. Kit laughed anyway, which encouraged him beyond the interests of the room.

Velvet arrived wearing half her performance costume and carrying the other half in a bag large enough to contain a small successful business. She wanted a clear turn beside the stage, a usable mirror, and the fee we had already agreed. Her budget instincts were sharper than my scissors, and considerably more likely to cut something.

Rae wanted the signing table to stand still. This had become her recurring demand because I had repeatedly purchased things that photographed better than they supported elbows. Nia wanted that table near the room, where people could speak without being exhibited like auction lots. She also wanted to ask Rae about the dance, but every time she approached, somebody handed her another page written in my decorative language.

Auntie June and Dez took their chairs near the rehearsal area. June wore the posture of a retired bus driver who could still tell when somebody had parked badly from across a room. Dez wore June's old jacket, repaired so carefully that its disputed ownership had survived longer than many actual institutions.

Between them lay the Blue Comet rental invoice. The peace terms were on its back. June had signed the front and Dez the back, an arrangement that had supported fifty-nine years of each declaring the other's signature absent. I had initially treated this as a tragedy of diplomacy. Shawna said it sounded like two women who enjoyed having an excuse to bring up the same night.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The first Great Butch versus Stud War belonged to our invented 1967 social club history, complete with contradictory jukebox accounts and an unreasonable quantity of emotional investment in one borrowed jacket. The second had reached the stage-equipment phase. Nobody's dignity required a vote. My purchases, unfortunately, required several.

I proposed raising the signing table on a platform beneath the illuminated portrait. Rae sat at the table and asked me to hand her the pen. I had to walk around a vase, a costume rack, and the unconnected lever to reach her.

"Nigga," she said, "we have discovered the problem."

Mika moved the vase. Kit moved the rack. I held the lever because nobody had yet found it a job. Shawna put a small ordinary pen in my other hand and guided me back along the clear route.

"Try this version."

I handed the pen to Rae. She wrote a test word, pushed gently against the table, and looked up. It wobbled.

Tank took the lever from me. For one terrible second I thought he had discovered its purpose. Then he set it aside and helped Rae inspect the legs.

The war had finally found its first objective: a table that could survive somebody agreeing with somebody else.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P121 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Baba Is You

Edition considered: PC release

Discover puzzles where moving the words changes the rules, if a small action leading to a big conceptual surprise appeals.

What you do. Move around compact boards, push rule words into new arrangements and observe how the changed rules affect the puzzle.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The simple movement system supports difficult reasoning; verify movement repeat, undo and exact controls before choosing it.

Why it might click. Baba Is You turns the rules of a puzzle into objects you can move. A short arrangement of words can transform what a wall, flag or character does. The appeal is the surprise of realizing that the rule you assumed was fixed is actually the thing to manipulate.

The full catch. The small number of movement actions should not be confused with easy reasoning. The developer describes a large collection of increasingly inventive rule interactions. Reading the words, predicting consequences and revising a plan can become demanding. Check the exact movement, undo and restart controls rather than assuming they are comfortable because the board is compact.

Try this first. Try an introductory level and deliberately move one rule word. Observe what changes before attempting a long solution or consulting an entire set of hints.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P121 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Baba Is You

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / HOST IS OPTIONAL Was an Act of War

Baba Is You had me thinking about moveable rules, which was unfortunate because Rae was already rearranging the magnetic words on my ceremony board.

I had written HOST IS ESSENTIAL. She changed it to HOST IS SEATED.

"Nigga, that's constitutional vandalism."

Kit changed STAGE IS GRAND to STAGE IS CLEAR. Velvet added PAID beside SHOW and folded her arms until I acknowledged the amendment.

Auntie June examined the board. She said the Blue Comet jukebox dispute had begun with people treating their own rules as sacred. Dez said it had begun with June playing the same song four times.

"Because it was good."

"Because you had all the quarters."

Remy moved the word SHARED beside MICROPHONE. The resulting sentence was ugly but useful. I put OPTIONAL beside my speech as a generous gesture, then tried to remove it when everyone applauded.

Shawna kept her hand over the magnet. Nigga, my wife had discovered a very small way to hold executive power.

Aiden's verdict. The ceremony board keeps shared equipment and an optional host speech. June and Dez dispute the historical jukebox allocation, while Shawna guards the magnet that makes the present tolerable.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/736260/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P122 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Patrick's Parabox

Edition considered: PC release

Explore boxes within boxes, if discovering how nested spaces fit together sounds more interesting than following a conventional character story.

What you do. Move pieces through recursive box arrangements, reconsider the spatial relationships and try new paths through the compact puzzle.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The developer declares untimed input, but nested relationships can create substantial reasoning and memory demands.

Why it might click. Patrick's Parabox explores boxes that contain other boxes, including recursive arrangements. The repeated act of pushing gains new meaning as the space folds into itself. Its interest is in discovering how a small set of relationships can support surprisingly rich puzzles.

The full catch. The current Steam listing declares play without timed input and keyboard-only support. Spatial nesting can still require holding several relationships in mind even when the controls are limited. Verify key repeat, undo and any zoom behavior in the actual version. There is little conventional character story to carry the experience if the recursive logic itself does not appeal.

Try this first. Play the earliest introduction to entering and leaving a box. Explain one relationship aloud if useful, then try a move that tests that explanation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P122 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Patrick's Parabox

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Table Was Inside the Table's Box

Patrick's Parabox put boxes inside boxes while the hotel delivered our signing furniture in a crate that seemed to contain another crate.

Mika opened the first. Tank opened the second. I announced that anticipation increased the ceremony's value.

Rae found a tiny model table inside the third.

"Nigga, you ordered the display sample."

I examined the invoice. The scale measurement had looked like a decorative fraction.

Velvet sat the miniature table on her palm and asked whether the coalition planned to sign with individual eyelashes. Remy produced a pencil nub and offered a suitably modest fanfare.

Mika was delighted. They added the model to their hotel collection, then borrowed a full-size table from the lounge. Rae checked its legs. Kit arranged the chairs around it.

The small table cost too much to throw away, so Shawna placed it beside my enormous receipt. In that arrangement, at least, the proportions accurately represented my evening.

Aiden's verdict. The borrowed table receives the actual chairs, while Mika keeps the expensive miniature. My receipt becomes a scale reference for the distance between anticipation and reading the purchase description.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1260520/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P123 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Stephen's Sausage Roll

Edition considered: PC release

Work through compact spatial puzzles built around a comic cooking premise, if figuring out a demanding arrangement sounds satisfying.

What you do. Inspect the puzzle space, move through its arrangement and test how your actions change the problem in front of you.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The primary description is brief; controls and full-game timing remain unresolved, and the reasoning can be demanding.

Why it might click. Stephen's Sausage Roll is a compact three-dimensional puzzle game built around unusually exact spatial problems. Its appeal is the satisfaction of understanding a small arrangement deeply enough to make it work. It belongs on the reasoning shelf for someone who enjoys a stubborn little mechanism more than an expansive story.

The full catch. The inspected primary storefront supplies very little detailed control information, so this card does not certify timing, holds or the full interaction set. The title's cheerful food premise should not imply easy puzzles. Treat both input comfort and the amount of planning as questions for an early trial, with no expectation of quick completion.

Try this first. Inspect the first small puzzle and test a single movement. If the rules interest you, try one hypothesis; if they merely irritate, leave the plate unfinished.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P123 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Stephen's Sausage Roll

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Sausage Had a Seating Preference

Stephen's Sausage Roll made the food layout look like an exact spatial problem, which Rae took as permission to intervene in the catering arrangement.

The sausages were under a hot lamp. The bread was across the table. The plates sat behind a vase taller than Remy.

"Nigga, who designed this, a person who hates wrists?"

I admitted choosing the vase. It was shaped like a victory flame.

Dez rotated the platter and moved the bread beside it. June shifted the plates. They performed this small cooperation without acknowledging its diplomatic significance, so I immediately ruined it by announcing the historic moment.

June put a plate in my hand.

"Be historic over there."

Rae used the freed space for a clear serving route. Velvet approached, assembled dinner without touching the victory flame, and declared the arrangement fit for performers of international stature.

Tank asked whether international stature wanted her second sausage. She moved her plate.

Negotiations remained rigorous.

Aiden's verdict. The serving arrangement prioritizes reachable plates and actual food. June and Dez decline a commemorative announcement, while Velvet retains both sausages under a clear and vigorously defended claim.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-game Steam description is very brief ('A simple 3d puzzle game'); source supports identity and basic genre, not detailed control or difficulty certification. Scene is original fiction. Specific input and full-game timing remain to be checked.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/353540/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P124 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Snakebird

Edition considered: PC original game

Guide an awkward growing creature through spatial puzzles, if planning around its shape sounds like an enjoyable challenge to explore.

What you do. Move the creature through a puzzle arrangement and account for how its changing shape affects the possible route.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The developer calls the puzzles challenging; colorful creatures and limited controls do not establish easy reasoning.

Why it might click. Snakebird makes the length and shape of its fruit-eating creatures central to spatial puzzles. What looks like a small comic animal becomes a tool for crossing, supporting and arranging a route. The attraction is the way a simple change in body length changes the whole problem.

The full catch. The developer explicitly calls the game deceptively challenging. A friendly drawing and a small board should not be sold as easy reasoning. Check directional input, switching between creatures and recovery from mistakes. The card does not establish universal no-timing behavior from genre alone; its strongest case is for a player who enjoys concentrated spatial experimentation.

Try this first. Try the earliest fruit-and-exit arrangement. Notice what the new length permits before attempting to plan several moves ahead.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P124 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Snakebird

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Feather Boa Outgrew the Floor Plan

Snakebird's changing shape suggested a problem Velvet had already brought into the room: every time she improved her costume, it occupied another chair.

Her feather boa crossed the model map like a glamorous river.

Mika lifted one end. Rae moved the snack bowl away from the other. Remy said the outfit now required its own entrance music and a turning permit.

"Nigga, it's called presence," Velvet said.

Kit measured the proposed stage passage with a ribbon. Velvet tried the turn, caught a feather on my portrait stand, and removed the portrait without consulting its subject.

The turn worked.

I argued that the obstruction had been artistically important. Velvet wrapped the boa around my shoulders and invited me to demonstrate a better route.

I became trapped between two chairs while everybody watched. Shawna freed one end, kissed my cheek, and asked whether presence wanted help.

Presence accepted. The stage passage became wider, and my portrait began another involuntary tour of the building.

Aiden's verdict. The costume gets a tested turning space and the portrait gets relocated. Presence may request assistance without surrendering glamour, a provision I endorse after briefly becoming part of the furniture.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/357300/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P125 / A PLACE TO START

Snakebird Primer

Edition considered: PC separate prequel game

Try a gentler introduction to Snakebird's spatial idea, if a clearer opening challenge makes discovering its rules more appealing.

What you do. Work through the separate Primer game's introductory puzzles, moving the creature and learning how its shape affects each route.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. This is the easier separate game, not a guarantee of effortless puzzles; movement and undo still need checking.

Why it might click. Snakebird Primer is a separate set of puzzles designed as a more approachable introduction to Snakebird's spatial ideas. The developer explicitly contrasts its easier island with the original game's serious challenges. It can be a useful place to discover whether moving and shaping these creatures is pleasurable before choosing the harder title.

The full catch. Easier is a comparison, not a personal guarantee. Directional movement, visual planning and keeping track of a changing shape still matter. Check undo, restart and control repetition in the exact release. The appeal remains puzzle logic rather than rich character dialogue, and a player need not graduate to the original game to justify enjoying this one.

Try this first. Complete or explore one introductory arrangement, focusing on how fruit changes the creature. Let curiosity about the next idea decide whether to continue.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, we're good.

P125 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Snakebird Primer

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Introductory Boa Saved My Marriage

After the full feather arrangement defeated me, Kit proposed a smaller rehearsal costume. Snakebird Primer was on the screen, offering a gentler introduction to its own spatial ideas.

Velvet selected a short scarf and draped it around my shoulders.

"Training wheels, nigga."

I strode toward the stage, turned cleanly, and bowed. Remy played a fanfare so ridiculous I forgot to be offended. Shawna applauded with actual affection rather than the earlier rescue expression.

June said Dez had once practiced an entrance through a doorway with a jacket over one shoulder. Dez said the jacket had belonged to June, who had invented the rehearsal story to get it back.

"Did it work?" Rae asked.

"Ask the jacket," June said.

Velvet took the scarf and showed me how one small movement could look deliberate. No collision. No rented spotlight. I tried again.

Shawna crooked a finger from the front row. The rehearsal suddenly had a destination that made my extravagant entrance budget seem very poorly targeted.

Aiden's verdict. The smaller rehearsal succeeds before the full costume returns. June's jacket history remains contested, and my best entrance cue turns out to be one finger from the front row.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1014140/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P126 / A PLACE TO START

A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build

Edition considered: PC release

Make charming snowmen through compact spatial puzzles, if arranging a small scene is enough motivation to think through a problem.

What you do. Move around each small space and manipulate snowballs to find an arrangement that makes the intended snowman work.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed and keyboard-only declarations help, but exact movement, holding and planning demands remain worth checking.

Why it might click. A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build makes a small, affectionate premise into a spatial puzzle: a monster creating snowmen. The compact scenes invite attention to a few objects and how their positions relate. It can offer a satisfying repeated activity without needing a sprawling world or a dense inventory story.

The full catch. The current developer listing declares play without timed input and keyboard-only support. Check movement, undo and snowball manipulation on the chosen device; those declarations do not establish that every action avoids holding. The puzzles still require planning and trial, so the gentle presentation should not become a promise of effortless solutions. Narrative is limited to the charm of the activity.

Try this first. Try making one snowman and notice where your first plan changes. Learn the recovery control before treating a mistaken move as a reason to restart everything.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P126 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Snowman Had Better Posture Than the Host

A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build made Kit fall in love with the idea of three rounded lanterns beside the signing table. I ordered them in gold.

Mika stacked the largest at the bottom. I suggested putting it on top for greater impact.

Rae stared at me. "Impact is exactly what I'm worried about."

The lanterns stayed in Mika's order. Remy added a little hat, and suddenly the decoration looked like a cheerful guest who had read the dress code.

June called it handsome. Dez said she had dated men with worse balance, then caught June laughing into her sleeve.

I gave the lantern guest my ceremonial sash. It wore the thing without complaining, moving, or requesting a speaking slot. Velvet suggested making it co-host.

"Nigga, I paid for him."

"And he's already doing less damage."

Shawna straightened my own jacket. We stood beside the finished arrangement for a photograph, two round-shouldered dignitaries of notably different competence.

Aiden's verdict. The lantern stack remains largest at the bottom and gains an honorary co-hosting role. I retain the microphone, but the decoration sets a demanding standard for quiet reliability.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/316610/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P127 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Cosmic Express

Edition considered: PC release

Design a tiny railway for unusual passengers, if finding a route within tight space and capacity limits sounds satisfying.

What you do. Draw or arrange tracks through the station so the train can collect and deliver its passengers in a workable order.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The puzzles are explicitly difficult; test track input despite declared untimed play and keyboard-only or mouse-only options.

Why it might click. Cosmic Express asks you to lay railway routes through small space stations and deliver their residents. The one-passenger constraint makes the order of visits important. Its appeal is the clean relationship between a visible route and the consequences that follow from it.

The full catch. The developer describes the puzzles as difficult and separately declares play without timed input, with keyboard-only and mouse-only options. Drawing tracks may still involve sustained pointer actions, so test the intended input method. Cute passengers do not reduce the planning burden: a compact station can hold a demanding puzzle. The declared input options do not certify hold-free interaction.

Try this first. Draw a route in an early station and watch one passenger's trip. Test editing or resetting the route before trying to optimize a complicated arrangement.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P127 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Cosmic Express

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Drinks Trolley Could Not Carry the Entire Coalition

Cosmic Express made route order matter on its small space stations. Our drinks trolley demonstrated the same principle by arriving at the stage with everything except room for its driver.

Tank had balanced flowers, cups, a speaker, and my ceremonial cushion on it.

"Nigga, you packed this like a hotel evacuation."

Mika separated the deliveries. First the speaker, then flowers, then drinks. Kit wanted the microphone tested before the cups appeared, which prevented Remy from attempting both jobs with one hand.

I objected to the number of trips. Rae asked how many drinks I planned to catch when the original arrangement tipped.

We made three calm journeys. On the last, Nia carried a small glass for Rae instead of adding it to the trolley. Rae accepted it with a look no transport diagram could improve.

Dez watched them and nudged June. June pretended to inspect the wheels, smiling at a mechanical feature nobody else could see.

Aiden's verdict. The trolley makes separate trips in a useful order. Nia handles one drink personally, and the transport committee declines to investigate the improvement this causes in Rae's mood.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option plus Mouse Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/583270/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P128 / A PLACE TO START

A Monster's Expedition

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a playful museum of human oddities through spatial puzzles, with discoveries and jokes giving the journey a welcoming purpose.

What you do. Explore the islands, solve environmental arrangements and investigate exhibits that offer an unusual outside view of human habits.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The charm accompanies real spatial reasoning, while movement, undo and object manipulation still need checking.

Why it might click. A Monster's Expedition combines tree-pushing spatial puzzles with comic museum observations about humanity. Small islands form a larger exploratory structure, so solving a route can lead to both a new place and a new joke. It offers a particular mix of thoughtful manipulation and dry amusement.

The full catch. The developer describes simple mechanics with substantial depth. That depth can mean difficult planning even when the action vocabulary is small. Check movement, undo, reset and the readability of the islands and exhibits. Its open structure should not be treated as proof that every puzzle is optional or that every route remains easy.

Try this first. Solve or experiment with one early crossing, then read the nearby exhibit. Judge whether the combination of puzzle and joke makes you want another island.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P128 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Monster's Expedition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Museum Put My Bad Idea on Display

A Monster's Expedition offered comic observations about human objects, so Remy created a summit museum from the equipment we had rejected.

The unattached lever occupied the central plinth. My gigantic welcome sign leaned behind it. Beside both sat the miniature signing table.

Kit wrote captions.

"Primitive host believed size created authority."

"Nigga, that is slander with good lettering."

June donated a Blue Comet jukebox token. Dez supplied a jacket button she claimed June had torn off during the famous borrowed-jacket argument. June said it had fallen naturally from a cheap seam.

Dez's eyebrows rose. "Watch yourself."

The museum drew a larger crowd than my proposed leadership display. Velvet offered to deliver the audio guide for a proper fee. I tried one recorded caption and found myself laughing halfway through.

Shawna added a photograph of the two of us beside the lantern guest. Her caption said TWO HOSTS, ONE LEARNING. I refused to ask which one had completed the course.

Aiden's verdict. The museum preserves rejected equipment and contradictory Blue Comet relics. Velvet may quote for narration, while my leadership display is absorbed into a more popular history of practical mistakes.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1052990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P129 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Bonfire Peaks

Edition considered: PC release

Work through spatial puzzles with a reflective theme of carrying and letting go, if that combination feels intriguing to you.

What you do. Move through puzzle spaces, arrange what you carry and examine how the next position changes the problem's possibilities.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Its voxel spaces can be demanding to reason about; exact controls and full-game timing still need checking.

Why it might click. Bonfire Peaks presents a spatial puzzle journey organized around closure and moving onward. Its compact, sculptural environments make objects and their placement visually central. It may appeal when the satisfaction of an exact arrangement is strengthened by a quiet theme about what people carry.

The full catch. The primary description promises rewarding challenges and evolving mechanics, not low difficulty. Manipulating objects in three-dimensional puzzle spaces may require careful orientation and planning. Check the actual movement and object controls before assuming the fixed-looking presentation eliminates physical demands. The emotional theme is suggestive rather than a richly voiced character drama.

Try this first. Inspect an early puzzle, learn one object interaction and test how to recover from a mistake. Continue only if the precise arrangement feels absorbing rather than burdensome.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P129 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Bonfire Peaks

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / We Burned Nothing and Still Let It Go

Bonfire Peaks put closure and what people carry at the center of its puzzle journey. I looked at the pile of abandoned ceremony proposals and suggested a spectacular bonfire.

The hotel manager said no before I finished spectacular.

Dez picked up the supposedly unsigned Blue Comet agreement. June reached for it, then stopped. Both suddenly looked less interested in making jokes.

"We're not throwing that away," Dez said.

"Didn't say we were," June answered.

Rae brought a flat box. They placed the paper inside, keeping its creases and arguments intact. Mika labeled another box for rented equipment returns. My costly lever went there after a brief, unpersuasive appeal.

Shawna asked what I wanted to keep from this afternoon. I took the little photograph of us and left the gold sign behind.

"Nigga," Tank said, "growth got a return receipt."

We carried the boxes downstairs. Nothing burned. The room still felt as though somebody had opened a window.

Aiden's verdict. The old agreement is preserved, rented mistakes are returned, and no bonfire takes place. My photograph stays with me while the gold sign discovers the practical meaning of closure.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1147890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P130 / A PLACE TO START

Can of Wormholes

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a deep puzzle world with hints you can play, if learning through a smaller demonstration sounds more enjoyable than reading explanations.

What you do. Move through the puzzle situations, experiment with solutions and use playable hints to discover the underlying ideas when needed.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Explicit untimed input and unlimited undo are helpful; deeper reasoning and device-specific control comfort still matter.

Why it might click. Can of Wormholes develops many interactions from a small collection of puzzle objects. Its distinctive strength for this catalogue is a documented playable hint system: a smaller related stage can suggest the insight needed for the larger one. Experimentation and discovery are the main rewards.

The full catch. The developer explicitly states that no time-critical inputs or simultaneous key presses are required, and documents unlimited undo and restart. Those are unusually useful concrete claims. Keyboard or gamepad play is supported, with a Mac gamepad limitation noted by the developer. Spatial reasoning and learning new interactions can still be demanding; hold behavior should be checked separately.

Try this first. Try an introductory stage, use undo once and inspect a playable hint if curiosity stalls. Learn how the support works before a difficult puzzle makes it feel urgent.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P130 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Can of Wormholes

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hint Came with a Smaller Disaster

Can of Wormholes offered a playable smaller problem as a hint, which gave Rae an idea for our spectacularly tangled ribbon arch.

Instead of lecturing, she laid three short strips on a tray.

"Show me how these cross without hiding the opening."

I solved the small arrangement after two attempts. Then I looked at the full arch and finally saw what Mika had been explaining for ten minutes.

"Nigga, why didn't we start with the tray?" "We just did."

Kit tried the same little model before helping move the long ribbons. Velvet adjusted one corner for her costume. Remy tested his walk through with the microphone case.

The arch stayed decorative without becoming a curtain. I offered to teach the method to everybody else, claiming broad experience in miniature infrastructure.

Shawna handed me the tray and another three strips, this time arranged differently.

My lecture was postponed while I acquired a little more broad experience.

Aiden's verdict. The arch keeps an open passage after the small demonstration. Rae receives credit for the teaching method, and my masterclass waits until I can solve its second example.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Developer Steam description explicitly says no time-critical input or simultaneous key presses, unlimited undo/restart and playable hints; gamepad on Mac is not currently supported in that description. This supports the stated narrow timing claims, not universal hold-free operation.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1295320/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Dez Refused to Let the Jacket Lose on a Technicality

The costume rehearsal stopped when June noticed a loose thread at Dez's cuff. She reached for it. Dez caught her wrist gently.

"Leave it. You'll make it worse."

"I drove a bus full of people through winter. I can manage a thread."

"That's why I never let the bus hem my clothes."

Rae laughed into her drink. Nia tried not to, failed, and ended up holding the glass while Rae found a small sewing kit. Dez accepted the kit with the calm of somebody returning to familiar tools. June stayed beside her despite having several strong opinions about being supervised.

The jacket lay across both their knees. It had belonged to June first. It had spent enough time with Dez that every repair was also a small account of where it had been. Neither woman needed me to explain this, so naturally I began.

Shawna put a sandwich in my mouth.

Dez repaired the cuff. June held the little lamp at a useful angle without commenting on the appointment. Velvet came over to inspect the work and asked whether Dez would look at a loose fastening on her costume.

"For you, yes."

I offered to make the work an official heritage demonstration. Dez told me to finish chewing.

The repairs were small, exact, and almost invisible when done. They made the clothes behave better without making their wearers into examples of anything. Remy tried his stage turn nearby. Kit adjusted the light and accidentally directed it into my eyes, which everybody regarded as an acceptable temporary arrangement.

When Dez handed the jacket back to June, the room went quiet for one beat. June inspected the cuff, nodded, and helped Dez put it on again.

"There," she said.

"About time you returned it," Dez answered.

The old argument resumed before I could declare peace. Nia laughed properly this time, and Rae looked at her as if the sound had improved the room.

Mika called us back to the rehearsal route. The table still needed checking, the curtain still needed its final position, and the jacket had won the right to keep going without a plaque.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P131 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Braid, Anniversary Edition

Edition considered: PC Anniversary Edition

Explore platform puzzles that manipulate time, if clever movement challenges are appealing enough to accept their physical and timing demands.

What you do. Move through platforming spaces and use the game's time-manipulation ideas to reconsider routes, mistakes and puzzle solutions.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Rewinding does not remove timed jumps or other platforming demands, so this remains an action detour.

Why it might click. Braid, Anniversary Edition combines platform movement with puzzles built around unusual behavior of time. Its story and images concern memory, desire and regret. The new edition also includes extensive creator commentary, offering another route into the design for someone interested in how a game thinks.

The full catch. Rewinding does not remove jumping, hazards or required movement timing. The developer explicitly describes platforming and changing time mechanics. This is a conditional action-puzzle detour, not a standard no-rush fit. Check movement, jump combinations and rewind holds separately; a forgiving recovery system can reduce failure cost without reducing the action itself.

Try this first. Try one introductory movement puzzle and the rewind control. If the physical action is unwelcome, consider the design commentary as an interest to investigate rather than forcing play.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P131 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Braid, Anniversary Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / You Cannot Rewind a Champagne Invoice

Braid's strange behavior of time made me wish I could rewind the instant I had ordered a champagne fountain. It was currently blocking the signing table.

I stepped backward and repeated the purchasing conversation aloud, this time making a wiser decision.

The delivery driver still wanted a signature.

"Nigga, your performance doesn't change the invoice," Velvet said.

June offered an older example of regret: lending Dez the famous jacket in 1967. Dez said the jacket had improved dramatically while absent from its owner.

Kit watched their argument, then asked whether either woman regretted the entire evening.

Both went quiet.

Mika moved the fountain to a side table and replaced its towering decoration with a small bowl. The room became workable without pretending the purchase had never happened.

Shawna took my hand and walked me forward to the chairs. I could still choose what happened next. Unfortunately, next included paying the driver before he missed his actual dinner.

Aiden's verdict. The fountain moves aside and the invoice remains in chronological order. June and Dez reserve judgment on their old evening; I practice making the next decision smaller.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/499180/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P132 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

World of Goo

Edition considered: PC original game

Build unusual structures from connected creatures, if watching a physical construction succeed or wobble sounds like the pleasure you want.

What you do. Place and connect the available pieces, observe how the structure behaves and revise the arrangement when it fails.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Physics, precision and dragging can add pressure or sustained input; inspect the chosen level and controls directly.

Why it might click. World of Goo turns drag-and-drop construction into a physics puzzle with a comic corporate world around it. Structures bend, balance and fail in visible ways, so a small design change can be satisfying to test. Its personality comes from the creatures, signs and increasingly strange purposes of the construction work.

The full catch. The primary description explicitly says drag and drop. Holding and positioning the pointer may therefore be a central barrier. Physics unfolds while structures are running, and hazards vary by level, so do not assume an unlimited-waiting solution from the word puzzle. Check the ordinary building loop before becoming invested in the larger campaign.

Try this first. Build the smallest useful connection in an early level and watch it behave. Test selecting, dragging and releasing one piece before attempting an elaborate tower.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P132 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

World of Goo

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Garland Had Faith and No Support

World of Goo's bending constructions looked uncannily like the garland I had commissioned between two costume racks. Every new decoration made it sag closer to Remy's microphone.

I called the curve elegant.

Rae called for the hotel rigger.

The rigger gave us two sensible attachment points and removed half my decorative ambition. Velvet watched the garland settle, then selected a few pieces worth keeping. Kit arranged them where the lights could reach.

"Nigga," Tank said, "you bought enough sparkle to test gravity personally."

I suggested adding one more gold ball. The rigger looked at me without moving.

We left the ball in its box.

Remy walked beneath the finished garland and tried his fanfare. Nothing touched his head. Velvet followed with her boa, turned cleanly, and smiled at the reflection.

I finally understood the attraction of a structure doing exactly what you hoped. Then Shawna held up the unused gold ball and asked whether it was eligible for a refund.

Aiden's verdict. The garland uses proper supports and fewer ornaments. Remy and Velvet pass beneath it successfully, while the spare gold ball awaits a financial miracle more demanding than gravity.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/22000/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P133 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

World of Goo 2

Edition considered: PC sequel

Try new construction and liquid puzzles within World of Goo's satirical world, if experimenting with physical systems sounds entertaining.

What you do. Arrange the available elements, observe their physical behavior and revise the construction to make the current situation work.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. New physical systems can increase demands; check pointer precision, dragging and scene-specific timing before treating it as relaxed.

Why it might click. World of Goo 2 expands the construction idea with flowing liquid, new material behaviors and another satirical corporate story. The attraction is watching a designed structure interact with a physical process, then discovering a better arrangement. It is a distinct sequel with new puzzles rather than an alternative edition of the first game.

The full catch. The developer describes a dangerous world and varied material mechanics. Pointer precision, holding or dragging, moving liquid and level-specific hazards need assessment. Do not assume that familiarity with one type of goo makes the complete game mechanically simple. This is most plausible when hands-on construction is itself enjoyable, not merely a route to the jokes.

Try this first. Try one early construction problem and observe how one material behaves. Check whether editing the structure feels comfortable before attempting to manage several interactions at once.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P133 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

World of Goo 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Sequel Introduced Liquid to My Bad Idea

World of Goo 2 brought new material behavior to its construction puzzles. I brought liquid to our stage problem by proposing a decorative water channel around the signing table.

Mika loved it for three seconds, which was three seconds longer than Rae.

"Nigga, where do the cables go?"

I drew a very optimistic bridge.

Velvet asked where her train went. Kit asked where the chairs went. Tank asked whether the water was drinkable, then lost interest when it wasn't.

Mika erased their initial sketch and designed a reflection using a shallow decorative bowl well away from the equipment. The hotel technician approved its location. Mercedes tested the lights above it.

The effect looked almost exactly like the expensive thing I had imagined, except nobody had to step over my imagination to reach a chair.

I claimed collaboration had refined the vision. Shawna wrote DOWNGRADED MOAT on the back of the original drawing and slipped it into Remy's museum.

Aiden's verdict. The proposed moat becomes a modest reflection away from equipment and walking routes. Remy's museum receives another drawing, this one documenting the brief naval phase of my stage design.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/3385670/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P134 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

HUMANITY

Edition considered: PC non-VR mode proposed for assessment

Direct striking crowds through puzzle spaces as a dog, if the unusual spectacle appeals alongside more active stages and challenges.

What you do. Guide crowds through environments, place or use directions and respond to the puzzle and action situations along the route.

Mixed controls | Action continues while you think | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Action, platforming and bosses are documented, so the crowd-routing premise does not make the whole game untimed.

Why it might click. HUMANITY turns crowd direction into a striking puzzle-action spectacle. A dog places commands that shape the movement of many people, making routes and group behavior visible at a large scale. Its visual ideas may appeal to someone who enjoys watching a small instruction transform a complex scene.

The full catch. The developer explicitly includes action-focused stages, platform-like elements and boss battles. This prevents an unqualified no-rush recommendation. Navigation, command placement and the behavior of moving crowds need checking, and the ordinary-screen version should be assessed separately from VR. A clever planning premise does not remove required reactions elsewhere.

Try this first. Inspect an introductory routing stage and test one command. Treat later action sections as a real selection barrier, not a detail to discover after making a commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P134 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

HUMANITY

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dog Was Better at Crowd Direction

HUMANITY's dog directing crowds made me wonder whether our rehearsal needed fewer speeches and clearer instructions. This was an unpleasant idea because speeches were my principal contribution.

Mika asked everyone to try the entrance once.

I stood beside the arch and delivered a stirring welcome. Behind me, Kit and Velvet approached the same narrow corner from opposite directions.

Rae raised her hand. Everybody stopped before the costumes touched.

"Nigga, your speech is parked in the road."

We moved my position and marked a simple waiting place with a chair. Remy tried the entrance, then Nia and Rae. June took her time and chatted with Dez halfway through. The route still worked.

I asked whether we should increase the pace for dramatic effect.

Mika shook their head. "The effect is people arriving."

Tank applauded the last crossing with a bread roll in each hand. No grand instruction followed. We had successfully transported the coalition approximately twenty feet without losing a delegate to my introduction.

Aiden's verdict. The entrance rehearsal keeps clear waiting space and ordinary pace. My speech moves out of the path, permitting delegates to arrive without navigating around the ceremonial meaning of arrival.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1581480/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P135 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

COCOON

Edition considered: PC release

Explore worlds nested inside portable worlds, if that spatial invention is compelling enough to consider a game with guardian encounters.

What you do. Carry and use world-orbs, move between their environments and work out how the nested spaces relate to each other.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Guardian battles are a concrete action barrier; also check movement and world-handling controls before committing to the journey.

Why it might click. COCOON builds an alien puzzle adventure around worlds contained within portable orbs. Carrying a world into another world changes what can be done, creating a strong visual form of discovery. The appeal is the elegant connection between an object, a place and a new possibility.

The full catch. The official description explicitly includes guardian battles with new mechanics. A small-looking action vocabulary therefore does not prove a no-reaction experience. Check movement, aiming or triggering abilities, required timing and the effect of failure. This is a narrow puzzle-adventure detour for someone interested in those interactions, not a default quiet-game recommendation.

Try this first. Try the first world-and-orb interaction to see whether its logic feels satisfying. Preview a representative guardian encounter before assuming that the opening describes the full game.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P135 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

COCOON

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Mika Put the Ballroom Inside a Snow Globe

COCOON's worlds within portable orbs made Mika hold up their newest model: a tiny ballroom inside a clear sphere. They wanted it on the signing table.

I wanted it on a revolving pedestal.

Rae wanted enough table left for hands.

We tested the sphere beside the paper. Nia leaned in to write and bumped it with her sleeve. The ballroom rolled majestically toward Tank, who caught an entire civilization against his stomach.

"Nigga, this world needs a flat bottom."

Mika fetched a stand. Velvet moved the sphere to a separate display, where its little stage looked more impressive without competing with the actual one.

Kit peered inside and found miniature chairs facing a miniature portrait. She turned the portrait toward the wall.

I demanded respect for scale.

Shawna held up the globe so I could inspect the correction. Inside, a tiny unobstructed table waited for imaginary guests. I had to admit the world within our world had improved.

Aiden's verdict. The model ballroom stays in a stable display beside the ceremony. Its miniature portrait faces the wall until I produce evidence that tiny guests enjoy being watched while writing.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1497440/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P136 / A PLACE TO START

Gorogoa

Edition considered: PC release

Discover surprising connections between illustrated panels, if rearranging pictures into something newly meaningful sounds like a satisfying kind of puzzle.

What you do. Move or arrange illustrated panels, inspect their details and follow the relationships that emerge when images connect differently.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Panel dragging and exact pointer control need checking; visual calm does not establish hold-free interaction.

Why it might click. Gorogoa tells its story through illustrated panels that the player arranges and combines. Its puzzles depend on visual relationships, scale and the possibility that one image can become part of another. The result can feel like discovering how a picture thinks rather than manipulating a conventional inventory.

The full catch. Panel movement and visual precision are the main checks. The store supports arranging and combining images, but not a complete hold-free control claim. Inspect whether dragging, zooming or small targets are comfortable on the chosen device. The story is largely visual and interpretive, which may be appealing or may feel less concrete than dialogue-led mysteries.

Try this first. Move or inspect one panel in the opening arrangement and watch for a new relationship. Focus on that single change before trying to explain the whole story.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P136 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Gorogoa

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Windows Made a Picture My Face Could Not Improve

Gorogoa's illustrated panels made Mercedes suggest a backdrop composed of separate framed scenes. Kit found old window frames in the hotel's prop store. Mika arranged them on approved stands.

I brought four photographs of myself.

Mercedes turned them facedown.

She used a courtyard sketch, a photograph of June and Dez's jukebox token, a corner of the venue map, and a blank panel that caught the room's reflection. From one angle they looked unrelated. From another, the doorway in the sketch met the real doorway beyond it.

Velvet stepped into the reflected panel and stopped.

"Oh. That's mine."

Then Remy appeared beside her, ruining the solemnity with a grin. She elbowed him gently out of her light.

"Nigga," I said, "the art keeps changing."

Shawna stood beside me in the reflection. Mercedes adjusted one frame, and the background suddenly included everybody carrying chairs instead of just the people posing. I put my photographs back in the envelope.

Aiden's verdict. The backdrop combines separate views and leaves space for whoever crosses its reflection. Mercedes rejects four host portraits, preserving the room's ability to show more than its purchaser.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/557600/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P137 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Monument Valley: Panoramic Edition

Edition considered: PC Panoramic Edition

Explore impossible-looking architecture through a visual puzzle journey, if changing perspective and opening a path sounds appealing to you.

What you do. Inspect each architectural scene and manipulate its structures to create a route through the changing arrangement of shapes.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Pushing, pulling and clicking need a hold-and-drag check on this PC edition, despite its approachable presentation.

Why it might click. Monument Valley guides Ida through compact architectural illusions. Manipulating parts of the monuments changes which paths connect, giving visual discovery a clear purpose. The Panoramic PC presentation can suit someone drawn to beautiful, contained spaces rather than a freely steered open world.

The full catch. The developer describes pushing, pulling, clicking, raising and lowering parts of the scenery. Those operations need a hold-and-drag check; the game's approachable marketing is not a control guarantee. The current Steam header uses Monument Valley, while its description explicitly identifies the Panoramic edition. Keep that edition scope when checking settings and input.

Try this first. Complete one early architectural transformation and send Ida along the new path. Test the manipulation itself before deciding that the quiet presentation matches the desired physical comfort.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P137 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Monument Valley: Panoramic Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Staircase Worked Beautifully in the Photograph

Monument Valley's impossible-looking paths encouraged Mika to angle two stage panels so a staircase appeared to continue into the painted backdrop.

The illusion was gorgeous. I announced that visitors could ascend into symbolic unity.

Rae put a hand on my chest before I demonstrated.

"Nigga, that's paint."

Kit laughed so hard she lost her glasses again. Dez found them on the table and used one arm as a pointer while explaining exactly where my symbolic foot would have gone.

We marked the painted staircase as scenery and kept the real path beside it. Velvet tried the view from the audience, then chose the spot where her silver costume made the architecture look even stranger.

Mika took a photograph. I stood on the actual floor with Shawna and pointed upward as if we had commissioned the laws of perspective.

Remy called it a magnificent ascent. Rae called it two people staying where the stage technician had told them.

Aiden's verdict. The architectural illusion remains scenery, with the real path clearly separate. Velvet claims its best photographic angle, and my symbolic ascent is completed entirely on the actual floor.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected correct Steam app 1927720. Current header shortens the name, but detailed description explicitly identifies Panoramic Edition and manipulation actions. Wrong or unresolved automatic cache excluded. Holds/timing not certified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1927720/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P138 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition

Edition considered: PC Panoramic Edition

Follow a story of care and independence through architectural puzzles, if the relationship gives the changing spaces a stronger reason to explore.

What you do. Guide the journey through changing structures and manipulate the architecture as the relationship between the two travelers develops.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The PC description explicitly calls for clicking and dragging; check held movement, targets and recovery from mistakes.

Why it might click. Monument Valley 2 connects architectural illusion with a story of Ro and her child. The changing paths give its themes of care and independence a visual form. The developer describes it as a standalone adventure, so interest in this relationship does not require finishing the first game.

The full catch. The PC description explicitly calls for clicking and dragging to reshape the world. That is a concrete conditional barrier, even though the presentation is calm. Check how long manipulations must be held, target size and recovery from an unintended movement. The current storefront's shorter title still identifies the Panoramic edition in its detailed description.

Try this first. Try one early interaction involving the two travelers and the structure around them. Assess the drag action before assuming that a gentle story means physically effortless play.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P138 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Auntie June Let Dez Find Her Own Spotlight

Monument Valley 2's journey of care and independence arrived at exactly the wrong moment for June to direct Dez's rehearsal entrance.

"Left," June said. Dez went right.

"The good light is left."

"The woman wearing this jacket is right."

I offered to resolve the disagreement with a third spotlight. Velvet told me to let the entrance happen before renting a galaxy.

Dez walked to the position she preferred and looked back. June had stopped giving instructions. She was holding the old Blue Comet button between two fingers, smiling despite herself.

Kit moved the light slightly. The jacket caught it beautifully.

"Nigga, you could've just asked," Rae told me when I began claiming credit for the compromise.

I asked Shawna where she wanted to stand in our photograph. She chose a place I had not considered. I joined her there and discovered my own best side was apparently wherever she had decided to laugh.

Aiden's verdict. Dez chooses her place and Kit adjusts the light around the actual entrance. June keeps the button, while I learn to ask where Shawna wants to stand.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected correct Steam app 1927740. Detailed text identifies Panoramic Edition and explicitly describes clicking and dragging. Wrong or unresolved automatic cache excluded. Calm presentation is not a hold-free guarantee.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1927740/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P139 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Room

Edition considered: PC original game

Investigate an elaborate puzzle box, if noticing small details and uncovering a mechanism feels more inviting than navigating a large world.

What you do. Inspect the box closely, examine its details and manipulate mechanisms to discover what the object is concealing.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Turning, zooming and dragging remain unresolved comfort checks; the primary premise does not certify a fully untimed route.

Why it might click. The Room offers close inspection of elaborate mechanical objects within an atmospheric mystery. Cryptic letters and unusual devices give each discovered mechanism a little narrative weight. Its concentrated setting may appeal more than walking through a large world, especially when the desired activity is examining something with a purpose.

The full catch. Close-up object puzzles can demand rotation, zooming, sliding and held pointer movement. The primary PC description calls the experience tactile but does not certify click-only controls. Check a representative latch or dial and the readability of details. The eerie tone may also matter even if the player is not controlling a combat character.

Try this first. Inspect the first object, identify one movable part and test the exact interaction. Learn how to leave a close-up before proceeding through several layers.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P139 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Room

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Pen Came in a Box with an Attitude

The Room's elaborate mechanical objects gave the pen supplier ideas nobody had authorized. Our ceremonial pen arrived inside a polished box with sliding panels and no obvious opening.

Rae wanted a pen. I wanted an unveiling.

Kit examined the seams while Remy read the enclosed letter in his deepest stage voice. Velvet asked whether the box contained wages.

"No." "Then lower the voice."

Mika found the simple catch underneath. The lid opened before I could finish describing the mystery. Inside lay a perfectly ordinary pen on far too much velvet.

Nia tried it on scrap paper. Her handwriting remained spectacularly terrible.

"Nigga," Rae said, smiling, "we spent all that money to reveal a problem we already knew."

I offered the pen another unveiling in better light. Shawna handed Nia a second sheet instead.

She wrote slowly this time. Rae could read her own name. Nobody else got to ask why that was the practice word.

Aiden's verdict. The ornate box opens and the ordinary pen writes. Nia practices on scrap paper, while the supplier's dramatic packaging is denied a separate appearance in the ceremony.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/288160/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P140 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Room Two

Edition considered: PC release

Continue The Room's mechanical mystery in broader spaces, if examining objects remains enjoyable and a larger investigation sounds welcome.

What you do. Investigate objects and mechanisms, follow the scientist's letters and connect discoveries across the spaces presented by the game.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Expanded environments add location and object memory, while turning, zooming and dragging still need a PC-specific check.

Why it might click. The Room Two continues the series' mechanical mystery while expanding the spaces and objects to investigate. Following an enigmatic scientist's letters gives the tactile puzzle work a thread to pursue. It may suit someone who liked the first game's close observation and wants a broader version of that activity.

The full catch. An expanded environment can add object and location memory to the familiar manipulation demands. Check turning, zooming, dragging and moving between viewpoints in the PC release rather than carrying over assumptions from a mobile version. The primary source establishes a rebuilt PC edition, not universal comfort or a completely untimed completion path.

Try this first. Investigate one object in the opening area and complete a single interaction chain. Notice whether finding the next relevant object feels inviting or starts to become visual clutter.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P140 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Room Two

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Second Box Had the First Box's Instructions

The Room Two was expanding its mechanical mystery just as a second package arrived from our pen supplier. I accepted it with the confidence of a man already defeated by one small catch.

Inside were instructions for opening the first box.

Tank looked from the paper to the open lid. "Nigga, the sequel arrived late."

Remy offered to read the instructions as a tragic monologue. Velvet requested a comic one and named her fee for laughing on cue.

Kit sorted the useful paper from the promotional nonsense. Mika found a proper diagram for changing the pen cartridge, which we kept near the spare.

June watched Dez test the pen. "You could've signed in sixty-seven with that."

"I could've signed with anything. You wouldn't stop changing the song."

They looked at each other, neither reaching for the old agreement. Rae returned the new pen to its easy-open tray. The present ceremony did not need to solve every old argument before having working equipment.

Aiden's verdict. The useful cartridge diagram stays with the spare pen. Remy's instruction monologue is deferred, and the new ceremony remains equipped without pretending to conclude the Blue Comet dispute.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/425580/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

The Camera Did Not Get to Name Everybody

The photographer arrived during the costume check and asked where he should put the men.

Remy raised one hand. Tank raised a bread roll. I stepped into the best light on instinct.

The photographer pointed at Velvet, Kit, and Rae.

"Also you three. The masculine side of the group."

Velvet looked down at her silver costume, then back at him.

"Baby, if this is your idea of masculine, I need to see what you wore to work yesterday."

His name was Owen. He was an adult gay man hired by the hotel, which he told us immediately, as if the information might excuse the photograph before he took it. It did not make him a villain. It also did not arrange anybody's feet.

"I meant the presentation," he said.

"Then ask about the picture you want," Remy said. "Don't assign people a whole life to get a balanced triangle."

I offered to form the triangle around myself. Shawna moved me two feet to the left and improved the conversation.

Owen lowered the camera and claimed he had meant to separate sharp tailoring from flowing costumes. Velvet looked down at the dress he had put on the tailored side. Even his excuse needed rearranging.

Kit considered the new proposal. She was willing to stand beside the silver costume. Rae wanted to remain beside Nia. Velvet wanted the light slightly higher. Remy wanted his name used when he was not performing.

These requests did not require a tribunal. Owen listened, adjusted, and began again.

The fees were already protected by the earlier budget argument. I thought that meant the photograph would be easy. Then the hotel's sponsorship coordinator arrived with an opinion nobody had purchased.

Martin was an adult straight man with a cheerful voice and the confidence of somebody accustomed to explaining what would appeal to everyone. He asked whether the photograph could look a little less like a drag show and more like a coalition.

Velvet folded one arm across the other.

"What do you think a coalition looks like?"

"A broader group."

"You're looking at one."

He said he meant the general public. Rae asked which people in the room had ceased to be members of it when they put their clothes on.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

I enjoyed that question so much I nearly repeated it into the microphone. Nia took the microphone off its stand and passed it to Remy before I could turn somebody else's irritation into my own grand moment.

Martin tried to clarify. He wanted the picture to look welcoming. The glitter, the posture, the deliberate styling might appear confrontational to some guests.

Kit glanced at Rae. This time she did not rush to explain Rae's expression for her.

Rae said, "Which posture?"

Martin looked at the camera rather than at her. "I'm not singling anybody out."

"You're already choosing who counts as the public. Tell us who gets left out."

The room became quiet. Owen set his camera on the table.

Martin admitted that he had asked Rae to soften her expression during an earlier test shot. He had described Kit's equally serious face as strong. Hearing the two instructions together embarrassed him more effectively than anything I could have purchased.

Rae did not smile to reward the admission.

"I don't need to perform friendly twice as hard so your brochure can feel relaxed."

Kit looked at her own test image. "And I don't want my picture used as the reasonable version of hers."

June gave a short approving noise from the front row. Then she told both younger women that neither was required to keep a serious expression out of principle if something was funny.

"Nigga, don't let the photographer steal your laugh just because you won't sell it."

Rae laughed at that, which was June's joke earning a response, not Martin's request finally being obeyed.

Owen asked whether everyone wanted a break before the group photograph. Rae said yes. Velvet said she wanted her individual stage pictures first, under the terms already agreed. Kit went to find her glasses. Remy tested the microphone with a joke so bad Martin laughed before remembering he was in trouble.

"You're allowed," Remy told him. "The joke's terrible for everybody."

During the break, Kit sat beside Velvet and asked whether she got tired of having every elaborate outfit treated as a declaration about her entire existence.

Velvet removed one earring. "Sometimes I want it to be a declaration. Sometimes I want you to notice I paid somebody to sew the damn hem."

"How do people know which?"

"They can ask a question smaller than what are you."

Velvet remembered one gay club booking where a man who called her family had then asked her to work for less. Another man at the same club had quietly fixed the payment before the show. She liked remembering both, especially because neither account let anybody use belonging as a discount code.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Kit nodded. She talked about enjoying a good jacket without wanting it interpreted as either a failure to be a woman or a promise to behave like a man. Rae joined them but did not simply echo her. She liked the word stud. It connected to a Black lesbian world she recognized, to people and style and ways of carrying herself that were not available for anybody else's casual relabeling.

"I like what we recognise in each other. I don't want to make your word mine," Kit said.

"Good. I like what we share," Rae said. "I'm still going to tell you when you get me wrong."

June leaned forward. "And leave room for an old Black butch. Some of us were here before your categories got assigned hotel rooms."

Dez touched her sleeve. "You were here before the chairs."

"Still more comfortable than that first jukebox stool."

The room laughed, then returned to the conversation without making either veteran an honorary textbook.

Remy unfastened the small crown from his costume. As King Receipts he could make himself grander, louder, and deliberately ridiculous. As Remy he wanted his date to know he was nervous about the flowers.

"I don't stop being me when the crown comes off," he said. "I just stop charging the room interest."

Velvet snorted. "Keep that one. It almost worked."

Nia asked Rae whether she liked being seen as protective. Rae considered the question.

"Sometimes. When I choose it. I like taking care of people. I also like somebody noticing I'm tired before handing me another box."

Nia set down the box she had been about to offer.

"Oh."

"That one was funny."

They smiled, but the question stayed useful. Caring could be pleasure. It could also become a job people assigned by looking at a body, a jacket, a voice, or the person standing beside it. Rae did not want her tenderness denied. She wanted the right to decide what she did with it.

Kit admitted that she sometimes enjoyed being read as competent before she had earned it. The temptation was especially strong when an event already treated her confidence as less alarming than Rae's. She could not fix that by pretending nobody noticed race, or by claiming Rae's experiences as another version of her own.

"I can stop accepting the comparison as a compliment," she said.

"That's a start," Rae answered. "It doesn't require me to grade the rest of your life."

Owen returned and asked whether they wanted the arrangement kept or changed. He did not call the room boys, girls, masculine, feminine, or brave. He used names. Martin stayed beside him and listened while Mika explained what the picture was for: a record of this evening, not proof that every person outside it would approve.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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Mika set one further condition: each person could approve the photograph and caption before the hotel posted either. Nia added that declining the picture would not mean declining the coalition. Martin wrote that down. It was a smaller promise than universal welcome, and one he could actually keep.

I offered to put a political declaration beneath the photograph.

Nia asked which declaration.

"Something powerful."

"Then know what you mean before ordering the lettering."

Shawna rescued me with a more demanding assignment: stand beside her and look as if I wanted to be there.

We made the picture with Rae next to Nia, Kit near Velvet, Remy holding his crown rather than wearing it, and June and Dez comfortably seated. Some people smiled. Some did not. The photographer took more than one image so nobody had to become the single official expression of an identity.

Afterward, Velvet put her earring back on and asked Owen for the stage light she had originally requested. He adjusted it without explaining himself again.

"Nigga," she said to me, "now watch the entrance."

She stepped through the curtain. The room belonged to her for that moment because she knew exactly what she was doing, and because the rest of us finally had the sense to look.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P141 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Room Three

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate a mysterious island and its intricate mechanisms, if a larger setting makes the invitation to examine objects more compelling.

What you do. Explore the presented spaces, inspect mechanisms and follow clues through the trials associated with the elusive Craftsman.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. More navigation and location memory join close manipulation; dragging, holds and full-game timing remain to be checked.

Why it might click. The Room Three expands mechanical puzzle investigation into a mysterious island and the trials of an elusive Craftsman. Its rebuilt PC presentation offers richly detailed objects and spaces. This is a candidate for someone who enjoys handling intricate mysteries and wants a broader setting around the mechanisms.

The full catch. Broader spaces can increase navigation and remembered-location demands. Close manipulation still needs an exact-device check for turning, dragging and zooming; a mouse interface does not establish that everything is click-only. The inspected description does not certify every later interaction as untimed. Eerie isolation is part of the appeal, so choose it for that mood rather than assuming the title means a quiet decorating game.

Try this first. Inspect the first available mechanism and follow one clue to its consequence. Check manipulation comfort before treating the island's larger mysteries as a commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P141 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Room Three

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Craftsman Had Gone to Lunch

The Room Three's elusive Craftsman had a local equivalent: the hotel carpenter, who had completed our small platform repair and then gone to lunch.

I needed him to approve an additional ornamental arch.

Mika pointed to the completed inspection note. The existing arrangement worked. The extra arch existed only in my expanding imagination.

"Nigga, can't the man eat?" Tank asked.

I described the arch's mysterious significance. Velvet described the practical significance of getting her costume onto the finished stage before nightfall.

Remy tried the microphone position. Kit tested the entrance light. Rae sat at the table and reached the pen without moving a vase. All three actions succeeded, leaving me nothing useful to announce.

The carpenter returned carrying a sandwich. I began my pitch.

He looked at the clear stage, looked at my sketch, and asked what problem the arch solved.

Shawna answered before I could. "He can still see an empty space." The carpenter finished his sandwich in peace.

Aiden's verdict. The approved stage stays as built, and the carpenter keeps his lunch break. My additional arch is filed under problems created by noticing that air occupies no invoice.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/456750/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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P142 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Room 4: Old Sins

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a dollhouse concealing a darker domestic mystery, if detailed rooms and their connections make you want to understand what happened.

What you do. Investigate the dollhouse's rooms, manipulate tactile contraptions and follow the disappearance story through objects and their relationships.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Room switching and object uses add memory work; turning, dragging and complete-path timing remain unverified.

Why it might click. Old Sins frames its mechanical puzzles around an unusual dollhouse and a disappearance at Waldegrave Manor. An engineer, his wife and a sought-after artifact give the investigation a darker domestic story. The PC edition rebuilds the visual presentation around detailed rooms and their interconnections.

The full catch. The dollhouse is a mysterious adult setting, not evidence of simple mechanics. Moving among rooms and tracking object uses can add memory demands; rotating and manipulating mechanisms may involve sustained pointer actions. Check the PC controls directly. The reviewed source establishes the premise and tactile puzzles, but leaves full-game timing and hold requirements unresolved.

Try this first. Explore one dollhouse area and identify what changed after a single mechanism. Continue if the relationship between the small room and the larger mystery feels satisfying.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

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P142 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Room 4: Old Sins

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dollhouse Exposed My Dressing-Room Plans

The Room 4's dollhouse mystery made Mika's model hotel the center of attention again. They had built little versions of the dressing rooms so everyone could test the arrangement.

I had quietly enlarged my own.

Rae lifted the roof. My suite occupied half the model. Velvet's costume rack stood in a space roughly equal to one shoe.

"Nigga, whose disappearance we investigating? The other rooms?"

Kit moved the dividing walls. Remy added a miniature chair near the mirror. Nia placed the quiet room back where the venue annex had agreed it belonged.

I protested that the model was an artistic interpretation. Mika handed me the real measurements. Shawna examined our suddenly smaller suite and nodded. "Still room for what we need."

I became much less interested in square footage.

Velvet tested the improved dressing space with a folded paper stand-in for her boa. It turned cleanly. The dollhouse investigation closed with all rooms found and my secret extension removed.

Aiden's verdict. The dollhouse returns to the agreed measurements, restoring useful dressing space and the quiet room. My unauthorized extension disappears, while Shawna confirms our smaller suite remains entirely sufficient.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1361320/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

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P143 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The House of Da Vinci

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate Leonardo's disappearance through Renaissance machinery, if a fictional historical mystery gives mechanical puzzles a more compelling reason to solve them.

What you do. Inspect the workshop's objects, solve mechanical puzzles and use unusual devices to examine the environment in different ways.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Small details, object memory, viewpoint changes and tactile manipulation need checking; a point-and-click label does not eliminate holds.

Why it might click. As Leonardo's apprentice, investigate his disappearance through mechanical puzzles and hidden objects in a Renaissance setting. Special devices add unusual ways to inspect the environment. The appeal is fictional intrigue joined to elaborate machinery, with an atmosphere inspired by historical inventions rather than a plain sequence of abstract boards.

The full catch. Inspecting objects can involve viewpoint changes and tactile manipulation; do not assume that a point-and-click label eliminates dragging or holds. Puzzles may require noticing small details and remembering where a device belongs. The source describes a fictional adventure, not a history lesson or a verified fully untimed control path. Test the intended PC input arrangement.

Try this first. Examine one early device and identify its moving parts before trying to solve everything nearby. Check whether manipulating it feels pleasant enough to support a longer mystery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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P143 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The House of Da Vinci

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Leonardo Would Have Asked Where the Screws Went

The House of Da Vinci made me want the ceremony to display invention, so I purchased a wooden mechanism that raised a small curtain when a wheel turned.

Rae unpacked it and asked where the screws were.

"Perhaps concealed for discovery."

"Perhaps missing, nigga."

Kit examined the delivery checklist. Remy found the hardware packet inside the decorative wheel. Mika called the hotel technician before anyone attempted an inspired reconstruction.

While we waited, Dez showed June a neat repair she had made to the old jacket lining. June touched the seam and stopped arguing for a whole minute. I nearly rented a spotlight for the occasion.

The technician assembled the curtain device and demonstrated its modest movement. No Renaissance conspiracy. No vanished genius. Just a little curtain that opened when asked.

Velvet tried it and approved the timing of her reveal. Rae put the spare screws in a labeled bag. I called that archival practice because I still needed a dignified contribution.

Aiden's verdict. The small curtain mechanism is assembled by the technician, with spare hardware kept nearby. Velvet approves the reveal, and I supply an impressive name for putting screws in a bag.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/522470/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P144 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The House of Da Vinci 2

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a narrated Renaissance mystery where actions connect past and present, if discovering consequences across time sounds interesting to you.

What you do. Investigate mechanisms, listen to the story and use the time-related device to understand connections between earlier and present conditions.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Redesigned controls are not proof of low demand, and multiple time relationships can add substantial remembering work.

Why it might click. The second House of Da Vinci combines Renaissance mystery, mechanical puzzles and a device that connects past actions with present conditions. The developer describes a fully narrated story and redesigned controls. Those are useful distinctions to check when choosing this installment, particularly if hearing the narrative is part of its appeal.

The full catch. Redesigned controls are not proof of low physical demand. Test the actual manipulation, viewpoint changes and dragging on the PC version. Time travel can increase the number of relationships to remember, and narration does not guarantee that every clue is spoken. The reviewed source does not settle all later timed interactions or the option to avoid sustained input.

Try this first. Try one narrated scene and one mechanical interaction. Notice separately whether the voices help the story and whether the device controls feel comfortable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P144 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The House of Da Vinci 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Past Had Installed the Curtain Backward

The House of Da Vinci 2's connection between past actions and present conditions felt personal when we discovered why the ceremonial curtain kept catching.

Yesterday, I had asked the installer to reverse it so the embroidered crest faced the camera.

Today, the pull ran behind the furniture. "Nigga, your past self owes us labor," Rae said.

I offered to apologize to yesterday. Mika asked me to help move the chair instead.

We restored the original arrangement. Remy read the brief equipment instructions aloud while Kit checked the sightline. Velvet tested the reveal again and emerged at exactly the right place with a magnificent expression of being worth all this trouble.

She was.

Shawna asked whether I had learned anything about giving last-minute artistic directions. I said future Aiden would be exceptionally careful.

She handed me the chair. "Present Aiden can finish."

I carried it back, discovering that time travel remained unnecessary for encountering the consequences of my own decorative taste.

Aiden's verdict. The curtain returns to its intended arrangement and Velvet's reveal works. Past Aiden receives no exemption, future Aiden receives no advance praise, and present Aiden carries the chair.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1259840/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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P145 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The House of Da Vinci 3

Edition considered: PC release

Continue Giacomo's Renaissance adventure through conspiracies and machinery, if the series' characters and atmosphere already make its conclusion appealing to you.

What you do. Follow the concluding story, inspect mechanical puzzles and investigate the time-related mysteries surrounding Giacomo and Leonardo's journey together.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Finale context, manipulation and viewpoint controls make this conditional; full-route timing is not verified by the reviewed source.

Why it might click. The third game concludes Giacomo's adventure with Leonardo, combining mechanical puzzles, time-related mysteries and conspiracies across Italian settings. The developer advertises voiced historical figures within the fictional story. It is most appealing as a continuation for someone already enjoying the series' machinery and atmosphere.

The full catch. A finale can carry more narrative context than a first encounter needs. Its polished presentation and claims of intuitive interaction do not verify click-only play or absence of required holds. Check the PC manipulation and camera behavior, and establish whether prior story knowledge matters to the intended experience. Full-route timing remains unverified in this source pass.

Try this first. Watch or inspect the opening premise without racing onward. If the characters and controls are already familiar, try one mechanism; otherwise consider starting with the first installment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P145 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The House of Da Vinci 3

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Third Revelation Was a Working Light Switch

The House of Da Vinci 3 was concluding an elaborate adventure while our own three-part curtain saga approached its final revelation: the lamp behind it had never been switched on.

I had blamed atmosphere. Kit found the plug.

Remy requested a voiced announcement of the discovery. Velvet told him to save his best voice for the actual entrance, then winked when he tried a ridiculous royal whisper anyway.

"Nigga, one more sequel and this curtain gets its own dressing room," Tank said.

June and Dez sat side by side watching the test. When the light came up, Dez's repaired jacket shimmered at the cuff. June quietly straightened it before anybody took a photograph.

I saw the gesture and kept my mouth shut. Shawna noticed me noticing. She squeezed my hand once.

The final test worked from beginning to end. Curtain, light, entrance, microphone. Four ordinary things, all cooperating. I almost hated how much better it looked than a mystery.

Aiden's verdict. The curtain sequence concludes with a working light and a clear entrance. Remy's royal whisper remains optional, while the equipment declines my proposal to commission a fourth installment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1603640/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P146 / A PLACE TO START

Carto

Edition considered: PC release

Help Carto find her grandmother by rearranging the map itself, if changing geography sounds like a playful way to solve a journey.

What you do. Rearrange map pieces to create paths, then move through the changed world and meet people along the route.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Map manipulation and character movement are separate activities; check dragging, rotation and held movement before settling in.

Why it might click. Carto combines a journey to reunite with Granny with puzzles that rearrange the map itself. Changing the arrangement creates new paths and possibilities in the world. Friendly encounters and varied communities give the spatial puzzle a human thread, offering more story context than an isolated logic board.

The full catch. There are two activities to learn: moving the character and manipulating map pieces. Check rotation, placement, any dragging and the amount of direction holding needed for walking. The peaceful presentation is encouraging, but it does not establish every interaction as untimed or effortless. Later map relationships may demand more spatial reasoning than the first examples suggest.

Try this first. Complete one map change, then walk the resulting route and notice what it changed. Judge whether switching between map thinking and character movement feels natural.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

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P146 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Carto

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / We Could Move the Map Before Moving the Piano

Carto's rearranged map gave Mika a useful way to explain the stage problem. They shifted two paper room shapes and opened a straight route from the dressing area to the microphone.

I preferred the previous arrangement because my portrait faced the entrance.

Rae slid the portrait symbol aside. The route improved further.

"Nigga, the map's discovering freedom."

Kit placed a paper piano near the stage. Mercedes moved it closer to the power supply and asked whether anyone had checked the actual clearance before carrying anything heavy.

We had not. We did.

The revised arrangement worked, though it cost me a little symmetry. Remy pushed two empty chairs through first. Velvet followed with the boa over one arm. Nobody struck the piano, the mirror, or each other's patience.

Shawna drew a tiny heart beside our seats. I left it there instead of adding a host emblem. Some changes to a map made the place feel more like somewhere I wanted to go.

Aiden's verdict. The paper arrangement is tested before the piano moves. The portrait yields its preferred angle, and Shawna's small heart remains the only symbol I decline to enlarge.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1172450/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P147 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Chants of Sennaar

Edition considered: PC release

Decode languages and discover a divided tower's peoples, if understanding symbols is appealing enough to consider the adventure's separate stealth demands.

What you do. Observe conversations and scenes, record meanings in the notebook and revise symbol interpretations while traveling through the tower.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Developer-confirmed guard timing conflicts with a strict no-rush route, despite useful mouse-only and camera-comfort declarations.

Why it might click. Chants of Sennaar builds a tower journey around interpreting several interconnected languages. Observation, conversations and a notebook of symbols support the process of finding meaning. Its distinctive appeal is the moment when a scene becomes understandable, with communication across separated peoples supplying a larger purpose.

The full catch. The developer explicitly confirms stealth sections that require choosing a path and timing movement around guard patterns. This conflicts with a strict no-rush route. The Steam listing's mouse-only and camera-comfort declarations do not remove that demand, and the developer says the gamepad cover/free toggle does not apply to mouse-and-keyboard play. Language deduction also adds substantial memory work.

Try this first. Explore the early language puzzle only if that bounded visit is wanted. Preview the stealth requirements before committing; do not promise that enjoying the opening makes the full game suitable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P147 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Chants of Sennaar

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Coalition Needed Words Beside the Symbols

Chants of Sennaar had us considering how meaning travels between people while Remy designed the ceremony's cue cards entirely in symbols.

A crown meant begin. A moon meant pause. A little bird meant something he had already forgotten. Velvet held up the bird. "Fly away from this proposal?"

Kit added ordinary words beneath each image. Nia checked that the wording matched what people had agreed. Rae asked whether pause could mean an actual pause instead of a dramatic inhalation. It could.

June studied the crown. She said Dez had once used a similar doodle on the disputed Blue Comet agreement. Dez said it had been a badly drawn jukebox.

"Nigga, this is why we need labels," Tank said.

Remy wrote BEGIN, PAUSE, and READY beside the remaining symbols. The bird became WATER BREAK after a vote I lost to thirst.

At the next rehearsal, everybody understood the cue. Nobody needed to agree what kind of bird it was.

Aiden's verdict. The cue cards keep their pictures alongside plain words. PAUSE means a real pause, the bird means water, and the old crown-or-jukebox debate remains outside operational instructions.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam premise and declared input categories; developer Rundisc replies of December 4, 2023 and March 23, 2024 explicitly confirm stealth timing and distinguish gamepad from mouse/keyboard. No whole-game no-rush claim.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1931770/>

Source 2: <https://steamcommunity.com/app/1931770/discussions/0/4040354734349221032/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P148 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Heaven's Vault

Edition considered: PC release

Explore archaeology through an evolving character story, if translations that remain uncertain make discovery more interesting than simply finding a correct answer.

What you do. Talk with characters, examine inscriptions and explore the world while developing and revising theories about its ancient language.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Exploration includes sailing and navigation; camera or held travel input and heavy interpretation memory need checking.

Why it might click. Heaven's Vault follows archaeologist Aliya and her robot companion Six through a network of places and histories. Translating an ancient language is woven into an adaptive story, where discoveries and interpretations affect the journey. It offers grown-up curiosity, character exchanges and the possibility of forming a theory that later evidence complicates.

The full catch. This is more than a static translation screen: exploration includes navigation and sailing, and the source describes fast-flowing space rivers. Check camera movement, sustained travel input and the handling of those sequences. Tracking inscriptions, earlier interpretations and story choices can be demanding. Do not read its reflective subject matter as proof that every physical action waits comfortably.

Try this first. Try one conversation and one inscription before evaluating a travel sequence separately. Keep a translation provisional and notice whether uncertainty feels intriguing or merely burdensome.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P148 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Heaven's Vault

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ancient Inscription Said Bring the Jacket

Heaven's Vault made interpreting old language sound like an adventure. Dez produced a folded Blue Comet note, and I declared it a summit relic demanding expert translation.

Nia squinted at the handwriting. "I'm not qualified to complain."

Kit found three possible readings. June insisted the final line said bring the jacket. Dez said it said bring your courage, which sounded more romantic and considerably less likely to return clothing.

Rae examined the back. There was a shopping list.

"Nigga, whoever wrote this also wanted onions."

The grand historical interpretation briefly collapsed. Then June laughed and remembered the supper afterward. Dez remembered the rain. Neither recalled exactly which words had been written, but both remembered waiting beneath the same awning.

Mika put a copy beside the museum display with both readings attributed to their speakers. The original went back into Dez's bag.

I asked which version we should believe. Shawna said I could start by believing that they had both been there.

Aiden's verdict. The display records both readings without selecting a winner. The original note returns to Dez, while the onions provide firmer evidence than my proposed theory of ceremonial courage.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/774201/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P149 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Return of the Obra Dinn

Edition considered: PC release

Reconstruct the mystery of a merchant ship that returned without its crew, if a large network of human clues sounds compelling.

What you do. Explore the ship, inspect details and use logical deduction to work out the events connected to its missing crew.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. First-person controls, many identities and disturbing death-related material make this a substantial conditional mystery.

Why it might click. Return of the Obra Dinn casts the player as an insurance investigator examining a merchant ship that has returned without its crew. The developer emphasizes first-person exploration and logical deduction. Its appeal is reconstructing a complicated human mystery through observation, making it a strong story-and-evidence candidate for the right input setup.

The full catch. First-person navigation brings camera coordination and movement holds into the assessment. Connecting many identities and events can also impose a large memory burden, while the ship's fate involves death and disturbing material. The inspected primary description is brief; it does not establish every timing or interaction requirement. Choose it for substantial deduction, not as a low-effort introduction to mysteries.

Try this first. Inspect the opening environment and the investigation interface. Check visual comfort and navigation before deciding whether maintaining a larger network of people and clues sounds enjoyable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P149 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Return of the Obra Dinn

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Nobody Had Died, but the Mirror Was Missing

Return of the Obra Dinn's reconstruction of a ship's human mystery sharpened Rae's interest in our missing dressing mirror. She began asking who had moved what.

I offered a dramatic account involving rival stage interests.

Velvet said she had lent it to Kit. Kit said she had passed it to Remy after finding her glasses. Remy remembered leaning it beside the model hotel while carrying his flowers.

Mika pointed behind my portrait.

There it was, reflecting the back of my expensive head.

"Nigga, the investigator recovered the victim," Tank said.

Rae wrote MIRROR on a plain card and marked its home beside the dressing station. Nobody was accused of a conspiracy, which disappointed me but made the next rehearsal considerably easier.

June asked whether we should do the same with the old jacket. Dez lifted one sleeve and said its current location was visible to anyone with ordinary eyes.

Kit borrowed the mirror again, this time leaving a note.

Aiden's verdict. The mirror returns to a marked dressing station with a simple borrowing note. My conspiracy theory loses every witness, and Dez declines to label clothing she is presently wearing.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/653530/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P150 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Opus Magnum

Edition considered: PC release

Build working alchemical machines within a story of ambition, if arranging a mechanism and watching it succeed sounds like the central pleasure.

What you do. Place equipment, sequence its instructions and revise the arrangement until the machine performs the required transformation successfully on its own.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The editor, component placement and sequencing are complex, and optimization comparisons can add unnecessary self-imposed pressure.

Why it might click. Opus Magnum is an open-ended machine-building puzzle about arranging and programming alchemical equipment. Several solutions can work, with optional interest in making them cheaper, smaller or faster. A story of ambition and intrigue surrounds the workshop, while watching a successful mechanism repeat its work provides a distinctive reward.

The full catch. The editor, component placement and instruction sequencing create substantial interface and reasoning demands. Optimization comparisons can introduce self-imposed pressure even when a solution already works. Machine execution speed is not the same thing as required human reaction speed, but exact editing holds and all control requirements still need checking. The narrative is woven around construction rather than replacing it.

Try this first. Follow one introductory construction and make a single operation work. Ignore efficiency comparisons while deciding whether arranging and revising a machine is enjoyable in itself.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P150 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Opus Magnum

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Perfect Machine Delivered One Napkin

Opus Magnum made arranging a working mechanism look deeply satisfying. Remy responded by designing a ceremonial napkin delivery system from a tray, a rotating stand, and Tank.

Tank asked which component received dinner.

I offered to optimize the design. Velvet asked whether optimization would make it less expensive or merely give me another reason to order brass.

Rae watched one cycle. Tank turned the stand, Remy lifted the tray, and a single napkin arrived beside an empty plate. Then the mechanism had to be reset by two people who looked increasingly aware of their evening.

Kit picked up the napkin stack and set it beside the plates.

"Nigga," Tank said, "we been outperformed by putting something down."

Remy laughed and kept the rotating stand for his prop display. I watched it turn a little crown through the light. That was a fine purpose, provided nobody pretended it had solved a catering problem.

Shawna took a napkin without applauding.

Aiden's verdict. The napkins stay within reach, and the rotating stand becomes a prop display. Tank's dinner survives optimization after his mechanical duties are replaced by the ordinary location of a stack.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/558990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

The Pen Was Tested on Paper That Did Not Bind Anybody

We reached the rehearsal where everything looked ready enough to tempt me into a premature conclusion. The curtain worked. The light worked. Remy's microphone no longer produced a sound like a distressed kitchen appliance.

I picked up the charter.

Nia put a blank sheet beneath my hand.

"Practice paper."

"Nigga, I know what paper is."

"Then you'll appreciate the distinction."

Rae sat at the table and wrote her name. The pen worked, the table stayed still, and the vase remained far enough away to contribute nothing except looking like a vase. Kit sat next, then Velvet, who signed her stage name with an extravagant sweep that cost no one an extra chair. Remy drew a small crown. Mika sketched a tiny hotel. Tank wrote DINNER and underlined it twice.

June examined both sides of the blank sheet before writing anything. Dez watched her, then turned the sheet over with a look that made fifty-nine years of Blue Comet argument briefly visible in one wrist movement.

"We can use the same side this time," she said.

June laughed. She did not pick up the actual agreement. Neither did Dez. The moment was a possibility, not a settlement I had permission to announce.

Shawna drew a small heart on the practice page and handed me the pen. I started writing an extravagant dedication. She tapped the little space beside her heart.

"Here."

I wrote our initials, which proved sufficient for the task.

Mika gathered the practice sheets and left the real charter untouched in its tray. Nia still wanted to check the final wording. People still had their own conversations to finish. The room could be ready without requiring everybody inside it to move at the same speed.

I asked whether we could at least have a photograph of the successful rehearsal. Velvet said yes, after she adjusted one earring. Remy waited. Kit moved the lamp. For once, the picture happened when the people were ready instead of when I declared the light historically significant.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P151 / A PLACE TO START

Sokobond

Edition considered: PC release

Make molecular connections into compact logic puzzles, if discovering spatial relationships appeals without needing prior knowledge of chemistry to begin.

What you do. Move through introductory molecular arrangements, observe the result of each action and revise the spatial idea when needed.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Untimed-input support is declared, but key behavior, undo comfort and reasoning demands still need a practical check.

Why it might click. Sokobond turns molecular connections into compact logic puzzles with a minimalist presentation. The developer explicitly says chemistry knowledge is not required. Its current Steam declarations include keyboard-only play and play without timed input, making this a useful candidate when deliberate problem-solving is welcome but reaction pressure is not.

The full catch. A small control vocabulary can still support difficult spatial reasoning. Confirm comfortable key presses, any repeat behavior and how undo works on the actual device. The developer's no-timed-input declaration is useful evidence, not a hands-on comfort guarantee. This is mainly abstract puzzle pleasure; it will not supply the character-rich narrative that motivates some other choices in the catalog.

Try this first. Try one introductory molecular puzzle and learn the result of a single movement. Continue only if revising a spatial idea feels satisfying, without requiring prior chemistry expertise.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P151 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Sokobond

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Chemistry Was Not Required for This Seating Plan

Sokobond's connected pieces made me describe the seating arrangement as molecular diplomacy. Nia looked at Rae, then at the empty chair beside her, and said the chemistry seemed straightforward.

Rae pulled the chair out.

I offered to explain the larger structure. Nobody required it.

Kit wanted a seat with a clear view of the entrance. Velvet wanted to be near the dressing passage.

Remy needed room to set down his microphone case without making it somebody else's footrest.

Mika joined those practical requirements into a layout that looked less symmetrical than my first draft and behaved much better.

June and Dez chose neighboring chairs while denying that this choice resolved any historical dispute. Tank sat beside Rosa and immediately reached for the bread.

"Nigga, what bond is that?" I asked.

"Dependable."

Shawna tapped the chair beside hers. I joined the arrangement without changing anyone else's position, demonstrating an advanced understanding of a system I had nearly ruined by explaining it.

Aiden's verdict. The seating plan connects actual preferences without demanding a lecture. June and Dez retain their disagreement in adjacent chairs, and my advanced contribution consists of sitting where Shawna points.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam source supports chemistry-themed puzzles without required chemistry knowledge. Current developer declarations include Keyboard Only Option and Playable without Timed Input. Those declarations are not a hands-on test of sustained keys or individual comfort. Remote Play Together is not treated as native co-op.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/290260/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P152 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Hexcells

Edition considered: PC original game

Try an ambient cell-based logic puzzle, if studying a compact board and finding a justified next move sounds enjoyable to you.

What you do. Read the board's instructions, inspect its cells and make selections based on the relationships you can establish from the clues.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The primary description is brief; exact input, readability, holding and full timing requirements remain unresolved.

Why it might click. Hexcells is presented by its developer as an ambient logic puzzle. Its compact cell-based format offers a different kind of interest from walking through a world: inspect the board, understand its rules and look for a reasoned next step. It is a candidate for someone who likes deliberate abstract deduction.

The full catch. The inspected primary description is unusually brief, so it does not substantiate a full no-timer or hold-free claim. Check the game's instructions, cell readability and the distinction between its input actions before relying on it. A sparse screen does not guarantee an easy deduction. This original Hexcells entry should not inherit features or extra modes from the separate Plus and Infinite games.

Try this first. Read the opening board instructions and make one move whose reason is clear. Check whether selecting and distinguishing cells feels comfortable before increasing the puzzle size.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P152 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Hexcells

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Six Sides Did Not Make a Better Place Card

Hexcells' compact logic board inspired Kit to cut hexagonal place cards. I admired the shape so much I suggested using every edge for a different ceremonial title.

Rae held up one blank card. "Could we try a name?"

"Nigga, that's only one side."

"It's the useful side."

We wrote names clearly and left the other edges alone. Nia's attempt at her own card looked like a small mountain range. Rae wrote a second version while Nia made an unnecessarily careful show of choosing its position beside hers.

Velvet requested larger lettering for stage visibility. Remy wanted KING RECEIPTS on one side and REMY on the other, so he could turn the card when the performance ended.

That was a use I hadn't imagined. Kit made it neatly.

My card read AIDEN in ordinary letters. Shawna drew a tiny star beneath it when nobody else was looking. I stopped asking for the other five titles.

Aiden's verdict. The place cards favor readable names over spare-edge ambition. Remy receives two clearly distinguished sides, and Shawna's private star satisfies a host previously demanding five additional titles.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

The exact-game Steam page describes an ambient logic puzzle; its short primary text does not establish full controls or timing. The separate sequels' features were not imported. Detailed input verification remains outstanding.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/265890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P153 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Tametsi

Edition considered: PC release

Work through demanding tile logic with drawing tools and saved progress, if making a supported deduction is itself a satisfying reward.

What you do. Inspect tile relationships, reason about hidden mines and use the drawing tools to keep notes while developing a solution.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The developer explicitly calls it difficult; large clue relationships, tile visibility and exact controls still need checking.

Why it might click. Tametsi offers demanding logic puzzles about finding hidden mines among tiles. The developer says solutions do not require guessing, provides on-screen drawing tools for notes, and saves progress even within a level. For someone who enjoys careful deduction, those features can support a substantial problem without requiring an immediate answer.

The full catch. The developer also explicitly describes the game as difficult. Large patterns, written notes and relationships between clues can become mentally busy even when the physical action is modest. Verify the click controls, tile visibility and stopping behavior on the device. The inspected text supports automatic progress saving, but it does not explicitly certify every input as hold-free or every activity as untimed.

Try this first. Try an early board and write down one deduction with the available note tools. Decide whether the reasoning itself is enjoyable before treating more difficult boards as an objective.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P153 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Tametsi

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Glitter Was Somewhere We Hadn't Counted

Tametsi's careful deduction put Kit in a methodical mood just as Mika discovered loose glitter near the signing table. We needed to know which decorations were shedding before the papers arrived. I suggested guessing.

Kit looked at me over her recovered glasses.

"That was a test," I said.

Rae inspected the garland. Remy checked his crown. Velvet shook her boa gently over a clean tray and proved, with some satisfaction, that the expensive feathers were innocent.

The trail led to my ceremonial sash. Every time I insisted on walking through the middle of the room, another little constellation appeared.

Mika replaced it with a plain ribbon. June brushed one last spark off Dez's sleeve and said the Blue Comet had never needed this much cleanup. Dez reminded her about the broken jukebox bulb.

Kit wrote the remaining checks on a card. We finished them one by one, and the table finally stopped looking as if it had hosted a tiny explosion.

Aiden's verdict. The shedding sash leaves the ceremony and a plain ribbon takes its place. Kit's remaining checks proceed by inspection, while June's claims of historical tidiness encounter a broken bulb.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/709920/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P154 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Mario Paint

Edition considered: 1992 SNES original; SNES Mouse input

Make a playful picture in the original SNES creative toy, using stamps and fills as a narrow first activity to enjoy.

What you do. Choose a stamp and a fill color, place a few elements and experiment with a small picture using the mouse.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Original hardware needs the SNES Mouse; other tools involve dragging, many icons add clutter, and Gnat Attack requires reactions.

Why it might click. The original SNES Mario Paint is a creative toy for pictures, music and animation, built around the SNES Mouse. Stamping and filling areas offer a narrower first activity than exploring the entire toolbox. Its appeal is making something playful, with nostalgia as an optional bonus rather than a requirement.

The full catch. The original hardware needs the mouse peripheral. Manual instructions distinguish simple selections from held-button dragging used by other tools, so the whole program is not hold-free. Many icons and palette choices can create menu clutter. The separate Gnat Attack activity adds reaction demands and is outside this suggested stamp-and-fill trial. This is creation, not a character-story adventure.

Try this first. Choose one stamp and one fill color, then make a small picture. Leave freehand dragging, animation and the reaction minigame aside while checking mouse comfort.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P154 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Mario Paint

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Mario Could Paint the Banner Faster Than My Committee

Mario Paint's little creative tools persuaded Remy to design a simple welcome image instead of ordering another enormous photograph of me.

He made a microphone, a chair, and a bright uneven heart. Kit suggested clearer letters. Velvet requested enough sparkle in the drawing that we could stop shedding it in the room.

I asked where the host appeared.

Remy added a small crown on an empty chair.

"Nigga, that's a vacancy notice."

Shawna liked it. She said a welcome picture should leave room for people to arrive. Mika printed a draft at a sensible size, and Rae held it beside the entrance.

June and Dez argued over the heart's color, then both agreed the chair looked comfortable. Tank asked whether the microphone might also be a breadstick. Remy refused to settle the question.

The banner went up. For the first time all afternoon, somebody entering the room smiled before discovering how much I had spent.

Aiden's verdict. The welcome image uses a chair, a heart, and a disputed microphone-shaped breadstick. My portrait stays off the banner, which performs its welcome without requiring anyone to admire the host.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo announcement confirms the 1992 original; original Nintendo manual transcription, hosted by a third party, distinguishes stamps/fills from held dragging and the separate Gnat Attack activity. Card scope is original SNES Mouse play, not an automatic claim about modern ports.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/whatsnew/mario-paint-scribbles-into-the-super-nes-collection/>

Source 2: <https://manualzz.com/doc/26101036/nintendo-mario-paint-family-user-manual>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P155 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Color a Dinosaur

Edition considered: 1993 NES original

Revisit an unusual NES coloring toy if choosing colors for simple pictures is exactly the small retro activity you want.

What you do. Select a picture, choose colors and fill a few regions, trying the manual's narrow point-to-point coloring arrangement first.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Its child-oriented style and limited variety may rule it out; full timing and modern-device behavior remain untested.

Why it might click. Color a Dinosaur is an original NES coloring toy with a deliberately small activity loop. Its manual describes selecting pictures and filling regions with colors, including a point-to-point control arrangement. It belongs here as a specific retro curiosity for someone who wants that simple action, not as a substitute for adult narrative.

The full catch. The presentation is aimed at young children and the variety is limited. That may be a taste veto regardless of how few controls are needed. The original manual supports the coloring controls, while full-play timing and modern-device behavior have not been tested here. Mode changes can affect the drawing; check the intended setup rather than assuming an emulator reproduces every behavior conveniently.

Try this first. If the retro coloring idea itself appeals, fill a few regions in one picture. Stop the trial once its narrow appeal is clear; completing a picture is optional.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P155 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Color a Dinosaur

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dinosaur Got the First Uncontested Color

Color a Dinosaur was a deliberately tiny activity, which made it perfect for settling our absurd argument over the rehearsal cards. Everyone wanted a different border color.

I announced a palette summit.

Rae said we were already at one and wanted dinner.

Dez chose green for the dinosaur picture on the screen. June said it suited him. The ease of this agreement stunned me so thoroughly that I tried to declare the old war over.

"Baby, we agreed on a dinosaur," June said.

Velvet laughed, then picked a border for her own cue card. Kit chose another. Mika added the same plain words to both, so the colors could differ without changing the meaning.

"Nigga," Tank said, "the animal got us farther than your speech."

I chose gold, naturally. Shawna let me, because my card was now small enough that the decision affected almost nobody else. Even decorative ambition improved when contained inside a reasonable rectangle.

Aiden's verdict. The cue cards may use different colors while keeping identical plain instructions. June declines to confuse agreement about a dinosaur with a treaty, and dinner remains a live demand.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Original manual scan, hosted by a third party, was visually examined in the earlier project research (work/retro-games.json); current reopen yielded no searchable text. Manual-supported point-to-point coloring is a narrow option, not a tested whole-game or emulator guarantee. Wrong Steam coloring-game match excluded.

Source 1: <https://www.digitpress.com/library/manuals/nes/Color%20a%20Dinosaur.pdf>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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P156 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Incredible Machine 3

Edition considered: 1995 Windows original

Revisit a historical contraption puzzle if making an unlikely chain of cause and effect succeed is the attraction you remember.

What you do. On an existing working setup, inspect an introductory contraption and change one component to observe the resulting chain of effects.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Primary mechanics verification, exact controls, current availability and compatibility remain unresolved; setup could overwhelm the intended evening.

Why it might click. The Incredible Machine 3 is a historical contraption-building puzzle candidate: arrange parts into chains of cause and effect to achieve an objective. Its appeal is seeing an unlikely mechanism succeed after a useful adjustment. This 1995 Windows entry is included for a revisit if an existing copy and workable setup are available.

The full catch. Evidence is weaker here than for the modern store entries. A Sierra historical archive identifies the game, but its descriptive text credits a secondary database; the linked scanned manual was located without usable text verification. Exact mouse actions, timers, compatibility and present availability remain unresolved. Do not mistake this historical candidate for a certified easy-to-run or hold-free recommendation.

Try this first. On a working existing setup, inspect one introductory contraption and its controls before changing a single component. Avoid turning software setup into the evening's main activity.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P156 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Incredible Machine 3

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Incredible Machine Was a Person Opening the Curtain

The Incredible Machine 3's chain reactions encouraged me to sketch a ceremony opener involving a rolling ball, a tipping flag, and a bell that would release the curtain.

Rae stared at the page. "Who resets it?"

"An attendant."

"Then the attendant could open the curtain."

Remy liked the sketch anyway. He built a harmless tabletop demonstration with a marble and a little flag while the actual stage retained its ordinary pull. Kit watched the flag fall and applauded the tiny success.

Darnell arrived with a much more complicated proposal, a cocaine-party anecdote, and a yacht reference before reaching the second sentence. Mercedes pointed him toward the snack table.

"Nigga, take the long version somewhere with sandwiches."

Mika kept Remy's miniature machine in the display. It could amuse people without controlling the whole evening. Shawna asked me to pull the actual curtain once. I did. It opened beautifully, requiring neither a theory nor a marble to announce her entrance.

Aiden's verdict. The chain reaction becomes an optional tabletop amusement, while a person handles the curtain. Darnell's extended proposal travels toward sandwiches without gaining a role in the stage machinery.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Explicit source gap: historical Sierra archive page inspected, but its descriptive prose credits MobyGames. Original scanned manual located, not successfully read for mechanics in this pass. Primary identity locator is available; detailed controls, timing, current availability and compatibility remain unverified.

Source 1: <https://www.sierragamers.com/tim-3/>

Source 2: https://www.sierragamers.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/12/TIM_3_Manual.pdf

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P157 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

SimCity 2000 Special Edition

Edition considered: PC Special Edition

Build and manage a classic city if planning how its parts support one another sounds as interesting as watching the skyline grow.

What you do. Inspect a city, use its building and service tools and respond to the relationships between the settlement's needs.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Budgets, services, simulation behavior and old menus add substantial complexity; pause behavior and no-pressure modes were not verified.

Why it might click. SimCity 2000 Special Edition offers the classic city-building and management fantasy, with the ability to design a settlement and respond to its needs. The current exact-edition store description includes additional cities and scenarios. It may appeal through nostalgia, long-term planning and the satisfaction of a place taking shape.

The full catch. Management brings budgets, services, tools and simulation behavior into the same interface. This is a meaningful increase in menu and system complexity, not a default low-demand choice. Check speed controls, pausing, the ability to inspect while paused and the readability of the old interface on the intended setup. The reviewed sources do not establish a special no-pressure mode or hold-free operation.

Try this first. Inspect an existing city or an introductory situation and identify one service before building extensively. Decide whether managing relationships between systems sounds enjoyable, rather than merely liking the skyline.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P157 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

SimCity 2000 Special Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My City Had a Monument and No Toilets

SimCity 2000 made planning a whole place look irresistible. I expanded our model ceremony into a miniature capital with a central monument, two plazas, and a boulevard named after Shawna.

She asked where the toilets were.

I explained that the capital was ceremonial.

"Nigga, so are a lot of emergencies."

Mika added the practical rooms and routes already agreed in the annex. Rae placed the food where it could be reached. Velvet put the dressing area near the stage instead of behind my monument.

The beautiful boulevard shrank. The place began working.

June examined the model and said her old bus route would never have cleared my original corner.

Dez reminded her she had once clipped a flowerpot. June said the flowerpot had been badly governed.

Tank moved my monument to the small display table. I kept Shawna's name on the boulevard, now a very short route between our chairs and the courtyard. She approved its improved destination.

Aiden's verdict. The miniature capital acquires practical rooms and loses an obstructive monument. Shawna's boulevard survives at a useful scale, while June's disputed flowerpot incident remains outside the transport assessment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Special Edition GOG listing and official EA title page inspected. Supports city design/management and edition identity; pause behavior, no-pressure modes and present-device control comfort were not verified.

Source 1: https://www.gog.com/en/game/simcity_2000_special_edition

Source 2: <https://www.ea.com/games/simcity/simcity-2000>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P158 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe

Edition considered: PC Deluxe edition

Design a familiar little amusement park if caring about its visitors and finances is part of the attraction alongside building rides.

What you do. Place or inspect attractions, arrange the park and manage the guest needs and finances surrounding its operation over time.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Menus, money and scenario demands can create pressure; prebuilt rides do not remove the wider management system.

Why it might click. RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe combines the original park-management game with its two expansion packs. It offers both custom coaster construction and prebuilt rides, alongside the business of keeping guests and finances in order. The pleasure can be a recognizable little park evolving through practical and creative decisions.

The full catch. Designing rides is only part of the game: management menus, guest needs, money and scenario demands can create pressure. Check simulation speed and pause behavior, exact mouse operations and interface size. The presence of prebuilt rides does not remove the rest of the management system, and this edition should not be credited with modes from later RollerCoaster Tycoon releases.

Try this first. Inspect an opening park or scenario and locate one prebuilt attraction in the interface. Evaluate whether the management surrounding construction feels interesting before committing to a large custom coaster.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P158 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ride Was Two Chairs and My Big Mouth

RollerCoaster Tycoon's park-building fantasy gave me a final dangerous thought: what if guests entered the signing ceremony on a little moving platform?

Mika's eyes lit up. Rae closed hers.

Velvet asked whether the platform could manage her costume. Kit asked whether it could simply remain still. Remy wanted to know if its fanfare came included.

The quotation arrived before we agreed to anything. That cured Mika.

"Nigga," Tank said, "we could pay everyone to walk."

June and Dez took two chairs at the front and began narrating the imaginary ride. June supplied the uphill anticipation. Dez supplied the terrible drop into my bank account. The entire room joined the scream.

I bowed as if I had commissioned the entertainment on purpose.

Shawna pulled me into the chair beside her. The actual floor did not move. Somebody brought drinks. I had to admit this attraction had remarkably good capacity, excellent comfort, and no additional installation fee.

Aiden's verdict. The moving entrance is abandoned before purchase. June and Dez provide a seated parody instead, and the ordinary floor earns favorable reviews for remaining exactly where guests expect it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/285310/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P159 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Theme Hospital

Edition considered: 1997 PC original

Run a satirical institution if exaggerated operational problems and resource management sound entertaining, rather than looking for a personal character adventure.

What you do. Design and maintain the hospital, manage its staff and rooms and balance the resources needed to keep it operating.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Busy menus and simulation pressure need checking, while fictional illnesses and death may make the subject unwelcome.

Why it might click. Bullfrog's original Theme Hospital is a comic management game about designing and running an institution with limited resources. The official EA page emphasizes building, maintaining and managing the hospital while balancing cash and its exaggerated fictional problems. Its appeal is institutional satire and operational tinkering, rather than a rich personal adventure.

The full catch. Staff, rooms, resources and developing demands can make this a busy management choice. Its comic visual style does not remove time pressure or menu work. Check pausing, speed behavior, readable text and the exact mouse controls before assuming a relaxed setup is possible. The humor includes exaggerated illnesses and death, which may simply be the wrong subject for an enjoyable evening.

Try this first. Inspect the early building and management interface without committing to an elaborate plan. Decide whether its subject and overlapping responsibilities are appealing before taking on the continuing simulation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P159 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Theme Hospital

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hospital Admitted My Budget

Theme Hospital's comic institution made Velvet declare an emergency consultation for our wounded ceremony budget. She seated me opposite her and asked where the spending hurt.

"Mostly in areas people haven't appreciated yet."

"Chronic," she said.

Rae brought the hardware receipts. Mika brought the revised layout. Kit carried one lamp that did the work of the three I had first ordered. Remy arrived as King Receipts with a clipboard and an appalling bedside pun.

"Nigga, don't operate on me with that joke."

We removed duplicate rentals, kept the technician's actual work, and paid Velvet's agreed fee without trying to cure it. The budget looked less feverish.

June said the Blue Comet had once balanced an entire evening with a coffee tin. Dez said June had forgotten who bought supper afterward.

Velvet handed back my pen. "Stable enough to stop ordering."

Shawna took the catalog from my other hand before I could challenge the discharge conditions.

Aiden's verdict. The budget retains useful work and the agreed performance fee while shedding duplicate rentals. I am released from consultation on the strict practical condition that Shawna keeps the catalog.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Official EA page identifies Bullfrog's original 1997 Theme Hospital and building/management with limited resources. The automatic Steam hit was unrelated DLC and is excluded. Exact pause/hold behavior remains to be checked.

Source 1: <https://www.ea.com/games/theme/theme-hospital>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P160 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Zoombinis

Edition considered: 2015 PC remake of Logical Journey of the Zoombinis

Guide familiar blue travelers through a cartoon logic journey if its particular nostalgia and pattern-discovery charm are what you want tonight.

What you do. Try the remake's puzzle types, notice patterns and make choices that help the travelers continue toward their new home.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The child-oriented style is a real taste limit; difficulty, dragging, penalties and timing require puzzle-specific checks.

Why it might click. This is the 2015 remake of Logical Journey of the Zoombinis, a cartoon adventure built around pattern and logic puzzles. The developer describes twelve puzzle types with several difficulty levels as the travellers seek a new home. It may appeal through nostalgic character, rule discovery and a sequence of distinct reasoning tasks.

The full catch. The child-oriented presentation is a real taste consideration, especially when the desired experience is a grown-up character story. Logic difficulty can increase independently of that appearance. Check the specific puzzle's clicking, dragging, penalties and timing; the store description does not establish a universally untimed or hold-free route. This entry refers to the remake, not every older edition or platform version.

Try this first. Try one early puzzle and explain the pattern you think matters. Check whether helping these characters feels charming before investing in harder levels or the larger journey.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P160 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Zoombinis

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Travelers Reached a Table That Finally Worked

Zoombinis sent its travelers toward a new home through different reasoning problems. Our own procession faced the last rehearsal route: entrance, clear passage, chair, table, and a pen that actually wrote.

Mika invited people to try it in whatever order suited the check. Nobody had to perform the signing itself.

Kit reached her light. Velvet cleared the arch. Remy found his microphone. June and Dez sat together, still debating whether the Blue Comet jacket had been borrowed or strategically relocated.

Nia stopped beside Rae and asked if they could talk after the rehearsal. Rae smiled.

I lifted the charter, ready for a grand premature conclusion.

Shawna lowered my hand.

"Nigga, the room's ready. The words aren't."

We set the unsigned paper in its tray. The stage held everything it needed without requiring anyone to disappear into a role. Tank brought the last snacks over, and for once I announced nothing before taking one.

Aiden's verdict. The ceremony is ready for people, while the charter stays unsigned for the remaining conversations. The last rehearsal ends with snacks instead of an unauthorized declaration that everybody has agreed.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/397430/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

The Stage Could Hold the Peace, If We Ever Finished Talking

At the final equipment check, the table stood still. I pressed one corner to confirm this personally, then another because I disliked being excluded from a successful test.

Rae watched me. "You can stop trying to make it interesting."

The curtain opened. Velvet stepped through, made her turn, and reached the microphone with her costume intact. Remy followed at the agreed distance, delivered one deliberately terrible fanfare, and bowed before the joke became an endurance event. Kit found the light flattering enough to defend publicly.

Mika checked the route from the quiet room. June took it at her own pace. Dez walked beside her with the Blue Comet invoice safely inside her bag. They could reach the table without climbing, squeezing past my portrait, or listening to an explanatory recording about why the route was grand.

Mercedes played a few notes. Porsche listened from the seat she had chosen. Tank set down the snack tray where it could be reached, and Rosa immediately proved the placement successful.

"Nigga," I said, "look what we built."

Shawna looked at the room. Then she looked at me.

"Yes. We did."

The word we landed properly that time. It included the hotel workers, the people who measured, the people who asked for a chair, the people who cut a bad idea, and the people whose costume needed more room than my first sketch allowed. It also included me, though not always in the position I had drawn for myself.

I picked up the lever one last time. Remy asked whether I wanted it in the museum or the return box.

"The return box."

Tank put a hand to his chest as if witnessing a miracle. I threatened to order something just to restore his understanding of the world. He handed me a plate before I could act.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

The new charter remained unsigned. Its final wording belonged to the next conversations, including matters too personal for my microphone. Nia crossed the room to Rae with no page in her hand. Rae set down the toolkit. Whatever she asked next was quiet enough that neither I nor the ceremony needed to own it.

June and Dez sat beside the finished stage. One remembered the first Blue Comet song; the other remembered the last. Mercedes asked them to hum both. The versions disagreed, but she found a few notes that let them begin together.

I almost announced the second war over. Shawna kissed the beginning of the announcement away.

"Not yet."

"Then what now?"

She took my hand and led me toward the seats. "Let them talk. Sit with me."

The stage was ready. The paper could wait. I sat down before somebody found another useful thing for me to carry, and discovered that this, too, counted as contributing to the peace.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 5 OF SIX

The Witnesses Disagreed About the Jacket

Character stories, dialogue and consequential choices

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.
Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.
New ChatGPT prose under Nolan’s creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.
Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden’s scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [The Dance Was Not a Reward for Being Useful](#) - page 27. Desire, femmes and the work of care.

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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 5. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P161	P162	P163	P164	P165	P166	P167	P168
2. Ready for conversation	P169	P170	P171	P172	P173	P174	P175	P176
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P177	P178	P179	P180	P181	P182	P183	P184
4. Here for the atmosphere	P185	P186	P187	P188	P189	P190	P191	P192
5. Open to a wildcard	P193	P194	P195	P196	P197	P198	P199	P200

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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My Summit Had Two Eyewitnesses and Neither Endorsed Me

By the time we reached the final wording, the casino convention floor contained a working signing table, an actual clear aisle and a portrait of me big enough to possess its own weather. Nigga, peace had acquired infrastructure.

Mika stood beneath the portrait with a tape measure. They said it might have to leave through the loading entrance. I said that was no way to treat the face of reconciliation.

'It's the width of reconciliation,' Mika replied.

Shawna touched my arm. 'Baby, stop negotiating with the tape.'

At the good table, Rae had put a small wedge under the troublesome leg. Nia watched her check it, put the tools away and return to the draft. My wife caught me watching Nia watch Rae.

'Leave it alone,' she whispered. 'I was observing a promising alliance.' 'They can flirt without a ribbon cutting.'

Across the room sat the women whose memories had helped turn my game night into The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War. Auntie June, eighty-two, retired bus driver and proud butch, had commandeered the chair with the best view of the music. Odessa, known as Dez, eighty-four, retired seamstress and equally proud stud, sat beside her holding the disputed jacket.

They agreed the trouble began at the Blue Comet Social Club in 1967. They disagreed about the song, the weather, the jacket's destination and whether June had ever said she was sorry.

'I said it was unfortunate,' June told Nia.

'That the jukebox broke,' Dez said. 'You didn't mean my coat.'

I offered to appoint a historical commission. June looked at me. 'You got biscuits?'

Rosa brought biscuits before I could explain the commission's mandate. Tank followed with tea. My brother had identified which contribution would receive the more favourable account.

The original peace agreement was supposedly unsigned. June said someone lost the pen. Dez said the pen went home in June's pocket. June said a good crossword was not going to complete itself.

Nia asked what they wanted settled tonight. Dez could return June's jacket, then borrow it again by asking. Everybody could choose a jukebox song. The old stories did not have to become identical.

'And nobody makes me play something because they bought it,' Dez added.

'That sentence belongs in there,' Rae said.

I looked toward the portrait. Its expression suggested generosity without limits. Its invoice suggested limits should have arrived considerably earlier.

Velvet Payroll crossed the floor in half her costume, carrying the other half like an expensive weather event. She wanted her show time confirmed. Remy, currently becoming King Receipts,

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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wanted the working microphone and a place for the ridiculous fanfare he had defended through four separate departments.

Kit, a white butch with excellent opinions about her own entrance, wanted to sing under the light she had chosen. Mercedes wanted her arrangement heard. Porsche wanted one photograph everybody actually agreed to stand in. None of these wishes required another summit about what sort of person had permission to want them.

Nia put her name beside both caucuses she belonged to and carried on correcting the last sentence. Rae passed her a cup. The room survived this overlap without installing a second Nia.

I said I was delighted by the complexity of our coalition.

'Nigga, drink your tea,' Velvet told me.

Rae asked Nia whether the pen always made her writing look like that. Nia admitted the pen was innocent. Rae turned the draft sideways, smiling. 'I can learn it.'

Something quiet happened between them. Not mysterious. Two adults taking pleasure in the particular person across the table.

I almost called the photographer.

Shawna closed my hand around my cup instead. 'You can witness something without owning the picture.'

June asked Dez which song she intended to choose. Dez said it would be a surprise. June declared surprises responsible for at least half the original war.

Mika dimmed the portrait's lamp to improve the table light. My enormous forehead disappeared from the ceiling. The actual people became easier to see.

I sat beside my wife, accepted a biscuit and opened the next story.

The room had enough narrators. For a little while, I intended to hear some of them.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P161 / A PLACE TO START

Coffee Talk

Edition considered: PC first game

Listen to customers in a late-night café, where preparing a drink creates space for intimate conversations and gradually unfolding personal stories.

What you do. Read conversations, prepare requested drinks and follow the people who return to the counter with different concerns.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Choose Main Story with manual text advance; timed Challenge Mode is a different experience, and ingredient selection still needs attention.

Why it might click. Coffee Talk makes a café counter into a place to get to know recurring people. The fantasy setting puts a fresh surface on work, romance, identity, and belonging. Serving drinks influences story branches; the appeal is noticing a person's request and watching relationships develop.

The full catch. Use the main story with manual text advance; avoid timed Challenge mode. Expect substantial reading and ingredient selection. Drink choices can change story branches. Check the brewing interface and text controls; any decorative latte work is a separate hold/drag question.

Try this first. Choose the main Story mode and manual text advance. Serve one early request, then stay for the conversation it supports. Notice whether ingredients add pleasure or interrupt listening; check the exact edition's controls before settling in.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P161 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Coffee Talk

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Barista Declined My Peace Prize

Coffee Talk put a late-night café on the screen. I put six empty cups in front of Rae and announced that refreshments would heal the remaining divisions.

'Where's the coffee?' she asked. 'Arriving as a concept.' 'Nigga, I repair bikes. I know when a thing has no fuel.'

Nia brought her a real cup. No speech. Just remembered how Rae had ordered it earlier, which struck me as suspiciously effective diplomacy.

I offered to name their emerging relationship after the summit. Nia kept looking at Rae. 'Would you like to sit beside me?'

Rae moved her chair. I was still holding the cups. Tank took two and used them to collect the crackers falling through my decorative snack basket.

The café customers had their own reasons for talking. So did the women beside me. Rae wanted to hear about Nia's ridiculous first job; Nia wanted a second coffee to last longer than the first.

I supplied both drinks. Shawna kissed my cheek. Finally, a service contract with benefits.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the café for its conversations if the drink selection feels comfortable. My contribution to romance improved considerably after I stopped trying to put my name on it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam supports the first game's premise and drink-driven story. The identified secondary walkthrough separates the main story from timed Challenge objectives; this is a mode-specific recommendation. Manual advance, brewing and hold comfort still need checking in the chosen edition. The whole-game pace field remains unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/914800/>

Source 2: <https://www.trueachievements.com/game/Coffee-Talk/walkthrough>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P162 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Coffee Talk Episode 2: Hibiscus & Butterfly

Edition considered: PC sequel

Return to familiar café company for new conversations and drink-making, with another set of relationships to follow across the nights together.

What you do. Prepare drinks, follow customer conversations and explore the latte-art interface if its particular form of interaction interests you.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Returning relationships and recipes add tracking; fluid latte-art controls may require drawing, dragging or sustained pointer movement.

Why it might click. The second Coffee Talk offers more café conversations with returning and new fantasy customers, additional drink ingredients, and latte-art play. It suits an appetite for spending more time with this particular world rather than racing through a chain of dramatic reveals.

The full catch. Recipes and returning relationships can increase the things to remember. The official description includes fluid-simulation latte art, so drawing or held-pointer demands need checking separately. Nothing about the calm presentation establishes a complete absence of fiddly inputs.

Try this first. Make an early drink and follow one customer's situation. Try the art interface only if it interests you; inspect how to proceed if it does not. Decide whether the return feels welcoming or depends too much on previous familiarity.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P162 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Coffee Talk Episode 2: Hibiscus & Butterfly

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Butterfly Had a Catering Budget

The returning café in Hibiscus & Butterfly made Mika propose a signature drink for the summit. I approved before asking what signature meant. An expensive habit, beautifully consistent. Velvet Payroll wanted a butterfly in the foam. Rae wanted coffee that still tasted like coffee. Nia drew something on a napkin to explain a compromise.

'That's a butterfly?' I asked. 'That's my name,' Nia said. 'You asked me to sign the sample order.'

Kit found her reading glasses on top of the sugar and examined the napkin. 'I can confirm several intentions. None of them are letters.'

Rae laughed, then folded the napkin into her pocket. Nia watched it disappear with the pleased surprise of somebody whose bad handwriting had finally secured a useful outcome.

I asked whether we could enlarge it above the stage. Velvet slid the printing quote back toward me. 'Nigga, let one small thing be small.'

The drinks arrived without edible portraits. Everybody finished theirs. My proposed foam monument remained entirely theoretical.

Aiden's verdict. Return for more café relationships if recipes and text remain inviting. The summit's butterfly may be optional; my face in anyone's drink is now expressly unwanted.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC sequel. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1663220/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P163 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

VA-11 Hall-A: Cyberpunk Bartender Action

Edition considered: PC release

Work behind a cyberpunk bar where mixing drinks gives you time with distinctive customers, their problems and the life outside the counter.

What you do. Read customer exchanges, follow drink recipes and serve mixtures while learning more about the people who visit the bar.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Reading, recipes and customer preferences need attention, alongside sexual conversation and alcohol themes; test the actual mixing controls.

Why it might click. The game uses bartending to frame a series of conversations about life in a high-tech, unequal city. Drinks influence which stories unfold. Its attraction is the contrast between large political systems and the specific people living, working, joking, and struggling inside them.

The full catch. Reading, recipe selection, and remembering customer preferences are real parts of the experience. Sexual conversation, alcohol, and adult subject matter belong to its tone. Check ingredient operations and any mixing or waiting controls rather than inferring simplicity from the visual-novel label.

Try this first. Complete one customer order with the recipe information available on screen. Then judge the conversation itself: are these people enjoyable company, and is the bar routine a satisfying rhythm rather than unwanted clerical work?

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P163 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

VA-11 Hall-A: Cyberpunk Bartender Action

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Cocktail Had No Constituency

The cyberpunk bar in VA-11 Hall-A encouraged me to invent a drink called Executive Intimacy. Shawna asked what went in it. I said expensive things served close together.

'That's the seating plan,' she said. 'Try again.'

Velvet wanted her usual drink before rehearsal, not a beverage bearing the emotional difficulties of the host. Remy wanted water. His victory fanfare involved a note he had never previously met.

I treated these as negotiating positions and began describing a glittering pitcher. Rae took the menu from my hand. 'Nigga, people already told you what they want.'

Nia ordered something for herself. Rae ordered something different. They touched glasses without establishing a joint beverage policy, a development I found administratively reckless.

The fictional customers brought their problems to a counter. Ours brought actual orders. Porsche wrote them down and handed them to the waiter before I could announce a tasting committee.

Shawna kept Executive Intimacy as a private joke. She said we could discuss the seating later.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the cyberpunk counter for customers worth hearing, with recipes and mature conversation in view. My signature cocktail remains an unwritten promise between consenting married people.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/447530/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P164 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Red Strings Club

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a cyberpunk story about emotion and influence through unusual work, conversations and choices that question what helping another person means.

What you do. Shape objects, prepare drinks, use telephone conversations and make choices while following the story's questions about emotional influence.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Object shaping can require precision; several interaction types and morally difficult themes need checking beyond the point-and-click label.

Why it might click. This cyberpunk conspiracy story asks what happiness and emotional freedom mean. Its unusual sequence of bartending, implant pottery, and phone impersonation gives those arguments different forms; you manipulate both objects and conversations while learning what a corporation intends.

The full catch. The store explicitly describes a lathe and cocktail manipulation, which makes pointer precision and held movement significant checks. This is not safely described as dialogue-only. Its emotional manipulation and corporate-control themes may also feel sharper than a relaxed conversation game.

Try this first. Inspect the first hands-on task as soon as it appears. Determine whether its movement is enjoyable and whether the offered controls work for you. A compelling ethical question is not an obligation to tolerate an irritating interface.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P164 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Red Strings Club

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Emotional Sculpture Looked Like My Ear

The Red Strings Club raised questions about shaping other people's feelings. I immediately offered the summit a sculpture intended to inspire unanimous affection for its host.

Mika rotated the clay model. 'It looks like an ear.' 'That represents listening.' 'Why is the ear wearing your watch?'

Velvet wanted a stage entrance, not an emotional adjustment. She moved the model away from the lighting diagram and asked Remy to test the microphone she actually needed.

Nia said she could draft a clause about requests. I told her my sculpture communicated without words. Rae leaned closer. 'It's communicating that you bought clay before sandwiches.'

That hurt because the sandwiches were late.

I tried squeezing the clay into a heart. It became a second ear. Tank placed the two together and said the summit finally had enough equipment to hear Rosa asking for plates.

The game could keep its difficult questions about influence. I fetched plates. Velvet thanked the technician, not my sculpture, when the microphone worked.

Aiden's verdict. Consider this story if its questions about influence interest you and its varied interactions suit. The clay ear has been retired before it acquires another procurement budget.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/589780/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P165 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Neo Cab

Edition considered: PC release

Meet passengers whose conversations reveal a troubled city, while a driver's relationships, money and emotional state complicate the choices ahead.

What you do. Read passenger exchanges, choose responses and consider the relationships, ratings and resources affected by the driver's decisions.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Money, ratings and emotion restrictions create pressure; check text flow and map/menu operations despite the declared mouse-only option.

Why it might click. Neo Cab is a visual novel about Lina, a human driver in an increasingly automated city. Passengers become sources of stories and possible leads in her search. Her emotional state affects available responses, giving conversations a connection to the strain of working and surviving.

The full catch. Do not confuse its driving premise with a promise about vehicle controls: the inspected listing calls it a visual novel and declares a mouse-only option. Money, ratings, and emotion restrictions can still create pressure. Check reading flow and map/menu operations.

Try this first. Follow an early passenger conversation through to its outcome. Look at how a mood change affects the next available response. Decide whether that constraint deepens the character or makes the conversation feel less enjoyable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P165 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Neo Cab

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Passenger Rated My Marriage Advice

Neo Cab's passengers made me offer Rae an imaginary ride across the convention floor. I rolled up in a chair, opened a nonexistent door and asked where she wanted to go.

'To the woman holding two coffees,' she said. 'Excellent. Before we arrive, a few thoughts about relationships.' 'Cancel the trip.'

Nia was only three tables away. My proposed service had already introduced a delay, a fare dispute and an unsolicited emotional assessment.

Shawna stopped the chair with one hand. 'Baby, you could just move your foot.'

I moved it. Rae walked past me, sat beside Nia and immediately received the second coffee. No application required.

The driver's relationships and money on screen still interested them. Rae asked Nia which passenger she would find hardest to hear out. Nia looked toward me, smiling into her cup.

'Aiden gets four stars,' she said. I straightened. 'Out of how many?'

Tank started laughing before she answered. That nigga had learned to recognise a meter running.

Aiden's verdict. Try the passenger conversations if the money, emotional restrictions and interface remain manageable. My chair service has suspended relationship advice while customer confidence undergoes necessary repairs.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/794540/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P166 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Eliza

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a story about scripted emotional support, work and listening, where the gap between a helpful conversation and a performance becomes interesting.

What you do. Read conversations, choose responses and follow the character's work and relationships as the story questions how support is delivered.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Substantial dialogue explores personal distress and counselling technology; check text pacing and whether the subject feels welcome tonight.

Why it might click. Eliza follows Evelyn as she works as a human proxy for an AI counseling program and reconnects with people from her past. Fully voiced characters and a contemporary setting carry questions about work, responsibility, technical power, and whether simulated care meets real needs.

The full catch. The subject includes personal distress and the limits of counseling technology. Consider whether that is welcome material tonight. Expect substantial dialogue and choices; verify text pacing and navigation. This is a fictional story, not an instruction manual for supporting another person.

Try this first. Read an early work scene and a conversation outside it. Compare the constrained professional role with Evelyn's own voice. Continue if the contrast makes you curious, rather than because the subject seems worthy enough to require homework.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P166 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Eliza

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Listening Service Wanted a Tip

Eliza's scripted support gave me an idea for improving summit hospitality. I stood beside the buffet and told Kit I understood her concern before she had expressed one.

'Where are my glasses?' she asked. 'Your feelings are valid.' 'My glasses are missing.'

I nodded with expensive sincerity. She reached past my shoulder and took them from the pocket where I had put them while demonstrating attentive listening.

Nia nearly spilled her tea. Rae passed her a napkin before I could describe the incident as a breakthrough.

Kit wanted to pick her karaoke song. She had not requested a journey through my capacity for empathy. Once she could read the list, she chose something loud enough to punish an indifferent microphone.

Mercedes asked whether Kit wanted accompaniment. 'Yes. And no announcement that I am brave.'

The story on screen could investigate the difference between listening and performing concern. Mine had developed a practical test: Kit began singing, and I remained quiet.

Shawna tipped me with half her dessert for maintaining the new service.

Aiden's verdict. Choose this dialogue-led story when its distress and counselling themes feel welcome. My listening franchise has narrowed its offering to hearing the sentence before selling a response.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/716500/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P167 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Citizen Sleeper

Edition considered: PC first game

Build a precarious life through dice and daily choices, with relationships and meaningful opportunities competing for the resources available each cycle.

What you do. Allocate dice, choose tasks, manage resources and follow relationships while deciding what can be done during each cycle.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. No timed input is declared, but resource shortages, cycle clocks and interconnected choices create substantial planning pressure.

Why it might click. Citizen Sleeper turns life on a crowded station into choices about work, friendships, resources, and survival. Assigning dice creates a clear connection between what you can do this cycle and what you care about. Its characters make those allocations feel personal rather than merely numerical.

The full catch. Steam declares playable without timed input, but the story uses resource pressure and advancing clocks. Several systems and ongoing relationships need attention. That declaration does not verify hold-free controls; inspect dice placement, text size, and the station interface.

Try this first. Spend one cycle slowly, explaining to yourself what each chosen action will cost or advance. Meet somebody whose situation interests you. Notice whether the limited opportunities feel engaging or like a second schedule to manage.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P167 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Citizen Sleeper

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dice Refused to Sponsor My Portrait

Citizen Sleeper's scarce resources made the remaining summit budget look less like a number and more like several people waiting for dinner. I proposed solving this with confidence.

Rae counted the available dessert portions. Nia counted the guests. Tank counted again because he disliked the first answer.

'We could cut my portrait lighting,' I said generously. Shawna checked the bill. 'That has its own battery.' 'Nigga, I invested in resilience.'

Mika suggested moving the spare flowers and using their table for additional plates. Velvet offered to shorten her costume reveal if it got the cooks another clear path.

Everybody was finding something useful to give. I had contributed an illuminated explanation of why my contribution was difficult.

The daily choices on screen carried needs that could not all disappear through enthusiasm. I paid for the extra desserts.

Rae saved Nia a seat and half a tart. Nia split it unevenly in Rae's favour. Tank watched this resource allocation with professional respect.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the precarious life if resource planning sounds meaningful, remembering that untimed choices can still carry pressure. The portrait's independent power supply does not make it dinner.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC first game. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1578650/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P168 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Citizen Sleeper 2: Starward Vector

Edition considered: PC sequel

Travel with a crew through uncertain contracts, where imperfect dice and limited resources make shared needs and consequences part of the story.

What you do. Choose contracts, allocate dice, manage crew concerns and resources, and respond to stress and damaged dice as journeys develop.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Crew systems, stress, contracts and damaged dice add heavy tracking despite declared untimed play and adjustable difficulty.

Why it might click. The sequel expands the dice-driven roleplaying into travel, crew-building, and contracts across an asteroid belt. A battered ship can become a home, while temporary jobs bring distinct characters and risks. The appeal is making a future through relationships as well as careful decisions.

The full catch. The current Steam record declares adjustable difficulty and play without timed input. It also describes stress, damaged dice, and multi-cycle contracts: waiting for you is not the same as removing consequences. Inspect the actual difficulty choices before relying on them.

Try this first. Learn one contract's objective, available dice, and stress consequences before committing actions. Try a manageable early job and ask whether preparing with a crew adds pleasure or too many interconnected things to track.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P168 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Citizen Sleeper 2: Starward Vector

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Crew Declined My Inspirational Luggage

Citizen Sleeper 2 put an uncertain crew journey before us. I decided our signing team needed a name, matching bags and a statement about carrying each other.

Remy held up the bag I had ordered. Its handle came off. 'Are we starting with the metaphor broken?'

Mika wanted the spare cable inside it. Velvet wanted the cash envelope for the performers. Rae wanted the table stabiliser we had somehow packed beneath my commemorative slippers.

I said all missions suffered unexpected stress. Nia examined the slippers. 'Some stress arrives with a monogram.'

The game's imperfect dice and contracts gave everybody enough genuine uncertainty to discuss. Our own crew did not need an additional challenge locating equipment in my personality.

Tank tipped the bag gently onto the sofa. Everything appeared at once. Rae fixed the table leg; Remy connected the microphone; Velvet counted her envelope and grinned.

I wore the slippers. Shawna called them excellent for the short voyage between the sofa and whatever useful thing she asked me to fetch.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the crew story if damaged dice, stress and contracts invite thought rather than exhaustion. My inspirational luggage works best when removed from the equipment it supposedly supports.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC sequel. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2442460/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P169 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Disco Elysium - The Final Cut

Edition considered: PC Final Cut

Investigate through conversations and competing inner voices, with unusual characters, roleplaying choices and a darkly funny world giving the detective story depth.

What you do. Explore scenes, question people, read or hear dialogue and make choices shaped by the detective's different skills and impulses.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Extensive dialogue, skill checks and inventory/character menus add substantial work; not every interaction is verified as untimed or hold-free.

Why it might click. The Final Cut presents a dense, voiced detective roleplaying story about a damaged investigator and a politically complicated city. Skills become argumentative inner voices, making character-building part of the writing. Conversations can be funny, cruel, revealing, and unexpectedly tender.

The full catch. Expect extensive dialogue, skill checks, inventory and character menus, and mature material including addiction and violence. A failed choice can have consequences. The manually checked source confirms the Final Cut edition, but does not certify all interactions as untimed or hold-free.

Try this first. Follow an early conversation and inspect one relevant skill explanation. Decide whether the competing voices delight you or interrupt the person you want to hear. Treat the opening as a test of tone as much as controls.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P169 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Disco Elysium - The Final Cut

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Inner Voices Lost the Microphone

Disco Elysium's competing inner voices made me feel represented. One part of me wanted the summit to finish. Another wanted my closing entrance accompanied by thunder.

'Which part ordered the smoke?' Shawna asked. 'Artistic judgment.' 'The hotel calls it a cleaning surcharge.'

Velvet said the smoke belonged to her number, which she had actually rehearsed. Remy backed her until he remembered his own fanfare needed the same technician.

Nia asked whether either performance needed to precede the final wording. Both performers said no. My thunder suddenly had no surviving relative.

Rae borrowed Kit's glasses to read a small line. Kit said she could borrow them only if somebody remembered where they went. I announced that a detective was among them.

'Find the pen you're holding, nigga,' Tank said.

The game offered a rich investigation. Our immediate mystery solved itself when I lowered my hand. Nia took the pen, read the disputed sentence aloud and left my weather system out of it.

Aiden's verdict. Enter the detective's crowded mind if dialogue, checks and menus appeal. Our host's inner thunder has been overruled by the people who brought an actual working microphone.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected Steam app632470 on 2026-09-20, exact title Disco Elysium - The Final Cut. Source supports full English voice acting, skills, roleplaying choices, and mature content. Control and workload judgments remain editorial.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/632470/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P170 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

NORCO

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate a family mystery in a distinctive industrial landscape, where conversations, local detail and strange events make the place itself compelling to explore.

What you do. Explore scenes, talk to characters, inspect clues and work through the story's puzzles and other interactive sequences.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense themes and puzzles add work, and the source mentions fights; do not assume it is exclusively quiet dialogue.

Why it might click. NORCO combines a missing-person search with family history, industrial landscapes, and increasingly strange science fiction in South Louisiana. Its dialogue-focused point-and-click structure invites attention to both particular characters and the forces shaping their world.

The full catch. The official description also mentions puzzles and fights; do not treat dialogue-focused as proof that every sequence is mechanically quiet. Expect dense imagery, unfamiliar connections, and bereavement. Check each new interaction type and the text/interface size.

Try this first. Explore an early location and follow one clue about the missing brother. Pause to decide whether the place feels intriguing in its own right. Inspect the first unfamiliar mechanical sequence before assuming later play matches the opening.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P170 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

NORCO

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Scenic Backdrop Needed a Break

NORCO's industrial landscape had Rae talking about the street behind her workshop. A place could carry history without putting it in a gold frame. I looked at our summit backdrop.

It showed my face floating over a fictional skyline. Several buildings were taller than necessary to support the emotional claim.

'Where's the loading entrance?' Rosa asked. 'This is aspirational geography.' 'The caterer is aspirationally waiting outside.'

Rae described the little lunch counter by her shop. Nia wanted to visit. Rae said Thursdays had the good soup and the least theatrical customers.

I offered to arrange a limousine. 'You can recommend a soup without acquiring transport,' Shawna told me.

Porsche unhooked one side of the backdrop so the carts could pass. My enormous eye folded neatly against a palm tree.

The family mystery on screen kept its strange, complicated place. Our room became a little more specific too: food coming through, people making plans, and one floating face learning to leave a gap.

Aiden's verdict. Visit NORCO for its distinctive place and mystery if the dense themes and varied demands suit. My imaginary skyline has acquired a practical and deeply necessary loading entrance.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1221250/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

The Dance Was Not a Reward for Being Useful

Nia's invitation reached Rae just as Kit asked whether Rae could fix the little light above the karaoke screen. Rae had spent most of the evening making objects less likely to collapse. She put the note down without reading it and reached for her tools.

Nia covered the tool bag with her hand.

'You can say no,' she said.

Kit looked from one woman to the other. 'I asked. I didn't issue an order.'

'Then let her answer before you tell the technician she's coming.'

The technician stood behind Kit holding a ladder. Nigga, witnesses had developed terrible timing.

I offered to buy another light. All three women ignored me with impressive coordination.

Rae took her hand off the bag. 'I don't want to climb anything. I want to read this note.'

Kit turned to the technician. 'I'm sorry. I assumed.' He nodded and carried the ladder toward the lamp. Kit watched him go. 'We already had this argument over the fees. Apparently I can understand a budget faster than I can stop doing it.'

The less practical problem stayed.

'You could have told me,' Kit said.

'I just did.'

Nia moved her hand away. Rae did not pick up the tools.

Kit was white, butch, wearing a carefully chosen suit and the expression of somebody discovering that a useful intention had arrived badly. Rae was a Black stud with a mechanic's hands and several very specific reasons to dislike being treated as the room's available solution.

I had printed their labels across opposite sides of a banner. It looked impressive from the lift. Up close it had done a remarkably poor job of explaining either woman.

'When I walk into a room like this,' Kit said, 'I already feel as though people are waiting for me to prove I can be useful. I thought we were doing the same thing.'

'We can recognise something without having the same night,' Rae replied.

Kit folded her arms, caught herself and let them drop. 'I know that.'

'You might. You still sent the ladder.'

Velvet sat on the edge of the table. She had heard enough to stop arranging her entrance and start listening.

Kit looked at Rae's tool bag. 'I liked that you seemed certain. You knew what to do with the table. I was still trying to ask for the right light without apologising for having a face.'

'You thought certainty meant I wasn't tired.'

'Maybe.'

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

Rae looked at the note beneath her hand. 'Sometimes I like fixing things. Sometimes I like being good at something in front of a woman I want. Both can be true, and I can still want the next person to leave the screwdriver alone.'

Nia smiled, but only briefly.

'You don't have to earn this chair,' she said.

Rae turned toward her. 'I know.'

'Do you?'

The room got quiet enough for my portrait's ventilation fan to sound obscene.

I reached for its switch. Shawna pointed to the correct one before I blacked out the entire floor.

Nia waited until the fan stopped. 'I like the way you look at me. I like your terrible opinions about the biscuits. I wanted to flirt with you. Then every time something happened, I became the person who could make your answer sound diplomatic.'

'I didn't ask you to do that,' Rae said.

'No. I did it. I'm stopping.'

She put the marked-up draft on the table. The gesture was small. Rae watched it as though Nia had moved a wall.

'I'm Black, trans, a lesbian, a femme and a lawyer,' Nia said. 'Tonight you have all managed to remember the lawyer whenever a sentence becomes awkward. I would like the woman in the nice dress to get a turn.'

Velvet lifted her glass. 'The dress has been waiting patiently.'

Nia laughed. Rae did not reach for a polished reply.

'I don't want you to translate me,' she said. 'I want you to tell me when I'm being an ass. Preferably before it becomes a programme item.'

'You're being an ass about accepting help.'

'Excellent. Efficient. No billable preamble.'

Kit sat, leaving room between their chairs instead of turning the whole exchange into a panel.

'I don't want the banner to decide what I can ask you,' she said. 'But I can see I've been using same side when I meant please recognise me.'

Rae nodded. 'Ask for that. Don't send equipment.'

June arrived with tea and looked at the banner. 'White butches over here, Black studs over there. Where did you intend to put my Black butch ass?'

I began to explain visual balance.

'Try the chair,' June said, and sat wherever she pleased.

Dez followed. She put the borrowed jacket over June's chair and took the cup June offered her. The banner had lost another jurisdiction.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Kit looked at June. 'I grew up thinking there was one way to look like I belonged. Then I spent years resenting people who looked at ease in it.'

'Who looked at ease?' June asked.

Kit laughed despite herself. 'Fair.'

'I like being butch,' Kit continued. 'I like how my shoulders sit in this jacket. I like a woman calling me handsome without sounding surprised by her own taste. I don't want to speak about all of it as damage.'

'Good,' Rae said. 'Because the jacket looks good. I noticed before we argued.'

Kit looked pleased, then slightly embarrassed by how pleased. Nia told her to enjoy the compliment without preparing a counterstatement.

Rae rubbed one hand over her knee. 'Stud is my word. It doesn't mean I'm volunteering to be a man in somebody else's romance. It doesn't mean I don't want tenderness because I like this shirt.'

Nia touched the cuff, waiting until Rae turned her hand toward hers.

'I like this shirt too,' she said. 'I also like when you stop arranging the space around me long enough to ask where I want to stand.'

'I was trying to make a path.'

'I know. Sometimes I want the path. Sometimes I want your hand. They're different requests.'

I felt Shawna glance at me. Nigga, a lesson had crossed the room without my name appearing anywhere in it.

Remy came over carrying the working microphone. He had missed the start, asked what was happening and accepted Kit's short answer instead of inventing one.

'My gay friends sometimes introduce me as the one who understands women,' he said. 'I'm a man with one particular history. I'm not a customer-service desk for everybody they date.'

Velvet nodded. 'And I put on a queen because I want this room watching the number I rehearsed. That doesn't entitle anybody to invent the rest of my life from the costume.'

'They do enjoy a convenient character,' Kit said.

'So do I,' Velvet replied. 'Mine charges.'

The joke loosened something without ending the conversation. Kit asked Rae whether she wanted another coffee. Rae said water. Kit brought water and did not make the correction into a test of her goodness.

Nia finally picked up the note. 'Now can somebody tell me whether this invitation is legible?'

Rae read it sideways. 'Are you asking me to dance or to inspect a second table?'

'Dance.'

'Then ask.'

'Will you dance with me after the signing?'

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

'Yes. And if I'm nervous, don't let me pretend I need to check the furniture.'

Nia smiled fully. 'If I'm nervous, don't let me turn it into a contract.'

'You can both be nervous,' Shawna said. 'The floor will cope.'

Rae looked at Nia's hand. 'When we get there, will you hold me first? I keep reaching like I'm supposed to know the whole way.'

'I'd like that,' Nia said. She offered her hand, palm up. Rae took it. Nothing about her shirt, her name or her chosen word needed altering for the gesture to fit.

I offered to have the floor inspected. Shawna put one finger against my lips.

Mercedes asked what song they wanted. They chose together. Kit wanted her own song afterwards; Velvet wanted the time she had booked; Remy wanted his ridiculous fanfare to survive being funny.

Nobody's desire dissolved into the couple's. The room held several wants at once, untidily, without arranging them into opposing armies.

Rae folded the note and kept it. Nia asked why. 'Because you made a bad drawing of a good question,' Rae said.

'That's my handwriting.'

'I know. I'm learning it.'

I looked at the banner again. Its enormous words could still sell a theatrical war. They could not do this part: two women admitting what the pose concealed, another recognising what she had assumed, and June refusing to move to make my categories prettier.

I asked Mika to lower it before the music. Mika asked where to put it.

Shawna pointed at my portrait's transport crate. 'Plenty of room for another oversized explanation.'

Nigga, I held the crate open myself.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P171 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Kentucky Route Zero

Edition considered: PC complete five-act edition

Follow an unusual theatrical journey where conversations, working lives and strange places matter as much as finding out what happens next.

What you do. Explore scenes, choose conversation responses and follow the people met along a mysterious delivery route.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Expect substantial reading and ambiguity; the existing source does not certify every timing or held-input demand.

Why it might click. This five-act magical-realist adventure follows a delivery into a world of strange roads, precarious work, debts, and fragile communities. Its pleasure lies in language, staging, music, and atmosphere. Choices can feel like shaping a performance rather than selecting the correct solution to a puzzle.

The full catch. Expect substantial reading, ambiguity, and a pace that may feel deliberately indirect. The PC Edition has been manually matched to the assigned complete game. Check movement and text advance; no inspected source establishes every scene as free of held or timed input.

Try this first. Stay with one early encounter rather than trying to solve the whole world's meaning. Notice whether choosing a line makes you feel involved. If the theatrical distance leaves you cold, that is useful taste information, not a reading failure.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P171 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Kentucky Route Zero

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Route Went Through My Introduction

Kentucky Route Zero's strange working journey inspired Mika to describe our evening as a passage through temporary architecture. I thought that sounded expensive enough to approve.

Then a waiter asked which door reached the kitchen. Mika pointed at the floor plan. The waiter pointed at the actual wall.

'That door exists in the earlier drawing,' Mika said. 'My tray exists now,' the waiter replied.

Rae moved a folding screen. An ordinary door emerged behind it. I announced a discovery. 'Nigga, it has EXIT written over it,' Tank said.

Nia liked how the game left space around what people meant. She asked Rae about the longest ride she had ever taken without a particular destination.

Rae told her. I tried to improve the story by adding a helicopter. Shawna squeezed my hand with the exact pressure required to land it.

The waiter returned with dinner. Mika abandoned the drawing, kept the beautiful lighting and opened the route that actually went somewhere. Our strange journey had found the potatoes.

Aiden's verdict. Take the theatrical journey if ambiguity and reading appeal. The summit map now recognises the kitchen door, although my helicopter remains available in several entirely imaginary jurisdictions.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected Steam app231200, Kentucky Route Zero: PC Edition; the five-act PC edition matches this assigned game despite title-review flag. Other control and mood judgments remain provisional.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/231200/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P172 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Night in the Woods

Edition considered: PC release

Revisit friendships in a changing hometown, where funny conversations and ordinary outings lead into a more unsettling story about belonging.

What you do. Move through town, talk with friends, explore familiar places and take part in activities along the story.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Movement includes platforming and other active sequences; a strong character story does not remove those control demands.

Why it might click. Night in the Woods offers the company of young adults negotiating friendship, disappointment, work, and changes in their hometown. Its animal characters carry recognizably human conversations, with a mystery growing around the edges of daily wandering.

The full catch. Movement and platforming are part of its adventure structure, and additional activity types require checking. Do not file it as a static visual novel. Its themes can be bleak, including economic decline and emotional distress, despite the bright designs and frequent jokes.

Try this first. Walk through an early stretch of town and talk to somebody who knows Mae. Test the movement before investing in the story. Decide whether the everyday conversations are reward enough for the amount of traversal between them.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P172 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Night in the Woods

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Homecoming Band Had Already Replaced Me

Night in the Woods brought old friendships and a changing hometown into the room. Kit remembered the terrible band she had joined in her twenties.

'What did you play?' Remy asked. 'Bass. What did you play?' 'A duke once. Reviews were divided.'

June remembered the Blue Comet band playing it in 1967. Dez said there had been a jukebox, not a band. 'It sounded live,' June insisted. 'So did you,' Dez replied.

I offered to join their reunion. Kit asked what instrument I played. I said atmosphere. 'We already had a broken amplifier,' she replied.

Rae leaned against Nia's chair and listened. Nia kept time with her pen, producing a tiny rhythm and three additional dots on the final wording.

The game's active movement still needed its own trial. The music in our room needed no intervention from me. Velvet took the chorus, Kit laughed through a forgotten bridge, and even the waiter waited.

I supplied the last note by dropping a spoon. Nobody invited it back.

Aiden's verdict. Meet the hometown friends if the story interests you and the active sections fit. My proposed reunion role has been reduced to transporting instruments without performing atmosphere.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/481510/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P173 / A PLACE TO START

Beacon Pines

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a branching storybook mystery where discovering and choosing particular words can change what happens to its characters in meaningful ways.

What you do. Move through the setting, talk to characters, collect useful words and try them at branching moments.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Branch tracking and creepy events remain despite untimed-play declarations; test walking and menu selection for held-input demands.

Why it might click. Beacon Pines combines exploring a small town with collecting word charms and revisiting branches through a story tree. New words can transform a moment and open different events. Curiosity about how a sentence changes the world becomes part of solving its mystery.

The full catch. The Steam record declares play without timed input and keyboard-only operation. Branch tracking still adds a memory burden, and the cute art accompanies creepy events. Those declarations do not establish that every control avoids holds; test ordinary walking and menu selection.

Try this first. Collect an early charm and use it at a turning point. Then inspect how the story tree represents the route. Continue if comparing possibilities feels like discovery rather than keeping several unfinished stories in your head.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P173 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Beacon Pines

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / One Word Made the Proposal Considerably Worse

Beacon Pines made choosing a word seem like an excellent way to influence a story. I examined the summit sentence promising an enjoyable evening and suggested replacing enjoyable with legendary. Nia said it described an intention, not a warranty. I suggested inevitable. Rae put down her cup. 'You want to guarantee fun now?' 'I want strong language.' 'Nigga, this is strong: sit down.'

Kit offered optional. Velvet preferred paid, but admitted she was looking at a different paragraph. Remy proposed resplendent and pronounced it as though it came with its own trumpet.

Shawna asked what the sentence needed to do. Nia read it again without any of our ornaments. Everybody understood it.

On screen, the words could send a mystery along another branch. Ours had nearly sent a modest invitation into the insurance department.

I accepted enjoyable. Rae wrote a separate word on Nia's napkin: later. Nia read it, looked toward the dance floor and stopped considering resplendent.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the branching word mystery if its story and tracking suit. Our charter retains ordinary language, while the evening's most effective amendment fits on a napkin.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1269640/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P174 / A PLACE TO START

Mutazione

Edition considered: PC release

Spend time in an unusual community through conversations and gardening, with music helping give the people and their surroundings a distinctive mood.

What you do. Explore the community, speak with residents and tend gardens as their interconnected stories develop around you.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Illness, family secrets and community conflict matter; verify the declared untimed, input and saving options on the installed version.

Why it might click. Mutazione follows Kai visiting her grandfather in an unusual island community. Conversations, old tensions, and musical gardens sit alongside the supernatural plot. Its attraction is spending enough time with a place that the relationships begin to matter.

The full catch. Illness, family secrets, and community conflict are central; gentle presentation is not a promise of emotionally light material. Steam declares no timed input, mouse-only and keyboard-only options, and save-anytime. Verify those options on the installed version and inspect ordinary navigation.

Try this first. Meet one resident and spend time with an early garden interaction. Judge the balance between conversation and moving through the community. If you like it, a note of the next person to visit may make returning easier.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P174 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Mutazione

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Garden Refused My Opening Address

Mutazione's conversations and musical gardens gave Mercedes an idea for the corner beside the signing table. She wanted a quiet place to hear a song after the crowd thinned.

I ordered a decorative tree. It arrived with blinking lights and a speaker inside the trunk. Nigga, even my foliage had an introduction.

Mika loved it for nine seconds. Then the tree announced a discount on spa treatments in the middle of Mercedes's melody.

Kit found its switch. Rae shifted two chairs into the corner. Nia sat in one and asked Rae whether the other was reserved.

'Depends,' Rae said. 'You planning to sell me a facial?'

The community on screen had lives beyond what a visitor first noticed. Our corner acquired its own little history: a bad purchase, an excellent song and two women staying after the joke.

I carried the unplugged tree toward the service lift. Shawna walked beside me. 'Beautiful branches,' she said. 'Thank you.' 'I meant your arms. Keep carrying.'

Aiden's verdict. Visit the unusual community when conversation, gardening and its heavier themes sound welcome. The summit's musical tree will remain unplugged until it develops an ear for other people.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1080750/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P175 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Wytchwood

Edition considered: PC release

Gather strange ingredients and craft useful things while a witch's errands lead through an illustrated world of stories, creatures and connected tasks.

What you do. Explore locations, collect ingredients, follow recipes and return with crafted items to advance different characters' requests.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Nested recipes, repeated travel and monsters add work; keeping several ingredient chains in mind can become demanding.

Why it might click. Wytchwood turns gothic fairy-tale errands into gathering and crafting. The witch's judgments give the recipes personality: ingredients are steps toward changing a troublesome situation, not simply collecting for its own sake. The illustrated world helps make each place distinctive.

The full catch. Expect repeated travel, nested recipes, and remembering where resources come from. The official description includes monsters and overcoming them through tools and spells; do not assume that crafting removes all hazards or movement demands. Check inventory and held movement.

Try this first. Follow one early recipe from request to ingredients to use. Notice whether retracing a route is satisfying familiarity or unwanted repetition. The useful trial is the whole small crafting loop, not just admiring the art.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P175 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wytchwood

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Recipe Required a Different Host

Wytchwood's ingredient chains made me claim that a good evening was simply a recipe. Velvet asked for the recipe's payment stage. Rosa asked about its missing forks.

I listed music, friendship, lighting and a mysterious spark. Rae lifted the empty fork basket. 'Can you eat with the spark?'

Nia was drafting one final sentence while Mika looked for the tape needed to secure the tablecloth. The tape was in the box beneath the ribbons I had ordered to conceal the table legs.

The ribbons required scissors. The scissors were on the piano. The piano was occupied by Remy's enormous hat, whose storage apparently required an instrument.

Tank moved the hat, retrieved the scissors and produced the tape. Rosa produced forks from a drawer I had decorated shut.

The witch could keep gathering her strange ingredients. Our summit had enough nested errands without adding my theory of ambiance.

Shawna handed me the ribbon scraps. 'Your spark needs clearing off the floor.' I began the next recipe: husband, bin, silence.

Aiden's verdict. Try the witch's errands if collecting and recipe chains feel satisfying. My hospitality recipe has been simplified until it includes forks before any reference to mysterious sparks.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/729000/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P176 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Wandersong

Edition considered: PC release

Meet a colourful world through a bard's singing, with music and character encounters giving an active adventure its playful and emotional shape.

What you do. Move through scenes, sing to interact with the world and handle platforming as the adventure continues.

Mixed controls | Action continues while you think | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. This is an active platforming detour; warm music and artwork do not remove real-time movement and reaction demands.

Why it might click. Wandersong builds a characterful adventure around a bard who changes things through music. Its humor, unusual interactions, and emotional story can make singing feel like a way of meeting the world. The official pitch also explicitly calls it a platforming adventure.

The full catch. Directional movement, platforming, and selecting musical responses are meaningful demands. The developer's broad accessibility language about color and sound does not answer every motor-input question. This is a contrasting option for someone who wants those active elements, not a guaranteed quiet story.

Try this first. Try an early singing interaction and a small piece of traversal. Check whether choosing the notes and moving through the space are enjoyable. If either feels like an obstacle, keep the musical premise separate from the actual fit.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P176 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wandersong

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Bard Asked Me to Stop Conducting

Wandersong put a singing bard before us. Remy immediately offered a preview of the victory fanfare. It began with a pun about major agreements and minor concessions.

Kit stared at him over her glasses. 'You rehearsed that?' 'Repeatedly.' 'I can hear the damage.'

Mercedes found a key that suited his voice. Velvet added a ridiculous harmony. Soon the little rehearsal had more life than the grand recording I had commissioned for the doors.

I rose to conduct. Three people stopped singing.

'Nigga, you cannot lead a song by threatening the ceiling,' Velvet said.

Rae asked Nia whether this was the music she had imagined for their dance. Nia said she had imagined fewer puns, but she remained open to evidence.

The game's musical warmth did not erase its active adventure. Our musical problem was easier: I sat down. Remy finished the fanfare, Kit joined the last phrase, and Mercedes made the absurd thing land.

Shawna applauded. I applauded too, carefully keeping both hands below leadership level.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the bard's journey if its real-time movement also appeals. The summit fanfare survives, while my conducting career has ended before the ceiling could file a complaint.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/530320/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P177 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Chicory: A Colorful Tale

Edition considered: PC release

Paint and explore a world where colour, creativity and a character's personal story develop together, with an optional second person helping paint.

What you do. Move through the world, colour scenes, solve obstacles and try the different available painting roles with a companion.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Painting, movement and active sequences need checking, and the two cooperative roles do not offer identical control.

Why it might click. Chicory is a coloring-book adventure about taking up an artist's brush. Painting changes the environment and supports puzzles, while the story explores creativity and the people around it. The official listing explicitly includes local cooperative painting.

The full catch. Painting, directional movement, and more active sequences need separate checks. Local co-op does not necessarily give both people identical roles. Inspect brush behavior and the game's actual options before deciding whether the action is welcome; no assumed setting is required by this card.

Try this first. Color one small area and use paint for an early puzzle. If playing together, establish who controls movement and who paints. The point is to discover whether making marks feels playful without turning the result into an art assessment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P177 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Chicory: A Colorful Tale

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Colour Scheme Had a Personal Grievance

Chicory's painting made Mika wonder whether the signing backdrop needed one final splash of colour. I offered gold. Everybody looked at the gold table, gold frame and gold bowl.

'Something we haven't already swallowed,' Rae said.

Kit wanted cool light for her song. Velvet wanted warmth for her costume. Porsche adjusted one lamp while Mercedes stood where the performers would actually be seen.

I tried settling it by declaring gold neutral. Nia asked neutral toward what. 'My taste,' I said. 'That's one of the parties,' she replied.

The game's painting helper did not occupy the same role as its main player. Our decorators had different jobs too, which became obvious when I touched a control and turned the curtains purple.

Velvet liked it. Kit hated it. Mika saved the setting for Velvet's number and restored Kit's.

Two looks. One room. Nigga, they had solved the dispute without commissioning a sculpture. I asked for a photograph before anybody improved it further.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the painted world if its actions and unequal helper roles fit. Our lighting compromise permits two tastes and has temporarily removed my thumb from the control panel.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1123450/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P178 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Rakuen

Edition considered: PC release

A hospital story opens into a fantastical world, connecting exploration and puzzles with the lives and feelings of people encountered along the way.

What you do. Guide the character through scenes, speak with people, explore the storybook world and solve puzzles that connect their stories.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Illness and grief are central, while non-combat play still includes movement, navigation and puzzle demands that need checking.

Why it might click. Rakuen follows a boy and his mother as helping people in a fantasy world reveals the lives of people around him. Music and character stories connect the two settings. The developer explicitly describes a non-combat adventure with puzzles and dialogue-based mysteries.

The full catch. Hospital life, illness, grief, and unfinished relationships are central themes. Non-combat does not mean no navigation or difficult puzzle. Check walking, object interaction, text advance, and any eerie sections; decide separately whether the emotional subject is welcome.

Try this first. Explore a small early area and speak with one person. Test the ordinary movement and the way information is presented. Continue for interest in the people, with permission to stop before an emotional scene feels like an obligation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P178 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Rakuen

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Quiet Corner Had Actual Company

Rakuen's hospital story changed the room's pace. Rosa wanted to hear the beginning. Tank sat beside her without reaching for the microphone somebody had left on the chair.

I began to explain why a powerful story required respectful attention. Shawna gently removed the microphone from my own hand. Apparently I had acquired it during the explanation.

Rae asked Nia whether she wanted company or a little space. 'Company,' Nia said. Rae settled beside her.

Across the room, Velvet needed a clasp repaired before performing. Kit took her glasses off, realised she needed them for the clasp, and put them back on with considerable dignity.

The game could carry illness and grief without our summit turning them into a test of anybody's seriousness. Rosa watched until she wanted to stop. Tank asked about tea.

I went to fetch it and returned with the correct number of cups. No announcement. Shawna made room for me.

Later, Velvet thanked Kit from the stage. Her clasp stayed shut; my mouth mostly followed its example.

Aiden's verdict. Consider Rakuen if its grief and illness themes feel welcome alongside exploration and puzzles. Tonight's quiet corner offers company without charging anyone an explanation for leaving.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/559210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P179 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

To the Moon

Edition considered: PC original release

Follow a person's memories toward a final wish, discovering how small details change the meaning of an emotionally focused story over time.

What you do. Explore scenes from a life, examine important objects and follow conversations that gradually connect the memories.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Bereavement and emotional revelations matter; non-combat storytelling still leaves movement and particular interaction sequences to check.

Why it might click. To the Moon follows two doctors working backward through a dying man's memories to understand and fulfill his final wish. Its compact story links small details across a life. Music and changing context supply much of the emotional effect.

The full catch. The developer describes a non-combat experience, but movement, searching for objects, and puzzle interfaces remain. Bereavement and questions about memory and relationships carry significant emotional weight. Verify text advance and the particular PC version rather than assuming all ports behave alike.

Try this first. Play through an early memory investigation, noticing whether gathering its clues supports your curiosity. There is no need to solve the eventual meaning in advance. Check whether the dialogue rhythm and movement let the story land comfortably.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P179 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

To the Moon

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Final Wish Had an Itemised Estimate

To the Moon's journey through memories prompted Remy to ask what single moment we would preserve. I chose my entrance before the question had reached its full stop.

June chose lending Dez her jacket in 1967. Dez chose June pretending she had not offered it because Dez was cold. Both claimed the better memory. Neither reached for the coat.

Nia chose something nobody else had noticed: Rae quietly repairing the wobble in a stranger's chair, then acting as if furniture routinely cured itself.

Rae looked down at her hands. 'You remember that?' 'I was watching you,' Nia said.

I nearly offered a professional photographer. Porsche caught my eye and shook her head. Even my generosity had learned to arrive with too much equipment.

The game's emotional revelations deserved room to unfold. So did the little revelation beside us. Rae touched Nia's wrist and left her hand there.

I changed my answer to dinner. Shawna smiled. 'Which part?' 'The part where you stayed.'

She leaned against me. Nigga, I finally found a memory that did not need a larger screen.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the memory story if its emotional weight and interactions suit. My preserved summit moment has been revised to include another person doing something besides applauding me.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC original release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/206440/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P180 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Finding Paradise

Edition considered: PC release

Discover a life through memories and conflicting wishes, with a standalone story that gives its character's contradictions room to matter and develop.

What you do. Explore remembered scenes, examine significant objects and follow conversations that reveal the circumstances behind a difficult wish.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Reading, walking and details that matter later require attention, while end-of-life material remains central to the story.

Why it might click. Finding Paradise is a standalone follow-up in the memory-traversing series. The doctors investigate Colin's life and a wish whose apparent contradictions invite a closer look. It offers another character-centered story about how a life can mean more than its neatest explanation.

The full catch. Expect reading, walking, and attention to details that gain significance later. End-of-life material remains central. The publisher says previous games are not required, but that does not establish identical controls or a complete absence of unusual sequences.

Try this first. Follow the first substantial memory scene and identify one question you want answered. Check ordinary movement and dialogue handling. Let the uncertainty be part of the pleasure rather than trying to create a complete timeline immediately.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P180 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Finding Paradise

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Paradise Needed One Less Trumpet

Finding Paradise's conflicting wishes gave the table a question worth arguing about: what would make the rest of tonight perfect?

Velvet wanted her full fee and the last chorus. Kit wanted karaoke without a spotlight making her look like a witness. Remy wanted the fanfare nobody had authorised him to play twice.

Rae wanted Nia to stop rewriting their dance invitation as though it might be appealed. Nia wanted Rae to understand that the extra sentence was a joke.

I wanted everybody to get everything. Mika asked whether that included my trumpet player. Shawna said the trumpet player had already gone home.

The contradictions in the memory story were not going to resolve because I announced harmony. Neither were ours. We chose an order, left gaps and let the second fanfare go.

Nia folded the invitation and took Rae's hand instead. The message became considerably easier to read.

I accepted a trumpet-free ending. My wife promised it would leave us more interesting things to hear.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the contradictory wishes if the reading and end-of-life story appeal. Our perfect evening now permits different desires, and its trumpeter has been released into a separate paradise.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/337340/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P181 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Impostor Factory

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a strange murder-and-memory story in which familiar situations twist into something unexpected, with a standalone narrative and unsettling comic touches throughout.

What you do. Explore scenes, examine objects and follow conversations as the story rearranges what familiar events appear to mean.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Its time-loop premise does not establish actual timer behavior; movement, interaction sequences and disturbing material still need checking.

Why it might click. Impostor Factory begins with a strange party and a time-loop murder mystery, then develops into a broader narrative. Its mixture of absurd comedy and emotional storytelling makes it a candidate for someone who enjoys being led somewhere they did not initially expect.

The full catch. The publisher permits independent play but notes that series order affects the experience. Expect reading, walking, deaths, and disturbing imagery within the mystery. The time-loop premise does not itself verify the absence of timed tasks or unfamiliar input sequences.

Try this first. Follow the opening invitation and inspect an early area without looking up the eventual explanation. Check movement and dialogue handling. Decide whether the strange humor earns your trust before committing to the story's later changes of direction.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P181 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Impostor Factory

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Second Entrance Cost the Same as the First

Impostor Factory's looping strangeness made Mika suggest replaying our opening entrance for the camera. I agreed, thrilled to discover time travel with a booking number.

Rae stayed seated. 'I saw it.' 'This version will be definitive.' 'The first version was sufficiently loud.'

Nia offered to play the astonished witness. She delivered a gasp so extravagantly false that Velvet immediately asked whether she wanted paid stage work.

I backed through the doors. Remy played the wrong fanfare. The photographer's battery died just as Tank brought in a tray of sandwiches.

Everybody turned toward the sandwiches. Again.

The game's murder-and-memory twists remained its own business. Our recurring mystery concerned why I kept expecting a room full of hungry adults to prefer my arrival to bread.

On the third attempt, Shawna met me at the door and kissed me instead. The photographer found a spare battery too late.

'We could repeat that,' I whispered. 'After you stop calling it definitive,' she said. I abandoned the entrance and kept the possibility.

Aiden's verdict. Try the unsettling standalone story if its twists and interactions appeal. My repeated entrance has been replaced by something worth repeating without a photographer or a fanfare.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1182620/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P182 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

A Bird Story

Edition considered: PC release

A short, largely wordless story uses animation and small interactions to follow a boy and a bird through an imaginative, emotional experience.

What you do. Guide the character through brief scenes and follow the changing relationship through gestures, movement and visual events.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Little reading does not remove movement or input checks; this is a compact interactive story rather than a complex mystery.

Why it might click. A Bird Story is a short, wordless interactive animation about a boy and an injured bird. Its small scale and reliance on images make it distinct from the more dialogue-heavy games nearby. The developer explicitly presents it as an experiment, not To the Moon's sequel.

The full catch. Fewer words do not eliminate movement, interaction, or waiting through a deliberately authored sequence. The child-and-bird story still has emotional stakes. Check the ordinary controls and whether the amount of interaction matches what you want from a game tonight.

Try this first. Follow the first simple routine and observe how images communicate the relationship. Let the initial section show you its rhythm. If you want many decisions or extensive dialogue, use that preference to choose another page rather than forcing this one.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P182 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Bird Story

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Bird Needed No Coalition Badge

A Bird Story's largely wordless little journey made Remy decide to rehearse his entrance without the fanfare. He pointed toward the stage, placed a hand over his heart and bowed.

Kit thought he was asking for the bathroom. She pointed down the hall.

Velvet understood immediately and gave him a grand answering bow. The exchange became a silent duel of increasingly unnecessary dignity. Tank put down his sandwich to watch.

I tried joining with a gesture meaning beloved host. Shawna interpreted it as indigestion and offered me water.

Nia sketched two figures dancing on the back of a programme. Her handwriting could frighten an experienced printer, but the little drawing was clear. Rae took it and added a third figure carrying the coats.

'That me?' I asked. 'You wanted a role,' Rae said.

The game's small interactions did not need us to invent a complex mystery. Nor did the picture. I would carry the coats while the women danced.

Remy finally found the stage. Kit applauded him for locating it.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the compact story if its wordless approach and interactions appeal. The coat-carrier understands his illustrated assignment, and Remy's silent entrance no longer points toward the toilets.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/327410/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P183 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

OPUS: Rocket of Whispers

Edition considered: PC release

Gather and build toward a meaningful farewell in a world shaped by loss, with exploration and crafting supporting the emotional story.

What you do. Travel through locations, gather materials, craft what is needed and follow the characters working toward their shared purpose.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Gathering and travel add practical work, while plague, bereavement and grief make the story emotionally demanding despite its gentle appearance.

Why it might click. Rocket of Whispers connects exploring a ruined snowy world with building a rocket to honor the dead. Objects found along the way reveal history as well as supplying materials. The gathering has an emotional purpose shared by the surviving characters.

The full catch. Expect travel, searching, equipment crafting, and keeping track of needed supplies. Plague aftermath, loss, and saying goodbye are central. The store's single-player description is explicit; two protagonists do not imply two-player control. Check navigation and repeated collection demands.

Try this first. Explore an early area and bring back one useful material or discovered story. Notice whether the search feels purposeful or repetitive. A strong emotional premise need not compensate for a gathering loop you do not enjoy.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P183 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

OPUS: Rocket of Whispers

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Rocket Was for a Farewell, Not My Press Kit

Rocket of Whispers brought its work of gathering toward a farewell into the room. Mercedes wanted the song heard without another announcement over the opening.

I lifted my hand toward the microphone, caught Shawna's expression and used the motion to adjust my collar. Nigga, a smooth recovery known to absolutely nobody.

Rosa remembered someone who would have loved the song. She told Tank one small story about them. He asked for another, and she chose to give it.

Across the table, Rae straightened the place cards. Nia helped without making the work into an excuse to ask a difficult question.

I had ordered a tiny decorative rocket for the centrepiece. Mika found it beside a box labelled AIDEN ASCENDS and turned the label toward the wall.

The game's loss belonged to its story. The room's memories belonged to whoever wanted to share them. Mercedes finished, and nobody rushed to fill the pause.

Then Rosa asked whether the tea was still hot. I checked before answering.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the farewell journey when its grief and practical gathering both feel welcome. Our centrepiece has surrendered its publicity campaign so the song can belong to the people hearing it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/742250/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P184 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

OPUS: Echo of Starsong - Full Bloom Edition

Edition considered: PC Full Bloom Edition

Travel through an emotional science-fiction story where mysterious songs, remembered relationships and exploration give the journey its distinctive sense of longing and discovery.

What you do. Read conversations, explore locations, manage journey resources and work through light puzzles connected to the characters' search.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The voiced edition uses Japanese or Chinese audio with English text; resource choices and reading still need attention.

Why it might click. Full Bloom presents a voiced, visual-novel-style space adventure following Jun and Eda in search of mysterious starsongs. Their journey connects personal motives with conflict, ancient places, and other travelers. Music and the relationship between the leads are central attractions.

The full catch. The official page describes light puzzles and resource management alongside narrative scenes. English subtitles/interface are listed, while the checked full-audio languages are Japanese and Chinese. Check reading, exploration, and sound-puzzle presentation; the word accessible in marketing is not a complete control audit.

Try this first. Follow an early exchange, then inspect one exploration or travel decision. Confirm language settings and whether the sound-related information is presented in a usable way. Continue if the relationship interests you as much as the scenery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P184 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

OPUS: Echo of Starsong - Full Bloom Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Starsong Was in the Wrong Key for Me

Echo of Starsong made Mercedes talk about a melody she remembered more clearly than the person who first played it. Porsche knew exactly which recording she meant.

I claimed an excellent ear. Mercedes played three notes. I named an expensive restaurant. 'That's where I heard them,' I said.

Kit called it a promising start for a menu.

The voiced game still carried English text for us to read. Nia adjusted her chair to see it. Rae moved her own rather than narrating over Nia's shoulder.

Remy wanted a piece of the music for his entrance. Velvet reminded him that wanting something beautiful did not put it in their show. He settled for asking Mercedes to help with his own tune.

I tried humming along. Shawna laid one finger against my lips, smiling. That was the most persuasive musical direction I received all night.

The strange journey kept its songs. Our room found a quieter harmony: Rae and Nia reading together, Porsche listening, and me temporarily absent from the soundtrack.

Aiden's verdict. Travel with the songs if the reading and resource choices suit. My excellent ear remains available, provided nobody mistakes it for permission to add my voice.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually opened Steam app1504500 and verified exact Full Bloom Edition title, voice-language table, narrative/exploration/light puzzle/resource description. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1504500/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P185 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

I Was a Teenage Exocolonist

Edition considered: PC release

Shape a life in a science-fiction colony, where relationships, remembered experiences and card-based decisions develop across years with consequences for the surrounding community.

What you do. Choose activities, build relationships, use experience cards and make decisions as the character grows within the colony.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Cards, skills, schedules and branching relationships require heavy tracking; the attractive setting also includes danger, death and difficult personal material.

Why it might click. This narrative roleplaying game follows ten formative years in an alien colony. Experiences become cards used in challenges, while activities and relationships influence the future. Its appeal is watching personal growth and a larger community's fate affect one another.

The full catch. Cards, skills, schedules, and branching relationships create substantial system and memory demands. The attractive watercolor setting includes danger, death, and difficult personal material. Inspect challenge rules and content information rather than treating a youthful cast as proof of lightness.

Try this first. Choose an early activity and learn one card challenge deliberately. Pay attention to a character whose company you enjoy. Decide whether the cards make your history feel meaningful or add a management layer you would prefer to avoid.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P185 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

I Was a Teenage Exocolonist

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Colony Rejected My Ten-Year Plan

I Was a Teenage Exocolonist made me wonder what our summit might become over ten years. I pictured recurring galas, an annual portrait and a building with my name above the lifts. Mika pictured a useful storage cupboard. Rae pictured replacing the workshop kettle. Nia pictured knowing Rae well enough to stop asking how strong she liked her coffee. 'That last one has a shorter procurement route,' Velvet said.

The game's years, relationships and cards promised more to track than one attractive beginning. I was proposing a decade before we had agreed what happened after dessert.

Kit asked which year included returning her glasses. They were on my programme. Again. I handed them over and abandoned the educational institute bearing my initials.

Rae asked Nia to visit the workshop next week. Nia accepted and wrote the day clearly for once. I suggested making it an official summit follow-up. Shawna pulled my chair closer. 'Baby, you can have a future without chairing everybody else's.'

Aiden's verdict. Try the colony life if its branching systems and difficult material interest you. The summit has declined my decade of portraits while two people have successfully arranged next Thursday.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1148760/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P186 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Growing Up

Edition considered: PC release

Guide a life through interests, skills and school choices, with a nostalgic setting and everyday decisions gradually opening different possible futures for the character.

What you do. Choose activities, develop abilities, manage opportunities and take part in school-related tasks and minigames as time passes.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Numerous skills, planning decisions, exams and minigames can turn the life story into a substantial menu and tracking task.

Why it might click. Growing Up combines a coming-of-age story with choosing activities and developing skills. Friendships and family continuity give the schedules a narrative context, while its nineties setting offers a particular flavor of ordinary life and remembered ambitions.

The full catch. The primary description explicitly includes aptitude mini-games, exams, daily scheduling, many skills, and varied outcomes. This is a management-rich life game, not only dialogue. Check the mini-game inputs and whether balancing the systems feels enjoyable rather than like another planner.

Try this first. Set one early schedule, try its associated activity, and see how a friendship develops around it. Use the result to judge the management loop. There is no need to optimize a whole childhood before deciding whether you like playing one day.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P186 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Growing Up

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Life Coach Failed Lunch

Growing Up's everyday choices prompted me to describe the summit as an educational opportunity. Remy asked what we had learned. Tank said decorative chairs rarely improved a man's back.

I proposed a timetable for personal growth. Rae looked at it and found no lunch. 'Nigga, your future is hungry.'

Kit had once spent a whole summer learning a difficult song to impress somebody. She admitted she no longer remembered the person's name. She still knew the song.

Nia asked to hear it. Kit said she would, after her actual place in the programme. A personal achievement with excellent boundaries around its encore.

The game could make interests and skills accumulate across a life. Our evening did not need every conversation turned into a qualification.

Mika used the back of my timetable to draw the remaining stage positions. Velvet approved the space around her skirt.

Shawna asked what I wanted to learn next. I said how to make her stay beside me. 'Start by ordering lunch,' she replied.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the life choices if planning, exams and menus sound enjoyable. My personal-growth timetable now includes lunch and no longer awards a certificate for sitting beside my wife.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1191120/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P187 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Volcano Princess

Edition considered: PC release

Guide a young character's development through activities and relationships in a fantasy setting, seeing how many choices shape the life ahead of her.

What you do. Choose activities, develop skills, manage relationships and consider how different opportunities fit the character's growing interests and future.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Menus, statistics and many activities require planning; parental death and conflict accompany the development story, so inspect each activity's controls.

Why it might click. Volcano Princess mixes a fantasy coming-of-age story with arranging a daughter's activities, studies, and relationships. Different interests can lead toward different lives. The attraction is seeing a character develop through the choices and people around her.

The full catch. Menus, stats, planning, and multiple activity types are a substantial part of play. The story begins after a parent's death and includes conflict and combat-related training. Inspect each activity's controls and avoid treating the parenting premise as a simple conversation game.

Try this first. Choose one early activity and see how its result connects to a conversation or new opportunity. Check the calendar and character information together. Continue if guiding development is enjoyable without needing a supposedly perfect outcome.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P187 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Volcano Princess

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Princess Had Not Applied to My Academy

Volcano Princess's development choices made me announce that I could recognise potential. Velvet asked whether that explained the gold chair whose upholstery had surrendered before the opening. I said I meant people. 'Then let them finish introducing themselves,' Rae replied.

Remy wanted to learn a quieter way to enter a room. Kit offered to coach him. He took one dignified step, whispered his stage name and made himself laugh.

Nia applauded. Rae asked whether the whisper came with a smaller invoice. Velvet defended his fee while requesting that he keep the ridiculous whisper in the show.

The game's young character belonged to its own story of guidance and consequences. The adults around me were perfectly capable of choosing which new thing to try.

I offered a scholarship anyway. Shawna handed me the replacement upholstery quote. 'Fund that first.'

Remy made a second entrance. The whisper landed beautifully. I paid for the chair and received no credit for developing his talent.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the development story if its many activities and heavier themes suit. Remy's new entrance belongs to Remy; my educational foundation currently repairs one gold chair.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1669980/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P188 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Long Live The Queen

Edition considered: PC release

Plan a young ruler's education while dangerous events test what she has learned, making preparation and consequences the central attraction of the story.

What you do. Select lessons and activities, develop abilities and make story decisions whose outcomes depend on the skills already learned.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. This is a difficult planning detour with dangerous outcomes and death; substantial skill tracking matters more than the gentle-looking artwork.

Why it might click. Long Live The Queen makes preparation and choices the center of a perilous royal coming-of-age story. Learning which skills and decisions help the young heir survive can become a puzzle across attempts. It is an option for someone who actively enjoys that kind of consequence.

The full catch. The official premise emphasizes threats and survival. Skill planning, hidden consequences, and character death make this a deliberate detour rather than a low-pressure suggestion. Cute presentation does not soften the underlying challenge into a guaranteed easy evening.

Try this first. Inspect the training choices and follow an early consequence. Ask whether discovering how the system works is enjoyable even when an outcome goes badly. If avoiding punishing decisions is a hard preference, choose another story immediately.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P188 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Long Live The Queen

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Long Live the Woman Who Found the Switch

Long Live The Queen made Velvet declare that a crown required preparation. She opened her costume case, checked three fastenings and asked Remy to stand clear of the feathers.

I said natural majesty needed no rehearsal. At that moment my ceremonial sash slid off one shoulder and took a bread roll with it.

Kit caught the roll. Rae caught the sash. Nobody attempted to catch my authority.

The young ruler's dangerous education on screen carried consequences beyond its gentle appearance. Our own royal programme carried a simpler danger: I had ordered the spotlight to follow whichever crown was tallest.

Velvet's crown won. So did her performance, which had been rehearsed. I remained beside the darkened table holding a sash with butter on it.

Nia found the ordinary lamp switch so Rae could read the final wording. No palace intrigue required. Shawna pinned my sash properly. 'There,' she said. 'You may survive the remainder of dinner.' Nigga, I accepted the favourable prediction.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the ruler's difficult planning only if its danger and tracking appeal. The summit crown rewards rehearsal, while my continued reign depends on a pin and ordinary table lighting.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/251990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P189 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Roadwarden

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a text-led journey through a difficult region, choosing routes and responses while supplies, time and encounters give the travel meaningful consequences.

What you do. Read locations and conversations, choose actions, manage supplies and decide which paths or duties to pursue on the journey.

Dialogue / text choices | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Heavy reading, survival resources, health and limited in-game time add pressure; exact input timing remains unverified.

Why it might click. Roadwarden offers a richly written fantasy journey through settlements, roads, and uncertain loyalties. Its text-based roleplaying combines conversation, inventory problems, survival, and discoveries about a particular place. The pleasure is becoming familiar with a world through attentive decisions.

The full catch. The source explicitly mentions hit points, survival mechanics, and quests restricted by in-game time. Reading at your own pace does not remove that strategic pressure. Expect substantial text and several tracked resources; inspect any typed-response or menu operations.

Try this first. Reach an early conversation or travel choice and identify what it costs in the game's systems. Make one decision because you are curious about its result. Judge whether the prose and the management work well together for you.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P189 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Roadwarden

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Roadwarden Carried the Wrong Briefcase

Roadwarden's consequential journey made Rae ask what we actually needed for the walk to the signing table. Nia named the agreed draft. Kit named her glasses. Velvet named space for the dress. I arrived with a briefcase containing a speech, a spare speech and a photograph of me looking available for questions.

Rosa opened it, found no water and shut it again. 'You've packed a drought.'

The text-led traveller had supplies and limited time to consider. We had a room full of people whose patience could not be restocked by saying almost ready.

Mika checked the route. Remy moved his microphone stand. Dre lifted the casserole out of the only clear place for the document and put it where Tank could protect it.

Rae slipped the draft into my empty briefcase. 'There. Now you're useful luggage.'

I carried it carefully. Shawna walked beside me, one hand on my arm. Nigga, the journey improved as soon as the cargo stopped being my autobiography.

Aiden's verdict. Take the text-led road if survival resources, reading and limited in-game time sound engaging. My briefcase now transports the agreement instead of three versions of my importance.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1155970/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P190 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Life and Suffering of Sir Brante

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a life shaped by a rigid social order, with consequential choices about identity, loyalty and ambition giving the narrative its serious weight.

What you do. Read the character's developing life, choose responses and commitments, and follow how decisions alter relationships and possible futures.

Dialogue / text choices | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense reading and long-term planning accompany oppression, death and costly consequences; this is a deliberately heavy narrative option.

Why it might click. This narrative roleplaying game follows a life within a harsh fantasy empire. Decisions, learned traits, family ties, and social position shape possible paths. It offers the pleasure of tracing how personal ambitions interact with an unjust and powerful order.

The full catch. The publisher calls it a hardcore narrative RPG and emphasizes costly consequences, oppression, death, and rebirth. Dense reading and long-term planning are central burdens. Treat it as a deliberate heavy-story option, not a gentle alternative simply because much of the action is written.

Try this first. Read an early chapter and inspect how one decision changes a relationship or trait. Decide whether you want to inhabit this society's pressures. You can value the writing without accepting the emotional weight of a full life inside it.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P190 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Life and Suffering of Sir Brante

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Sir Aiden's Suffering Was Mostly Upholstery

The Life and Suffering of Sir Brante made me consider how social order shaped a person. I started with the injustice of discovering my reserved chair had been moved.

Tank pointed across the room. 'It's by the socket.' 'I had a place of honour.' 'Now your phone has a place to charge.'

Nia wanted to hear the game's choices without me converting every serious premise into an allegory about my seating. Rae wanted to ask her about a difficult decision she had once made.

Nia answered. Not with a lesson for the room. With a story about leaving a job she had worked very hard to get.

Rae listened, then said she was glad the decision had brought Nia here. Nia smiled slowly.

The fictional hierarchy remained cruel. Our room did not need one. Kit took the chair nearest the lamp; Velvet took the space her costume required.

I sat beside Shawna. My suffering ended at a perfectly reasonable cushion.

Aiden's verdict. Consider this heavy life story for its consequential choices and dense reading. Sir Aiden has survived relocation to an ordinary cushion without requiring anyone else's place in the room.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1272160/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P191 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Suzerain

Edition considered: PC base game; Kingdom of Rizia expansion separate

Lead a fictional country through political choices, competing interests and personal relationships, with reports and conversations revealing the consequences of your decisions over time.

What you do. Read briefings, speak with political figures, choose policies and manage relationships that affect the country and the president's family.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense reading, many factions and difficult consequences create heavy tracking; the base-game card excludes the separate Rizia expansion.

Why it might click. As President Anton Rayne, you navigate Sordland's political institutions, economy, international relationships and family life. The attraction is sustained argument: people want incompatible things, and a policy decision can become a personal problem later.

The full catch. This is a dense reading and decision game with a codex, reports and many relationships to remember. Political violence and harsh outcomes add pressure. The inspected description does not establish every input's timing or hold requirements. This card covers the base game, excluding the Rizia expansion.

Try this first. Read the opening political setup and one conversation. Judge whether identifying factions feels intriguing or like an unwanted meeting. A companion can discuss priorities without supplying the supposedly correct ideology.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P191 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Suzerain

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The President Lost the Dessert Vote

Suzerain's competing interests turned the final dessert decision into a summit election. I nominated chocolate because a statesman should stand for something.

Rosa nominated fruit because we had already eaten three courses. Tank supported both positions with remarkable ideological flexibility.

Nia wanted a choice. Rae wanted whoever chose cheesecake to admit the hotel version was mediocre. Velvet demanded that dessert arrive before her lipstick had to be repaired again.

I proposed a grand coalition platter. Mika approved the spectacle, then discovered I had ordered it on a slab of ice with my initials carved through the middle.

The waiter asked where the meltwater should go. Nobody voted for the final draft.

The game's reports and factions could keep their complicated consequences. Our platter moved to the bar, where its initials gradually dissolved into a bucket.

Shawna fed me a strawberry. 'Still leading?' she asked. 'From the centre.'

'Nigga, you're standing over the drain,' Tank said. I accepted the fruit and declined a second election.

Aiden's verdict. Try the political story if its reading and faction tracking interest you. Our dessert coalition offers a choice, and the president's initials are no longer threatening the agreement.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1207650/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P192 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Yes, Your Grace

Edition considered: PC first game

Hear a kingdom's petitioners while balancing scarce resources, family needs and dangerous alliances, giving each political choice an immediate human face and cost.

What you do. Listen to requests, allocate resources, speak with family members and consider alliances and preparations as the kingdom's problems develop.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Requests conflict and resources run out; strategic preparation and harsh family outcomes prevent the throne screen from guaranteeing carefree play.

Why it might click. King Eryk hears petitioners, manages scarce resources and tries to protect his family and kingdom. Small requests sit beside larger alliances and threats, giving decisions an immediate human face rather than reducing everything to an abstract national graph.

The full catch. Resources run out, requests conflict and family decisions can hurt. The presentation includes strategic preparation and dangerous events; a throne screen is not a promise of carefree play. Verify the controls and pause behavior in the chosen PC version before assuming all situations wait.

Try this first. Hear the first petition and look at the resources attached to an answer. Ask whether saying no feels satisfyingly consequential or simply unpleasant. Stop without treating a difficult decision as something you must finish tonight.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P192 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Yes, Your Grace

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Your Grace Owes the Singer Money

Yes, Your Grace put petitioners before a ruler. Velvet immediately stood in front of my chair and requested the balance of her fee.

'A powerful dramatic parallel,' I said. 'A bank transfer,' she replied.

Remy wanted the spare microphone battery. Rosa wanted two people to move the hot tray. Shawna wanted me to stop referring to her perfectly ordinary request as the queen's business.

I spread my hands to suggest the burden of command. Rae put a tray in them. Nigga, the kingdom had identified an available resource.

Nia read the last practical clause to Mika while I carried dinner. They changed a clumsy phrase without asking whether history would remember the amendment.

The game's scarce resources and family stakes gave its petitions weight. Ours had weight too, especially the tray.

I paid Velvet before sitting down. She smiled and kissed my cheek, leaving a lipstick mark the exact size of my improved financial behaviour.

Shawna inspected it. 'Good. Now the invoice has a receipt.'

Aiden's verdict. Consider the petitioning kingdom if conflicting needs and harsh outcomes appeal. Our ruler has discovered that paying the performer resolves her request more effectively than describing his burden.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1115690/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P193 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Orwell: Keeping an Eye On You

Edition considered: PC first game

Investigate digital records for a surveillance programme, deciding which details to submit and discovering how your selections can change somebody else's life and apparent guilt.

What you do. Read messages, profiles and files, connect information, and choose which pieces of evidence to pass onward through the interface.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense records, names and relationships require tracking; evidence-transfer controls and any timing demands need a direct check.

Why it might click. You investigate digital records for a state surveillance program and decide what information to submit. The pleasure lies in connecting messages, profiles and apparent contradictions, then noticing how your selection shapes somebody else's fate.

The full catch. Expect substantial reading, interface switching and memory for names and relationships. Surveillance, terrorism and personal intrusion are central themes. Selecting or transferring evidence needs a direct input check; the premise alone cannot certify mouse-only ease, no dragging or an absence of timed sections.

Try this first. Examine one person's available records and identify two details that might mean different things together. Before forwarding evidence, decide whether the ethical discomfort interests you. A companion can compare interpretations while one person operates the interface.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P193 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Orwell: Keeping an Eye On You

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Surveillance System Found My Shopping Basket

Orwell's records made Mika joke that the summit needed a fact checker. I offered my phone as evidence of impeccable organisation.

Porsche glanced at the open shopping basket. It contained a rotating portrait stand, six ceremonial pens and a fountain shaped like a handshake.

'The fountain was research,' I said. Rae folded her arms. 'Into what? Wet sleeves?'

Nia wanted the final draft checked, not anybody's private messages. She slid that document across the table. Mika compared the actual wording with the practical arrangements already agreed.

Velvet caught a mistaken performance time. Remy caught his stage name spelled as King Recess. He briefly considered keeping it.

The game made selecting evidence consequential. Our little check worked because it concerned the thing we were about to use.

I closed the shopping basket without buying the fountain. Shawna looked delighted, which suggested a purchase cancellation could occasionally function as foreplay.

I did not ask to have that observation included in the minutes.

Aiden's verdict. Investigate the surveillance story if dense records and consequential selections appeal. The summit checked its draft, and my handshake fountain remains an unpurchased threat to dry clothing.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/491950/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P194 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Orwell: Ignorance is Strength

Edition considered: PC sequel

Investigate political information and manipulation in a darker surveillance story, where deciding what to investigate and when affects the narrative that emerges from the records.

What you do. Read digital records, compare accounts, choose investigative leads and consider how selected information shapes a political story.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The time-of-day system adds scheduling pressure; dense records remain, and actual real-time or pause behavior is not fully verified.

Why it might click. This second Orwell story places you in a darker investigation shaped by political narratives and information manipulation. It can reward a reader who enjoys noticing how an apparently factual detail becomes a persuasive weapon.

The full catch. The official description introduces a time-of-day system and decisions about whom to investigate and when. That establishes scheduling pressure inside the story, not a verified real-time countdown or a no-timer guarantee. Expect dense records, unsettling politics and morally compromised work.

Try this first. Read the first assignment and inspect how the interface represents time before making several moves. Decide whether tracking opportunities sounds engaging. Discuss one competing interpretation with a companion without assuming the game offers a neutral choice.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P194 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Orwell: Ignorance is Strength

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Headline Arrived Before the Agreement

Ignorance is Strength's information manipulation gave Porsche an idea for catching my latest excess. She found the announcement I had prepared: HISTORIC SUMMIT HAILS HOST.

'We haven't agreed the final sentence,' Nia said. 'The headline anticipates momentum,' I explained. Velvet took my phone and read the subheading. It claimed thunderous applause. Remy offered to generate some, but only after his fee cleared.

Rae suggested a more accurate headline: MAN ORDERS THINGS. Tank wanted a photograph of the receipt.

The game's time-of-day choices made the order of information matter. Our announcement had jumped over the part where people decided what they actually wanted to say.

Mika replaced it with the starting time and the room number. Both facts survived immediate scrutiny. Nia and Rae bent over the last line together. Their shoulders touched; neither moved away.

I asked Porsche whether we could retain historic. She said the hotel lift had broken twice, which gave me a better chance of being remembered as upstairs.

Aiden's verdict. Try the darker information story if its scheduling pressure and records interest you. Our announcement now reports a room and a time instead of predicting universal gratitude.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/633060/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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| Niggas, games up. | Niggas, pens out. | Niggas, chairs in. | Niggas, snacks here. | Niggas, receipts ready. |
| Niggas, lights on. | Niggas, mic check. | Niggas, take turns. | Niggas, dance later. | Niggas, read first. |
| Niggas, pick freely. | Niggas, no rush. | Niggas, sign here. | Niggas, stay petty. | Niggas, we're good. |

P195 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Emily is Away

Edition considered: PC first game

Follow a relationship through a nostalgic instant-messenger interface, where brief exchanges and changing profiles convey uncertainty, growing apart and things left unsaid across several years.

What you do. Read messages and profiles, choose responses, and use the messenger's keyboard interactions as conversations move through different stages.

Dialogue / text choices | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Test the actual typing demand and text size; relationship regret can weigh more heavily than the small interface suggests.

Why it might click. A simulated desktop and instant messenger frame a relationship across several years. Buddy profiles, changing circumstances and brief exchanges turn a familiar piece of technology into a story about growing apart, uncertainty and what people leave unsaid.

The full catch. Reading is central, and the messenger presentation includes keyboard interaction that should be tried directly. Do not assume every message is simply a pointer click or that arbitrary typing works identically across versions. Relationship regret may carry more weight than the small interface suggests.

Try this first. Choose a screen name and follow the first conversation far enough to feel its rhythm. Check the actual typing demand and text size. The useful question is whether the intimacy of messaging appeals, rather than whether you chose the best reply.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P195 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Emily is Away

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Nia Was Typing for an Unreasonable Amount of Time

Emily is Away's brief messages made Nia admit she had drafted Rae's dance invitation three different ways. Rae was sitting beside her when she confessed this.

'You could have asked,' Rae said. 'I did. Eventually.' 'You sent a paragraph.'

Nia showed her the unsent version. Rae read two lines and started laughing. It contained the phrase subject to mutual scheduling, which no slow dance had previously required.

I offered help. Shawna held out my own last message to her: AWAIT DEVELOPMENTS. Beneath it sat her reply: Bring the room key.

Velvet said men should not be allowed to abbreviate romance until they could locate a door.

The game's relationship could carry things left unsaid. Ours had briefly suffered from too many words said in advance.

Rae took Nia's hand. 'After the signing. One song. Then we'll see.' Nia stopped typing.

I sent Shawna a new message from six inches away. Got the key. She read it, smiled and pocketed my phone.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the messenger relationship if its text and regret feel inviting. Nia's invitation has become one spoken sentence, while my own romantic correspondence has finally located the key.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/417860/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P196 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

We Know the Devil

Edition considered: PC release

Three teenagers at a religious camp face an unsettling story about closeness, exclusion and belonging, with relationships carrying the tension of the visual novel.

What you do. Read the characters' exchanges and make choices about their time together, following how closeness shifts among the three.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Psychological horror, religious pressure and isolation are central; quiet-looking controls do not make the subject gentle or certify all inputs.

Why it might click. This visual novel uses a small cast and a threatening camp setting to explore belonging, exclusion and queer identity. Which characters spend time together matters, creating room for conversation about relationships rather than inventory puzzles or navigation.

The full catch. Psychological horror, religious pressure, isolation and an alarming soundscape are integral to the experience. Light movement demands would not make the subject gentle. The inspected page supports its visual-novel form but does not independently verify every advance input or the absence of all timing demands.

Try this first. Read the opening exchange and listen to a short portion of the atmosphere at a comfortable volume. Decide whether this kind of unease is welcome before pursuing a route. Nobody owes the camp a complete visit.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P196 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

We Know the Devil

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Three Chairs and Nobody on the Outside

We Know the Devil's tension around closeness and exclusion made Kit look at the little seating cluster by the screen. Two chairs faced it properly. The third faced a plant.

'Who designed this?' she asked. I praised the intimacy before noticing where Remy was sitting. He raised one hand from behind the leaves. 'I'm having a very intense relationship with a fern.'

Velvet moved her chair sideways. Remy moved his forward. Kit adjusted the lamp, then asked whether everyone actually wanted this horror story tonight.

Rae did. Nia preferred to hear about it later. She went to help Rosa with dessert, taking no committee's disappointment with her.

The game's teenagers faced their own unsettling story. Our adult guests could simply want different things.

I started moving a fourth chair into the cluster for myself. Shawna tapped my shoulder. She had found a quiet table with two seats and no fern.

Nigga, I discovered a powerful commitment to leaving the arrangement alone.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the visual novel only if its psychological and religious horror feels welcome. Our third chair now faces the screen; choosing another seat does not require a defence.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/435300/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P197 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

A Normal Lost Phone

Edition considered: PC release

Piece together a fictional person's life through messages, photographs and apps, discovering relationships and circumstances behind a disappearance by reading the details closely.

What you do. Navigate the fictional phone, read message threads, inspect pictures and connect information found across its different apps.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The recorded Steam page says unavailable; establish an existing playable copy, then check small text and navigation across apps.

Why it might click. Messages, pictures and apps form a narrative investigation into Sam's life and disappearance. The appeal is close reading: an ordinary digital object gradually reveals relationships and circumstances that were invisible at first glance.

The full catch. The inspected Steam page says this game is no longer available on that store as of September 20, 2026. Existing access must be established before planning a session. Expect personal, potentially sensitive material, small interface details and searching across apps; the page does not certify input comfort.

Try this first. If you already have a legitimate playable copy, inspect one message thread and test the fictional phone's navigation. Ask whether piecing together a person's circumstances feels compelling, and stop before curiosity becomes an obligation to finish.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P197 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Normal Lost Phone

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Lost Phone Was Under My Own Elbow

A Normal Lost Phone had us looking at a fictional life through messages and apps. Then I could not find my actual phone and accused the summit of creating an immersive experience.

Tank pointed at my elbow. I lifted it. There lay the entire mystery, slightly warm and open to a photograph of my portrait.

Rae said the first clue had been my inability to stop leaning on myself.

The recorded availability catch meant we still had to establish a playable copy of the game. Mika checked that practical question while I attempted to restore the dignity of the real investigation.

Nia's phone chimed. Rae glanced at her face rather than the screen. Nia grinned and said the restaurant had confirmed their table.

I asked whether the summit would be mentioned during dinner. 'Only if the bill is surprising,' Rae said.

Shawna took my photograph again, this time without the portrait. She sent it to me. A private little improvement, delivered through a device I had successfully recovered.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the phone mystery only after establishing a playable copy and comfortable text. My actual missing device has been recovered from beneath the detective's very available elbow.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified Steam app 523210 identifies A Normal Lost Phone and explicitly states it is no longer available on Steam, observed September 20, 2026. Premise comes from the product description. Existing access, controls and availability elsewhere are not established.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/523210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P198 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Another Lost Phone: Laura's Story

Edition considered: PC release

Reconstruct Laura's life through her fictional phone, connecting personal and professional details to understand the circumstances behind her disappearance rather than exploring a physical landscape.

What you do. Read messages, examine photographs and navigate apps, separating what the phone shows from what you infer about its owner.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Close reading and app navigation are central; difficult personal circumstances and unverified control details remain meaningful catches.

Why it might click. A fictional found phone holds Laura's photographs, messages and apps. Following connections between professional life, relationships and social habits creates a story through investigation rather than through moving an avatar around a large landscape.

The full catch. Expect close reading, app navigation, inference and difficult personal circumstances. The official game site verifies the premise, while a retailer verifies this PC edition; neither settles every control demand or current availability elsewhere. Automated Steam matches were wrong, so those unrelated products are excluded from this card.

Try this first. Start by examining the fictional phone layout and a short exchange. Compare an observation with an interpretation, keeping them separate. Decide whether the interface is legible and the personal investigation welcome before following every available thread.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P198 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Another Lost Phone: Laura's Story

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Laura's Story Did Not Need My Press Release

Laura's Story had us connecting a fictional person's personal and professional details. I suggested an official summit biography for each guest.

Velvet asked whether mine mentioned the unpaid flower deposit. I said we would emphasise achievements. 'Then put paid flower deposit in your future ambitions,' she replied.

Rae said her biography could consist of mechanic, likes good snacks. Nia added terrible at leaving a café when she has somewhere to be.

Rae looked at her. 'You've known me one evening.' 'And we've left the coffee table four times.'

The game invited close reading of a particular life. Our biographies kept collapsing under the charming inconvenience that people could speak for themselves.

Remy wanted his to include an enthusiastic review from Kit. Kit offered: unusually committed to a pun. He accepted it with pride.

I tore up the proposed glossy booklet before it became another printing charge. Shawna asked me to keep one blank page.

She wrote our room number on it. At last, a biography with somewhere useful to go.

Aiden's verdict. Explore Laura's fictional records if close reading and difficult circumstances suit. The summit's glossy biographies have been replaced by people talking and one exceptionally useful room number.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Official game site anotherlostphone.com is credited to Accidental Queens and directly describes the narrative investigation, phone apps, friendships, professional life and disappearance. GameHouse separately verifies the PC title. Incorrect automated Steam matches were excluded. Neither source certifies full-path timing or holds; checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://anotherlostphone.com/>

Source 2: <https://www.gamehouse.com/games/another-lost-phone-lauras-story>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P199 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Slay the Princess - The Pristine Cut

Edition considered: PC Pristine Cut

Question a confident narrator through a branching psychological-horror story, where choices and beliefs reshape the princess, the situation and the meaning of what happens.

What you do. Listen to narration, read choices and decide what to believe or do as the story changes around those decisions.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Intense violence, gore and suicide themes are explicit; voice acting does not settle every timed or held-input question.

Why it might click. The Pristine Cut expands a fully voiced psychological-horror visual novel whose branching story turns on what you do, believe and question. Narration, performance and shifting interpretations are major attractions for somebody who enjoys arguing with a story's apparent authority.

The full catch. The developer explicitly warns of intense violence, gore, partial nudity, strong language and suicide themes. This is a substantial content catch, not a gentle princess tale. Full voice acting does not establish no timed or held inputs; check the exact interface before making that assumption.

Try this first. Read the content notice first. If the premise still appeals, hear the initial narration and inspect how dialogue advances. Choose whether to continue for its argument and atmosphere, without accepting the narrator's urgency as your own.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P199 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Slay the Princess - The Pristine Cut

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Narrator Had No Authority Over the Door

Slay the Princess made the confident narrator a subject of suspicion. I found this excessive until Shawna asked whether my promised private terrace actually existed.

'The hotel described an exclusive outdoor experience,' I said. 'Where?' 'Beyond that door.'

Rae opened it. A tiny service balcony contained two stacked chairs and a mop. Nia looked at me with professional interest.

'Exclusive,' Tank said. 'Nobody else wants it.'

Velvet took one chair, sat beside the open door and announced she would perform a tragic monologue about misleading adjectives. Remy supplied a mournful chord from his phone.

The game's psychological horror could reshape what a claim meant. My claim needed only an ordinary door to become considerably less impressive.

Shawna pulled me toward the real window overlooking the city. 'This is enough,' she said.

I agreed before narrating anything else. Behind us, Velvet's princess demanded a better balcony and received a standing ovation from the mop.

Aiden's verdict. Try the branching horror only if its explicit disturbing themes appeal. The host's narration remains fallible, and the actual window offers a better view than his exclusive terrace.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified exact Steam title Slay the Princess - The Pristine Cut, app 1989270. Publisher description supports branching fully voiced psychological horror and expanded Pristine Cut; developer mature-content notice supplies the explicit content catches. No full-playthrough timing or hold audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1989270/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P200 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Scarlet Hollow

Edition considered: PC episodic release; current completion status must be checked

Enter a branching horror mystery where character traits, family relationships and a troubled town shape what you notice and how people respond to you.

What you do. Choose traits, read conversations, investigate unsettling events and make decisions that affect relationships and the story's branches.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The recorded release is unfinished; disturbing imagery remains despite the no-jumpscare statement and declared play without timed input.

Why it might click. Character traits and choices shape a branching horror mystery around a family visit and a troubled town. Conversations can reveal different details, making personality and relationships part of the investigation rather than merely decoration around clues.

The full catch. The inspected description lists five available episodes and another major update before the conclusion as of September 20, 2026: this is unfinished. The developer declares no jumpscare and Steam lists play without timed input, but disturbing imagery and tension remain. Neither statement certifies every hold or device.

Try this first. Inspect the opening traits and read the first family exchange. Decide whether you want a tense serial whose ending is still pending. A companion can debate impressions while the person playing keeps authority over the actual choices.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P200 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Scarlet Hollow

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Town Had Secrets; Our Draft Had My Thumbprint

Scarlet Hollow's troubled town and branching relationships made Rae ask whether the summit would look different through each guest's account. I said mine would be definitive.

Nia placed the final wording in front of me. There was a greasy thumbprint over the word voluntary. 'That's an editorial mark,' I said. 'That's a samosa,' Rosa replied.

Kit read the clean copy. Velvet checked her show time. Remy checked that his name still contained Receipts. Everybody found the part they needed without pretending to have written the whole evening.

The game's unfinished release remained an unfinished release; nobody in our room could promise its ending. We could finish this particular draft.

Nia asked whether Rae wanted any change. Rae said the signing table was level and the snack clause was understandable. 'The dance invitation stands?' Nia asked. 'It does.'

I lifted my clean hands away from the paper. Shawna smiled. Final wording agreed, portrait reimbursement still absent, and two women waiting for the song after the signatures.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the branching town if an unfinished horror story appeals. Our own wording is finished, my thumbprint is excluded, and the promised dance still belongs to its two participants.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description on September 20, 2026 says five episodes available and another major update before the conclusion. Developer states no jumpscare; the Steam category declares playable without timed input. Those are sourced declarations, not a complete no-hold or no-distress certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1609230/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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The Final Wording Left My Face Out of It

Nia read the finished wording once, slowly enough for everybody to follow. No heroic music beneath it. Remy had offered, but even he agreed that a fanfare could make a sentence about borrowing coats sound like a siege.

People could choose a game, ask for help, watch, take a break or decline. Sharing a controller required an actual agreement about who did what. The jukebox belonged to everyone's choices. Borrowing the old jacket began with asking the person who currently had it.

My portrait appeared nowhere.

I cleared my throat.

Shawna looked at me. 'You signed that order yourself.'

'I haven't raised the matter.'

'You raised your reimbursement throat.'

Rae laughed. Nia waited until the room settled, then asked whether the wording described what we had actually agreed.

June wanted it clear that she could still say Dez remembered the weather wrong. Dez wanted it clear that she could still point out the jacket's excellent lining.

'You can both keep telling your stories,' Nia said. 'This settles tonight's arrangements.'

They approved. The old war did not need a winner to stop acquiring new invoices.

Velvet checked that her paid performance stayed paid regardless of whether everybody watched. Remy checked his cue. Kit asked for the lamp to remain where she could read the song list. Mika checked the clock and looked briefly overcome by the astonishing possibility that the gala might begin.

Rosa brought the last tray past the table without catching her sleeve. Rae's repaired leg stayed steady. Tank sat beside her and declared the engineering department a success.

Nia put down the pen. Rae took her hand under the edge of the table. I saw their shoulders relax at the same time.

'Still after the signatures?' Rae asked.

'Still,' Nia said.

I wanted to tell them that a great romance deserved an audience. Then I remembered several great romantic moments in my own marriage had occurred specifically because the audience left.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

Shawna caught my eye. The woman could follow a terrible idea across my face before I found words expensive enough to decorate it.

'Good choice, baby,' she said.

'You don't know what I chose.'

'I know what you didn't say.'

The clean draft went into its folder. June and Dez rose slowly, helping each other without deciding which assistance counted toward the coat account. They would return for the signing after the last shared-play trial.

Mercedes touched the first chord of the chosen dance song. Rae looked toward the floor; Nia watched Rae.

Mika asked whether my portrait's lamp could stay off for the rest of the evening.

I looked at the faces already lit around the table.

'Yeah,' I said. 'Leave it.'

Nigga, the final wording was agreed. Nobody had surrendered a name, a story or the right to go home. I had surrendered one unnecessary spotlight, which felt like enough personal history for tonight.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 6 OF SIX

Peace, Shared Songs and My Unpaid Portrait

Native cooperative games, shared puzzles and stories for an optional companion

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.

Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan's creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.

Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden's scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [Peace Could Not Be Purchased with My Portrait Budget](#) - page 27. Coalition, resources and accountability.

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P219	Blanc	47	P203	Pode	11
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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 6. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P201	P202	P203	P204	P205	P206	P207	P208
2. Ready for conversation	P209	P210	P211	P212	P213	P214	P215	P216
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P217	P218	P219	P220	P221	P222	P223	P224
4. Here for the atmosphere	P225	P226	P227	P228	P229	P230	P231	P232
5. Open to a wildcard	P233	P234	P235	P236	P237	P238	P239	P240

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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The Rehearsal Had Two Controllers and One Unnecessary Throne

I placed two controllers on a velvet cushion beneath the portrait. It was meant to suggest equality. Tank looked at the cushion, then at the only chair facing the screen.

'Where's the other person sit?'

Nigga, equality had arrived ahead of the furniture.

Rae pulled up a second chair. Nia moved the cushion so both controllers could reach their cables. My wife sat in the chair I had reserved for the host and asked whether I planned to stand there explaining the arrangement all night.

'I'm establishing the mood.'

'You've established a queue.'

The final wording waited in its folder. The signing table stood level, the light reached the page and Mika had timed the walk from the buffet without including any pause for my autobiography. We were going to try sharing actual controls before celebrating an agreement about sharing a room.

Dez arrived wearing the disputed jacket. Auntie June followed carrying its empty hanger.

'Evidence,' June told me.

Dez said a hanger could not prove the weather in 1967. June said she had brought it to hang the coat, which was a far more devastating reply than any courtroom flourish I could have supplied. Both veterans still claimed the other had never signed the old Blue Comet agreement. This one had acquired enough working pens to alarm a stationery wholesaler. I had bought the gold one. Nia preferred the plain black one because it actually wrote.

Rae tested both. 'Yours writes too,' she told Nia. 'Just not in a recognised direction.'

Nia smiled. 'You understood the invitation.'

'Eventually.'

They would dance after the signing. Their only unresolved question was whether Rae could persuade Nia that being good at a contract did not require counting every step before the music began.

Kit had her karaoke song ready and her reading glasses attached to a cord. Remy admired the practical innovation, then discovered his crown prevented him from putting on his headphones. Velvet Payroll removed the crown, set it on the table and told him to preserve his head for the performance. She had been paid, her shoes were fastened and her stage time existed on an actual clock. A powerful woman with excellent grounds for happiness.

Mercedes checked the music. Porsche checked that the photographer understood which pictures people wanted. Nobody needed another staged candid in which Rae pretended not to notice a lens six inches from her coffee.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Dre brought the blue controller and a casserole. He was a Crip with a hot dish, not an available metaphor for my summit title. He wanted a clear space to set the food and the particular colour of plastic he had chosen.

I offered the gold controller. 'Nigga, you keep the expensive-looking problem,' he said.

Darnell appeared behind him with a little case and an offer to sponsor fireworks. Velvet asked whether the sponsorship involved money or cocaine. He said relationships. She told him her actual relationships had already paid for the show.

He tried describing a yacht. The host opened the lift before the description acquired a second deck. Darnell went to find a different audience. Dre stayed to ask Rosa whether the casserole needed warming.

Mika suggested using the model hotel to rehearse the procession. I liked the idea until they assigned my paper figure to hold the door.

'I have a speaking role.'

'You have a useful arm,' Rae said.

Shawna kissed that arm through my sleeve. Suddenly the assignment developed possibilities.

Some games would give two people separate characters. Some would divide their information. Some would give one person a smaller helping role. Others could simply be enjoyed together with one person operating the controls.

June said she might watch. Dez said she might try. Neither statement triggered an emergency meeting.

I looked up at the portrait, whose enormous expression appeared to endorse every arrangement. That was generous of it, considering the evening had still authorised none of its cost.

Then Rae handed Nia a controller and asked which role she wanted. A normal question, asked without a trumpet.

I sat beside Shawna, took the other available chair properly and waited to hear the answer.

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War had reached the dangerous stage where people might enjoy themselves enough to forget who was supposed to receive credit.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P201 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Secret of Mana

Edition considered: 1993 SNES original / Collection of Mana on Switch; not 2018 remake

Explore a colourful retro adventure together once companions join, with towns, magic and party equipment giving the shared journey a continuing sense of purpose.

What you do. Move through connected areas, fight enemies in real time and use ring menus to manage the party's items, equipment and magic.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Real-time combat and held actions remain; original SNES three-player play needs an adapter, and cooperation begins after allies join.

Why it might click. The original 1993 adventure offers a colourful party journey with native cooperative fighting once companions join. Its overhead view removes free-camera steering, while towns, equipment, magic and connected areas give the journey continuity.

The full catch. Combat runs in real time. Original manual instructions include held dashing and charged attacks, plus Y opening the paused ring menu. Original SNES two-player play needs two controllers; a third needs a multiplayer adapter. Collection of Mana supports up to three. The 2018 remake is excluded.

Try this first. Enjoy the solo opening together or use an existing shared save after an ally joins. Try moving, opening the ring and one familiar encounter. The second player should choose their own role rather than automatically receiving every difficult job.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P201 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Secret of Mana

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hero Had to Wait for His Friends

Secret of Mana's party adventure made me offer to be the summit's central hero. Auntie June asked whether that position involved carrying chairs. I said it involved vision.

'Then carry two,' she replied. 'One for each eye.'

Dez laughed into her tea. June had been telling her what needed moving since the Blue Comet dispute of 1967; the instructions had apparently improved with age.

The original game's companions had to join before shared control became available. Rae liked that the plan required checking the actual party rather than handing out imaginary jobs.

I carried the chairs. Nia tested the second controller with Rae while Tank found the correct cable. Nobody appointed me commander of their buttons.

Dez touched the jacket folded beside her. 'She lent this with a lecture about the pockets.' June said a borrower deserved to know where things went.

Both women accepted the dry chairs I supplied. Nigga, I had achieved a modest diplomatic victory entirely through furniture.

Aiden's verdict. Try the original adventure if its real-time demands and hardware arrangement suit. The appointed hero has discovered that a useful party member sometimes begins by carrying two chairs.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Nintendo Collection of Mana page confirms original Secret of Mana supports 1-3 players. Original manual text inspected through archival transcription establishes ring pause, held actions and SNES controller/adaptor rules. Ally-gated joining follows party availability. No 2018 PC remake metadata is used.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/en-ca/store/products/collection-of-mana-switch/>

Source 2: https://www.world-of-nintendo.com/manuals/super_nes/secret_of_mana.shtml

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P202 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Spiritfarer: Farewell Edition

Edition considered: PC Farewell Edition

Build and travel on a ferry while caring for spirits, sharing everyday chores and eventually saying goodbye to people whose stories become familiar.

What you do. Explore islands, gather resources, cook and craft, build the boat, and try Stella's or Daffodil's role in local cooperation.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Chores and resources accumulate, roles differ, and later timed challenges remain alongside jumping, gliding and bereavement.

Why it might click. Build and travel on a ferry, care for spirits, gather materials and eventually say goodbye. The Farewell Edition includes the expanded character stories. Native local cooperation pairs Stella with Daffodil, giving two people a shared place to inhabit.

The full catch. Movement includes jumping and gliding; chores, recipes and resources accumulate. The cat's role differs from Stella's. A previously inspected secondary walkthrough identifies Elena's later timed Gold Dragon challenge, so the gentle presentation is not a no-rush guarantee. Bereavement is the central theme.

Try this first. Meet a passenger, walk around the boat and try one chore in each role. Check whether both people enjoy what their character can do. Leave the larger building plan alone until the small shared activity feels worthwhile.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P202 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Spiritfarer: Farewell Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ferry Had Room for Another Chair

Spiritfarer's ferry made Mika describe our convention floor as a vessel carrying everyone toward a farewell. Velvet asked whether the vessel had paid its entertainment bill.

'Yes,' I said proudly. She checked her phone. 'It has. Continue floating.'

June wanted a seat near Dez without sitting beneath the speaker. Tank found one. Rosa brought tea and asked whether either wanted anything in it.

The game's caring chores and eventual goodbyes gave the room a quieter subject. Dez remembered replacing the borrowed jacket's worn lining. June remembered choosing the colour.

They disagreed gently about the colour. Neither disputed that someone had kept the coat.

Nia and Rae tried their different roles without pretending they were identical. I offered to supervise their shared voyage. Shawna asked me to carry the empty cups back instead.

On my return, June was showing Dez a photograph. Velvet had sat down to listen. Our vessel had finally stopped announcing every passenger over the public-address system.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the caring ferry journey if its chores, unequal roles and bereavement feel welcome. Our vessel now serves tea without demanding that every passenger deliver a farewell speech.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam publisher description confirms Farewell Edition activities and local Daffodil cooperation. Prior inspected GuideStrats walkthrough supplies the secondary-source warning about Elena and the timed Gold Dragon; not represented as a developer access statement.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/972660/>

Source 2: <https://guidestrats.com/spiritfarer-elena-guide/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P203 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Pode

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

Guide a rock and fallen star through beautiful caverns, combining their different abilities to solve spatial puzzles and bring the environment to life together.

What you do. Move the two characters, explore cave rooms and coordinate their positions and special abilities to open ways forward.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Spatial positioning and movement still need checking; gentle art does not establish no held actions, tricky jumps or timed sections.

Why it might click. A rock and a fallen star explore Norwegian-inspired caverns, using different abilities to bring an ancient environment to life and solve spatial puzzles. The Switch edition supports one or two players on one system.

The full catch. You still move characters through three-dimensional spaces and coordinate their positions and abilities. The store's cooperative and gentle-looking presentation does not prove no held movement, no tricky jumps or no timed sections throughout. The assigned edition is Switch; PC controller requirements are not imported here.

Try this first. Try the first shared room and let each person explain what their character appears able to change. Check movement, positioning and the viewpoint before tackling a long puzzle. Switch roles only if both people would like to.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P203 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Pode

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Fallen Star Wanted Its Own Billing

Pode's rock and fallen star gave Remy and Velvet an irresistible casting dispute. He wanted to be the star. She asked whether his contract supported that interpretation.

'I'm naturally luminous,' he said. 'You're standing under my lamp,' she replied.

Rae wanted to try the characters' different abilities. Nia chose the other role, then asked what Rae needed from her before either moved.

I declared this an ideal model for the signing. Mika immediately assigned me the heavy end of the table. Nigga, somehow I kept auditioning for light and being cast as rock.

Remy and Velvet settled their quarrel by taking turns, discovering that each preferred doing something different from what they had predicted.

Kit adjusted the real lamp so both could see. She refused to select a winner for the billing dispute.

The beautiful caverns kept their spatial puzzles. Our room solved one of its own when the table stopped blocking a chair.

Shawna admired my effort. I asked whether I glowed. 'A little sweaty,' she said.

Aiden's verdict. Try the complementary pair if its movement and spatial coordination suit both players. My rock performance has cleared a chair, and the star may negotiate its own lamp.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/pode-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P204 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Stardew Valley

Edition considered: PC current release; platform and version must be recorded

Grow a farm and become familiar with a community, sharing work and exploration while seasons, friendships and personal projects give the place continuity.

What you do. Plant crops, manage tools and resources, visit neighbours and explore activities together in the chosen cooperative PC setup.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. The active day, inventories and multiple activities add pressure; verify multiplayer pause behavior before expecting menus to stop time.

Why it might click. Farming, friendships, seasons, crafting and exploration create a place that can grow alongside a group. The current inspected PC listing advertises online cooperation and shared-screen support, allowing genuine joint work rather than only discussion beside one controller.

The full catch. An active day, energy, inventories, travel, fishing and combat create different demands. Multiplayer pause behavior must be checked; a partner does not automatically stop the clock. Many recipes and social schedules can turn leisure into planning. Record the actual installed version before comparing features.

Try this first. Plant a small patch or take one walk together. Inspect movement, item selection and what happens to time when a menu opens. Avoid choosing a mining or fishing challenge as the sole measure of whether village life appeals.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P204 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Stardew Valley

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Farm Did Not Recognise My Opening Bell

Stardew Valley made Rosa imagine a small farm with enough room for flowers and no stage. Tank immediately asked what they would grow for dinner.

I offered to fund an agricultural wing of the summit. Rae asked whether it came with a portrait on the barn. My pause answered before I did.

Nia wanted to understand the active day and shared setup before promising an evening of joint farming. Rae agreed. They chose one modest task instead of naming an estate.

June said the Blue Comet had once tried growing herbs behind the kitchen. Dez said June had watered the same plastic basil for a month.

'It stayed green,' June replied.

The game had enough tools, seasons and activities without my bell announcing every crop. Rosa and Tank looked at the starting work together and kept their plans small.

Shawna took the bell from my hand. 'This is why nobody lets you near livestock.'

I told her I possessed pastoral charm. She asked me to demonstrate it by remaining seated.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the shared farm if its active days and management appeal after checking multiplayer pacing. Our agricultural wing remains a single conversation with no portrait on the barn.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/413150/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P205 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Minecraft

Edition considered: Java & Bedrock Edition for PC; editions need separate control profiles

Create a shared place from blocks in Creative mode, using unlimited resources to focus on a modest build instead of surviving the world's dangers.

What you do. Look around, move through the world and place or remove blocks while coordinating a building project on compatible editions and devices.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Camera movement and precise placement remain; Java and Bedrock differ, and PC versions do not provide console-style split-screen.

Why it might click. Creative mode supplies unlimited resources, damage immunity and flight for shared building. Java and Bedrock both support multiplayer, but they have different compatibility and input profiles. A modest construction can give two people an enjoyable shared purpose.

The full catch. Moving while steering a three-dimensional view and precisely placing blocks can be substantial work. Creative mode changes survival pressure, not those demands. Official comparison lists controller support for Bedrock, not Java, and split-screen only on consoles; do not plan PC couch split-screen.

Try this first. Choose the exact edition and arrange compatible separate-device play if sharing online or locally. In Creative mode, try looking around and placing a few blocks before planning anything large. A wall with one window is an adequate architectural brief.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P205 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Minecraft

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Peace Palace Had No Back Door

Minecraft's Creative mode encouraged Mika to propose a block-built model of the signing room. I began with a triumphal entrance tall enough to accommodate my reputation.

Rae began with the table. Nia added space around it. Tank asked where a person could leave. I pointed proudly at the triumphal entrance.

'Without walking through your announcement,' he clarified.

June said the Blue Comet had one narrow exit and too many people trying to look unbothered in it. Dez said June had blocked it while arguing about the jukebox.

Mika added another door. The model improved instantly.

The camera and placement still needed an actual trial, and compatible editions mattered before anyone promised a shared build. Meanwhile, our imaginary architecture was already learning from the people who would use it.

I put a tiny portrait above the entrance. Shawna moved it into a side room. 'Private collection,' she said.

Nigga, my first museum had opened without public funding or a compulsory route through it.

Aiden's verdict. Build together in a compatible setup if camera movement and placement suit. The model's second door stays open, and its portrait collection may be visited entirely by choice.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.minecraft.net/en-us/about-minecraft>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P206 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Animal Crossing: New Horizons

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game

Make an island home through collecting, crafting, decorating and meeting animal neighbours, with different ways to spend time alongside other players on Switch.

What you do. Walk around the island, speak with residents, gather materials and place objects while trying the specific shared-system or visiting mode.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Storage, tools and repeated menus add work; shared-system roles and installed-version restrictions need checking before assuming equal freedom.

Why it might click. Collect materials, meet animal neighbours and gradually arrange an island home. The current Switch page supports up to four people sharing one system and larger visits with separate systems, though these are different ways of playing together.

The full catch. Crafting, tool selection, storage and repeated dialogue can create menu work. Same-system roles and restrictions deserve a practical check before assuming everyone has identical freedom. The page reflects current updates, so check the installed version; this card does not certify every activity as untimed.

Try this first. Walk around, talk to one neighbour and try placing or collecting an object. If playing together, test the specific visiting or shared-system mode and let both people describe what they can actually do. An unproductive beach stroll is a valid result.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, we're good.

P206 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Animal Crossing: New Horizons

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Island Host Misplaced His Mandate

Animal Crossing's island home made me ask what sort of neighbour I would be. Rosa said one who installed a fountain before learning when the bins went out.

I called that civic ambition. Rae called it plumbing with an audience.

Kit wanted a quiet corner to decorate. Remy wanted to visit and bring something ridiculous. They checked which shared mode actually gave them the freedom they expected.

Dez remembered how the old club's jukebox had acquired a handwritten AUNTIE JUNE'S CHOICE sign. June said it was temporary. 'It lasted longer than the curtains,' Dez replied.

Nia wrote the new jukebox sentence plainly: everybody could choose songs, and nobody's name owned the machine.

I asked whether the host received priority. Seven faces turned toward me. Nigga, the island had developed a remarkably efficient weather system.

Shawna suggested I bring a useful gift instead. I offered the gold fountain. She asked for batteries.

I found batteries. My promising career as a neighbour survived its first planning objection.

Aiden's verdict. Make an island home if the chosen shared mode and its restrictions fit. Our host has exchanged priority at the jukebox for the more useful privilege of supplying batteries.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/animal-crossing-new-horizons-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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P207 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Portal 2

Edition considered: PC release

Solve a dedicated two-player puzzle campaign together, using portals and complementary perspectives to discover how unusual test chambers can be crossed or rearranged.

What you do. Walk and look around in first person, aim portals and coordinate actions with the other player to solve chambers.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. First-person aiming and coordinated manoeuvres remain substantial catches; the timed-input declaration is not a complete cooperative-play audit.

Why it might click. The dedicated two-player campaign has its own robots, story and chambers designed around joint portal solutions. Humour and mechanical discoveries make it attractive to companions who like discussing how a space works.

The full catch. First-person movement, aiming, spatial transformations and coordinating actions remain substantial catches. Steam declares play without timed input, but that declaration is not a tested guarantee that every cooperative manoeuvre avoids urgency or awkward timing. Both camera comfort and joint execution need direct trials.

Try this first. Enter the cooperative introduction and test looking, walking and placing a portal before pursuing a complex solution. Describe a location without pointing at the other person's screen. Stop if the camera or required coordination outweighs the pleasure of solving.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P207 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Portal 2

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Portal Opened Onto My Own Mistake

Portal 2's cooperative chambers made me and Rae a dangerous combination: she wanted to understand the route, and I wanted to explain it before looking.

'Over there,' I said. 'Where?' 'By the significant wall.'

She turned toward me. 'Nigga, every wall got significance if you walk into it.' Nia laughed so suddenly that her pen rolled under the table.

We stopped to retrieve it. Rae described what she could actually see. I finally looked at my own view and discovered I had been discussing the wrong direction with magnificent confidence.

The first-person aiming and coordinated actions were real things to test. My commentary was an optional obstacle.

Across the room, Remy rehearsed his entrance through one door while Velvet left through another. Mika asked them to exchange places. They managed without inventing interdimensional law.

I gave Rae one clear description. She answered with one useful instruction. Something worked.

Shawna applauded softly. 'A portal to competence,' she said. I resisted announcing that I had designed it.

Aiden's verdict. Try the dedicated cooperative puzzles if first-person aiming and coordination suit both people. The host's directional commentary is now required to identify an actual place before becoming advice.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/620/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P208 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Untitled Goose Game

Edition considered: PC release with two-player update

Cause slapstick trouble together in a village, coordinating distractions and stealing objects while watching the inhabitants react to two very determined geese and their pranks.

What you do. Move around the village, honk, handle objects and work together to distract people or complete comic tasks.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Pursuit and useful timing occur in real time; object handling and later time challenges need checking despite the charming premise.

Why it might click. The updated PC game lets two people play the whole village prank campaign together. Watching people react, coordinating distractions and creating ridiculous little situations can be as entertaining as completing the written objectives.

The full catch. Stealth, pursuit, object handling and positioning operate in real time. Some tasks require observing routines and acting at a useful moment; held inputs and later time challenges need checking. A charming goose is still capable of making a control scheme demanding.

Try this first. Explore the first garden together and try moving, honking and handling one object before attempting an elaborate prank. Agree whether either person wants hints. Enjoy an accidental comic moment without turning every task into a performance target.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P208 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Untitled Goose Game

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Two Geese and an Unattended Sash

Untitled Goose Game put two determined troublemakers before us. Velvet and Remy exchanged a look I should have recognised as a warning about my unattended ceremonial sash.

I was explaining how shared mischief required trust when Velvet asked me to inspect a stage light. Remy quietly lifted the sash from my chair.

By the time I returned, it decorated the buffet's bread basket. GRAND CONVENOR OF ROLLS, Kit announced.

Rae laughed hard enough to lean against Nia. Nia caught her elbow and kept laughing too. The summit had found its first completely unanimous resolution.

The geese's real-time trouble still needed a practical control check. Our trouble required only leaving two entertainers bored within reach of fabric.

I went to reclaim my office. Rosa put a fresh roll into my hand and said the basket wore the sash well. Shawna untied it after everyone had eaten. 'You can have your title back now.'

Nigga, I had been defeated by two performers and temporarily replaced by bread.

Aiden's verdict. Try the comic mischief if pursuit and object handling feel enjoyable. Our ceremonial sash may return to its owner once the bread basket finishes its entirely successful term.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/837470/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P209 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Unravel Two

Edition considered: PC release

Help two connected Yarnys through beautiful environments, using their physical link to turn movement and obstacles into a shared puzzle with an emotional story.

What you do. Run, jump, swing and help the other Yarny cross obstacles while exploring the route together in local cooperative play.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Active platforming and chases remain; being linked can add coordination pressure when the two players want different paces.

Why it might click. Two Yarnys work through natural and built environments, helping one another across obstacles. Native local cooperation makes the physical connection between characters a direct shared puzzle, with an emotional story running through the journey.

The full catch. This is an active platforming game: jumping, swinging, running and reaction demands are explicit. Coordination can amplify frustration when one person wants a slower pace. Its warmth does not establish an easy route through every chase or challenge; check any assistance options in the actual build.

Try this first. In an early safe area, each person should try movement and one simple shared traversal. Ask whether being physically linked feels funny and satisfying or restrictive. Do not make completing a chase the admission test for an enjoyable evening.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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P209 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Unravel Two

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ribbon Connected Two Unrelated Plans

Unravel Two's connected Yarnys made Mika suggest a ribbon linking the two ceremonial pens. I approved the symbolism before asking whether anyone planned to move them.

Rae tested one pen. Nia reached for the other. The ribbon caught my champagne flute and brought it halfway across the cloth.

'Beautiful unity,' Rae said. 'Where do you want the spill?'

I blamed insufficient tension. Kit said that was the first inaccurate description of the room all evening. The game's physical connection could create shared possibilities and coordination demands. Our pens needed to stay ordinary pens. Mika cut the ribbon and tied two small bows instead.

June took one bow and attached it to the jacket Dez had been carrying. Dez pretended to object, then straightened it carefully.

Nia tested the free pen again. Her signature still looked like a bird escaping a saucepan. Rae said she could recognise it now.

Shawna rescued my flute. 'You can connect with me later,' she whispered. 'Without tying anything to the table.'

Aiden's verdict. Consider the linked platforming if its active demands and shared pace suit. Our signing pens now travel independently, leaving affection free to use a less hazardous connection.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1225570/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P210 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

80 Days

Edition considered: PC release

Plan an alternate-history journey around the world, balancing routes and resources while conversations and unexpected encounters give each trip its own character and possibilities.

What you do. Choose destinations and transport, read encounters, manage luggage and money, and consider Fogg's wellbeing along the route.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Travel deadlines and schedules add pressure; inspect clock behavior, and remember shared discussion is not native cooperative control.

Why it might click. As Passepartout, choose routes and encounters across an alternate-history world while managing Fogg's wellbeing, money and travel. This is single-player storytelling that can be discussed beside the screen; its shared appeal does not make it native cooperative play.

The full catch. The premise includes a travel deadline, schedules and an in-game clock. The inspected store language stresses continuous time, so do not assume a fully untimed experience or confuse the multiplayer journey feed with joint control. Reading, inventory and route planning are significant.

Try this first. Inspect the opening route choices and how time behaves in each screen before committing to a journey. Let the person operating choose whether advice is welcome. One interesting encounter is enough to assess the prose and decision rhythm.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, we're good.

P210 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

80 Days

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Eighty Days to Find the Correct Coat

80 Days made June describe the old jacket's supposed travels. According to her, it had visited three cities before Dez remembered that borrowing eventually involved returning.

Dez said June had recommended two of those cities herself. 'Then you kept the coat,' June said. 'Because you said the weather looked terrible.'

I offered to commission a map. Rae asked whether the map would arrive before the jacket already sitting on the chair beside us.

Nia wanted a simple settlement: the coat could be returned, lent again when asked, and kept out of the expense claim for my portrait.

'That last bit wandered in,' I said. 'Like the coat,' Shawna replied.

The game had routes, luggage and schedules to weigh. Our shared discussion needed no extra controller, but it did need me to stop proposing freight insurance for a sixty-year argument.

Dez draped the jacket over June's shoulders to check the fit. June smiled.

Nobody called that surrender. Tank called it time to bring the dessert trolley closer.

Aiden's verdict. Plan the journey together if its reading and travel pressure appeal, remembering it remains shared discussion. The coat's latest route covers one chair and requires no commemorative map.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected publisher or platform product description supports the premise and stated multiplayer features. Movement burden and editorial fit are inferences, not a full control audit. Exact edition limits and unknowns appear in the card; sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/381780/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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Peace Could Not Be Purchased with My Portrait Budget

The disagreement started with a line on the hotel's final service sheet: HOST TO DETERMINE PARTICIPANT SUITABILITY. I thought it meant deciding who could fit into Remy's spare crown.

Nia read it again. Rae put down her water.

'Suitable for what?' Rae asked.

The floor manager said it was standard wording. Nigga, people kept presenting standard as though it meant nobody had chosen it.

Kit asked whether it gave the door staff discretion to stop a guest who looked difficult. The manager said they would use judgment.

'Whose?' June asked.

I began saying the hotel was very welcoming. Shawna touched my sleeve. 'Let them answer.'

The manager explained that the host could approve the guest list. I was the host. Suddenly the expensive room had handed me a power I had been enjoying without examining its edges.

Rae said a security guard had asked her twice that afternoon whether she was working here. The second time, she was carrying her own coffee. Kit had walked beside her with a lighting cable and received a welcome.

'I told him she was with us,' Kit said.

Rae looked at her. 'I was already with myself.'

Kit nodded, embarrassed. 'I know. That's what came out.'

'It helped him stop asking. It also made you the person who could confirm I belonged.'

The manager said the guard was only checking. Velvet asked why checking had required the same person twice.

I recognised the expression on the manager's face. It was the one I used when I wanted a complaint to become a misunderstanding before anybody priced the remedy.

Nia did not translate Rae's sentence into nicer language. She asked the manager to answer it.

He could not explain the difference in treatment. He said he would speak to the guard.

Rae asked what would happen if it happened again while everybody was busy watching the stage. The manager gave his own name and said he would stay on the floor. Mika wrote down the number he supplied and checked that the phone rang.

A small test. No fanfare. A real person expected to answer.

Kit said she would correct her own introduction if it happened again. 'I don't need to tell him you're with me. I need to tell him he's already been answered.'

'And when I'm not standing there,' Rae said.

'Yes.'

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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The manager took the sheet away to replace the vague line. I watched him go, wondering why it had seemed so harmless until somebody described being on its receiving end.

June set her cup down. 'Your invitation put us on opposite sides before we got through the door. Then your hotel decided who looked like staff.'

I said the war title was a joke.

'I laughed,' she replied. 'I'm still asking you something.'

That stopped me more effectively than anger would have. I knew how to posture against an accusation. I had less practice staying still inside a question asked by someone who did not need to dislike me.

Rae touched the edge of the table she had repaired. 'I like making things work. I don't want that to become the price of being the kind of woman I am in this room.'

Kit said she recognised the temptation to earn welcome through competence. Then she stopped herself.

'That's my experience,' she said. 'It doesn't finish yours.'

Rae nodded. The distinction did not turn either of them into an enemy.

June tapped the portrait crate, where my folded war banner now lived. 'And I remain a Black butch whether your campaign knows where to put me or not. Don't use me as the exception that excuses the arrangement.'

'I won't,' I said.

She waited. I checked the entrance myself. The new signs named the rooms and where to ask for help. The banner stayed in its crate. The main title could remain the title of our absurd story without becoming sorting instructions for arriving guests.

Dez watched me straighten a sign. 'Careful with the corner. That's how jackets start wars.'

The laugh helped. It did not return the conversation to where it had been.

Mika brought the remaining staff costs. The performers had been paid, but the technicians' booked finish time came before the extra photographs I had requested. Someone would be packing down while I pretended the room existed indefinitely.

I offered the portrait's lighting budget.

'That money is already spent,' Nia said.

'A symbolic transfer.'

'The technician takes actual money,' Velvet replied.

Remy asked to cut his second entrance so the work could end on time. Velvet refused to solve my extension by making his performance smaller. Kit offered to shorten her own song, then admitted she did not really want to.

Nobody applauded her sacrifice. She looked relieved.

Rosa said the people clearing plates also had homes to reach. Tank moved the empty trays onto the trolley instead of describing his solidarity with the catering profession.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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I asked the manager for the real cost of the time I had added. He returned with a number. It was less than the frame around my face.

Nigga, the comparison did something unpleasant to my priorities.

I paid the extension. We also ended the extra photo session early. Money bought the agreed work; it did not make staying late everyone's natural obligation.

Nia put the corrected sheet beside the game-night charter. 'These are arrangements for tonight. They don't buy forgiveness, desire or a story in which everybody now understands everybody.'

Mika put the remaining voluntary contributions on the table. The money had been collected for microphones and getting people home. I suggested applying it to the hotel's final total. Velvet asked which contributors had agreed to buy my decorations.

Kit pushed the envelope back toward Mika. 'I put in what I could. That doesn't buy me a better chair, and it doesn't become somebody else's portrait because the cheque was small.'

Rae proposed checking each remaining expense with Kit against the stated purposes. Mika would keep the record visible to contributors. Anything left would go back by the arrangement they had actually accepted. No surprise donation to my face.

I accepted that. The envelope stayed on their side of the table. Nigga, shared money had developed a location outside my pocket.

'Do they buy my dance?' I asked Shawna, attempting a recovery.

'No. I happen to want you. Don't make it accounting.'

Rae smiled at Nia. Nia smiled back, then turned toward the room. 'I also don't want our dance used as proof that the summit worked. I asked a woman I like to dance. That gets to be smaller than your campaign.'

I nodded. Porsche removed the planned photograph from the list without asking Nia to defend it.

Porsche asked what should happen if a recording continued after somebody said stop. Rae wanted it stopped, not debated over her head. Kit wanted a named person to take the request so the person objecting did not have to chase the whole room.

Mika took that job for the event. The photographer agreed to check a shot before using it and to set disputed material aside. If the plan broke, the recording would pause while the people involved decided the next step. An apology would not substitute for stopping the camera.

Nia approved the arrangement and declined the job of supervising it. She had a dance to attend. Porsche lowered her phone to show she had heard.

Remy sat on the arm of a chair. 'When people argue about whether men belong in a room, I hear the word differently from the way I did before transition. I still want friendships with women. I don't want my being a man treated as either a betrayal or a useful exception.'

June asked what he wanted tonight.

'My name used correctly. My number heard. My terrible fanfare tolerated once.'

'Once is a strong negotiating position,' Dez said.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Velvet flicked his crown with one finger. 'He is still responsible for the pun. Coalition will not save him.'

I liked that. Responsibility could remain particular. Nobody had to defend an entire category before admitting one man's joke was bad.

Kit asked whether our agreement should include never offending each other. Rae said no. She wanted people to stop, listen and repair what they could when they did. She did not promise to become instantly comfortable because the apology sounded polished.

Kit accepted that without asking how long Rae's patience would last.

The corrected service sheet returned. Nia read it; Mika checked the contact details; Rae said it answered the practical question she had asked. June asked whether everybody could still decline a game without being asked to explain their mood.

That line was already there. We kept it.

Dez reached for the jacket on her chair. 'And can we finally settle the sleeve business?'

Dez said she would return the coat when they signed. Could she then borrow it for the walk downstairs? June said yes.

Fifty-nine years of comedy briefly reduced itself to a question that could have been asked over a jukebox. Neither woman looked diminished by the answer.

I looked at the portrait crate. No communal payment, no title granting me the last word, no proof that I had become a better man merely because the floor was expensive.

Shawna took my hand anyway.

'You staying?' I asked.

'For the signing. For the dance. For you, if you stop trying to invoice the feeling.'

I kissed her hand, paid the remaining real workers and helped Mika clear the path to the table.

Peace was not everybody agreeing that I meant well.

Tonight, it was a door that stayed open, a number somebody would answer, work somebody would pay for, and enough room for two women to choose a song without becoming my evidence.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P211 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Past Within

Edition considered: PC release; two devices required

Exchange clues across two separate perspectives in a Rusty Lake mystery, making describing what you see the central cooperative activity rather than sharing one controller.

What you do. Use separate devices to inspect scenes, describe symbols and objects, and combine information from the past and future to solve puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Both players need copies, devices and communication; eerie imagery and remembering described clues add demands, while exact input behavior remains unchecked.

Why it might click. Two players occupy different times and exchange information to solve a Rusty Lake mystery. Separate perspectives make describing, listening and comparing observations the actual cooperative activity rather than a decorative addition to a solo puzzle.

The full catch. This is co-op only: each player needs their own copy, a device and a way to communicate. Eerie imagery and puzzling symbols may be unwelcome. Reading, remembering descriptions and manipulating the interface still need checking; the premise does not establish a complete absence of timed or held actions.

Try this first. Set up both perspectives and exchange one precise observation before pursuing a solution. Try any unfamiliar interaction separately. Decide whether the pleasure comes from explaining what you see, and whether either person wants brief written notes.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P211 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Past Within

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Past Said Blue; the Future Said Burgundy

The Past Within gave June and Dez an immediate reason to dispute separate accounts of the same object. June remembered the jacket as blue. Dez remembered replacing its burgundy lining.

'Those are different parts,' Rae said. Both women paused, irritated by the possibility of a cheap solution.

Nia and Rae tried the game's separate perspectives, checking their own screens before describing what they saw. I hovered between them like an unsolicited weather report.

'Can I provide context?' I asked. 'You can provide a chair,' Nia said.

I brought one and sat in it, which was not quite what she meant. Shawna moved it back far enough that my knees stopped entering Rae's view.

The eerie mystery required communication, copies and devices, not simply two people staring at one display. Our coat mystery required noticing an inside and an outside.

Dez turned the lining out. June touched the blue sleeve. Both accounts survived.

I declared reconciliation. Rae asked me to wait until somebody had finished a sentence before installing the plaque.

Aiden's verdict. Try the two-perspective mystery when its setup and clue communication appeal. Our witnesses have discovered that a jacket can possess an outside without cancelling the evidence of its lining.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1515210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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P212 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Kirby and the Forgotten Land

Edition considered: 2022 Nintendo Switch original; not Switch 2 Star-Crossed World edition

Explore colourful three-dimensional stages and rescue Waddle Dees, with a second player joining as Bandana Waddle Dee and a town developing between adventures.

What you do. Move through stages, use character abilities, fight enemies and explore together, trying the distinct Kirby and Bandana Waddle Dee roles.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Platforming and combat remain; timed Treasure Road challenges and held abilities are explicit, and the cooperative roles differ.

Why it might click. Explore three-dimensional stages, rescue Waddle Dees and develop a town between adventures. Original Switch local cooperation adds Bandana Waddle Dee beside Kirby. Nintendo's Spring-Breeze mode gives more health and easier enemies.

The full catch. This remains platforming and combat. Nintendo explicitly describes timed Treasure Road challenges and abilities involving held buttons, such as charging a hammer or aiming a bomb. The second role differs. The 2022 Switch original is assessed here, not the Switch 2 expansion or upgrade.

Try this first. Try the opening area in Spring-Breeze mode if desired, testing movement and each character's basic actions. Check whether both people like their role before pursuing a boss or time challenge. The official page lists a demo, whose current availability can be checked on the console.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P212 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Kirby and the Forgotten Land

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Kirby Was Not Available to Clear the Buffet

Kirby and the Forgotten Land made Tank ask whether the pink hero could help with the remaining buffet. Rosa told him the buffet already had sufficient heroic attention.

Remy wanted Kirby. Velvet wanted to know what the second character actually did before accepting a role described vaguely as also there.

Rae checked the different jobs with them. Nia watched the first trial while Mika cleared enough table space for both controllers.

I offered a magnificent introduction for Player Two. Velvet said she preferred actual information. Nigga, my ceremonial skill set was experiencing another small recession.

The game had real platforming, combat and timed challenges beyond its welcoming appearance. Remy liked the movement; Velvet wanted to switch roles once they understood them.

They did. Nothing about the exchange reduced either performer's billing.

Across the room, June took another pastry. Dez quietly moved the napkin closer. Tank observed that partnership could be measured in the distance between food and a clean sleeve.

Rosa kissed his cheek and handed him the empty tray.

Aiden’s verdict. Try the colourful adventure if both people like its active demands and understand the unequal roles. Player Two receives a proper explanation before any speech about shared greatness.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/kirby-and-the-forgotten-land-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS				
Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P213 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Kirby's Return to Dream Land Deluxe

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch Deluxe edition

Share a colourful platform adventure with several character choices, helping rebuild a ship while abilities and a helper option offer different ways to participate together.

What you do. Choose characters, move through stages, float, jump and fight together while trying the main adventure's available assistance.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Active moves and platforming remain despite Helper Magolor; later modes and subgames have different demands from the opening adventure.

Why it might click. The Deluxe Switch platform adventure supports up to four local players, including different Kirbys and familiar companions. Repairing Magolor's ship gives the group a shared journey, while character abilities and separate subgames provide variety.

The full catch. Floating, fighting, jumps and different move sets remain active demands. Nintendo confirms Helper Magolor for the main adventure, but that does not erase every challenge. The later Magolor Epilogue must be unlocked and has its own action; do not treat all modes as equivalent.

Try this first. Use an early main-adventure section to test movement and a character's basic ability. Examine Helper Magolor if helpful. Leave competitive subgames and coordinated team attacks for later, and keep the first shared session free from a completion target.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P213 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Kirby's Return to Dream Land Deluxe

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Ship Rebuilders Rejected My Figurehead

Kirby's Return to Dream Land Deluxe offered a ship to rebuild and several characters to choose. I suggested decorating the summit's signing table like a vessel and putting my head on the prow. Mika considered it for half a second. That was enough to frighten Shawna. 'No additional carpentry,' she said. 'The table works.'

Kit and Remy chose characters for a small trial. Kit wanted to understand the ordinary movement before looking at extra modes. Remy wanted to announce every successful action in his royal voice. Velvet asked whether he could announce one successful silence. He tried. We enjoyed it. The game's assistance did not make its active platforming disappear. Nor would a carved head make our table easier to use. Rae checked the leg once, found it steady and went back to Nia. I offered to demonstrate seaworthiness with a glass of water. Rosa removed the glass from my hand. The table remained a table. Nigga, occasionally an entire fleet must accept that destiny.

Aiden's verdict. Try the shared platform adventure if its movement suits, treating extra modes separately. The rebuilt signing table has declined a figurehead and will continue performing its excellent ordinary function.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/kirbys-return-to-dream-land-deluxe-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P214 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Super Mario Bros. Wonder

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

Discover playful changes in side-scrolling courses, with local multiplayer and character choices that can reduce enemy-damage concerns while keeping the platforming adventure active and surprising.

What you do. Run and jump through courses, try power-ups or character abilities, and help other players as unexpected Wonder effects change the surroundings.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Jumps, gaps and moving hazards remain; enemy-damage protection does not establish an easy, no-hold route through every course.

Why it might click. Side-scrolling courses change in imaginative ways when Wonder effects appear. Up to four local players can tackle them together. Nabbit and Yoshis avoid damage from enemies, and Yoshis can carry other players.

The full catch. Running, jumping, gaps, moving hazards and coordination remain part of an action game. Enemy-damage protection does not certify an effortless or no-hold path through every course. Character restrictions also matter: Nintendo says Nabbit and Yoshis do not transform with power-ups.

Try this first. Pick characters for their actual appeal and try one early course without collecting every optional item. Check movement and jump controls before introducing extra badges. A companion should match the agreed pace rather than racing ahead to demonstrate expertise.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P214 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Super Mario Bros. Wonder

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Wonder Effect Was My Wife Saying Yes

Super Mario Bros. Wonder made every unexpected change look like an invitation to react. Mika proposed a surprise at the signing. Shawna immediately asked whether it involved falling objects. 'Not falling,' Mika said. 'Descending with intention.'

I loved it. Rae asked for the ceiling plan. Nia asked why anyone needed a ceiling plan to sign a sheet of paper.

Kit chose a character and tested the movement. The available protection did not eliminate gaps or moving hazards; she wanted to see what her hands would actually do.

Remy cheered once, too loudly, then lowered his voice when she asked. A remarkably affordable adjustment.

Mika cancelled the descending decorations and saved one small lighting change for the music. I asked Shawna whether she would dance with me when it happened.

'Yes,' she said.

Nigga, that was the surprise I should have commissioned. Across the room, Rae heard Nia laughing at my expression and moved her chair closer.

The ceiling remained entirely loyal to the ceiling.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the surprising courses if their platforming fits the chosen players. Our ceremony's wonder effect is now a lighting change, with all ceiling decorations keeping their existing altitude.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

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Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/super-mario-bros-wonder-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P215 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Tick Tock: A Tale for Two

Edition considered: PC release; two-device format

Solve an eerie clockwork mystery through two separate screens, combining what each person can see and turning clear description into the main shared pleasure together.

What you do. Inspect your own scenes, describe clues and symbols, and use information from the other player's screen to solve linked puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Two players need separate devices and setup; clue communication can be demanding, and the clock imagery does not establish actual timer behavior.

Why it might click. Separate screens hold pieces of an eerie clockwork mystery, and two people combine what they see to escape. The developer describes cross-platform play, so communication rather than a shared physical controller is the central partnership.

The full catch. It requires two players and separate devices; check the exact copies and setup needed on the chosen platforms. Describing symbols and retaining another person's clues can be demanding. The clock imagery and promotional urgency do not establish the actual timer behavior; inspect it directly.

Try this first. Choose the two perspectives and compare one visible clue. Try describing shape, location and order before proposing a theory. Establish that asking for a repeat is ordinary cooperation, then see whether the eerie atmosphere adds pleasure or merely pressure.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P215 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Tick Tock: A Tale for Two

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Clock Had Two Faces and I Misread Both

Tick Tock's separate screens suited Nia and Rae until I volunteered to improve their descriptions. Nia said there was a clock. I called it a statement about history.

Rae waited. 'Does history have a number on it?'

Kit laughed into her sleeve. Nia ignored my contribution and described the thing she could actually see. Rae answered with a useful detail from her own side.

I turned toward the real clock above the bar and announced that we were almost ready for the signing. The clock was a decoration fixed at ten past ten.

June remembered the Blue Comet's clock doing the same thing. Dez said June had used it as an excuse for being late.

The game's clock imagery did not settle its actual timing behaviour. Our wall clock did not settle anything at all.

Mika checked the time on their phone and gave the performers a clear order. Remy had four minutes to locate his crown.

Velvet was wearing it. For once, the description needed no interpretation.

Aiden's verdict. Try the paired mystery if separate devices and careful descriptions appeal. Our symbolic clock has lost scheduling authority, and Remy's crown has been identified without a historical dissertation.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/790740/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P216 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Captain Toad: Treasure Tracker

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch version

Explore compact three-dimensional puzzle courses, turning the view to discover hidden routes, treasures and mechanisms, with Switch two-player support depending on the installed setup.

What you do. Move through small courses, rotate the view, inspect paths and treasures, and try the actual second-player role on the console.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Camera rotation, hazards and aiming remain; check the installed version's cooperative roles instead of assuming both players control identical characters.

Why it might click. Compact three-dimensional courses invite you to inspect routes, hidden items and mechanisms from different angles. The Switch release includes two-player support, making it a possible shared puzzle expedition once the actual roles and update level are clear.

The full catch. Camera rotation, hazards, aiming and some moving challenges remain relevant. Nintendo's current product text describes second-player turnip assistance and newer features separately; verify the installed version's cooperative roles rather than assuming identical control. This card excludes VR and separately sold extra stages.

Try this first. Explore an early course and rotate the view deliberately before moving near a hazard. Try the second-player role on the actual console. Ask whether discovering a route together feels satisfying and whether the camera is comfortable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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P216 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Captain Toad: Treasure Tracker

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Captain Found the Pen from the Other Side

Captain Toad's little courses made Rae turn the signing table around to inspect the last troublesome corner. A cable ran directly beneath the chair where June wanted to sit.

I had inspected that table repeatedly from the side with my portrait. Apparently excellent branding did not provide complete visibility.

Rae moved the cable. Nia held the lamp. Mika discovered that the lamp's cord now reached without stretching across anyone's lap.

I announced a triumph of collaborative vision. 'You can lift that end,' Rae said. Nigga, the title arrived with a carrying assignment again.

The game's view rotation and differing two-player arrangements needed checking on the installed setup. Our room benefited from trying a second angle before declaring itself finished.

June sat and tested the space. Dez placed the coat over the back, where it did not drag on the floor.

Shawna found the missing pen beneath my unused speech. She handed it to Nia.

The treasure had been waiting under the one object nobody wanted to examine.

Aiden's verdict. Inspect the compact courses if rotating views and movement suit. Our signing table has passed inspection from a second angle, and the speech no longer conceals essential equipment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

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Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/captain-toad-treasure-tracker-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, mic check.

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P217 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Yoshi's Crafted World

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch release

Explore a playful world made from everyday craft materials, sharing two-player movement and discovering new details when familiar stages are viewed from their reverse side.

What you do. Move and jump through stages, aim at objects, collect items and explore with another Yoshi, trying Mellow mode if desired.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Jumping, aiming and enemies remain despite Mellow wings; collecting everything can also add repeated travel and extra tasks.

Why it might click. Everyday craft materials become a playful landscape for two local Yoshis. Collecting objects and seeing stages from the reverse side can turn a familiar route into a fresh observation game. Mellow mode gives Yoshi wings.

The full catch. Jumping, aiming, enemies and movement still exist, and searching for every collectible can add repeated travel. Wings change part of the challenge; they do not prove every input is comfortable or every sequence untimed. Both players should test their controls rather than relying on the handmade appearance.

Try this first. Try an opening section, with Mellow mode if desired, and practise one jump and one aimed action. Enjoy the scenery without making complete collection a requirement. Let either player decide that looking together is more pleasant than controlling a character.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, we're good.

P217 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Yoshi's Crafted World

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Cardboard Palace Looked Better from Behind

Yoshi's Crafted World made Mika bring out a tiny hotel model built from leftover packaging. I admired its grand entrance until Rae turned it around.

The reverse side read ECONOMY COFFEE FILTERS. Kit said the architecture had finally admitted its budget.

I offered gold paint. Mika refused. They liked that the ordinary materials were still visible, and the model already looked better than the expensive centrepiece I had ordered.

Remy and Velvet tried the shared movement, discussing aiming and jumps without claiming the wings would settle every demand. Remy wanted to collect everything. Velvet wanted to see the next place first.

They chose one route for now. The rest could wait without becoming a dispute over who loved the game more.

Nia placed two tiny paper figures beside the model's door. Rae moved them toward its little dance floor.

I asked where my figure was. Shawna lifted a coffee-filter lid. 'In the private collection.'

Nigga, even in miniature I had secured an entirely unpaid annex.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the handmade stages if their active controls appeal and collecting stays enjoyable. Our cardboard hotel keeps its visible materials, while my miniature annex remains available by appointment.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/yoshis-crafted-world-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P218 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Snipperclips - Cut it out, together!

Edition considered: Nintendo Switch base game; Plus expansion separate

Reshape paper characters together to interact with objects and solve inventive physical puzzles, finding humour in experiments that do something different from what you expected.

What you do. Move and rotate the characters, overlap their shapes, cut deliberately and work together to manipulate objects in cooperative puzzles.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Precise overlap, rotation and unstable objects can require repeated attempts; competitive and action-focused modes have different demands.

Why it might click. Partners reshape paper characters to interact with objects and solve physical puzzles. The Switch base game includes cooperative play; its competitive Blitz activities and larger Party challenges are distinct choices, not one uniform experience.

The full catch. Precise overlap, rotation, movement and manipulating unstable objects can take repeated attempts. Some modes are action-focused. The cheerful visual style does not establish no holds or no urgency, and the Plus expansion should not be assumed to be part of the base release.

Try this first. Begin with an ordinary cooperative puzzle, test how cutting and restoring a shape work, and agree before cutting the other character. See whether the shared experimentation is funny even when it fails. Leave competitive activities out of the initial trial.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P218 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Snipperclips - Cut it out, together!

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Paper Crown Became a Useful Hole

Snipperclips made Kit and Remy argue cheerfully about what shape would solve a shared problem. Remy wanted everything to resemble a crown. Kit wanted the next object to fit.

I understood both positions, having spent the evening wearing a title that did not fit through several doorways.

Velvet gave them a paper mock-up of her stage arch. Mika wanted the centre opened wider. Remy proposed more points along the top.

'The dress passes through the middle,' Velvet said. 'My invoice goes wherever it likes.'

They cut the middle. The model suddenly worked. Remy kept one point as a tiny crown for Mika's miniature hotel.

The game's precise overlap and unstable objects still required trial and coordination. Our paper arch required asking the person wearing the dress what she needed.

Nia offered Rae the scissors handle first. Rae took them, trimmed a rough edge and returned them with a smile.

I called it romance through craftsmanship. Shawna said I could start by cutting the label out of her coat.

Aiden's verdict. Try reshaping together if precision and repeated experiments feel playful. Our paper arch now accommodates its performer, while its spare crown has accepted a smaller and entirely decorative kingdom.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/store/products/snipperclips-cut-it-out-together-switch/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P219 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Blanc

Edition considered: PC release

Help a wolf cub and fawn find their families through a hand-drawn snowy landscape, using their different strengths in a wordless cooperative journey together.

What you do. Guide the two animals through the environment, follow tracks and use their complementary abilities to get past shared obstacles.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Two buttons still involve positioning and coordination; separation, harsh weather and movement demands need checking despite the gentle artwork.

Why it might click. A wolf cub and a fawn travel through a hand-drawn black-and-white landscape, following their families' traces and using complementary abilities. The PC release supports local and online cooperation, with text-free storytelling.

The full catch. The developer describes two buttons plus movement, but a small button count does not settle coordination, precision, repetition or held movement. Navigation and obstacles still need both players. Separation and harsh weather give the gentle artwork an emotional edge.

Try this first. Move each animal through the opening space and try its first useful action. Check whether the viewpoint and character positions are easy to read together. Agree that either person can request a pause or a repeated explanation without apologising.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P219 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Blanc

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Snow Tracks Led to Dessert

Blanc's wolf cub and fawn made June remember walking home from the Blue Comet after a winter party. Dez said there had been no snow.

'There was frost,' June replied. 'On your windscreen. We took the bus.'

I offered to reconstruct the journey with a projection. Both women told me not to spend money proving either of them right.

Rae and Nia looked at the characters' different strengths and tried describing what each needed. Their route could be shared without every movement becoming an examination of the relationship.

The snowy game's separation and movement still mattered beneath its gentle art. Our old eyewitnesses had a gentler immediate problem: remembering which way the dessert table had moved.

Tank pointed it out. June offered Dez her arm. Dez took it while continuing to dispute the weather.

Shawna watched them go and leaned against me. I said lasting affection clearly required historical flexibility.

'It requires you to remember where I put my shoes,' she replied. I began with the present.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the snowy pair if complementary movement and coordination suit. Our witnesses may keep disputing the weather while sharing a perfectly visible route toward the last slice of cake.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1982340/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P220 / A PLACE TO START

Hidden Through Time

Edition considered: PC first game

Search lively illustrated scenes for hidden objects, using clues and small visual jokes to make patient shared observation feel like a succession of discoveries together.

What you do. Inspect hints, scan each scene, adjust the view and select hidden objects, with others welcome to look beside the player.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense scenes and small targets can be tiring; test zooming, panning and clicking, and do not assume native co-op.

Why it might click. Search colourful scenes for hidden objects across historical settings, using hints and visual detail. The PC game also offers a map editor and community creations, though the initial appeal can simply be one busy picture enjoyed together.

The full catch. Dense scenes, small objects and repeated scanning may be the main burden. Zooming, panning and clicking deserve direct checks; a hidden-object premise does not establish a complete no-timer or no-hold path. The inspected product lists single-player: shared looking is not verified native co-op.

Try this first. Open one ordinary scene and inspect a clue, a small object and the available view controls. Search without a race or a requirement to clear the whole picture. Ask whether the artwork makes looking pleasant before adding community maps.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P220 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Hidden Through Time

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Hidden Object Was the Person Making the Speech

Hidden Through Time made me promise an easy search for the ceremonial pen. It was bright gold, larger than necessary and currently nowhere near the signing table.

Kit scanned the shelves. Remy checked his costume pockets. Mika inspected the miniature hotel because they had already hidden three useful things inside it.

Rae watched me explain the pen's importance. Then she pointed at my lapel.

There it was, clipped beside the flower I had ordered to make myself look approachable. Nigga, I had spent four minutes describing a missing object that was attending my speech.

Nia took it and tested the ink. June said the old Blue Comet agreement had failed because someone lost the pen. Dez said June kept it to do the crossword.

'It was a good pen,' June admitted.

The illustrated searches could be enjoyed beside one player without pretending that meant native cooperation. Our search ended with several witnesses and one embarrassed host.

Shawna unpinned the flower too. She said it was hiding my last remaining sense of proportion.

Aiden's verdict. Search together if dense scenes and small targets remain pleasant. Our signing pen has survived the host's lapel, and June has agreed to bring a separate crossword pen.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected official Nintendo platform page or matched Steam publisher description supports the stated premise, mode and edition. Control demands are editorial observations or explicit checks, not a complete accessibility certification. Sources checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/524910/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

- | | | | | |
|----------------------|--------------------|---------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| Niggas, games up. | Niggas, pens out. | Niggas, chairs in. | Niggas, snacks here. | Niggas, receipts ready. |
| Niggas, lights on. | Niggas, mic check. | Niggas, take turns. | Niggas, dance later. | Niggas, read first. |
| Niggas, pick freely. | Niggas, no rush. | Niggas, sign here. | Niggas, stay petty. | Niggas, we're good. |

P221 / A PLACE TO START

Tiny Lands

Edition considered: PC first game

Compare miniature three-dimensional scenes without a time limit or mistake penalty, enjoying small visual discoveries while turning the view to inspect another angle together.

What you do. Rotate and zoom the scenes, compare details and select differences, taking as much time as the ordinary search needs.

Movement + camera | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Small visual differences and camera manipulation still need checking; the no-time-limit promise does not establish hold-free or drag-free input.

Why it might click. Rotate and compare miniature three-dimensional scenes to find their differences. The publisher explicitly states that there is no time limit and no penalty for mistakes, making patient shared observation a plausible way to enjoy it.

The full catch. The scenes still require visual discrimination, zooming and rotation. Check whether the actual camera manipulation uses uncomfortable holds or drags. The inspected description presents a single-player comparison game; shared looking is an informal arrangement, even though Remote Play Together appears among store features.

Try this first. Compare one pair of scenes at whatever pace feels pleasant. Rotate once, zoom once and make an uncertain selection to understand the feedback. Nobody needs to find every difference before deciding whether the artwork and observation suit the mood.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P221 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Tiny Lands

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Miniature Summit Contained One Fewer Ego

Tiny Lands suited Mika's collection of little hotels so closely that they accused me of choosing it to flatter them. I said I would never manipulate a colleague that cheaply.

Rae held up the catering bill. 'We believe you.'

Mika placed two versions of the model summit beside each other. Kit spotted a missing chair. Remy spotted a different curtain. Nia spotted that one portrait was considerably smaller.

I called that version inaccurate. Shawna called it promising.

The game's unhurried comparison still involved small differences and camera manipulation to test. Our tabletop version involved spotting which room left the most space for people to move.

June preferred the smaller portrait. Dez said it resembled the back of a postage stamp. I pointed out that stamps were historically important.

Rae moved the miniature signing table closer to the light. Nia shifted the paper dancers away from the door.

Neither model needed another improvement from me. Nigga, I had become the only difference still arguing with its own solution.

Aiden's verdict. Compare the little scenes if their visual details and camera controls suit. Our miniature summit chooses the smaller portrait and has declined a commemorative stamp explaining why I matter.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Tiny Lands Steam publisher description explicitly states no time limit and no punishment for mistakes, and describes adjustable angle and zoom. Single-player comparison is explicit; Remote Play Together is not treated as proof of native cooperative roles. Held/dragged camera input remains to check.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1354910/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, we're good.

P222 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

PHOGS!

Edition considered: PC release

Guide two connected dog heads through playful physics puzzles, with stretching and grabbing turning different intentions into comic shared problem-solving across food, sleep and play worlds.

What you do. Move the two heads, grab objects, stretch and coordinate their actions to cross obstacles in the chosen cooperative setup.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Connected movement and grabbing can require precision or holds; test the controller arrangement before assuming shared-controller play is easiest.

Why it might click. Red and Blue stretch, grab and bounce through physics puzzles in food, sleep and play worlds. The PC release explicitly supports local and online co-op as well as single-player and shared-controller arrangements.

The full catch. Two connected heads create funny movement but also coordination demands. Grabbing, stretching, positioning and repeated physical attempts can matter more than the cheerful setting suggests. Check the chosen controller arrangement and any holds directly; shared-controller play is a separate configuration, not automatically the easiest one.

Try this first. Try moving toward one object together and agree which head will act first. Test grabbing and releasing before pursuing a larger challenge. Judge whether accidental entanglement feels playful or irritating, and adjust the partnership rather than blaming either person.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P222 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

PHOGS!

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Two Heads, One Very Unhelpful Destination

PHOGS! made Dre claim the blue side before I finished introducing the connected dog. Rae asked whether I knew where my own end planned to go.

'Toward success,' I said. 'Try the object,' she replied.

Dre wanted to inspect something nearby. I wanted to demonstrate leadership by stretching dramatically in another direction. Our intentions became visible immediately, which I found an unfair feature of shared effort.

'Nigga, tell me first,' Dre said, laughing.

We stopped and chose a small plan. The movement and grabbing still needed testing; our friendship did not automatically supply precise coordination.

Across the room, June and Dez lifted the old jacket together to show Nia the repaired lining. One held the collar, the other the hem. Somehow a garment with decades of disputed ownership proved easier to coordinate than me.

Shawna asked whether the two heads had reached a settlement. Dre said one of them had discovered speech.

I described my next move before making it. The room treated this modest development as a historic event.

Aiden's verdict. Try the connected dog if its grabbing and shared movement feel enjoyable. One head now announces its destination before attempting to drag the other into a victory speech.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/850320/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P223 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Pikuniku

Edition considered: PC release; co-op levels separate from solo story

Explore an absurdly cheerful world with a darker story underneath, or choose separate local cooperative levels for a shared dose of comic physical puzzles instead.

What you do. Move, jump and kick through the story's situations or work with another player in the distinct cooperative challenge levels.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. The solo campaign and co-op levels are different modes, and simple drawings do not remove active movement or timing demands.

Why it might click. A deliberately silly puzzle-exploration adventure pairs peculiar characters with a story about a deceptively cheerful dystopia. The separate local cooperative levels offer a different way to enjoy its physical comedy with another player.

The full catch. The story campaign is not the same as the dedicated co-op challenges. Movement, jumping, kicking and physical timing can require active coordination. Do not infer an untimed or hold-free experience from the simple drawings or the description's invitation to explore at your own pace.

Try this first. First decide whether the goal is shared story viewing or actual two-player puzzles. Try one short movement section in that mode and see whether the comic physics are enjoyable. Leave progress targets aside while testing the basic legwork.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, we're good.

P223 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Pikuniku

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Revolution Had Separate Cooperative Levels

Pikuniku's bright absurdity tempted Remy to declare the overthrow of boring ceremonies. Velvet supported the movement until he proposed opening her performance with three new puns. 'The revolution has already betrayed me,' she said. I offered to mediate from the gold chair. Rae asked why every rebellion somehow supplied me with better furniture. The game's solo story and separate cooperative levels gave us a useful practical distinction. Kit wanted to inspect the shared challenges; Mika wanted to see the strange world another time. Nobody needed to turn those wishes into a contest for the correct way to enjoy it. Remy and Kit tried the movement while Velvet reviewed her own music. June announced that the Blue Comet's first rebellion had concerned a jukebox button that swallowed coins. Dez said it concerned June's refusal to admit she had pressed the wrong song. Both accounts produced excellent arguments. Neither required my chair. Shawna put the chair behind the signing table. At last, my throne had joined the furniture service. **Aiden's verdict.** Explore the comic movement if it appeals, choosing deliberately between story and separate co-op levels. Our revolution has retained the singer's song and reassigned the host's throne.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026. Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/572890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P224 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Overboard!

Edition considered: PC release

Play the culprit in a replayable shipboard mystery, using conversations and manipulation to change what other characters believe before the journey reaches its destination.

What you do. Choose where to go, question or mislead characters, and track what people have seen as you construct a possible cover story.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. The eight-hour story schedule creates pressure; reading, character movements and replay matter, while exact real-time clock behavior needs checking.

Why it might click. You play the culprit on a 1930s liner and try to escape justice through conversations, lies and manipulation. Characters remember events and move independently, making a replayed situation reveal new possibilities. A companion can discuss schemes beside the single-player screen.

The full catch. The story gives you eight in-game hours, with schedules and missed opportunities creating pressure. The inspected description does not resolve every real-time or pause detail, so test how the clock advances. Reading, remembering movements and replaying failed plans are central burdens.

Try this first. Inspect the first choices and clock behavior before pursuing an elaborate cover story. Discuss one possible explanation only if the player wants advice. Decide whether mischievous replay and moral inversion feel entertaining rather than exhausting.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P224 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Overboard!

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Alibi Had Been Photographed from Three Angles

Overboard!'s culprit-led mystery made me think about the missing portrait reimbursement clause. I suggested somebody must have removed it while I was attending to the guests.

Nia asked whether I had ever submitted it. 'Spiritually,' I said. Rae started laughing before the sentence finished.

Porsche had photographs of me posing beside the portrait during the relevant period. Mika had the original quote, addressed personally to me. Shawna had the message in which I called it my gift to history.

Tank said history should answer its phone.

The fictional shipboard cover-up required tracking what people knew. Mine collapsed because everyone knew exactly which nigga had ordered a face taller than the lift.

Velvet offered to make an announcement praising my personal generosity. I accepted, then realised that wording made reimbursement even less likely.

Nia left the clause out. Rae brought her a clean pen.

Shawna squeezed my hand. 'You can still enjoy the portrait.' 'Can you?' 'From a manageable distance,' she said.

Aiden's verdict. Try the culprit's conversations if schedules and remembered details sound entertaining. My reimbursement alibi has sunk beneath three photographs and the regrettably clear wording of my own message.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1546920/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P225 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Expelled!

Edition considered: PC release

Navigate a devious boarding-school mystery through gossip and remembered actions, trying to change the outcome of an accusation before the school day is over.

What you do. Talk to characters, investigate secrets, choose where to go and use information to alter how the accusation develops.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. One school day limits opportunities, and replay needs route memory; the official clock language does not establish every paused-screen behavior.

Why it might click. Verity Amersham navigates a 1922 boarding school after being accused of attempted murder. Conversations, secrets and manipulation reshape the day, offering a replayable narrative puzzle that can invite lively discussion from an optional companion.

The full catch. One school day limits the investigation, and characters act on what they witness. The official description's ticking-clock language establishes schedule pressure, not a verified rule for every paused screen. Expect reading, route memory and potentially unpleasant choices; it remains a single-player game.

Try this first. Inspect the opening accusation and the timetable or clock as presented. Try one conversation and observe the consequence of an action before designing a perfect route. Let curiosity about the characters decide whether another run sounds worthwhile.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P225 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Expelled!

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Summit Expelled My Reference Letter

Expelled!'s accusation-driven school day prompted me to draft a character reference for myself before anybody reviewed the final bill. I wrote dependable, visionary and financially misunderstood.

Rae read it once. 'You forgot tall.' 'I'm concentrating on moral qualities.' 'That would explain the empty space.'

Nia refused to countersign a reference presented as evidence for the portrait. She did offer to correct the spelling of indispensable, which I found unnecessarily intimate.

Remy proposed a mock trial. Velvet wanted to play the prosecutor until Mika reminded them both that the actual show started soon.

The game's gossip, routes and remembered actions could remain inside its fictional school. Our adults already possessed enough receipts to settle this smaller case.

June offered to sign my reference if I carried her tea. Dez said that was precisely how the original coat testimony had become unreliable.

I brought tea anyway. Shawna wrote one truthful sentence beneath my grand claims: He eventually gets the cups right.

Nigga, I kept that recommendation.

Aiden's verdict. Enter the scheming school mystery if its limited day and route memory appeal. My reference survives as one accurate sentence, with visionary temporarily removed pending independent evidence.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2963890/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P226 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Machinarium

Edition considered: PC release

Help a small robot through a hand-drawn mechanical city, reading gestures and solving puzzles as he works toward people he cares about along the way.

What you do. Inspect scenes, interact with objects, solve logical puzzles and use visual thought bubbles to understand the robot's problems.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Small targets, inventory logic and minigames can be demanding; wordless storytelling does not establish obvious solutions or entirely untimed play.

Why it might click. Guide a small robot through a hand-drawn mechanical city, solving logical puzzles and helping people he cares about. Animated thought bubbles replace long spoken conversations, giving a companion plenty to observe without requiring two playable characters.

The full catch. Inventory logic, small targets, brain teasers and minigames can become demanding. Wordless presentation does not mean obvious solutions or zero timing. Check the chosen PC interface and any puzzle assistance directly; the inspected source does not certify a fully untimed completion path.

Try this first. Explore the opening scene and try one object interaction. Ask whether the drawings and character gestures are appealing even before solving anything. Share a single suggestion only when requested, allowing the player to keep the satisfying discovery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P226 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Machinarium

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Little Robot Found My Missing Screw

Machinarium's small robot made Rae inspect the signing lamp with renewed suspicion. It leaned whenever somebody touched the table. I said the angle gave it character.

'It gives it a loose screw,' she replied.

Nia held the lamp steady while Rae found the problem. I offered to document the repair for the summit archive. Rae asked me to hold the shade instead.

That turned out to be an excellent job for someone with my particular combination of reach and opinions.

The game's visual gestures and mechanical puzzles still required patient interpretation. Our lamp gave a simpler clue: the base wobbled exactly where Rae had said.

She tightened it, Nia switched it on, and the page became easier to read. June said the Blue Comet had needed someone like Rae in 1967. Dez said it had needed someone to stop June moving the lamps.

Shawna stepped beneath the shade I was still holding. 'Finished, baby.'

I put it down. The lamp stood upright without being told who had made the evening possible.

Aiden's verdict. Meet the robot if visual puzzles and small interactions appeal. Our lamp now stands straight, and the repair record accurately credits the woman who located the screw.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/40700/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P227 / A PLACE TO START

Botanacula

Edition considered: PC release

Follow five little tree creatures through a world of peculiar inhabitants, music and playful reactions as they try to protect the last seed of their home.

What you do. Explore scenes, click on creatures and objects, interpret their reactions and try unusual combinations to solve the group's problems.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Minimal text shifts work toward visual interpretation and hotspots; some tasks may need precision or repeated attempts despite relaxed marketing.

Why it might click. Five tree creatures travel to protect the last seed of their home from parasites. The attraction is discovery: peculiar inhabitants, playful animations and inventive sound turn looking and clicking into a sequence of small surprises.

The full catch. Minimal text shifts the work toward interpreting visual behaviour, finding hotspots and inferring unusual puzzle rules. Some tasks may need precision or repeated attempts; the publisher's broad relaxed-play language is not a whole-game input audit. Shared observation remains distinct from native cooperative control.

Try this first. Explore a small area and interact with several visible creatures without trying to clear everything. Check the pointing demands and whether the nonverbal clues feel inviting. A companion can enjoy the reactions without supplying a running solution commentary.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P227 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Botanicula

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Five Creatures and One Uninvited Chairman

Botanicula's five little tree creatures made Mika arrange five miniature figures around their model hotel. I added a sixth, representing the host in a commanding pose.

Velvet turned it sideways. 'This one looks like it fell over.' 'It's addressing the assembly.' 'From the carpet?'

Rosa liked the little creatures' shared purpose. Tank liked the odd reactions. They watched an interaction together without demanding a formal plan for the entire adventure.

Nia noticed Mika had made one paper figure with a tiny crooked signature. Rae had supplied the drawing. Nia pretended to object, then moved the figure beside Rae's.

The game's minimal text left expressions and unusual responses to interpret. Our sixth figure had a clear problem: I had made its hat too heavy for its feet.

June propped it against the model wall. Dez said she had been doing something similar with June's arguments since the Blue Comet days.

Shawna saved my figure from another fall. 'No podium,' she advised. 'Start with balance.'

Aiden's verdict. Explore the peculiar creatures if visual interpretation and experimentation suit. Our sixth figure remains welcome after removing the oversized hat that prevented it from standing beside anybody else.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/207690/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P228 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Samorost 3

Edition considered: PC release

Explore alien worlds through a space gnome's curiosity, with a magical flute, unusual creatures and music making unfamiliar places inviting to investigate and understand.

What you do. Inspect scenes, listen to sounds, try object interactions and follow visual or musical patterns through the exploration puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Unusual puzzle logic, audio information and small hotspots need checking; the exploration premise does not certify no timers or dragging.

Why it might click. A space gnome follows the mystery of a magical flute through alien worlds full of creatures, images and music. The pleasure can lie in interpreting an unfamiliar place together, with one person operating the adventure and another noticing details.

The full catch. Sound and visual patterns matter to the experience, and some puzzle logic is deliberately strange. Check any audio-dependent clue, hotspot size and object manipulation directly. The inspected description supports exploration and puzzles, not a guarantee of no timers, no dragging or easy completion.

Try this first. Visit the opening area, listen at a comfortable volume and try a few visible interactions. Decide whether uncertainty feels intriguing or obstructive. Invite a companion to describe one noticed detail without immediately searching for an external solution.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P228 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Samorost 3

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Space Gnome Declined My Brass Section

Samorost 3's strange music gave Mercedes a reason to hush the room. She wanted to hear a sound again. I mistook the pause for an opening and offered a theory.

Porsche covered my mouth with the folded programme. Gently. Efficiently. A technique the summit should probably have discovered sooner.

Remy listened, then tried imitating the sound. It came out like an apologetic kettle. Kit supplied a second note and made it worse on purpose.

Mercedes laughed. Her original question survived the joke; she listened again without the rest of us performing an answer.

The space gnome's unfamiliar worlds invited looking and hearing, but their puzzle logic and interactions still needed checking. We had enough curiosity without promising effortless progress.

June said the Blue Comet jukebox once made exactly Remy's noise. Dez said that was because June selected a damaged record for six consecutive weeks.

I asked whether my commissioned brass recording would be welcome now. Shawna lifted the programme from Porsche's hand and returned it to its previous position.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the strange musical worlds if sound and observation appeal. Our brass section remains unplayed while Mercedes hears the actual note and the programme fulfils an unexpected acoustic purpose.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/421120/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P229 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

LEGO City Undercover

Edition considered: 2017 PC release; not original Wii U edition

Explore a large comic LEGO city together in the 2017 PC release, using disguises, vehicles and story missions to turn different neighbourhoods into shared adventures.

What you do. Walk and drive around the city, change roles, investigate objectives, fight and explore collectibles with another player.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Camera control, driving and action create broad demands; check split-screen legibility and controller setup before committing to the city.

Why it might click. Chase McCain pursues a criminal through a large LEGO city, using disguises, vehicles and comic situations. The 2017 PC release explicitly supports two-player cooperation, so companions can participate in the city rather than only watch its story.

The full catch. Open-world navigation, camera control, driving, fights, jumping and collecting create a broad action workload. A familiar toy aesthetic does not simplify every task. Check split-screen legibility and each controller setup before assuming the shared view works comfortably.

Try this first. Try walking, looking around and one simple objective together before driving fast or chasing collectibles. Agree on a meeting place and whether exploration or story is the purpose. Stop when the city's activity becomes more busy than amusing.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, lights on.

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Niggas, stay petty.

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P229 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

LEGO City Undercover

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Undercover Host Wore His Own Name

LEGO City Undercover made me propose attending the signing incognito to discover what people really thought. I put on sunglasses beneath my name badge.

Rae looked up. 'Excellent disguise, Aiden.'

Remy offered me a false moustache from his case. Velvet refused on behalf of costume integrity. Apparently some crimes against theatre remained outside the coalition's forgiving spirit.

The comic city's disguises and vehicles promised a broad shared adventure, with camera and action demands to inspect. Our floor offered a shorter investigation: why was the photographer standing behind a potted palm?

Porsche said she had asked him to stop interrupting Nia and Rae for staged candids. He was now trying to photograph the coat instead.

June held it up. Dez adjusted the collar. For once they agreed about its presentation.

I removed the sunglasses and asked if they wanted a picture together. They said yes.

Shawna straightened my badge as I stepped aside. 'There. You finally used the correct identity: helpful host.'

Aiden's verdict. Roam the comic city if both players welcome its broad action demands. Our undercover operation has ended in an ordinary requested photograph, with the host correctly outside the frame.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/578330/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P230 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

LEGO Star Wars: The Skywalker Saga

Edition considered: PC base game

Share familiar film adventures through LEGO humour, with many characters and places to explore across a large local cooperative action game covering the Skywalker films.

What you do. Move and aim through story scenes, fight, use vehicles and switch character abilities while exploring together in local cooperative play.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Combat, camera movement, vehicles and character menus add work; the large scope and split-screen controls need a modest first trial.

Why it might click. The nine Skywalker films become a large comic action adventure with local cooperative play. Familiar scenes, many characters and places to explore can make a lively shared journey for people who already enjoy the setting.

The full catch. Combat includes aiming and attack combinations, and the game adds vehicles, camera movement, character abilities and extensive menus. The large scope can overwhelm a simple evening plan. Split-screen comfort and both players' controls need checking; brand familiarity does not remove those demands.

Try this first. Choose one starting trilogy and test a small opening section together. Try looking, moving, attacking and selecting a character without pursuing every collectible. Decide whether the shared jokes justify the action load before treating the whole saga as a commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, we're good.

P230 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

LEGO Star Wars: The Skywalker Saga

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Coalition Did Not Require a Galactic Emperor

The Skywalker Saga made Remy enter behind Velvet while humming the least triumphant part of his fanfare. She turned, cape sweeping, and told him the empire could wait until after her shoes were fastened.

I admired their scale. Nia admired the clear floor space beyond the cape. Rae inspected the route to the signing table one last time.

The game's many characters and local cooperative action needed a modest first trial. Our ceremony needed the same restraint, which I expressed by proposing a tiny throne.

'How tiny?' Shawna asked. Mika held up the model hotel chair. I decided the joke had become unreasonably organised.

June and Dez each chose a song for the jukebox after the signatures. Neither chose the song the other expected. Their original quarrel suddenly had an unfamiliar future.

Velvet fastened the shoe herself and offered Remy her arm. His fanfare finally sounded pleased.

I took Shawna's hand. Nigga, there were enough interesting people entering this room without appointing a galactic emperor.

Aiden's verdict. Share a small galactic outing if its action and control demands suit. Our ceremony now has two requested songs and no throne larger than Mika's miniature hotel furniture.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description inspected for exact title, premise and explicit mode claims. Control burden and preference routing are editorial judgments; unknown timing and held-input demands remain visible. No full-playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/920210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P231 / A PLACE TO START

LEGO Builder's Journey

Edition considered: PC release; Creative mode separate

Arrange small LEGO scenes through atmospheric geometric puzzles, or explore the separate Creative Mode when making a little construction is more appealing than following the narrative.

What you do. Select, rotate and place pieces, adjust the view, and either solve a small scene or build a model in Creative Mode.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Precise placement and camera control may involve holds or drags; shared design discussion does not establish native cooperative play.

Why it might click. Small geometric LEGO puzzles tell an atmospheric story through placed pieces and changing situations. The PC release separately includes Creative Mode for free construction and photographs, offering another route when arranging objects is more appealing than solving the narrative.

The full catch. Selecting, rotating, positioning and viewing small pieces may require precision. A quiet presentation does not prove every placement avoids holds or dragging. This is single-player; discussing designs beside someone is optional shared activity, not verified native cooperative control.

Try this first. Try one simple placement and rotate the view before choosing a longer puzzle. Alternatively, inspect Creative Mode and make a tiny scene. Let the person's interest in solving or building determine the mode instead of insisting on story progress.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P231 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

LEGO Builder's Journey

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Small Bridge Cost Less Than My Speech

LEGO Builder's Journey gave Mika an excuse to place a tiny bridge between the two halves of their model. I wanted an arch large enough to carry the summit title.

Rae asked what the bridge connected. 'People,' I said. 'Which two bits of the model?'

I pointed. One was the loading dock.

Nia and Rae tried arranging a small scene together, keeping clear that discussing a build did not magically provide a native second-player role. Mika watched the pieces with obvious pleasure.

I finally understood that a little construction could be complete without becoming a monument. This revelation arrived several invoices too late, but Shawna seemed prepared to enjoy it anyway.

June moved the paper jacket from one miniature chair to another. Dez put the two chairs side by side. Their revised historical model required no triumphal arch.

Remy placed his spare paper crown on the loading dock. Velvet approved its new jurisdiction.

I left the bridge alone. Nigga, it successfully crossed the gap without quoting my opening remarks.

Aiden's verdict. Build or solve if small arrangements and their controls appeal, keeping shared discussion distinct from co-op. Our bridge reaches the other side without carrying a monument to its sponsor.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1544360/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P232 / A PLACE TO START

The Gardens Between

Edition considered: PC release

Manipulate time through dreamlike islands built from two friends' memories, discovering how familiar objects connect without text, speech or pressure to finish quickly.

What you do. Move time forward and backward, watch how objects interact and adjust the sequence to help the friends progress through each island.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Sequence puzzles still need attention, and moving time may require sustained input; simple controls do not establish no holds.

Why it might click. Manipulate time through dreamlike island scenes built from two friends' memories. The publisher explicitly describes a single-player game with no text, speech or time pressure, giving shared observation room to focus on images and sequences.

The full catch. You control the flow of time rather than simply steering each friend independently. Understanding cause and sequence can still be demanding, and sustained input to move time needs a direct check. Simple controls do not automatically mean no holds. This is shared thinking beside one player, not native co-op.

Try this first. Move time forward and back in the opening scene, noticing one object that changes or interacts differently. Check how the input feels before pursuing a long sequence. Decide whether the visual friendship story gives the puzzle enough emotional interest.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, lights on.

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Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P232 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Gardens Between

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Garden Remembered the Song Differently

The Gardens Between's islands of memory made June hum a piece of the old club's jukebox song. Dez supplied the next line with complete confidence and entirely different words.

Mercedes knew the recording. She let them finish before revealing that both had invented a verse.

'It was loud in there,' June said. 'You were loud in there,' Dez replied.

The game let a sequence be reconsidered through moving time. Our women reconsidered one small piece of their story without losing the evening it belonged to.

Rae asked Nia what she would remember from tonight. Nia said the terrible invitation, the good coffee and Rae fixing a chair as though kindness could disguise itself as maintenance.

Rae kissed her cheek. I looked away just late enough for Shawna to notice me doing it theatrically.

'Nobody requested a privacy curtain made of your forehead,' she whispered.

I faced the screen. The remembered song continued behind me, beautifully wrong. For once, the room had no need of a definitive edition.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the memory puzzles if their sequences and sustained-input demands suit. June and Dez may keep their invented verse; the summit is not commissioning a corrected soundtrack.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Publisher description explicitly calls The Gardens Between single-player and states no text, speech, time pressure or complex UI. Time manipulation, friendship and island puzzles are supported. The card retains uncertainty about sustained input and does not equate simple controls with no holds.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/600990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P233 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Day of the Tentacle Remastered

Edition considered: PC Remastered edition

Solve a comic adventure across three time periods, using changes in one era to create possibilities for another while following three unlikely friends and a tentacle's ambition.

What you do. Explore rooms, collect and use objects, switch characters and connect consequences between the different periods of the story.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Character switching, inventories and cross-era consequences create heavy tracking, and cartoon logic may feel inventive or frustrating.

Why it might click. A cartoon adventure links three protagonists across time, turning changes in one era into possibilities in another. The Remastered edition offers revised art and audio alongside classic presentation options, with comedy built into the puzzle logic.

The full catch. Inventories, character switching and consequences across different periods create a real memory burden. Cartoon logic may feel inventive or arbitrary. The source does not establish every timing or hold demand; preview the interface and selected presentation rather than assuming a classic adventure is automatically easy.

Try this first. Explore an early room and identify one useful object or conversation. Try switching the presentation if you prefer, then decide whether the humour and inventory handling appeal. A companion can keep one current question visible without delivering the whole solution.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P233 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Day of the Tentacle Remastered

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Tentacle Could Have Kept the Original Minutes

Day of the Tentacle's cross-era consequences made me wonder whether we could send someone back to the Blue Comet and prevent the entire coat dispute.

June said we could start by telling Dez to bring a hanger. Dez said we could start by telling June not to deliver a lecture with every borrowed sleeve.

Nia asked whether either wanted the actual years erased. Both women said no before I finished imagining the budget.

The game's three periods required tracking objects and consequences. Our own past required less equipment: a coat on the table, two surviving memories and room for neither to win every detail.

Rae suggested signing the useful parts now. Jukebox choices for everyone. Borrowing by asking. No compulsory games. No host portrait reimbursement.

'One of those came from the future,' I said. Shawna smiled. 'A brighter one.'

Remy checked the pens. Velvet checked the performance order. Mika opened the curtains around the table.

The tentacle could keep its ambition. Mine sat down and made space for two signatures.

Aiden's verdict. Travel through the comic time puzzles if their tracking feels enjoyable. Our past remains imperfect, while the present has acquired a practical agreement and an unmistakably personal portrait bill.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/388210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P234 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Trine Enchanted Edition

Edition considered: PC Enchanted Edition

Combine a wizard, knight and thief's different abilities in a fantasy adventure, using physical puzzles and cooperative action to find more than one way forward.

What you do. Move through stages, create or manipulate objects, fight and use character-specific abilities while coordinating with local or online partners.

Mixed controls | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Platforming, aiming and combat remain; character roles differ, and difficulty or saving features do not establish a no-reflex route.

Why it might click. Wizard, knight and thief combine different abilities in a fantasy world of physical puzzles and combat. Enchanted Edition supports up to three players locally or online, and the original 2009 release is also included as a separate launcher choice.

The full catch. Platforming, fighting, aiming and grappling remain active demands, with different burdens by character. The inspected description declares saving options and the store lists adjustable difficulty, but neither establishes a no-reflex or no-hold path. Choose Enchanted Edition deliberately rather than mixing its features with the original.

Try this first. In an early section, try each preferred character's movement and one ability. Discuss whether roles feel satisfying before combining them under pressure. A companion should not become the compulsory combat department unless that is genuinely the role they want.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, chairs in.

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P234 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Trine Enchanted Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Wizard Summoned a Stool Nobody Needed

Trine's different heroes made Remy claim the wizard's role in the ceremony. He produced a collapsible stool from behind the curtain. Velvet asked why. 'I anticipated an obstacle,' he said. 'You've supplied one,' she replied. Rae folded it and placed it against the wall. Nia needed room for her chair, not a demonstration of equipment. The game's character abilities could offer different ways through physical puzzles, but platforming and combat still mattered. Our ceremony had simpler jobs: keep the path clear, read the agreed wording and let the signers reach the pens. I volunteered to be the knight. Tank handed me the door to hold. Nigga, my chivalry continued to take a surprisingly architectural form. Kit chose the music cue. Mercedes checked the first note. Porsche put both phones away long enough to look at the room directly. June and Dez approached together, the jacket carried between them. Remy bowed without producing anything else. Velvet patted his shoulder. His best magic trick was restraint. **Aiden's verdict.** Try the fantasy action if its different roles and active demands suit. Our ceremonial wizard has returned the unnecessary stool, leaving a clear route for people with actual jobs.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/35700/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P235 / A PLACE TO START

Pilgrims

Edition considered: PC digital game; not the board game

Experiment with characters and objects in an illustrated adventure that welcomes different solutions, turning unexpected reactions and short comic situations into much of the pleasure.

What you do. Explore situations, choose items or characters to try, and watch how their combinations change a small story or solve a task.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Unusual responses still need interpretation, and item or card manipulation may involve dragging or holds that should be checked.

Why it might click. A playful illustrated adventure encourages trying items and characters in different situations, with multiple solutions rather than one fixed route through every task. Its brief, expressive reactions can be enjoyable to discover with someone watching beside you.

The full catch. Interpreting unusual responses and managing available objects still requires attention. Test how cards or items are selected and moved; do not assume that a playful interface avoids dragging or held actions. The inspected publisher description presents single-player experimentation, not verified native cooperative control.

Try this first. Try a couple of early combinations and watch what happens without demanding immediate progress. Check whether manipulating the items feels comfortable. A companion can suggest an experiment, but the person playing gets to choose which curiosity to follow.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, pens out.

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Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P235 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Pilgrims

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Pilgrims Brought the Wrong Gift and Stayed Anyway

Pilgrims' experiments made me propose three possible ceremonial gifts: the gold pen, the miniature hotel or a voucher for a photograph beside my portrait.

Rae rejected the last one before I finished saying complimentary.

Mika kept the hotel. Nia wanted the pen to remain available for its stated purpose. June asked whether anyone had a decent biscuit.

Rosa produced a plate. The summit's gift policy solved itself without selecting from my elaborate options.

The game's odd combinations and reactions could be enjoyed as discoveries. Our guests were good at similar surprises: Remy offered Dez his tiny paper crown; she used it to prop up her biscuit napkin.

Velvet admired the transformation. Kit asked whether the crown now governed refreshments. Remy said it was his most successful reign.

I offered Shawna the photography voucher privately. She wrote something on the back and handed it to me.

It was a promise to dance after the signing. Nigga, at last an experimental combination had produced a result better than the object I started with.

Aiden's verdict. Experiment with the little adventure if its unusual responses and gestures appeal. The ceremonial gifts have found useful owners, and my portrait voucher now contains a much better offer.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1049280/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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P236 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Longest Journey

Edition considered: Original PC release

Spend time with April Ryan's journey between parallel universes, following conversations and puzzles through a large imaginative world that can be shared as a story.

What you do. Explore locations, speak with people, examine objects and solve inventory puzzles while following April's changing understanding of the two worlds.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The older PC release needs readability and compatibility checks; long conversations, repeated travel and inventory puzzles add substantial work.

Why it might click. April Ryan moves between parallel universes in a substantial original PC adventure filled with conversations, places and puzzles. Its appeal is spending time with a large imaginative world; another person can share the story and discuss clues beside the player.

The full catch. This older PC release needs a compatibility and readability check on the actual machine. Long dialogue, inventory puzzles, repeated travel and remembering multiple locations add work. Do not infer no timers, no holds or modern interface options from its age or genre.

Try this first. Launch the exact original release, inspect text and save behavior, then hear an opening conversation and try an object interaction. Decide whether the people and world justify the interface effort before treating the title as a promise to finish a very long journey.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P236 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Longest Journey

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Longest Journey Was Across My Own Convention Floor

The Longest Journey made April's passage between worlds sound easier than getting our entire party from the buffet to the signing table.

Velvet had one shoe off. Kit was halfway through a story. Remy was looking for his microphone, which Tank held while Rosa adjusted its stand.

I called for everyone to assemble. Nobody heard because I used the unplugged display microphone I had purchased for photographs.

Rae walked over and asked, in an ordinary voice, whether people were ready. The room began moving.

The older adventure's long conversations and inventory puzzles deserved their own trial. Our present journey needed no additional object beyond the working microphone already in Tank's hand.

June waited for Dez to finish her tea. Nia waited for Rae to put down the plate she was carrying. Shawna waited for me to stop testing the dead microphone.

Then we crossed the room together.

Nigga, two universes may require a heroine, but fifteen feet of carpet occasionally require admitting that your props do not function.

Aiden's verdict. Visit April's older adventure if its people justify the interface and puzzle work. Our own longest journey has ended at the signing table with one properly connected microphone.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/6310/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P237 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Broken Age

Edition considered: PC complete two-act release

Follow two teenagers in very different worlds as they question the lives arranged for them, with expressive characters, voice performances and puzzles linking the adventure.

What you do. Switch between the protagonists, explore their scenes, speak with characters and use objects to solve the developing puzzles.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Two threads and later inventory reasoning add heavy tracking; an approachable opening does not establish simple puzzles throughout.

Why it might click. Vella and Shay navigate very different worlds while trying to take control of their lives. The complete two-act point-and-click adventure combines hand-drawn scenes, voice performances, odd characters and puzzles, with switching between the protagonists part of the structure.

The full catch. Two story threads and inventory reasoning can require remembering details across scenes. Later puzzle complexity should not be inferred from an approachable opening. The developer page supports the premise and point-and-click form, not a full no-timer or no-hold certification. This is shared viewing of a single-player adventure.

Try this first. Hear an opening conversation, try one interaction and look at the character-switching interface. Choose which story to follow by interest. A companion can remember an earlier clue without taking over every decision or explaining a solution before it is wanted.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P237 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Broken Age

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Two Stories Declined One Grand Explanation

Broken Age's two protagonists resisting arranged lives made me offer a unifying interpretation of June and Dez's long dispute. Both women looked immediately suspicious.

'You loved the same club,' I began. 'We know,' June said. 'We were there,' Dez added.

Nia asked whether they wanted separate final statements or a shared one. June wanted to keep her version of the jacket. Dez wanted to keep hers. They both wanted the music available to everyone.

That was enough for a sentence.

The game's linked stories could ask us to follow two threads without pretending they began in the same place. Our agreement could do something smaller and equally useful: settle what happened next.

I put away the explanation I had prepared about generations and healing. Shawna touched my arm. 'You can just witness it.'

Rae passed June the pen. Nia steadied the page. Dez watched the first signature appear.

Nobody's whole life had been solved. One piece of paper had finally become worth signing.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the two-world story if its later puzzle tracking appeals. Our witnesses may keep different accounts while signing the same practical sentence about what happens next.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected matched Steam publisher description or manually verified official product page supports the named game, premise and explicit mode features. Unknown controls remain visible; fit and burden are editorial suggestions, not a complete playthrough audit. Checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://www.doublefine.com/games/broken-age>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P238 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Dinkum

Edition considered: PC release; current version status must be checked

Build a town and explore an Australian-inspired landscape with friends, choosing whether default survival or the separate Creative Mode better suits the appeal of making a place.

What you do. Gather resources, farm, build and meet residents, or inspect Creative Mode before deciding which shared town activities to pursue.

Movement + camera | Action continues while you think | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Default play includes wildlife and combat; camera comfort, visitor permissions and some host-only town tasks still need checking.

Why it might click. Explore, gather, farm and build a settlement in an Australian-inspired landscape, meeting residents and inviting friends online. The full PC release combines town creation with survival and also includes a separate Creative Mode, offering a different focus for building.

The full catch. Default play includes wild animals, tools, combat, gathering, crafting and a three-dimensional view. Creative Mode changes building options, not the need to check camera comfort. Official launch notes leave some town quests to the host. Record the installed version rather than relying on old Early Access advice.

Try this first. Try walking, looking around and one modest town task before entering dangerous terrain. Inspect Creative Mode if building is the attraction, then check the chosen multiplayer permissions. Ask whether both players enjoy their available tasks rather than assigning one all the work.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P238 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Dinkum

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Town Host Needed Permission Too

Dinkum's shared town plans made Mika ask who would control the summit's remaining decorations after tonight. I answered as though ownership were an atmospheric quality surrounding my jacket. Rae asked who had actually built the useful pieces. Mika raised a hand. Kit raised one. Remy lifted the repaired arch. Velvet pointed at the light she had helped position.

Nia wrote that people could take their own contributions home, borrow by asking and leave unwanted ornaments for the person who bought them.

Everybody looked at me. Nigga, the portrait had become an unusually specific weather front.

The game's modes and visitor permissions needed checking before promising equal freedom. Our room needed the same ordinary clarity about whose thing was whose.

June returned the old jacket to Dez. Dez immediately offered it back for the walk to the car. This time June asked how long.

Dez returned the old jacket to June. Then Dez asked to borrow it for the walk to the car. June asked how long.

'Until you're cold,' Dez said.

Aiden’s verdict. Build the town if the chosen mode and visitor roles suit. Our borrowing agreement has successfully returned one jacket and left the portrait with its extensively documented purchaser.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched PC Steam description supports Australian-inspired survival, farming and online cooperation. Official launch announcements explicitly confirm the April 23, 2025 UTC exit from Early Access, Creative Mode and revised multiplayer permissions. Some town/building quests remain host-only in those launch notes. Current build behavior still needs checking; observed September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1062520/>

Source 2: https://store.steampowered.com/news/posts/?appids=1062520&enddate=1745490680&feed=steam_community_announcements

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P239 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Farm Together

Edition considered: PC first game

Grow and decorate a shared farm that keeps moving while you are offline, making return visits part of the pleasure without requiring continuous attendance from players.

What you do. Plant and tend crops, care for animals, arrange the farm and set permissions for friends helping with the ongoing work.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Repeated tending and expansion can become a workload; check camera controls, menus and permissions, and remember this is the first game.

Why it might click. Grow crops, keep animals, decorate a farm and invite other players to cultivate it together. The first Farm Together explicitly lets time progress while you are offline, creating a place that can be revisited rather than requiring continuous attendance.

The full catch. Repeated tending, expansion, currencies, waiting and item menus can become a workload. Movement and camera handling need a direct check. Online farm permissions matter when sharing; the source does not establish every activity as untimed or hold-free. This card covers the first game, not its sequel.

Try this first. Plant or tend one small area and inspect how a friend joins and what they may change. Try camera movement and a basic interaction. Decide whether returning to growing things feels pleasant without agreeing to an attendance schedule.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P239 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Farm Together

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Farm Kept Growing While the Pen Went Around

Farm Together's continuing little tasks made Tank wonder whether a place could carry on without its host supervising every minute. Rae looked at me. Nia looked at me. Shawna spared a glance.

I said I was sensing an unrelated agenda.

Rosa liked the idea of returning to a shared farm for a modest job. She also liked the right to leave it alone when dinner, sleep or other people sounded better.

June passed the signed page to Dez. Dez read the jukebox sentence once more, smiled and added her name. Nia signed beneath the agreed final wording with her magnificent, terrible handwriting.

Rae recognised it anyway.

The game's persistent work could become pleasant or burdensome depending on what people wanted. Our charter settled that nobody owed a game attendance simply because someone else loved it.

I signed last and discovered the portrait line had not secretly improved.

Shawna kissed my cheek. 'Congratulations, baby. Peace is official.'

'And expensive.' 'That part was official when you ordered the frame.'

Aiden's verdict. Return to the shared farm if its ongoing tasks remain pleasant. The coalition is signed, participation stays voluntary, and the portrait's continuing existence does not create collective financial responsibility.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified Steam app 673950 is the first Farm Together, published by Milkstone Studios. Product description explicitly supports shared farming, permissions and time advancing offline. These claims are not imported from Farm Together 2; exact control comfort remains untested.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/673950/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, take turns.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P240 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Staxel

Edition considered: PC release

Restore a farm and shape a blocky village with friends online, sharing one place or becoming neighbours while building projects give the world personal character.

What you do. Move around the world, place building materials, grow crops and help villagers, coordinating a small farm or construction project with friends.

Movement + camera | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. First-person camera movement, crafting and precise block placement add demands; establish the session setup and check sustained inputs before building.

Why it might click. Restore a farm, meet villagers and alter a voxel world through building and cultivation. The PC game explicitly supports online cooperation, allowing friends to share a farm or become neighbours while making their own projects.

The full catch. First-person movement, camera steering, selecting materials, crafting and placing blocks can create substantial coordination and menu demands. Farming tasks add routine work. The publisher's creative premise does not certify no holds, no timed activities or a frictionless multiplayer setup.

Try this first. Try looking around, moving through a doorway and placing or interacting with a simple object. If sharing online, establish who owns the session and how both people join. Choose one small project only after the controls feel worth using.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P240 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Staxel

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Village Had Enough Room for a Dance

Staxel's shared village made Mika place the last two figures inside the miniature hotel. Rae and Nia stood on its little dance floor. My figure remained near the loading dock.

'A strong logistical role,' I said. 'A safe distance from the music controls,' Kit replied.

The signed agreement lay beneath the lamp. June and Dez had chosen different songs. Both selections would play. June's jacket waited over Dez's arm, borrowed again by asking.

The game's building and first-person controls still needed an actual trial. Our constructed room had already passed a simpler test: people could see, sit, leave and find each other.

Mercedes began the chosen music. Nia held out her hand to Rae. Rae took it without requesting another furniture inspection.

I offered Shawna my own hand. 'No introduction?' she asked. 'I'm trying a local custom.'

She came close. Velvet laughed beside the stage, Remy finally played the right fanfare, and nobody looked toward my portrait for permission.

Nigga, the place had become ours without becoming mine.

Aiden's verdict. Make a shared place if its camera and building demands suit. Our finished room offers a dance, an open door and absolutely no reimbursement for the face above it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified Steam app 405710 is Staxel, with explicit online co-op and shared-farm or neighbour play in the publisher description. Voxel building, village life and crops are supported. Camera workload and first trial are editorial checks, not access certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/405710/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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Everybody Chose a Song; Nobody Bought My Face

The signatures were real. June wrote slowly, Dez added hers with a seamstress's steady care, and Nia's name crossed the line like an adventurous bird. Rae recognised it and signed beside it. The others followed in an order nobody would need to defend for sixty years.

Dez unfolded the old rental invoice while Nia checked the new names. June pointed at her own 1967 signature. Dez turned the paper over. Hers was on the back.

Both women stared. 'You signed the wrong side,' June said. 'You read the wrong side,' Dez replied. Nigga, I had hired a convention floor to resolve a failure to turn over one sheet.

I signed last. The portrait still received no reimbursement.

'Perhaps a commemorative allowance,' I murmured.

Shawna took the pen from my hand. 'Perhaps enjoy your wife.'

Nigga, finally a motion I could support without amendment.

The agreement protected an ordinary evening. Choose a game, ask for help, watch or decline. Stop when you want. Share the actual controls by agreement. Let different interests occupy the same room without drafting a winner.

Dez returned the jacket to June, then asked to borrow it for the walk downstairs. June said yes, provided it came back before another jukebox became obsolete.

'You make me sound unreliable,' Dez said.

'Only with sleeves,' June replied.

They laughed. The Blue Comet war ended without anyone fixing the weather in the official account.

June's chosen jukebox song played first. Dez tapped the table, pretending she had not liked it since 1967. Her own choice followed, and June sang the chorus incorrectly with magnificent commitment.

Then Mercedes began the song Rae and Nia had chosen.

Nia put her pen down and held out her hand. Rae took it and stood. No further invitation. No scheduling language. They walked onto the floor as two women who had spent the evening finding each other interesting and now wanted to be close.

Nia counted one step, caught Rae smiling and stopped counting aloud. Rae laughed softly. Nia drew a little nearer. Their first turn was imperfect and entirely theirs.

I signalled the photographer out of habit. Porsche touched his arm before he moved. Rae glanced over, shook her head once, and the camera stayed down.

Shawna took both my hands. 'Your turn.'

'For the photograph?'

'For me, nigga.'

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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I followed her onto the floor. The giant portrait watched from above, useful at last because it could not interrupt.

Velvet finished her number to the applause it deserved. Remy's fanfare arrived at the right moment and still contained the terrible pun. Kit sang. Rosa leaned against Tank; Dre collected the casserole dish only after checking nobody wanted more.

Mika placed the model hotel beside the signed agreement. Its little door remained open.

Later, Dez draped half the borrowed jacket across June's shoulders while they waited for the lift. June pretended the division needed measuring. Dez pulled her closer and said the seam allowance was generous.

The hotel manager handed me the portrait transport charge.

I looked at Shawna. She looked back with no intention of rescuing my budget and every intention of staying beside me.

I paid it.

Then I folded the receipt, put it in my own pocket and returned to the woman holding out her hand. Peace had its own music. For once, I did not need to introduce the singer.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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